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PREFACE

CivicCentre IAS proudly presents the Andhra Pradesh Group – I Mains Previous Year Questions (PYQs) with Model Answers Book — a highly useful resource for aspirants of APPSC and other competitive examinations. This meticulously prepared compilation provides comprehensive coverage of the entire syllabus, encompassing both static content and recent developments.

Since its inception, CivicCentre IAS has remained committed to delivering quality, precise and reliable material that enables students to excel in their preparation. The consistent efforts of Team CivicCentre IAS have ensured that our resources remain precise, relevant and comprehensive.

This Mains PYQs Book with Detailed Model Answers is a strategic tool to decode question patterns, understand examiner expectations, and master answer structure. Through well-framed model answers, aspirants learn effective Introduction–Body–Conclusion presentation, multi-dimensional analysis, and value addition. It strengthens analytical clarity, improves articulation, and builds confidence for the APPSC Group-1 Mains Examination while ensuring focused, trend-aligned preparation.

This achievement has been made possible through the collective hard work and dedication of our team. We also extend our heartfelt gratitude to the various sources and references that have enriched this work. In particular, this compilation has benefited immensely from the websites and publications of the Government of India which have provided authentic and valuable insights.

This book has been meticulously compiled to aid aspirants in mastering the key concepts for competitive examinations. We value student feedback, which drives our continuous improvement. Please share suggestions at response@civiccentre.in to help us enhance future compilations.

We would also like to express our gratitude and our sincere thanks to the Director of CivicCentre IAS, Mr. Venkat Chola for his unwavering support and guidance throughout this endeavor.

We, the CivicCentre Team, wish you all the best in your continuous efforts to support students on their journey to success.

Thank You.
Team CivicCentre

Thematic Area	Mains PYQs | Paper-III	Marks	Year
A. Indian Polity and Constitution			
1. Indian Constitution and its salient features - Functions and duties of the Indian Union and the State Governments			
(i) Indian Constitution and its Salient features	1. The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights?	10	APPSC 2025
	2. "Although borrowed from different sources, Indian Constitution is a unique document". Critically examine.	10	TGPSC 2024
	3. Why did we adopt federalism with a strong central government? Explain the important provisions that create a strong central government.	10	APPSC 2020
	4. "The Indian constitution is federal in form but unitary in spirit" –Discuss.	10	APPSC 2016
	5. It is said that basic structure of the constitution is a myth. Explain with the help of post-1973 Constitutional Amendments.	10	TGPSC 2016
	6. Is the conduct of the free and fair elections a basic feature of the constitution? Discuss the significant role of the Election commission for the conduct of free and fair elections.	10	TGPSC 2016
	7. Explain the significance of the preamble to the constitution. Discuss whether the preamble is the source of Constitutional power.	10	TGPSC 2016
	8. Is India a Federation?	10	APPSC 2008
(ii) Functions and duties of the Indian Union and the State Governments	9. The Indian Constitution favours a federal type of government. Considering this, what duties does the Constitution place on State Governments to ensure the smooth functioning of the nation?	10	APPSC 2025
2. Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure — Role of Governor in States - Distribution of powers between the Union and States (Union list, State list and Concurrent list) — Issues and challenges			
(i) Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure	10. Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council and discuss its relevance in the context of Centre-State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in India.	10	APPSC 2023
	11. "In spite of unitary features of the Constitution, federalism survived in India". Comment.	10	APPSC 2017
	12. Describe the formation and functions of Inter-State Council. State some of the important decisions taken by the Inter-State Council in the last 3 years.	10	APPSC 2017
	13. Do you agree with the view that functions are given to the states while resources are with the centre?	10	APPSC 2008
(ii) Role of Governor in States	14. The office of the Governor in certain situations carries with it the exercise of 'discretionary functions' and 'special responsibilities. Discuss this statement in view of the constitutional provisions.	10	APPSC 2023

	15. Explain the role of Governor in states by focusing on its powers and functions.	10	APPSC 2020
(iii) Distribution of powers between the Union and States	16. The procedure of enacting a law from a bill differs at the Union and State levels, primarily to safeguard the interests of the Union Government in state legislation. Elucidate this aspect.	10	APPSC 2025
	17. Are Direct taxes transferable or non-transferable? Explain the recent Direct Tax Reforms undertaken in India.	10	APPSC 2023
	18. What is concept of cooperative federalism? Does it exist in India?	10	APPSC 2016
	19. Discuss the administrative relations between the Union and the States. How are Inter State Water Disputes resolved in India?	10	APPSC 2012
	20. Give instances wherein the Constitution provides control of the Union over the States.	10	APPSC 2011
3. Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment - Constitutional Authorities and their Role			
(i) Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment	21. Discuss the significance of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in strengthening grassroots democracy in India.	10	APPSC 2024
	22. Discuss the scope and challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj. Briefly suggest on how to enhance women empowerment in rural and urban local governance.	10	APPSC 2023
	23. Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendment of the Indian Constitution.	10	APPSC 2020
	24. Describe the salient features of the Rural and Urban Local Governance under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Act.	10	APPSC 2020
	25. Critically examine the implementations of the 73rd and 74th Amendments. How far is it effective?	10	TGPSC 2016
	26. Panchayati Raj is a "God that failed"-Evaluate	10	APPSC 2008
(ii) Constitutional Authorities and their Role	27. The Finance Commission is considered the backbone of fiscal federalism in India. Examine its role and significance in maintaining the financial balance between the Union and the States.	10	APPSC 2025
	28. 'The Finance Commission, though not being a permanent body, has still maintained its credibility by promoting fiscal democracy in India' - Comment.	10	APPSC 2023
	29. Briefly describe the recommendations of 14th Finance Commission with regard to devolution of funds to rural local bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions). What measures have been implemented by the Government of India for monitoring and audit of the finances of Panchayati Raj institutions?	10	APPSC 2017
	30. What is the difference between a National party and a Regional party, in case of parties recognised by the Election Commission of India? Explain the features of the Indian party system.	10	APPSC 2017

	31. Mention the important events in usage of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) in elections in India. Analyse the recent allegations on tampering of EVMs and suggest solutions.	10	APPSC 2017
	32. Discuss the powers and functions of the Election Commission of India and explain its role in protection of representative democracy in India.	10	APPSC 2012
	33. "The Comptroller and Auditor-General of India is a friend, philosopher and guide of Public Accounts Committee"- Discuss	10	APPSC 2008
4. Parliament and State Legislatures — structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these			
(i) Parliament-Structure,Powers and Functions	34. 'The powers of the Parliament to amend the Constitution of India is limited'. Examine with examples.	10	TGPSC 2024
	35. Briefly discuss the different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament. Comment on the difference between motions and resolutions.	10	APPSC 2023
	36. Differentiate between the powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha on the basis of the following parameters: functions and control over election. Explain, with reasons, the powers that are exercised only by the Lok Sabha.	10	APPSC 2020
	37. What is office of profit? Critically analyse the developments in India on this issue.	10	APPSC 2020
	38. What is the relative position of the Rajya Sabha as compared to the Lok Sabha in our political system?	10	APPSC 2020
	39. There is no constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings. Explain with reference to leading cases.	10	APPSC 2011
	40. Comment on the declining trend of legislative debates.	10	APPSC 2008
(ii) State Legislature-Powers and Functions	41. Although States have their separate list for law-making, this authority is not beyond the overarching legislative powers of the Parliament. Examine.	10	APPSC 2025
	42. In what aspects is the Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) different from the Rajya Sabha, considering its role at the state level?	10	APPSC 2025
	43. Describe the matters in which the Legislative Council stands equal with the Legislative Assembly along with the matters in which it stands unequal with the Legislative Assembly.	10	APPSC 2023
	44. Explain the conflict resolution mechanism in case of deadlock between the two houses of a State legislature on a piece of legislation.	10	APPSC 2011
(iii) Legislative Privileges	45. Define Privileges of state legislature and classify it into two broad categories.	10	APPSC 2020
	46. Explain the privileges and immunities of legislature under the Constitution of India. How far can the judiciary interfere with such privileges and immunities?	10	APPSC 2012
5. Judiciary in India — Structure and functions, important provisions relating to emergency and constitutional amendments, judicial review, Public Interest Litigation			

(i) Judiciary in India - Structure and functions	47. Discuss any two constitutional amendments that have significantly affected the powers and functioning of the Indian Judiciary.	10	APPSC 2025
	48. The principle of Natural Justice plays a significant role in adjudication of cases in administrative tribunals'-Comment.	10	TGPSC 2024
	49. What according to the Supreme Court constitutes "the basic structure of our constitution? Please name a couple of important judgements of our constitution? Please name a couple of important judgements of the Supreme Court on this issue?	10	APPSC-2016
	50. What are the principle adopted by the Courts in an irreconcilable conflict between a law made by the Parliament and a law made by the State legislature?	10	APPSC 2011
(ii) Important provisions relating to Emergency and Constitutional Amendments	51. Discuss the constitutional provisions regarding state formation. Is a constitutional amendment necessary to bring a new state into exercise?	10	TGPSC 2016
	52. Discuss how the 42nd Amendment which introduced the clauses (4) and (5) to Article 368 prevents judicial review of Constitutional Amendments.	10	TGPSC 2016
	53. Describe the procedure for amending the constitution? What is the criticism against it?	10	APPSC 2016
	54. Analyse the Constitutional Amendments made so far in relation to the Fundamental Rights guaranteed under Part III of the Constitution.	10	APPSC 2012
	55. Write a critical note on the Emergency Powers under the Constitution and their misuse, if any.	10	APPSC 2012
	56. Explain the Constitutional guarantee to the Right to property in the light of the 44th Amendment Act.	10	APPSC 2011
	57. "Article 356 is more misused than used"-Comment.	10	APPSC 2008
(iii) Judicial Review	58. Define Judicial Review with special reference to the classification given by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri. Describe the importance and scope of Judicial Review.	10	APPSC 2020
	59. Distinguish between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism and also cite the important decisions of the Supreme Court on the two subjects.	10	APPSC 2017
	60. Discuss the grounds on which administrative action may be reviewed by the judiciary, and the various modes of such judicial review.	10	APPSC 2012
	61. What are the novel trends in Judicial Review?	10	APPSC 2008
(iv) Public Interest Litigation	62. What is meant by Public Interest Litigation (PIL)? Describe the nature of court orders that are passed by courts in PIL cases.	10	APPSC 2023
	63. Define judicial activism with special reference to PIL and SAL. Judicial activism has had manifold impact on the political system. Justify the statement adding suitable examples.	10	APPSC 2020
	64. What is meant by "judicial activism"? What is its impact on Indian polity?	10	APPSC 2016

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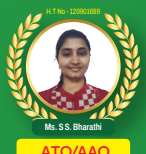

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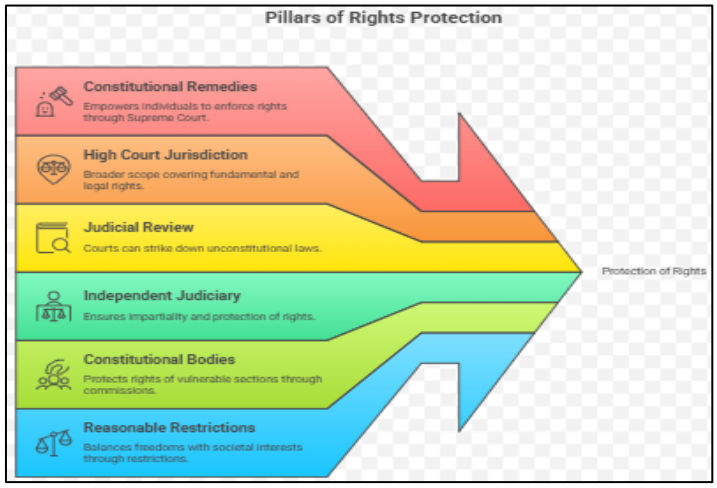
Mains PYQs | Paper-III | Section-A | Model Answers

A. Indian Polity and Constitution

1. Indian Constitution and its salient features - Functions and duties of the Indian Union and the State Governments

1. The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights? (APPSC, 2025)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	What
Approach	• Give an introduction by mentioning that fundamental Rights need protective mechanisms. • Judicial review, writ remedies, reasonable restrictions, independent judiciary, special provisions for vulnerable groups. • Give a conclusion by ensuring rights remain meaningful in a democratic framework.
Introduction	The Constitution of India enshrines Fundamental Rights in Part III (Articles 12–35) to ensure liberty, equality, and justice to all citizens. Recognizing that rights can be threatened by arbitrary state action or societal forces, the Constitution incorporates several safeguards such as judicial, constitutional, and institutional mechanisms, to protect these rights.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Constitutional Arrangements for the Protection of Rights of citizens:** • **Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32)** ✓ This Article is called the "heart and soul" of the Constitution by B.R. Ambedkar. ✓ It empowers individuals to directly approach the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights. ✓ The Writs Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari, and Quo Warranto come under this Article. ✓ **Example: Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar (1979)** ✓ The Supreme Court upheld the right to a speedy trial as an essential part of Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty), emphasizing that delays in the judicial process violate fundamental rights.  • **High Court Writ Jurisdiction (Article 226)** ✓ It has a broader scope than Article 32, covering both Fundamental and legal rights. ✓ **Example:** People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) v. Union of India (2003): Right to know candidates' criminal records.

	• **Doctrine of Judicial Review:** ✓ The Indian courts have the power to strike down unconstitutional laws and executive actions. ✓ **Example:** The Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) introduced the Basic Structure Doctrine. • **Independent Judiciary:** ✓ Security of tenure, fixed salaries, and separation of powers ensure impartiality. ✓ It enables courts to act as guardians of rights without political interference. • **Constitutional and Statutory Bodies** ✓ National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), National Commission for Women (NCW), National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR), and SC/ST Commissions safeguard the rights of vulnerable sections. • **Reasonable Restrictions and Constitutional Balance:** ✓ While Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees essential freedoms such as speech, assembly, movement, and profession, clauses (2) to (6) introduce reasonable restrictions to ensure these rights do not conflict with broader societal interests.
Conclusion	Thus, the Indian Constitution not only grants rights but also creates robust enforcement mechanisms to ensure they are meaningful. Through constitutional remedies, judicial review, and independent institutions, it upholds the rule of law and protects citizens from arbitrary action, thereby strengthening India's democratic fabric.
Model Question	The Constitution of India not only enumerates rights but also provides mechanisms to protect them. Examine the constitutional safeguards available to ensure the effective protection of citizens' rights.
Value Addition	• **Writs under Article 32 of the Constitution:** ✓ **Habeas Corpus:** ▪ It is a Latin term that means "to have the body of." This writ is an order issued by a court to a person who has detained another individual, compelling them to produce the detained person before the court. ▪ The court then examines the reasons and legality behind the detention. ▪ If the detention is found to be unlawful, the court will order the immediate release of the detained person. ▪ The writ of Habeas Corpus can be issued against both public authorities and private individuals. ✓ **Mandamus:** ▪ Mandamus means "we command." ▪ It is a directive issued by a court to a public official, compelling them to perform a duty that they are legally obligated to fulfil but have either failed or refused to do. ▪ This writ can also be issued to public bodies, corporations, lower courts, tribunals, or government agencies to ensure they perform their official duties. ✓ **Prohibition:** ▪ Prohibition means "to forbid." ▪ This writ is issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal, preventing it from acting beyond its legal authority or jurisdiction it does not have. ▪ While Mandamus commands an authority to take action, Prohibition specifically orders an authority to refrain from continuing proceedings that are outside its jurisdiction ✓ **Certiorari:** ▪ Certiorari means "to be certified" or "to be informed."

	▪ This writ is issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal, either to transfer a case to itself or to quash the decision made by the lower authority. ▪ It is issued when there has been an excess or lack of jurisdiction, or when there is an error in the application of law. ▪ Unlike Prohibition, which only prevents future actions, Certiorari can be both preventive and corrective, addressing past legal errors ✓ **Quo Warranto:** ▪ Quo Warranto means "by what authority or warrant." ▪ This writ is issued by a court to inquire into the legality of a person's claim to hold a public office. It serves to prevent the unlawful occupation of a public office by someone without proper legal authority.
2. "Although borrowed from different sources, the Indian Constitution is a unique document". Critically examine. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Critically Examine
Approach	• Brief introduction about the Indian Constitution in general and the features it borrowed but tailored them for India's needs. • Mention the features borrowed by the Indian Constitution and highlight how these features are tailored as per India's socio-political context. • List out the limitations of these features in the Indian context, in other words, weigh strengths vs tensions. • Conclusion in a balanced verdict - borrowed in form, unique in spirit.
Introduction	The Indian Constitution consciously borrowed institutional forms and doctrines from many constitutions (UK, USA, Canada, Ireland, Australia, Japan, USSR, Government of India Act 1935) but recast them into a distinctive constitutional architecture aimed at India's social, political and developmental realities.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Borrowed elements of the Indian Constitution** • Parliamentary system, Rule of Law, Cabinet responsibility from the British model. • Fundamental Rights (written bill), judicial review influenced by the USA. • Federal structure with a strong Centre, residuary powers are drawn from Canada and the Government of India Act, 1935. • Directive Principles are inspired by Ireland. • Fundamental Duties show Soviet influence. • Concurrent lists, joint sittings are influenced by the Australian Constitution. **Indianisation — how the Constitution is unique:**

	• The Constituent Assembly did not mechanically copy clauses; it selected, modified and combined features to meet India's diversity, development goals and anti-colonial ethos. • The Preamble's blend — "Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic" — and the inclusion of Directive Principles alongside enforceable Fundamental Rights reflect this synthesis. • Institutional adaptations (e.g., a ceremonial President with emergency powers, single citizenship, strong Centre) show pragmatic tailoring to Indian realities. The official text and Constituent Assembly debates record these conscious choices. **Critical examination of the Indian Constitution** • **Strengths:** ✓ Plural borrowing gave India tested institutional tools while the Constitution's flexibility (amendment process) and judicial guardianship (basic structure doctrine) secured core values against majoritarian drift. • **Tensions:** ✓ Selective borrowing produced contradictions — a formally federal polity with centralising features, ambitious socio-economic commitments that pressurise state capacity and recurring debates over judicial activism versus democratic choice. These are visible in landmark cases and continuing political contestation.
Conclusion	The Constitution is thus both borrowed and original: it uses comparative models as building blocks but integrates them into a context-sensitive, evolving document — a unique constitutional achievement that retains tensions requiring constant democratic negotiation.
Model Question	Critically examine the interplay between the Salient Features and the Basic Structure, especially in protecting democratic values in India.
Value Addition	B.R. Ambedkar called the Constitution "both unitary and federal according to the requirements of time and circumstances." Granville Austin termed it "a seamless web" of rights, principles, and structures — highlighting its pragmatic blend of global best practices with indigenous needs, making it adaptable yet rooted in Indian realities.
3. Why did we adopt federalism with a strong central government? Explain the important provisions that create a strong central government. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Why, Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining federalism and highlighting why India adopted a federal structure with a strong central government in its historical context. • Explain the constitutional provisions, historical reasons, and institutional mechanisms that give the Centre dominance, supported by relevant Articles, examples, and judicial interpretations. • Conclude by assessing how this centralised federalism balances unity with diversity, ensuring both stability and cooperative governance.
Introduction	India adopted a quasi-federal structure, a union of states with strong central authority to manage its immense diversity in language, religion, ethnicity, and geography. The framers, influenced both by British colonial governance and experiences with federal systems globally, designed a unitary-bias federal model to ensure national unity, effective governance, and socio-economic integration.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Reasons for Adopting Federalism with Strong Centre:** • **Preserving National Unity:**

	✓ Immediately after independence, India faced partition, princely state integration, and communal tensions. A strong centre was essential for keeping the nation intact. • **Ensuring Administrative Efficiency:** ✓ Central coordination enabled the harmonization of policies across diverse regions, promoting developmental uniformity. • **Protecting Fundamental Rights:** ✓ Uniform protection of citizens' rights required a central government with supranational authority. • **Economic Planning & Redistribution:** ✓ Central control over critical sectors such as finance and planning was vital for socioeconomic progress and nation-building. **Key Constitutional Provisions Strengthening the Centre:** • **Legislative Supremacy:** ✓ **Union List & Residuary Power**: Chapter I, Seventh Schedule gives Parliament exclusive legislative power on key issues (eg: Defense, Foreign affairs), and residuary powers under Article 248 extend central reach beyond listed subjects. ✓ **Emergency Provisions**: Articles 352, 356, and 360 allow central intervention in states by legislating on state subjects and suspending state government authority during crises. • **Financial Dominance:** ✓ **Union's Taxation Primacy**: Articles 268–281 designate central control over key revenue sources and limit state fiscal autonomy. ✓ **Centrally Sponsored Schemes & Grants**: Under Articles 275 and 282, the central government disburses revenue and capital grants to states, often with conditionality. • **Executive & Administrative Control:** ✓ **Governors with Central Loyalties**: Appointed by the President under Articles 153–156, Governors act as central agents, ensuring compliance with federal norms. ✓ **All-India Services**: IAS, IPS, and IFS officers, posted in states, ensure administrative uniformity and allegiance to the centre. **Balancing Federalism and the Centre's Strength:** • Although the centre wields extensive powers, the Constitution protects state autonomy through: ✓ Bicameral Legislature & Legislative Councils ✓ Judicial Review via a unified Supreme Court ✓ Federal Structure with devolved powers in the State List
Conclusion	India's adoption of federalism with a strong central government was a pragmatic response to its unique post-independence challenges—ensuring unity, development, and justice. Provisions in the Seventh Schedule, Emergency Powers, fiscal design, and administrative structure consolidate central authority. Yet, built-in constitutional checks preserve state sovereignty, creating a resilient "cooperative federalism" suited to India's complex reality.
Model Question	Examine the role of the Inter-State Council in promoting cooperative federalism in India.
Value Addition	• Even during normal circumstances, the central government has very effective financial powers and responsibilities. In the first place, items generating revenue are under the control of the central government. Thus, the central government has many revenue sources and the States are mostly dependent on the grants and financial assistance from the centre.

	• Secondly, India adopted planning as the instrument of rapid economic progress and development after independence. Planning led to considerable centralization of economic decision-making. The Planning Commission appointed by the Union government is the coordinating machinery that controls and supervises the resource management of the States.
4. " The Indian constitution is federal in form but unitary in spirit" -Discuss (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by defining federalism and explaining the phrase "federal in form but unitary in spirit" with a brief reference to the Constitution's structure. • Discuss federal features and unitary features with examples, case laws to critically examine the balance between the two. • Conclude by summarizing India's model as a pragmatic blend of federal and unitary elements ensuring unity while accommodating diversity.
Introduction	The Indian Constitution reflects a unique blend of federalism and Unitarianism, earning it the description of a 'quasi-federal' or 'cooperative federal' framework. While it divides powers between the Union and States (federal form), it also equips the Centre with overriding authority in certain circumstances (unitary spirit). This design is rooted in India's socio-political diversity and the framers' intention to maintain unity in a heterogeneous society.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Federal Features of the Indian Constitution:** • The Constitution incorporates classical federal elements: ✓ **Division of Powers**: The Seventh Schedule distributes legislative competence into Union, State, and Concurrent Lists, limiting encroachment. ✓ **Dual Polity**: Independent governments function at Union and State levels, with separate executive and legislature. ✓ **Bicameralism**: Rajya Sabha safeguards States' interests in the legislative process. ✓ **Independent Judiciary**: Articles 131 and 136 enable dispute resolution between Centre and States. ✓ **Partly Rigid Constitution**: Amendments affecting federal provisions require ratification by half the States (Article 368). ✓ Supreme Court in S. R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994**)** held that federalism as part of the Constitution's basic structure, limiting misuse of Article 356. • These features establish the federal form, ensuring regional autonomy and representation. **Unitary Features of the Indian Constitution:** • However, certain provisions tilt the balance towards the Centre: ✓ **Residuary Powers:** Article 248 vests these in Parliament**.** ✓ **Single Constitution & Citizenship:** Unlike federations like the USA, States lack separate constitutions or citizenship. ✓ **All-India Services:** IAS, IPS, and IFS maintain uniform administrative standards under central control. ✓ **Financial Centralization:** Union controls major revenue sources; States depend on Finance Commission transfers. ✓ **Emergency Provisions**: Articles 352, 356, and 360 allow the Union to assume State functions, centralizing power during crises.

	• Supreme Court in State of West Bengal v. Union of India (1963) affirmed that India's federalism is not strictly comparable to classical federations, Parliament can legislate even on State matters under certain conditions. • These traits embody the unitary spirit, ensuring decisive national governance. **Recent issues related to Federalism:** • **Governor's Veto Curbed**: In State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor of Tamil Nadu (2025), the Supreme Court ruled that Governors cannot apply pocket or absolute vetoes to legislative bills, reinforcing state autonomy. • **Federal Pushback on Central Regulation**: Kerala's Industries Minister criticized the Centre's unilateral 2025 Offshore Area Atomic Minerals Regulations that enable private mineral mining without state consultation. • **Delimitation Debate**: Southern states like Tamil Nadu fear the impending delimitation (with the freeze ending in 2026) could diminish their representation, raising concerns about federal equity and political marginalization.
Conclusion	The Indian Constitution's design is a pragmatic fusion, federal in structure but unitary in operation when needed. This "holding together" federation allows India to preserve unity without sacrificing diversity, embodying cooperative federalism in normal times and competitive centralism in exigencies.
Model Question	Evaluate the role of the Supreme Court in interpreting and protecting the basic structure of the Constitution.
Value Addition	• The founding fathers of the Indian Constitution were deeply concerned about ensuring the unity and integrity of the country. They were aware of the forces of disruption and disunity working within the country. These changes, at the time of independence, could be handled only by a strong government at the Centre. • Hence, the framers of the Constitution assigned a predominate role to the Centre. At the same time they made provisions for the establishment of a co- operative federalism. It is also a fact that during the working of the last six decades, the relations between the Centre and the States have not always been cordial.
5. It is said that the basic structure of the Constitution is a myth. Explain with the help of the post-1973 Constitutional Amendments. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Introduce by briefly explaining the Basic Structure Doctrine, its origin in Kesavananda Bharati (1973), and why it is considered a judicial innovation without explicit constitutional mention. • Critically examine key post-1973 amendments and landmark judgments to assess whether the doctrine has consistently restrained Parliament or is selectively applied, supporting with case laws and scholarly debates. • Conclude by balancing its role as a constitutional safeguard with criticisms of vagueness and judicial overreach, addressing whether its "myth" label is justified.
Introduction	The Basic Structure Doctrine, propounded in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), limits Parliament's amending power under Article 368 by safeguarding core constitutional features like democracy, secularism, federalism, and judicial review. While hailed as the "Constitution's safety valve," critics argue it is a judicially-created concept without an explicit textual basis, making it a "myth" in the sense that its scope and contents are determined entirely by the Supreme Court, often in conflict with Parliament's supremacy.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Why is the Basic Structure of the Constitution called a 'Myth'?** • **No explicit mention in the Constitution:** The doctrine is a judicial invention, not a textual provision. • **Indeterminate scope:** The Supreme Court has never provided an exhaustive list of what constitutes basic structure, leading to subjective expansion. • **Judicial supremacy concerns:** Parliamentarians and some scholars view it as the judiciary overstepping into the legislative domain. • **Selective application:** Not all constitutional changes affecting governance have been tested against the doctrine. **Post-1973 Constitutional Amendments and the Basic Structure Doctrine** • **42nd Constitutional Amendment (1976):** ✓ Known as the "Mini-Constitution," it attempted to give primacy to Directive Principles over Fundamental Rights and curtailed judicial review. ✓ Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980) struck down parts of the amendment, holding limited amending power, a balance between FRs and DPSPs, and judicial review as part of the basic structure. • **44th Constitutional Amendment (1978):** ✓ Reversed Emergency-era distortions, restored certain rights, and reduced misuse of Article 352. ✓ Seen as consistent with the basic structure, but critics say it reflects that Parliament can still fundamentally alter governance when aligned with judicial approval. • **73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992–93):** ✓ Introduced Panchayati Raj and Urban Local Bodies, altering federalism's working. ✓ Not tested against basic structure but significantly changed the power distribution. • **97th Constitutional Amendment (2011):** ✓ Gave constitutional status to cooperative societies. ✓ Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah (2021) struck down provisions affecting State cooperatives for violating federalism (part of basic structure). • **99th Constitutional Amendment (2014):** ✓ Established NJAC for judicial appointments. ✓ Struck down in Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association v. Union of India **(2015)** for violating judicial independence. **Criticism of Basic Structure Doctrine:** • Critics argue this violates the principle of separation of powers as the judiciary is seen as reading into the Constitution something that the framers did not intend. • The Supreme Court has never provided an exhaustive list of what constitutes the basic structure. • By allowing unelected judges to determine the "spirit" of the Constitution, the doctrine may override democratic processes and amendment procedures under Article 368. • Critics believe certain reservation-related amendments or electoral reforms could be stalled if perceived as affecting "equality" or "democracy" in the Court's view. **Contemporary Debates:** • **Delhi Ordinance Case (2023–24):** SC upheld the elected government's primacy in services, citing federalism as basic structure. • **One Nation, One Election proposal:** Critics warn of undermining federal character.

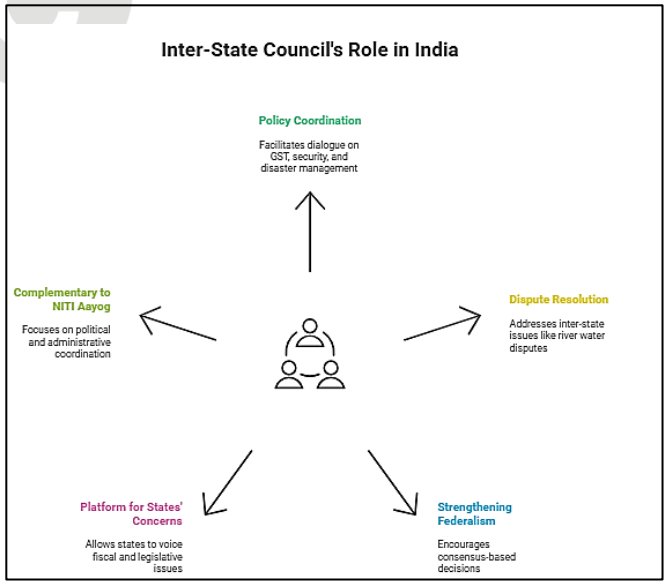
	• **CJI Gavai's remarks:** Rewriting the Constitution is against democracy; indirect affirmation of the basic structure's role.
Conclusion	While the Basic Structure Doctrine has prevented authoritarian amendments (Minerva Mills, NJAC Case), its judicially-crafted nature, lack of precise definition, and selective application have led to accusations of it being a "myth." Yet, in the absence of this doctrine, post-1973 amendments like the 42nd could have permanently altered India's democratic and constitutional identity. Thus, it remains a paradox, both a judicial safeguard and a contested construct.
Model Question	Evaluate whether the Basic Structure Doctrine strikes the right balance between parliamentary sovereignty and constitutional supremacy.
Value Addition	Fundamental Rights are human rights and, therefore, natural rights, which are not conferred by the Constitution of India to be taken away. Sarv Mittra Sikri, the 13th Chief Justice of India, has been proven right in subsequent judgments of the Supreme Court. Most notably, the decisions in *I.R. Coelho vs. State of Tamil Nadu* (2007) and *Justice K.S. Puttaswamy (Retd.) vs. Union of India* (2017**)** have recognized that this is indeed the position and have overruled judgments to the contrary. Parliament itself has recognized the Basic Structure Doctrine by amending Article 359(1), so that even when a proclamation of emergency is in operation, Articles 20 and 21 can never be suspended. - Justice Rohinton Nariman
6. Is the conduct of free and fair elections a basic feature of the constitution? Discuss the significant role of the Election Commission in the conduct of free and fair elections. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• State that free and fair elections are part of the Constitution's basic structure**,** upheld by the Supreme Court as essential to democracy. • Explain the constitutional provisions, judicial rulings, and the ECI's key functions ensuring impartial, transparent elections. • Emphasize that ECI safeguards democratic legitimacy by upholding electoral integrity.
Introduction	Free and fair elections form the bedrock of India's parliamentary democracy. The Supreme Court has recognised them as part of the basic structure of the Constitution, ensuring the legitimacy of governance and the peaceful transfer of power.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional & Judicial Basis for free and fair elections, forming a basic feature of the constitution:** • **Articles 324–329**: ✓ Provide the framework for elections, vesting superintendence, direction, and control in the Election Commission of India (ECI). • **Representation of the People Acts, 1950 & 1951**: ✓ Regulate voter rolls, qualifications/disqualifications, conduct of polls, and corrupt practices. • **Judicial Interpretation**: ✓ Indira Nehru Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975): Free and fair elections are part of the basic structure. ✓ Mohinder Singh Gill v. CEC (1978): ECI's plenary powers under Article 324. ✓ ADR (2002), PUCL (2003): Candidate disclosure of assets/criminal records. ✓ Subramanian Swamy v. ECI (2013): Introduction of VVPAT for transparency. **Significant Role of the ECI in the conduct of free and fair elections**

	• **Superintendence of Elections** – Deciding schedules, symbols, deployment of staff/security forces. • **Maintaining Electoral Rolls** – Purification, duplication checks, and inclusivity (Art. 325). • **Ensuring Level Playing Field** – Enforcing the Model Code of Conduct and curbing hate speech, paid news, and misuse of official machinery. • **Curbing Malpractices** – Expense monitoring, cVIGIL app, seizure of illicit inducements. • **Technology for Transparency** – Use of EVMs with VVPAT, webcasting, booth-wise turnout data. • **Voter Awareness** – **SVEEP** campaigns, accessibility for PwD and elderly voters.
Conclusion	The conduct of free and fair elections is a non-negotiable constitutional mandate and part of the basic structure. Through its constitutional authority, statutory powers and judicial backing, the ECI safeguards political equality, transparency, and democratic legitimacy, ensuring that the will of the people is faithfully reflected in governance.
Model Question	"Discuss the constitutional status, powers and functions of the Election Commission of India. Examine the challenges it faces in ensuring free and fair elections in the country."
Value Addition	The ECI's recent measures: Green Elections initiative to reduce poll-related carbon footprint, use of AI-based monitoring for MCC violations, real-time voter turnout apps, and expanded home voting for 80+ citizens, thus demonstrate its evolving role in enhancing transparency, inclusivity, and environmental responsibility in India's electoral process.
7. Explain the significance of the preamble to the constitution. Discuss whether the preamble is the source of Constitutional power. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Explain, Discuss
Approach	• Define the Preamble, mention its origin (Objective Resolution, 1946), and its constitutional status (Kesavananda Bharati, 1973). • Explain its significance (spirit, objectives, interpretative value, amenability) and discuss whether it is a source of constitutional power with case law and official position. • Summarise as the philosophical guide of the Constitution, clarifying that it inspires but does not confer legal powers.
Introduction	The Preamble to the Constitution of India, influenced by the Objective Resolution of 1946, is the introductory statement that encapsulates the ideals, philosophy, and goals of the Constitution. The Supreme Court in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) declared it an integral part of the Constitution, making it a guiding light for interpretation.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Significance of the Preamble to the constitution:** • **The Source of Authority:** ✓ The Preamble begins with the powerful phrase, "We, the People of India." * This signifies that the Constitution does not derive its power from a monarch or an external body (like the British Parliament), but from the citizens themselves. • **Reflection of the Constitutional Spirit** ✓ It proclaims India as a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, Republic, embodying values from the freedom struggle (Constituent Assembly Debates). • **Statement of Objectives** ✓ It declares aims such as Justice, Liberty, Equality, and Fraternity, which guide governance and law-making (Article 13 read with SC interpretations).

	• **Interpretative Value** ✓ In Berubari Union Case (1960), the Supreme Court (SC) termed it the "key to the minds of the framers" though not enforceable in court. • **Amenability** ✓ The SC in Kesavananda Bharati and LIC v. CERC (1995) held that the Preamble can be amended under Article 368, but its basic features cannot be altered. **Whether the Preamble is the Source of Constitutional Power** • **Not a Source of Power** ✓ It neither grants powers nor imposes limitations (Berubari Union Case). • **Declaratory, Not Substantive** ✓ It states what the Constitution aims to achieve rather than how powers are conferred.
Conclusion	The Preamble is the philosophical backbone of the Constitution, providing vision and purpose to its provisions. While it plays a crucial role in guiding interpretation and expressing the Constitution's ethos, it is not the legal source of constitutional authority, which arises from the operative parts of the Constitution.
Model Question	Critically analyze the importance of the Preamble in the Indian Constitution. How does it reflect the Constitution's underlying philosophy and guiding values?
Value Addition	Revered as the "conscience of the Constitution," the Preamble is not merely ceremonial but functions as a beacon for governance**.** It continues to inspire value-driven leadership and informed citizenship
8. Is India a Federation? (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Indian Constitution and its Salient features
Keyword	Direct
Approach	• Briefly define India's federal nature as a Union of States with a federal framework and unitary tilt. • Explain constitutional, judicial, and functional aspects highlighting both federal and unitary features. • Summarize India as a quasi-federal system evolving through cooperative federalism.
Introduction	The Constitution of India establishes a "Union of States", creating a federal framework with a unitary bias. While it incorporates many features of classical federations, such as a division of powers and dual governance.it also grants the Centre significant authority, leading scholars and courts to describe it as quasi-federal.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Federal Features** ✓ **Dual Polity:** India has two levels of government—Union and States—each operating in its own sphere. ✓ **Division of Powers:** The Seventh Schedule divides subjects into the Union List, State List, and Concurrent List. States enjoy autonomy in List II matters like police and public health. ✓ **Written Constitution & Supremacy:** A single, written constitutional document governs both the Union and States, ensuring clarity in powers. ✓ **Independent Judiciary:** Supreme Court acts as guardian of the Constitution and arbiter in Union–State disputes (Article 131). ✓ **Bicameralism:** Rajya Sabha represents states in Parliament (Article 79). • **Unitary Features** ✓ **Strong Centre:** Union List (97 subjects) outweighs State List (66 subjects); residuary powers rest with Parliament (Article 248).

	✓ **Single Constitution & Citizenship:** Unlike true federations (e.g., USA), India has one Constitution and single citizenship (Articles 5–11). ✓ **Emergency Provisions:** Articles 352, 356, 360 allow concentration of power in Centre. ✓ **Appointment of Governors:** The President appoints Governors (Article 155), giving the Centre indirect control. ✓ **All-India Services:** Article 312 creates centrally controlled services working in both Union and State spheres. • **Judicial Perspective** ✓ In State of West Bengal v. Union of India (1963), the Supreme Court held that states are not sovereign in the true federal sense. ✓ S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994) recognized federalism as part of the Basic Structure, limiting misuse of Article 356. ✓ Mohit Minerals (2022) on GST Council powers reaffirmed that states retain legislative space under Article 246A. • **Cooperative & Competitive Federalism** ✓ NITI Aayog promotes cooperative federalism via policy forums, SDG indices, and state rankings. ✓ The GST Council serves as a collaborative platform for fiscal policy-making between Union and States.
Conclusion	India is federal in structure but unitary in spirit, balancing state autonomy with strong central authority. Judicial safeguards and evolving practices like cooperative federalism aim to preserve this delicate balance.
Model Question	"The Indian federal system is cooperative in principle but confrontational in practice." Critically analyse with suitable examples.
Value Addition	The Sarkaria Commission (1988) recommended limiting misuse of emergency provisions, encouraging more decentralisation, and enhancing consultation through bodies like the Inter-State Council. Recent innovations such as performance-based grants and state-specific SDG indices have further incentivised healthy competition while respecting the spirit of federalism.
9. The Indian Constitution favours a federal type of government. Considering this, what duties does the Constitution place on State Governments to ensure the smooth functioning of the nation? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Functions and duties of the Indian Union and the State Governments
Keyword	What
Approach	• Introduce India's quasi-federal structure and the constitutional expectation for State Governments to function within the framework of unity, integrity, and cooperative federalism. • Explain the constitutional provisions, articles, and institutional mechanisms that place legislative, administrative, and cooperative duties on State Governments to ensure smooth national governance. • Conclude by stressing that the balance between State autonomy and national responsibility is essential for sustaining India's federal spirit and democratic stability.
Introduction	The Indian Constitution establishes a quasi-federal structure (federal in form, unitary in spirit), with a clear distribution of powers. While framing a structure of shared sovereignty, it also imposes constitutional responsibilities on State Governments that ensure national unity, cooperative governance, and constitutional integrity.

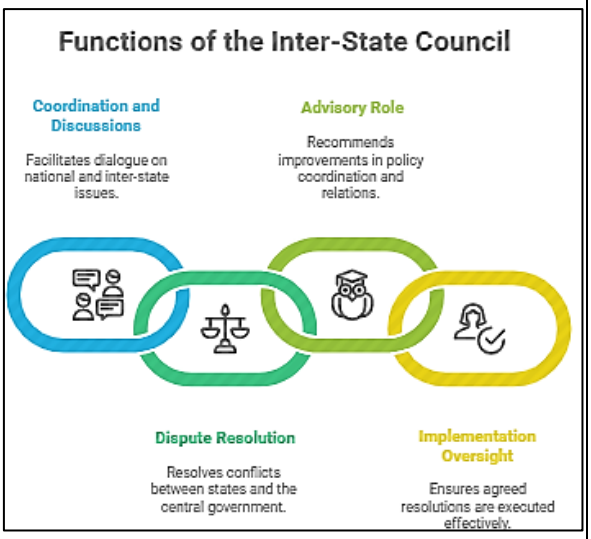
Body & Infographic Representation	**Duties of State Governments to ensure the smooth functioning of the nation:** • **Duty to Uphold Republic and Constitutional Values:** ✓ Article 35 empowers States to enact laws safeguarding Fundamental Rights, aligning with the Constitution's basic framework. ✓ Under Article 355, States are duty-bound to maintain peace and safeguard against external threats, and the Centre is empowered to aid them upon failure. ✓ Articles 156(4), 164(4), and 174 obligate State Executives and Legislators to take an oath to preserve the Constitution and discharge duties faithfully. ✓ Preamble's mandate to uphold justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity applies equally to States; courts have reinforced this, holding States accountable to these higher values. • **Cooperative Federalism and Inter-governmental Obligations** ✓ Article 263 enables the Governor to form advisory and dispute-resolution bodies, promoting inter-State coordination (Eg, Inter-State Council). ✓ States must support the Union's fiscal and financial directives, such as funding constitutional commissions (Eg, Election Commission), reflecting integrated governance. ✓ Under Articles 249 and 252, States may request the Centre to legislate on State subjects, demonstrating cooperative norms and policy-sharing. • **Compliance under Emergency Provisions and National Interest** ✓ During a National Emergency (Article 250) or Financial Emergency (Article 356), States must comply with Centre directives, preserving national coherence. ✓ Under Article 355, the Centre can step in if a State fails to maintain constitutional order, reinforcing mutual accountability for governance. • **Administrative and Structural Obligations** ✓ Article 151 enables States to provide for Official Languages, supporting national administrative unity. ✓ Articles 338 and 350-B create institutions like the National Commission for SCs and Special Officer for Linguistic Minorities, demanding State-level execution for social inclusion. ✓ States are responsible for conducting free and fair elections to local bodies and the Legislative Assembly, per Article 243-K, a cornerstone of grassroots democracy. • **Ensuring Nationally-aligned Governance and Social Justice** ✓ Under Article 46 and Part IV, States must promote the educational and economic well-being of weaker sections. ✓ Sustainable schemes include "LADLI" (MP) and "Kalyana Lakshmi" (Telangana). ✓ States must implement Centre–State welfare programmes such as MGNREGA, NFSA, Ayushman Bharat for SDG alignment and integrated development.
Conclusion	Legislative and administrative devolution has empowered States under India's federal model. Yet, the Constitution concurrently expects States to uphold national unity, constitutional values, and cooperative governance. By balancing autonomy with shared duties, through standards for law, civil conduct, elections, and welfare, the Constitution ensures States contribute to the smooth functioning of a diverse nation, strengthening both federal resilience and national integrity.
Model Question	Discuss the constitutional provisions that define the distribution of legislative powers between the Centre and the States under the Seventh Schedule. How effective are these provisions in maintaining the federal balance?
Value Addition	The Chief Minister is the real executive head of the State. It is he/she who formulates the policies and guides the Council of Ministers to implement them. He/She is the most

	powerful functionary, especially when one political party has an absolute majority in the Legislative Assembly. But if he/she heads a coalition government, his/ her role gets restricted by the pulls and pressures of other partners of the coalition. At times, he/she is pressurized by a few independent Members of Legislative Assembly (MLAs), if the majority in the House is thin.
2. Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure — Role of Governor in States - Distribution of powers between the Union and States (Union list, State list and Concurrent list) — Issues and challenges	
10. Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council and discuss its relevance in the context of Centre-State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure
Keyword	Explain and discuss
Approach	• Give an introduction on Article 263 provision, set up 1990 (Sarkaria recommendation). • Mention Composition, functions in Centre-State and inter-state disputes (GST, security, water issues). • Mention that ISC is vital for cooperative federalism, it must be activated more.
Introduction	The Inter-State Council (ISC) is a constitutional body established under Article 263 of the Indian Constitution to promote coordination between the Union and states and also among states themselves. Although provided for in 1950, it was only set up in 1990 on the recommendation of the Sarkaria Commission (1983). The ISC plays a vital role in cooperative federalism, especially in resolving policy disputes and promoting dialogue in a diverse polity like India.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Genesis of the Inter-State Council:** • **Constitutional Basis:** Article 263 empowers the President to establish an ISC if deemed necessary for the public interest. • **Sarkaria Commission (1983):** It recommended setting up a permanent council for cooperative federalism. • **Establishment:** ISC was constituted in 1990 by a Presidential Order under the chairmanship of the Prime Minister.  • **Composition:** PM (Chairperson), all Chief Ministers, Administrators of Union Territories, and selected Union Cabinet Ministers. **Relevance of ISC in Centre-State and Inter-State Coordination and Cooperation in India:** • **Policy Coordination**: It provides a forum for dialogue on matters like GST, internal security, and disaster management.

	• **Dispute Resolution:** It helps to address inter-state issues such as river water disputes (e.g., Cauvery, Krishna). • **Strengthening Federalism**: It encourages consensus-based decisions instead of unilateral central imposition. • **Platform for States' Concerns**: States can voice issues related to fiscal federalism, centrally sponsored schemes, or legislative overlaps. • **Complementary to NITI Aayog**: ✓ While NITI Aayog fosters developmental planning, ISC deals with political, legislative, and administrative coordination. ✓ Example: ISC has discussed issues like internal security coordination post-26/11 attacks, and implementation challenges of GST.
Conclusion	The Inter-State Council embodies the spirit of cooperative federalism, acting as a bridge between the Union and states. Although its meetings have been irregular, its institutional role is crucial for resolving disputes and fostering national consensus. Strengthening its frequency, recommendations, and follow-up mechanism can make the ISC a vibrant forum for federal harmony and coordination in India.
Model Question	Explain the genesis of the Inter-State Council. Discuss its relevance in strengthening Centre–State and Inter-State coordination and cooperation in the federal framework of India.
Value Addition	**Inter-State Council Background:** • Inter-State Council, proposed by the Sarkaria Commission on Centre-State Relations (1983–88), was intended to be a permanent body under Article 263. • The Commission recommended naming it the Inter-Governmental Council to differentiate it from other bodies established under the same article. • **Recommendation on Inter-State Council's Duties**: The Sarkaria Commission recommended that the Inter-State Council be tasked with responsibilities outlined in clauses (b) and (c) of Article 263 of the Constitution. • **Investigation and Discussion**: The Inter-State Council, as outlined under Article 263(b), shall investigate and discuss subjects in which some or all states, or the Union and one or more states, have a common interest. • **Making Recommendations:** The Inter-State Council, as specified under Article 263(c), shall also make recommendations on any such subject, and particularly for better coordination of policy and action related to that subject. • Following these recommendations, the Janata Dal government led by V. P. Singh established the Inter-State Council in 1990, with its operations under the Ministry of Home Affairs.
11. "In spite of unitary features of the Constitution, federalism survived in India". Comment. (APPSC, 2017)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Introduce India's federal structure with a unitary bias as designed by the Constitution to balance unity and diversity. • Discuss the unitary features, factors enabling survival of federalism, judicial role, institutional safeguards, and political practices, with recent examples. • Conclude by emphasizing that India's cooperative and evolving federalism ensures both national integrity and state autonomy.
Introduction	India's Constitution uniquely blends a federal framework with a unitary tilt. While it grants the Union significant powers to ensure national unity, states retain considerable

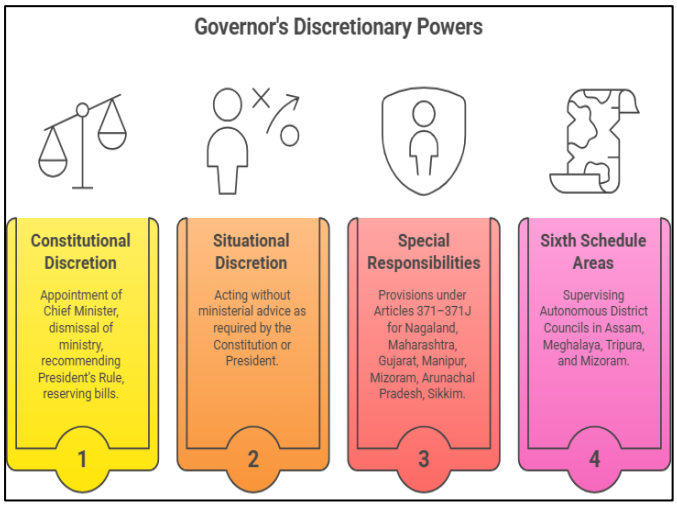
	autonomy. Despite centralising features like single citizenship and Union control during emergencies, federalism has endured. This survival stems from constitutional safeguards, strong institutions, judicial protection of federal principles, and evolving cooperative political practices balancing central authority with state autonomy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Unitary features of the constitution:** • **Strong Centre in legislation & finance:** ✓ Union List dominance, residuary powers (Art. 248), and emergency provisions (Arts. 352, 356, 360) centralize authority; Centre's fiscal pre-eminence and conditional grants shape state choices. • **Integrated administration:** ✓ All-India Services and Governor's office (Arts. 153–156) knit the Union–State executive into one system. ✓ These create centripetal pressures, occasionally amplified by proposals such as reducing states' tax devolution from 41% to 40% after 2026–27, triggering federal concerns. **Reasons for the survival of federalism in India** • **Constitutional architecture that safeguards state space:** ✓ The Seventh Schedule preserves significant State-List subjects (police, public order, and agriculture), while Articles 246–254 calibrate concurrency and repugnancy with judicial review acting as a check. ✓ **Institutionalized negotiation:** Inter-State Council (Art. 263), Finance Commission (Art. 280), and GST Council (Art. 279A) create formal platforms for policy coordination, with the GST Council seen as a successful model of cooperative federalism despite disputes over compensation delays. • **Supreme Court as the guardian of federalism:** ✓ **S.R. Bommai (1994):** Federalism declared a basic structure, limiting misuse of Article 356. ✓ **State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor (2025):** Introduced time-bound assent and deemed assent to state bills, curbing gubernatorial delays. ✓ **Recent pro-state rulings:** Upheld state powers in mineral taxation, alcohol regulation, and sub-classification in reservations, reinforcing legislative autonomy. • **Political & democratic forces:** ✓ Rise of regional parties since the 1980s has transformed Union–State relations from hierarchical to bargaining-based. ✓ Coalition governments at the Centre (1989–2014) empowered states in decision-making, especially on centrally sponsored schemes. ✓ State-level mobilisation (eg: on farm laws in Punjab & Haryana, NEET exemption debates in Tamil Nadu) demonstrates bottom-up assertion of federalism. • **Cooperative & competitive federalism in practice:** ✓ NITI Aayog's policy forums, competitive ranking (SDG Index, Health Index), and GST deliberations show functional interdependence. ✓ Fiscal tools like 14th & 15th Finance Commissions' devolution formulas have kept states financially viable, even amid debates on equity and efficiency. • **Public accountability and civil society pressure:** ✓ Media scrutiny, RTI activism, and civil society campaigns (Eg: opposing arbitrary use of Article 356) help protect state autonomy. ✓ Judicial monitoring of Centre–State disputes has created a culture where negotiation is the default over unilateralism.

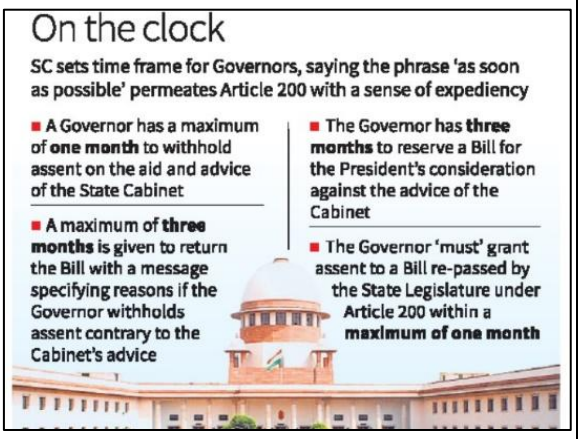
Conclusion	Despite a strong central bias in the Constitution, judicial safeguards, political decentralization, and institutional negotiation have ensured the endurance of federalism in India. The challenge now lies in making these mechanisms more transparent, time-bound, and consensus-driven to keep the balance intact.
Model Question	How do political differences between the Union and State governments affect the smooth functioning of the federal system? Illustrate with recent examples.
Value Addition	• According to KC Wheare, in practice, the Constitution of India is quasi-federal in nature and not strictly federal. In words of D.D. Basu, the Constitution of India is neither purely federal nor unitary, but it is a combination of both. • Throughout the Constitution, emphasis is laid on the fact that India is a single united nation. India is described as a Union of States constituted into sovereign, secular, socialist and democratic republic. • In State of West Bengal v Union of India, the apex court held that decentralization of authority in India was primarily to facilitate smooth governance of a large nation and therefore, it contains many centralizing features also. Indian Constitution is not a 'traditional federal constitution.'
12. Describe the formation and functions of the Inter-State Council. State some of the important decisions taken by the Inter-State Council in the last 3 years. (APPSC, 2017)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Introduce with Article 263 and the constitutional basis of the Inter-State Council as an instrument of cooperative federalism. • Describe its formation, composition, functions, and highlight key decisions taken by ISC/Zonal Councils in the last 3 years with examples. • Conclude by emphasizing ISC's role in strengthening Centre–State relations and the need for its regular, effective functioning.
Introduction	To promote cooperative federalism and resolve intergovernmental conflicts, Article 263 of the Constitution empowers the President to set up an Inter-State Council. Based on the Sarkaria Commission's recommendation, the ISC was established in 1990 as a permanent mechanism for Centre-State and inter-state coordination.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Formation of the Inter-State Council:** • **Constitutional Authority:** Article 263 allows the President to form an ISC if deemed necessary in the public interest. • **Inception:** The Council was constituted by a Presidential Order in May 1990, following the recommendations of the Sarkaria Commission. • **Composition:** ✓ **Chair:** Prime Minister ✓ **Members:** Chief Ministers of all states and UTs with legislatures; Administrators of UTs without legislatures; six Union ministers nominated by the PM ✓ **Standing Committee**: Home Minister as Chairman, several Union ministers, and Chief Ministers of select states **Functions of the Inter-State Council:** • **Coordination and Discussions:** Deliberates on subjects of national and inter-state importance such as water disputes, cooperative planning, and internal security. • **Dispute Resolution:** Seeks solutions for conflicts between states and between Centre and states. • **Advisory Role:** Recommends measures to improve policy coordination and Centre-State relations.

	• **Implementation Oversight**: Tracks and ensures execution of agreed resolutions via the Standing Committee. **Important Developments and Decisions (Last 3 Years)** Though meetings of the ISC have been infrequent (last full meeting in 2016), related mechanisms and sub-committees have taken notable steps: • **Reconstitution of the Standing Committee (2024)**: ✓ A significant institutional reform occurred in November 2024 when the government reconstituted the ISC's Standing Committee, appointing Home Minister as its Chair. ✓ The committee now includes Chief Ministers from key states and Union ministers from several ministries, making it more representative and functional.  • **Calls for Regular ISC Meetings**: ✓ States, including Tamil Nadu, have urged the Union government to convene the ISC thrice yearly. ✓ This reflects growing state demand for dialogue and a proactive platform to address Centre-State issues. • **Zonal Council Resolutions Supporting ISC Framework:** ✓ **Eastern Zonal Council (2025)** adopted the National Silt Management Policy to address flooding in Bihar; it also resolved river-sharing issues between Bihar and Jharkhand. ✓ **Central Zonal Council (2025)** championed regional cooperation, with Madhya Pradesh CM emphasizing ISC-like platforms as foundations of developmental planning and cooperative federalism. • **Boundary and Resource Agreements:** ✓ Assam–Arunachal Pradesh set timelines for resolving boundary disputes through a ministerial committee, achieving a near amicable framework. ✓ Andhra Pradesh and Telangana made progress on division-related issues, agreeing to apportion labor cess funds and manage other pending administrative matters.
Conclusion	The Inter-State Council, formed under Article 263, remains pivotal in enhancing cooperative federalism. While its original mandate included policy coordination and conflict resolution, recent restructuring of its Standing Committee and calls for regular meetings show its potential for renewal. Strengthening its relevance through sustained engagement and expanded institutional reach is essential for effective union-state cooperation moving forward.
Model Question	"Inter-State river water disputes are more political than legal." Comment with reference to recent cases.
Value Addition	The present composition of each of these Zonal Councils is as under:

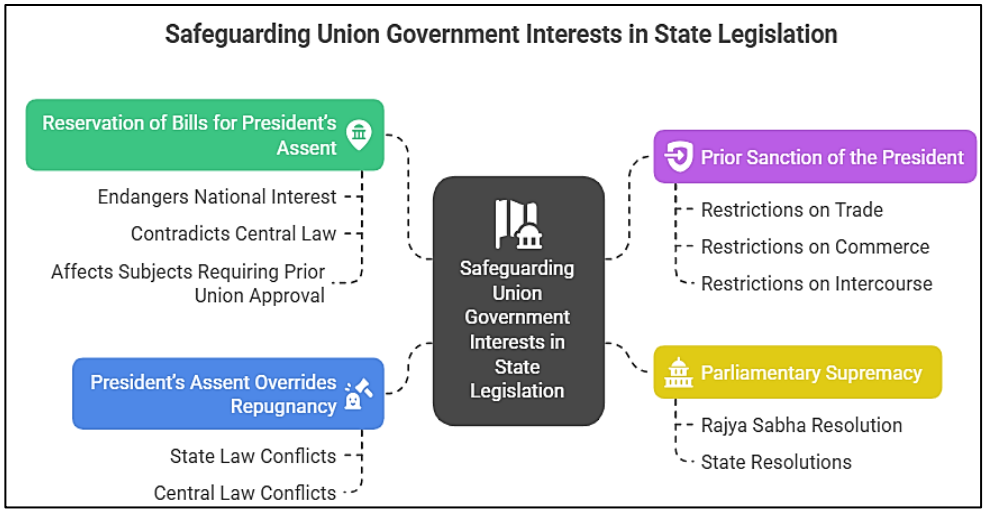
	• The **Northern Zonal Council,** comprising the States of Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu & Kashmir, Punjab, Rajasthan, National Capital Territory of Delhi and Union Territory of Chandigarh; • The **Central Zonal Council**, comprising the States of Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh; • The **Eastern Zonal Council,** comprising the States of Bihar, Jharkhand, Orissa, Sikkim and West Bengal; • The **Western Zonal Council,** comprising the States of Goa, Gujarat, Maharashtra and the Union Territories of Daman & Diu and Dadra & Nagar Haveli; • The **Southern Zonal Council**, comprising the States of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and the Union Territory of Puducherry. • The North Eastern States i.e. (i) Assam (ii) Arunachal Pradesh (iii) Manipur (iv) Tripura (v) Mizoram (vi) Meghalaya and (vii) Nagaland are not included in the Zonal Councils and their special problems are looked after by the **North Eastern Council**, set up under the North Eastern Council Act, 1972.
13. Do you agree with the view that functions are given to the states while resources are with the centre? (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Issues and challenges pertaining to the Federal structure
Keyword	Do you agree
Approach	• Note India's federal design and the Centre–State function resource gap. • Outline constitutional division, GST impact, CSS control, and corrective transfers. • A state gap exists but needs to be bridged via fair transfers and cooperative federalism.
Introduction	India's federal structure often leads to the perception that States bear significant functional responsibilities while the Centre controls major financial resources. This vertical fiscal imbalance is by design, aimed at ensuring national cohesion, equitable development, and uniform standards of public services.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Functional Responsibilities of States:** • State List (66 subjects) includes public order, police, health, agriculture, irrigation, and local government functions requiring significant expenditure. • States are primarily responsible for implementing welfare schemes like education, healthcare, housing, and rural development. • As per the RBI's State Finances Report (2024-25), states account for 60% of total government expenditure in India. **Resource Concentration in the Centre:** • **Union List (97 subjects):** Parliament controls major revenue sources like customs, excise duties, corporate tax, and income tax (Articles 268–272). • States depend heavily on transfers from the Centre through Finance Commission devolution, Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS), and grants-in-aid (Article 275). **Corrective Mechanisms:** • **Finance Commission (Article 280**): Recommends tax devolution; the 15th Finance Commission allocated 41% of the divisible pool taxes to states. • **GST Regime (2017):** Created a common tax base; though cooperative, states still rely on GST compensation from the Centre. • **Centrally Sponsored Schemes:** Though resource-heavy, they reduce states' fiscal autonomy as guidelines are decided by the Union. **Challenges and Criticism:**

	• Fiscal dependence restricts states' autonomy in policymaking. • Delays in GST compensation (e.g., during COVID-19) highlighted states' resource vulnerability despite large functional mandates.
Conclusion	While the constitutional framework inherently creates a functions–resources gap, it also embeds corrective fiscal transfers through Finance Commission awards and grants. The perception of central dominance is reinforced by CSS and GST's restructuring of tax powers. Strengthening predictable transfers, rationalising CSS, and fostering cooperative fiscal federalism can better align State responsibilities with adequate financial resources.
Model Question	Critically evaluate the impact of centrally sponsored schemes (CSS) on the financial autonomy of States.
Value Addition	During the COVID-19 pandemic, cooperative federalism was tested through Centre–State coordination on lockdowns, vaccine procurement, health infrastructure, and fiscal transfers. Tensions arose over centralized decision-making, uneven resource allocation, and GST compensation delays, highlighting the need for stronger institutional mechanisms to balance state autonomy with national-level crisis management.
14. The office of the Governor, in certain situations, carries with it the exercise of 'discretionary functions' and special responsibilities. Discuss this statement in view of the constitutional provisions (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Role of Governor in States
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Define the Governor's dual role as constitutional and Union agent. • Discuss discretionary powers (Article 163) and special responsibilities (NE states, Sixth Schedule, Maharashtra, Gujarat tribal areas). • Emphasise constitutional checks and cooperative federalism.
Introduction	The Governor is the constitutional head of a state under Article 153 of the Indian Constitution. While the Governor generally acts on the aid and advice of the Council of Ministers (Article 163(1)), the Constitution entrusts the office with certain discretionary powers and special responsibilities to ensure stability, safeguard federal interests, and protect sensitive regions or communities.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Discretionary Functions of the Governor:** • **Constitutional Discretion of the Governor:** ✓ Appointment of the Chief Minister when no clear majority exists (hung assembly). ✓ Example: In Karnataka (2018), the Governor invited the largest party to form the government. ✓ Dismissal of a ministry losing majority but refusing to resign. ✓ Recommending President's Rule under Article 356 when constitutional machinery breaks down. ✓ Reserving bills for the President's consideration (Article 200). • **Situational Discretion of the Governor:** ✓ Acting without ministerial advice in matters where the Constitution or the President so requires. ✓ Example: In Arunachal Pradesh (2016), the Governor advanced the Assembly session amid a political crisis. **Special Responsibilities of the Governor:** • **Provisions under Articles 371–371J:** ✓ **Nagaland (Art. 371A):** Maintain law and order in the Naga Hills.

	✓ **Maharashtra & Gujarat (Art. 371):** Special responsibility for development of tribal areas. ✓ **Manipur, Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim:** To promote peace and development in sensitive regions. • **Sixth Schedule Areas:** In Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram, the Governor supervises Autonomous District Councils and can modify or annul their decisions for safeguarding tribal interests. 
Conclusion	To sum up, the discretionary powers and special responsibilities of the Governor act as a constitutional safeguard for governance and regional interests. While they are necessary in exceptional situations, frequent or politically motivated use risks eroding the spirit of cooperative federalism. Therefore, these powers must be exercised with neutrality, constitutional propriety, and respect for democratic mandates.
Model Question	Discuss the discretionary powers and special responsibilities of the Governor under the Constitution of India. How have these powers impacted Centre–State relations in practice?
Value Addition	**The Constitutional Provisions of the Governor:** • The Governor, along with the Chief Minister, the Council of Ministers, and the Advocate General of the state, constitute the state executive. • Articles 153 to 167 in Part VI of the Indian Constitution outline the structure and functions of the state executive. • The constitutional provisions outlined in these articles address various aspects of the Governor's office, including appointment, qualifications, powers, functions, and other related matters. • **Article 153:** It states that there shall be a Governor for each state. However, it also provides that nothing in this article prevents the appointment of the same person as Governor for two or more states.
15. Explain the role of Governor in states by focusing on their powers and functions. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Role of Governor in States
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Introduce the Governor as the constitutional head of the state, bridging the Centre and State, with powers defined under Part VI of the Constitution. • Explain the Governor's executive, legislative, discretionary, and emergency powers, supplemented with recent judicial interpretations and political developments. • Conclude by emphasizing the need for a politically neutral Governor to uphold federalism and constitutional morality in state governance.
Introduction	The Governor, appointed by the President, acts as the constitutional head and the Centre's representative in Indian states. Their role, defined under Part VI (Articles 153–167) of the Constitution, includes ceremonial functions, legislative responsibilities, and

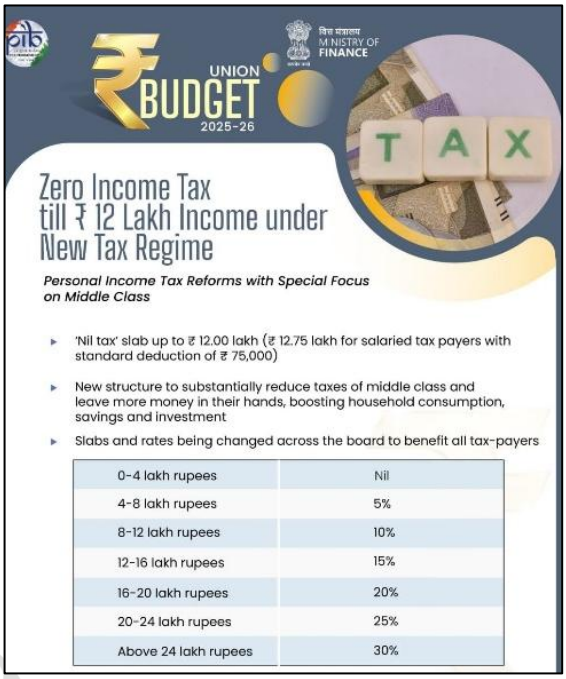
	discretionary decision-making, and emergency powers. Recent events in Tamil Nadu highlight the evolving benchmarks of gubernatorial conduct.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Powers and Functions of the Governor:** **Executive and Ceremonial Powers:** • **Appointments:** ✓ The Governor appoints the Chief Minister, Council of Ministers, Advocate General, and heads of key institutions. • **Chancellor Role:** ✓ In many states, the Governor is the Chancellor of state universities, guiding academic administration. • **Public Functions:** ✓ Presides over state ceremonies and issues notifications for judicial appointments and commissions.  **Legislative Powers:** • **Bill Assent:** ✓ The Governor must grant assent, withhold, return, or reserve for the President's decision. • **Ordinance-making:** Can promulgate ordinances during legislative recess under Article 213. • **Assembly Control:** Holds power to summon, prorogue, or dissolve legislative assemblies. **Discretionary Powers and Centre–State Delineation** • **Government Formation:** ✓ Chooses the Chief Minister in a hung assembly using constitutional conventions. • **President's Rule:** ✓ Can recommend invoking Article 356; historical misuse addressed in S.R. Bommai (1994). • **Discretion under Article 200:** ✓ The Governor must follow the Council of Ministers' aid and advice except in constitutionally specified cases, recently reaffirmed by the Supreme Court. **Emergency and Other Powers:** • **Articles 356 and 365:** The Governor plays a vital role in recommending central rule during political instability. • **Article 163:** Must act on advice, except when the Constitution is clear. • **Financial Oversight:** Can authorize spending when the assembly is not in session (Article 353). **Recent Supreme Court Intervention (2025):** • In the *State of Tamil Nadu v. Governor* case, the Court ruled that using a pocket or absolute veto to withhold assent on 10 state bills was illegal and arbitrary, streamlining a fixed timeline for the Governor's action. • As a result, all withheld bills were deemed passed. The Court clarified that discretion is limited and subject to judicial review.

Conclusion	The Governor's constitutional role spans executive, legislative, discretionary, and emergency domains, aimed at balancing State governance with constitutional stability. However, recent litigation, especially the 2025 Supreme Court judgment in Tamil Nadu has significantly curtailed discretionary excesses, enforcing timelines and mandatory adherence to ministerial advice.
Model Question	"The Governor is a constitutional head, but the Chief Minister is the real executive." Examine the statement in the context of state governance.
Value Addition	The Supreme Court reinforced the principle that judicial review is a fundamental feature of a written constitution. Governors' actions under Article 200, including withholding assent or reserving bills for the President, are subject to judicial scrutiny, as long as they fall within the constitutional limits. The Court affirmed that such decisions could be reviewed if they were made without proper constitutional justification.
16. The procedure of enacting a law from a bill differs at the Union and State levels, primarily to safeguard the interests of the Union Government in state legislation. Elucidate this aspect. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Distribution of powers between the Union and States
Keyword	Elucidate
Approach	• Mention legislative lists and constitutional scheme. • Show how the Union has overriding powers like the Governor's reservation for the President, previous assent under Article 304(b), and Parliament's legislation in the national interest. • Highlight the balance between autonomy and Union supremacy.
Introduction	India's Constitution provides a federal legislative framework through three lists in the Seventh Schedule, i.e., Union, State, and Concurrent Lists. While states enjoy legislative autonomy, certain procedural safeguards in state law-making ensure that the Union Government's interests and national integrity are not compromised. These are embedded in constitutional provisions to maintain harmony between the centre and states.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Difference in Law-Making Procedure at Union and State Levels to Safeguard Union Government Interests in State Legislation:** • **Reservation of Bills for President's Assent (Article 200):** The Governor may reserve a state bill for the consideration of the President, particularly if it: ✓ Endangers national interest. ✓ Contradicts central law.



	✓ Affects subjects requiring prior Union approval. ✓ Example: Kerala's 2021 University Laws Amendment Bill was reserved for the President's assent. • **Prior Sanction of the President for bills (Article 304(b)):** ✓ It is required for bills imposing restrictions on trade, commerce, or intercourse in the public interest. ✓ This ensures conformity with national economic policies. • **Parliamentary Supremacy in Certain Matters (Articles 249 & 252):** The Parliament can legislate on State List matters if: ✓ The Rajya Sabha passes a resolution in national interest (Article 249). ✓ When two or more states pass resolutions requesting it. (Article 252). ✓ Example: Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974, initially enacted with states' consent. • **President's Assent Overrides Repugnancy (Article 254):** If a state law conflicts with a central law on a Concurrent List subject, the President's assent can make the state law prevail in that state.
Conclusion	Thus, the procedural differences in law-making between Union and State levels are deliberate safeguards to ensure that state legislation aligns with national policies and constitutional objectives. These provisions uphold the federal balance while protecting the Union's primacy in matters of national importance, thus maintaining cooperative federalism.
Model Question	The legislative procedure for enacting a law at the State level incorporates safeguards to protect the Union Government's interests. Examine this statement with reference to constitutional provisions and relevant examples.
Value Addition	**Central laws:** • The Laws made by the Union of India are otherwise known as Central Laws. • Article 245 provides that Parliament may make laws for the whole or any part of the territorial area, and the legislature of the State may make laws for the whole or any part of the State. • Similarly, Article 246 of the Indian Constitution deals with the subject matter of Laws made by Parliament and by the Legislature of States. • Schedule VII of the Indian Constitution provides three lists enumerating matters over which power to legislate lies. • These lists are 'Union List', 'State List', and 'Concurrent List'. • Parliament has the exclusive power to make any law for any matter not enumerated in the 'Concurrent List' and 'State List'. • The power to legislate upon the matters enumerated in the 'Union List' specifically lies with the Union Govt. • This list contains 97 entries. • The entries are generally matters of national importance. • The laws made by the Union Government over the subjects mentioned in the 'Union List' are generally classified as Central Laws. • These laws are applicable to the whole country. • However, each Law/Statute has its own jurisdiction expressed in the term of applicability.
17. Are Direct taxes transferable or non-transferable? Explain the recent Direct Tax Reforms undertaken in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Distribution of powers between the Union and States

Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining direct taxes, clarifying their non-transferable nature, and highlighting their role in India's fiscal structure. • Explain why direct taxes are considered non-transferable, and detail the recent reforms such as simplified tax regimes, faceless assessment, digitization, and changes in corporate and personal tax rates. • Conclude by assessing how these reforms enhance compliance, transparency, and ease of doing business while contributing to sustainable revenue mobilization.
Introduction	Taxation is a key instrument for resource mobilisation and economic governance in India. Taxes are broadly classified into direct and indirect taxes based on the incidence and burden of payment. Direct taxes are levied directly on the income or wealth of individuals and entities, and the burden cannot be shifted to others. In recent years, India has undertaken significant direct tax reforms aimed at simplifying the structure, enhancing compliance through technology, and aligning the system with global best practices.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Are Direct Taxes Transferable or Non-transferable?** ✓ Direct taxes are non-transferable in nature. ✓ The burden of payment falls directly on the individual or entity on whom they are imposed and cannot be shifted to another person. ✓ Examples include Income Tax, Corporate Tax, and Capital Gains Tax. ✓ In contrast, indirect taxes like GST can be passed on to consumers through higher prices. • **Nature and Constitutional Position of Direct taxes:** ✓ In India, direct taxes are largely levied and collected by the Union Government under the Union List of the Seventh Schedule. ✓ Articles 268 to 270 outline the distribution of tax revenues between the Centre and the States. ✓ Though proceeds from some direct taxes are shared with States (as per Finance Commission recommendations), the incidence of tax remains with the original taxpayer. **Recent Direct Tax Reforms in India:** The Government of India has undertaken multiple reforms to simplify the tax regime, promote voluntary compliance, and widen the tax base. • **Simplification of Tax Structure:** ✓ **New Personal Income Tax Regime (Budget 2025):** ▪ No income tax payable up to total income of Rs. 12 lakh under the new regime. This limit will be Rs.12.75 lakh for salaried tax payers, due to standard deduction of Rs. 75,000. ▪ Raised basic exemption limit to ₹3 lakh. ▪ Streamlined slab rates to make compliance easier. ✓ **Corporate Tax Reform (2019):** ▪ Reduced base corporate tax rate to 22% for domestic companies and 15% for new manufacturing units. • **Faceless and Technology-driven Administration** ✓ **Faceless Assessment & Appeals (2020 onwards):** Eliminated physical interface, reducing harassment and corruption. ✓ **Pre-filled ITRs & Annual Information Statement (AIS):** Leveraging digital data to ease compliance and minimize errors. • **Widening the Tax Base**

	✓ **TDS/TCS Provisions Expansion:** Covers more transactions to bring untaxed income under the net. The limit for tax deduction on interest for senior citizens is proposed to be doubled from the present Rs. 50,000 to Rs. 1 lakh. Similarly, the proposals include annual limit of Rs. 2.40 lakh for TDS on rent to be increased to Rs.6 lakh. ✓ Integration of GST data with the Income Tax database to detect mismatches and curb evasion. • **Promoting Investment & Economic Activity** ✓ **Start-up Incentives:** Tax holidays and capital gains exemption extended to promote entrepreneurship. ✓ **International Financial Services Centre (IFSC) Benefits:** Tax holidays to attract global finance business to GIFT City. • **Dispute Resolution & International Compliance** ✓ **Vivad se Vishwas Scheme (2020):** Quick resolution of pending disputes, reducing litigation burden. ✓ Implementation of OECD's BEPS measures to prevent profit shifting by multinational companies. 
Conclusion	Direct taxes, being non-transferable, ensure that those earning income or profits bear the tax burden directly. Recent reforms, ranging from slab rationalization to technology-enabled compliance reflect a shift towards a simpler, transparent, and investor-friendly tax system. These measures aim to improve compliance, widen the base, and align India with global best practices, while ensuring equity and efficiency in revenue mobilization.
Model Question	Examine how centrally sponsored schemes (CSS) influence the autonomy of State governments. Suggest reforms.
Value Addition	**Reforms related to Employment and Investment:** • **Tax certainty for Electronics Manufacturing Schemes:** Proposal to provide a presumptive taxation regime for non-residents who provide services to a resident company that is establishing or operating an electronics manufacturing facility. Further, a proposal to introduce a safe harbor for tax certainty for non-residents who store components for supply to specified electronics manufacturing units. • **Extension for incorporation of Start-Ups:** To support the Indian start-up eco-system, a proposal to extend the period of incorporation by 5 years, to allow the benefits available to start-ups that are incorporated before 01.04.2030.
18. What is the concept of cooperative federalism? Does it exist in India? (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Distribution of powers between the Union and States
Keyword	What
Approach	• Define cooperative federalism and its relevance to India's polity

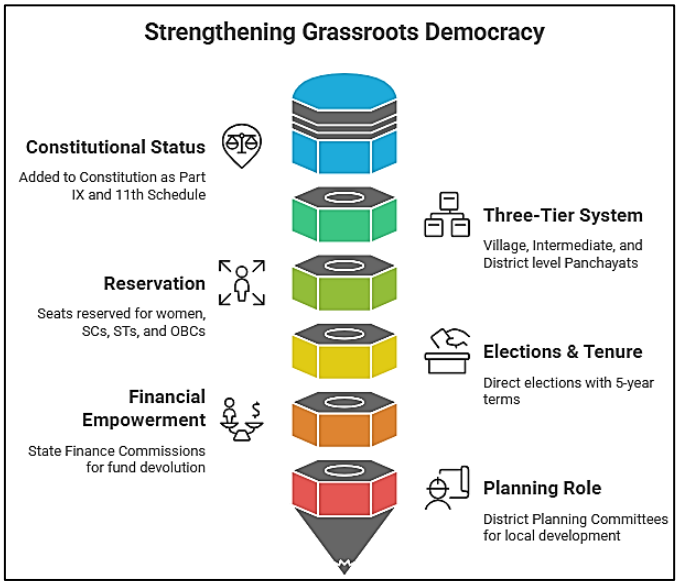
	• Explain its concept, constitutional basis, institutional mechanisms, and judicial recognition with examples • Highlight its necessity for inclusive growth and Centre–State harmony in a diverse federal structure.
Introduction	Cooperative federalism denotes a governance model in which the Union and State governments collaborate to frame and implement policies, ensuring balanced national development. In India's diverse polity, this partnership-based approach is vital for addressing interlinked socio-economic challenges.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Definition:** A federal arrangement where the Centre and States share powers, responsibilities, and resources, often through joint decision-making. • **Features** ✓ **Shared Policy Formulation** – Both levels consult and participate in framing laws and schemes. ✓ **Institutional Mechanisms** – Platforms like Inter-State Council (Art. 263), NITI Aayog, and **Zonal Councils** ensure dialogue. ✓ **Resource Sharing** – **Finance Commission (Art. 280)** recommends vertical and horizontal devolution of taxes. ✓ **Joint Implementation** – Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS) like PMGSY, Swachh Bharat Mission. **Existence of Cooperative Federalism in India** India's Constitution, though federal with a unitary bias (Keshavananda Bharati case, 1973), provides scope for cooperative federalism: • **Constitutional Provisions** ✓ **Seventh Schedule:** Division of powers, but with the Concurrent List allowing cooperation. ✓ **Article 282:** Allows the Centre and States to make grants for public purposes. ✓ **Art. 263 & Art. 280:** Promote coordination and resource sharing. • **Institutional Examples** ✓ **NITI Aayog**: Promotes participatory policy-making with State CMs as members. ✓ **GST Council (Art. 279A)**: Equal representation and consensus-based tax decisions. ✓ **Inter-State Council**: Resolves disputes, promotes coordination. • **Judicial Recognition:** In S.R. Bommai (1994), the Supreme Court highlighted federalism as part of the basic structure, advocating cooperative engagement.
Conclusion	India's federalism, though unitary in emergencies, functions cooperatively through constitutional provisions, fiscal mechanisms, and joint institutions. Cooperative federalism remains a practical necessity for inclusive, coordinated growth in a diverse nation.
Model Question	Discuss the role of the Inter-State Council and Zonal Councils in promoting cooperative federalism in India.
Value Addition	The Punchhi Commission (2010) recommended strengthening the Inter-State Council (Article 263), revising financial devolution under Article 280 to reduce dependency on Centrally Sponsored Schemes (CSS), and ensuring GST Council (Article 279A) decisions respect state autonomy. Internationally, models like Australia's COAG offer lessons in structured Centre–State cooperation, fostering trust, equal participation, and transparent dispute resolution mechanisms.

19. Discuss the administrative relations between the Union and the States. How are Inter State Water Disputes resolved in India? (APPSC, 2012)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Distribution of powers between the Union and States
Keyword	Discuss, How
Approach	• Introduce by explaining that the Constitution ensures administrative relations between the Union and States under Articles 256-263 to maintain coordination in India's federal framework. • Describe the key aspects distribution of executive powers, Centre's control, cooperative mechanisms like Inter-State Council and All India Services, and Union authority during emergencies. • Explain Inter-State Water Disputes resolution under Article 262 and the 1956 Act, highlighting tribunals and recent reforms. • Conclude by stressing the importance of cooperation and efficient dispute resolution for strengthening cooperative federalism.
Introduction	The Constitution of India establishes a federal structure with a strong unitary bias. Articles 256 to 263 of Part XI deal with administrative relations between the Union and States, aiming to ensure coordination and harmony in governance while maintaining the unity and integrity of the nation.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Administrative Relations between Union and States:** • **Distribution of Executive Powers:** ✓ The Union executive power extends to subjects on which Parliament can make laws, mainly those in the Union List. ✓ The State executive power extends to subjects under the State List. ✓ In Concurrent List matters, both share responsibility, but the Union prevails in case of conflict. • **Centre's Control over States:** ✓ Article 256: States must ensure compliance with Parliamentary laws. ✓ Article 257: Union can direct States regarding matters of national or military importance. ✓ Article 365: Non-compliance with Central directions may invite President's Rule under Article 356. • **Cooperation and Coordination Mechanisms:** ✓ All-India Services (IAS, IPS, IFS): Maintain administrative uniformity and efficiency across the country. ✓ Inter-State Council (Article 263): Promotes cooperative federalism and resolves policy frictions. ✓ NITI Aayog and Zonal Councils: Encourage Centre-State consultation on development and planning. • **Role during Emergencies:** ✓ During National Emergency (Article 352), the Union gains power to direct States on any matter. ✓ President's Rule (Article 356) allows the Centre to take over State administration. ✓ Financial Emergency (Article 360) enables Union control over State expenditure and salaries. **Resolution of Inter-State Water Disputes:** • **Constitutional and Legal Framework:** ✓ Article 262 empowers Parliament to provide for the adjudication of disputes relating to inter-State rivers and to bar court jurisdiction. ✓ Inter-State River Water Disputes Act, 1956 (ISRWD Act) is the main legal framework for settlement.

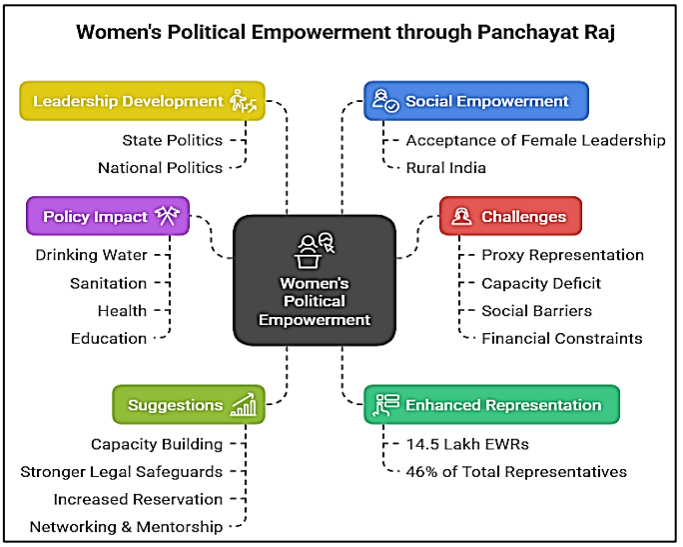
	• **Mechanism of Resolution:** ✓ Negotiation Stage: States are encouraged to resolve issues through dialogue. ✓ Dispute Resolution Committee (DRC): Formed by the Centre to attempt settlement within one year (extendable by six months). ✓ Water Disputes Tribunal: If DRC fails, a Tribunal is constituted to decide within three years (extendable by two). ▪ Examples: Cauvery, Krishna, Mahanadi, Mahadayi, Ravi-Beas, Vansadhara Tribunals. **Issues in Implementation:** • Delays in award delivery and publication (e.g., Cauvery dispute took over 17 years). • Politicisation of disputes and defiance by States. • Lack of transparent water data and coordination.
Conclusion	Effective administrative coordination between the Union and States ensures smooth governance in India's quasi-federal structure. A transparent and cooperative mechanism for resolving inter-State water disputes is essential to strengthen cooperative federalism and maintain national harmony through dialogue, trust, and institutional efficiency.
Model Question	"Examine how the constitutional provisions governing administrative relations between the Union and the States promote the spirit of cooperative federalism in India. Also, discuss the mechanisms available for resolving inter-state administrative disputes."
Value Addition	**Inter-State River Water Disputes (Amendment) Bill, 2019:** • **Disputes Resolution Committee (DRC):** Formed by the Centre to resolve disputes amicably within 1 year (extendable by 6 months). Includes a Chairperson, experts, and representatives from concerned states. • **Permanent Tribunal:** Replaces existing tribunals with a single permanent body having multiple benches. Composition includes a Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, 3 judicial and 3 expert members. • **Time Limit:** Tribunal to give its decision within 2 years (extendable by 1 year). If reconsidered, report must be submitted within 1 year (extendable by 6 months). • **Final and Binding Decision:** Tribunal's award is final; no need for gazette publication. • **Implementation Scheme**: The Centre must frame a scheme to ensure the award's execution.
20. Give instances wherein the Constitution provides control of the Union over the States. (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Distribution of powers between the Union and States
Keyword	Give
Approach	• Mention that India's quasi-federal structure allows the Union to exercise control over States for unity and governance. • Classify provisions into legislative (Arts. 249, 250, 253), administrative (Arts. 256, 257, 355), financial (Arts. 275, 279A), and emergency powers (Arts. 356, 360) with examples. • Emphasize the need for balance between Union supremacy and State autonomy to preserve cooperative federalism.
Introduction	While India follows a quasi-federal structure with a strong Centre, the Constitution provides several provisions enabling the Union to exercise control over States. These are embedded to ensure national unity, policy uniformity, and constitutional compliance, as highlighted in S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994).
Body & Infographic Representation	**Instances of the Constitution providing control of the Union over the states** • **Legislative Control** ✓ **Residuary Powers**: Under Article 248 & Entry 97, Union List, residuary matters rest with Parliament.

	✓ **During National Emergency**: Under Article 250, Parliament can legislate on State List subjects. ✓ **In National Interest**: Article 249 allows Parliament to legislate on State subjects if Rajya Sabha passes a resolution with a two-thirds majority. ✓ **Implementation of International Obligations**: Article 253 empowers Parliament to legislate on any subject to fulfill international treaties or agreements. • **Administrative Control** ✓ **Direction to States**: Article 256 & 257 allow the Union to issue directions to ensure compliance with laws and not impede Union's executive power. ✓ **Deployment of Union Forces**: Under Article 355, the Union can protect States against external aggression or internal disturbance. ✓ **All India Services**: Under Article 312, creation of services like IAS/IPS ensures uniform administrative standards. • **Financial Control** ✓ **Grants-in-aid**: Article 275 & 282 give Union power to provide conditional grants, influencing State policies. ✓ **Goods and Services Tax Council**: Under Article 279A, the Union plays a decisive role in indirect tax policy. • **Emergency Provisions** ✓ **President's Rule**: Article 356 allows Union to assume State functions if constitutional machinery fails. ✓ **Financial Emergency**: **Article 360** enables the Union to direct States on financial matters.
Conclusion	The Constitution thus balances State autonomy with Union supremacy to maintain political stability and national integrity. While these controls ensure coordinated governance, excessive centralization may dilute the spirit of federalism, warranting judicious use of such powers.
Model Question	"The Indian federal system is tilted in favor of the Centre." Do you agree? Substantiate with constitutional provisions and judicial pronouncements.
Value Addition	The Sarkaria Commission (1988) upheld Union control provisions as essential for national integrity but stressed they be used sparingly. Judicial review, as in S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994), acts as a safeguard against arbitrary central intervention, reinforcing the spirit of cooperative federalism.
3. Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment - Constitutional Authorities and their Role.	
21. Discuss the significance of the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act in strengthening grassroots democracy in India. (APPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Mention the 1992 Act. • Mention Provisions (3-tier, reservation, 11th Schedule) + significance in decentralization, participation. • Give a conclusion as Strengthened grassroots democracy, but needs fuller devolution.
Introduction	The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992, which came into effect on 24 April 1993, is a milestone in India's democratic journey. It gave constitutional status to Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and sought to strengthen grassroots democracy by ensuring people's participation in decision-making. This reform was based on Mahatma Gandhi's concept of Gram Swaraj.

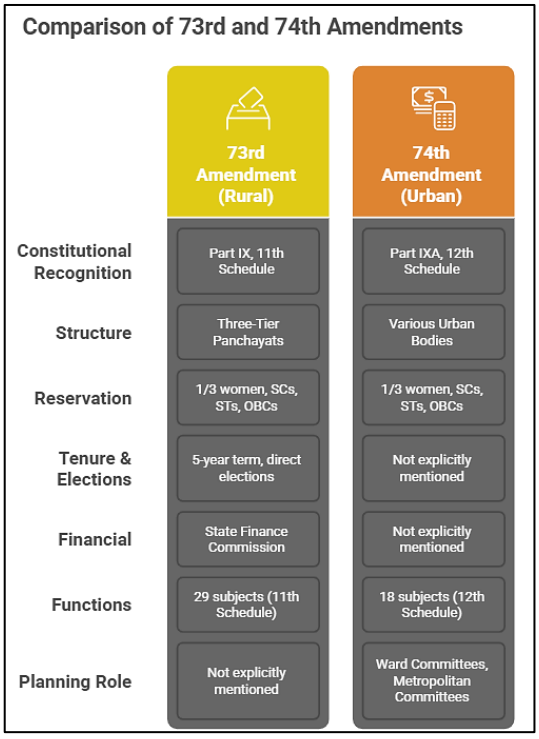
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Provisions of the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992:** • **Constitutional status:** This amendment was inserted in Part IX (Articles 243–243O) and the 11th Schedule of the Constitution. • **Three-tier system:** The act includes Village, Intermediate (Mandal/Block), and District level Panchayats (Zilla Parishads). • **Reservation**: Under the act, One-third seats are reserved for women, and also a proportionate reservation is given for SCs, STs, which was later extended to OBCs. • **Elections & Tenure:** The amendment provides for direct elections for panchayats with a 5-year term, conducted by the State Election Commission. • **Financial empowerment:** The act provides for the Constitution of State Finance Commissions to recommend fund devolution to the panchayats. • **Planning role:** District Planning Committees are set up to prepare local development plans in panchayats.  **Significance of the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992 in Strengthening Grassroots Democracy:** • **Decentralized Governance**: ✓ It brought decision-making closer to citizens. ✓ For example, Kerala's People's Plan Campaign empowered local bodies in planning and budgeting. • **Inclusive Participation:** Women's reservation enabled leadership like Sarpanch Chhavi Rajawat (Rajasthan), showing the transformative role of women in governance. • **Social Justice:** Political representation of marginalized communities strengthened democracy at the bottom. • **Accountability & Transparency:** Social audits in states like Andhra Pradesh under MGNREGS show how PRIs enhance accountability. • **Local Development:** It empowered villages to address issues like drinking water, sanitation, and rural roads through participatory planning. **Challenges in the implementation of the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992:** • Inadequate devolution of funds and functions by states. • Political and bureaucratic interference. • Capacity gaps in training elected representatives.
Conclusion	The 73rd Amendment has been instrumental in deepening democracy at the grassroots by empowering PRIs with constitutional legitimacy. While challenges of financial autonomy and effective devolution remain, successful models from states like Kerala and Karnataka highlight their transformative potential. Thus, the Act represents a

	decisive step towards realizing participatory democracy and inclusive development in India.
Model Question	Examine how the 73rd Constitutional Amendment has strengthened grassroots democracy in India. Do you think the vision of Gandhiji's 'Gram Swaraj' has been realized through it?
Value Addition	**Panchayati Raj Structure:** • **Division into three-tier Panchayati Raj System**: The 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act established a three-tier Panchayati Raj System in every state, including Panchayats at village, intermediate, and district levels. • **Enable Uniformity:** The decentralisation of power ensures uniformity in the structure of the Panchayati Raj System all over the country. • **Optional for smaller states**: A state with a population not exceeding 20 lakh has the option to either constitute or not constitute Panchayats at the intermediate level.
22. Discuss the scope and challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj. Briefly suggest how to enhance women's empowerment in rural and urban local governance. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Discuss, Briefly suggest
Approach	• Mention about Reservation under 73rd/74th Amendments with a scope for women's leadership. • Mention Achievements (political entry) and challenges (proxy Sarpanch, patriarchy, capacity gaps). • Give a conclusion by mentioning Training, 50% reservation, and digital literacy can enhance empowerment.
Introduction	The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992–93) marked a turning point in women's political empowerment by reserving one-third of seats in Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs). This constitutional guarantee has enabled millions of rural and urban women to participate in governance, thus strengthening grassroots democracy and advancing gender justice.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Scope of Women's Political Empowerment through the Panchayat Raj:** • **Enhanced Representation**: The country has approximately 14.5 lakh Elected Women Representatives (EWRs) in Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs), which accounts for about 46% of the total elected representatives. • **Policy Impact**: ✓ Women leaders prioritize social issues like drinking water, sanitation, health, and education. ✓ For instance, in Haryana and Bihar, women sarpanches spearheaded sanitation drives under Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. • **Leadership Development:** Political participation at the local level acts as a stepping stone for women's entry into state and national politics. • **Social Empowerment**: Women's presence challenges patriarchal norms, inspiring greater acceptance of female leadership in rural India. **Challenges involved in the political empowerment of women through the Panchayat Raj:** • **Proxy Representation**: In many villages, husbands or male relatives (Sarpanch Pati) exercise real power. • **Capacity Deficit:** Lack of training and awareness about governance reduces women's effectiveness.

	• **Social Barriers:** Patriarchal mindset, caste discrimination, and gender bias undermine women's autonomy. • **Financial Constraints**: Limited control over funds and bureaucratic hurdles hinder independent decision-making. **Suggestions for Strengthening Political Empowerment through the Panchayat Raj:** • **Capacity Building:** Regular training in leadership, budgeting, and digital governance. • **Stronger Legal Safeguards**: Enforce penalties against proxy governance. • **Increased Reservation:** Moving from 33% to 50% reservation, already implemented in states like Bihar and Madhya Pradesh. • **Networking & Mentorship:** Encourage women's federations and SHGs to support elected representatives.
Conclusion	Women's reservation in local governance has transformed India's democratic landscape, but empowerment remains uneven due to social and institutional challenges. Strengthening legal safeguards, enhancing capacity, and ensuring financial autonomy will help convert numerical representation into substantive empowerment, thereby fostering inclusive and participatory governance in both rural and urban India.
Model Question	Discuss the scope and challenges of political empowerment of women through Panchayati Raj Institutions. Suggest measures to enhance women's effective participation in rural and urban local governance.
Value Addition	**Women and Panchayati Raj:** • Political Empowerment of women starts with the active participation of women in political institutions. • The grassroots level democracy entails due importance to the initial participation of women in Panchayati Raj Institutions. • Even though in today's political system, where some reservations have been provided to women in local bodies, that has been misused by some i.e., women have been used as rubber-stamps. • Actual decision are being taken by their male family members. Women may have stormed the male bastion under the Panchayati Raj system, but in many cases, it is the husbands or male members of their families calling their shots. • Elected women representatives have reportedly been reduced to proxies of their male relatives. • Such a system of de facto rule by male counterparts has to be checked, and due importance has to be given to women in PRIs. • The political system and decision-making process are seen clearly in the changes incorporated in the Panchayati Raj Institution.

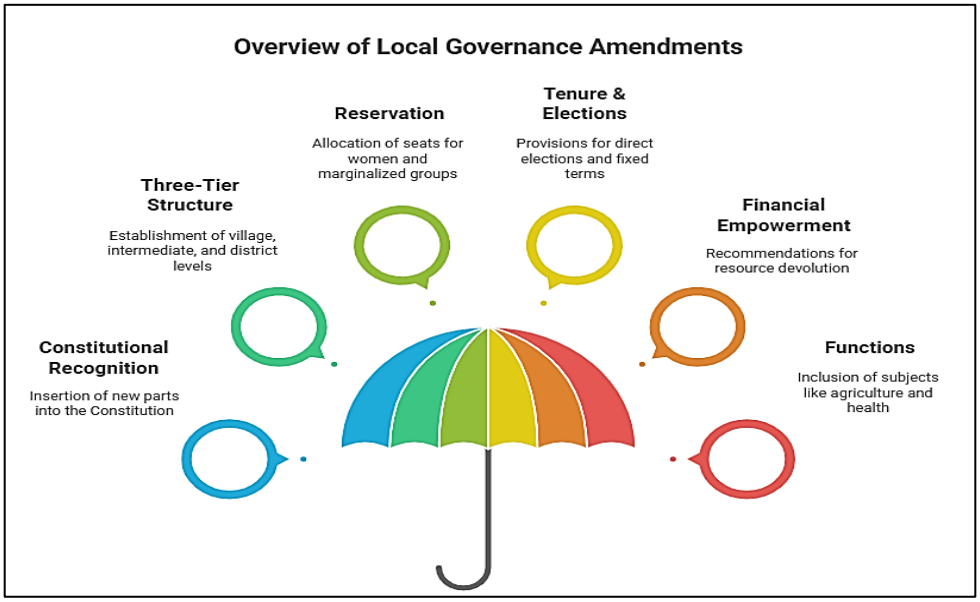


	• The objective of bringing improvement in the socio-economic condition of women could be successful only by taking suitable initiatives and measures for empowering them. • Empowerment of women will not be possible unless they are provided proper representation in the political system. • This objective should be achieved at the desired level through making the provision of linking and associating the maximum number of women in political affairs, even at the lowest level of political activity. • In recently introduced Panchayati Raj Institutions, the policy for reservation in favour of women has therefore been thought of as an important approach to maximize their participation at the local level.
23. Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendments of the Indian Constitution. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Mention how both amendments institutionalized local governance. • Describe the main features of the 73rd and 74th amendments of the Indian Constitution. • Mention how amendments strengthened democracy, but implementation is uneven.
Introduction	The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts (1992–93) are considered watershed moments in Indian democracy. They gave constitutional status to Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), thereby institutionalizing grassroots democracy. These amendments operationalized the vision of Mahatma Gandhi's Gram Swaraj and strengthened urban self-governance in the spirit of democratic decentralization.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Main Features of the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992 and 74th Amendment Act, 1993:** • **Main Features of the 73rd Amendment (Rural Local Governance) Act, 1992:** ✓ **Constitutional Recognition:** The amendment inserted Part IX (Articles 243–243O) and the 11th Schedule in the Indian Constitution. ✓ **Three-Tier Structure:** The act includes Village, Intermediate (Mandal/Block), and District level Panchayats (Zilla Parishads). ✓ **Reservation:** One-third seats are reserved for women, and proportionate reservation was given for SCs, STs which was later extended to OBCs under the act. ✓ **Tenure & Elections**: The amendment provides for direct elections for panchayats with a 5-year term, conducted by the State Election Commission.



	✓ **Financial Empowerment**: The State Finance Commission recommends resource devolution to the panchayats. ✓ **Functions:** The act included 29 subjects in the eleventh Schedule (e.g., agriculture, health, education, poverty alleviation) of the Constitution. • **Main Features of the 74th Amendment (Urban Local Governance)** ✓ **Constitutional Recognition**: The act inserted Part IXA (Articles 243P–243ZG) and the twelfth Schedule in the constitution. ✓ **Urban Bodies**: The act provides for different types of urban bodies, such as Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council, Municipal Corporation, and so on. ✓ **Reservation:** One-third seats are reserved for women, SCs, STs, and OBCs in the urban local bodies. ✓ **Planning Role:** Ward Committees are set up in large municipalities; Metropolitan Planning Committees for cities above 10 lakh population. ✓ **Functions:** ▪ The amendment listed 18 subjects in the twelfth Schedule of the Constitution (e.g., urban planning, water supply, public health, slum improvement). ▪ **Example:** The Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority (HMDA) functions under provisions of the 74th Amendment for integrated city planning.
Conclusion	The 73rd and 74th Amendments have deepened participatory democracy by empowering rural and urban local bodies with constitutional legitimacy. Despite challenges like inadequate devolution of powers and financial constraints, these reforms remain pillars of democratic decentralization, bridging the gap between citizens and governance
Model Question	Describe the salient features of the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments. How have they institutionalized rural and urban local self-governance in India?
Value Addition	**Powers and Functions of Panchayats:** • The powers and functions of the Panchayats are endowed by the State legislature. • The Panchayats prepare a plan for economic development and social justice for the people of the Panchayats. • It implements the scheme of the Central and State governments for the betterment of the people at the ground level. • Panchayats have the power to enhance employment facilities and undertake development activities in the area.
24. Describe the salient features of the Rural and Urban Local Governance under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Give introduction about 73rd (rural PRIs) and 74th (urban ULBs) amendments • Mention 11th Schedule, 29 subjects; 12th Schedule, 18 functions, ward/metropolitan committees. • Conclude how both amendments Institutionalized local self-governance, but with uneven devolution.
Introduction	The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992–93) marked a watershed in India's democratic journey by granting constitutional status to local self-governments in rural and urban areas. They institutionalized the third tier of governance, thereby ensuring participatory democracy, decentralization, and inclusive development.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Main Features of the 73rd Amendment Act, 1992 (Rural Local Governance) and 74th Amendment Act, 1993(Urban Local Governance):** • **Main Features of the 73rd Amendment (Rural Local Governance) Act, 1992:**

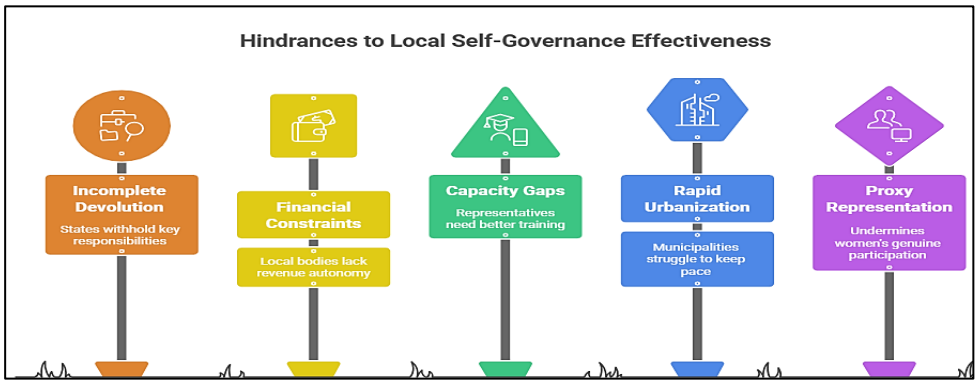
- ✓ **Constitutional Recognition:** The amendment inserted Part IX (Articles 243–243O) and the 11th Schedule in the Indian Constitution.
- ✓ **Three-Tier Structure:** The act includes Village, Intermediate (Mandal/Block), and District level Panchayats (Zilla Parishads).
- ✓ **Reservation:** One-third seats are reserved for women, and proportionate reservation was given for SCs, STs which was later extended to OBCs under the act.
- ✓ **Tenure & Elections**: The amendment provides for direct elections for panchayats with a 5-year term, conducted by the State Election Commission.
- ✓ **Financial Empowerment**: The State Finance Commission recommends resource devolution to the panchayats.
- ✓ **Functions:** The act included 29 subjects in the eleventh Schedule (e.g., agriculture, health, education, poverty alleviation) of the Constitution.

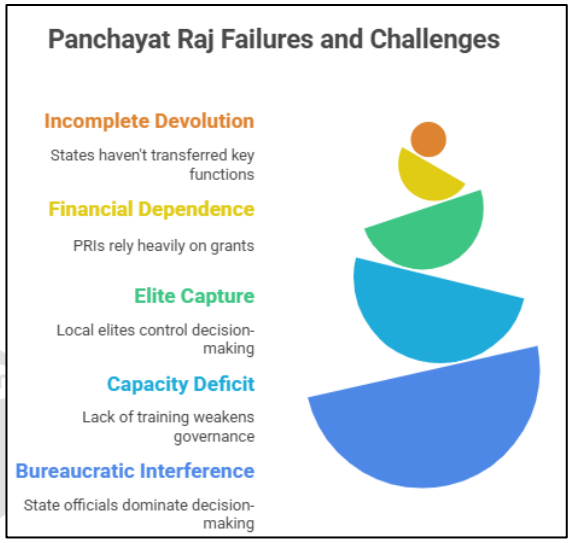


- **Main Features of the 74th Amendment (Urban Local Governance)**
  - ✓ **Constitutional Recognition**: The act inserted Part IXA (Articles 243P–243ZG) and the twelfth Schedule in the constitution.
  - ✓ **Urban Bodies**: The act provides for different types of urban bodies, such as Nagar Panchayat, Municipal Council, Municipal Corporation, and so on.
  - ✓ **Reservation:** One-third seats are reserved for women, SCs, STs, and OBCs in the urban local bodies.
  - ✓ **Planning Role:** Ward Committees are set up in large municipalities; Metropolitan Planning Committees for cities above 10 lakh population.
  - ✓ **Functions:**
  - ▪ The amendment listed 18 subjects in the twelfth Schedule of the Constitution (e.g., urban planning, water supply, public health, slum improvement).
  - ▪ Example: The Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority (HMDA) functions under the provisions of the 74th Amendment for integrated city planning.

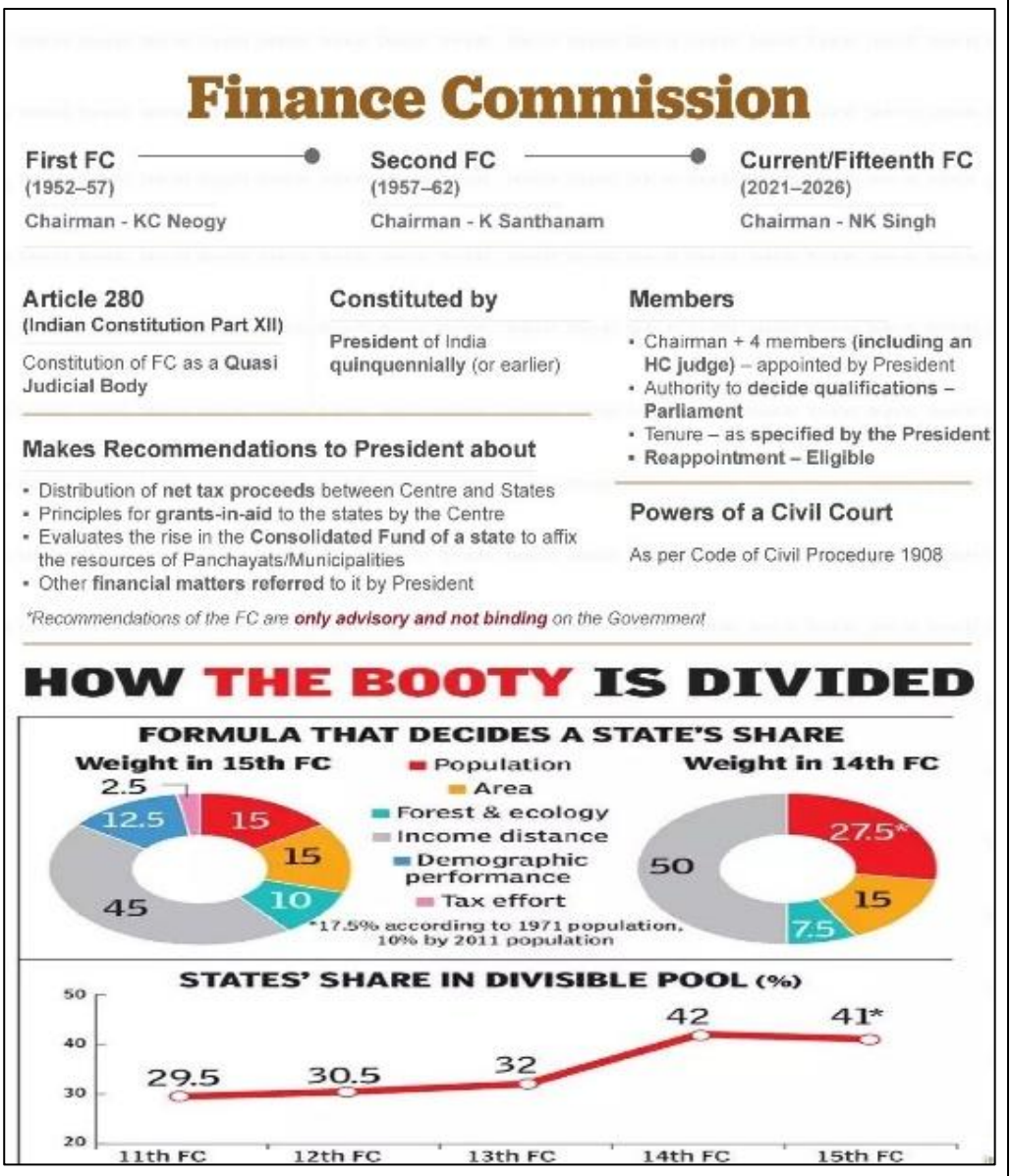
Conclusion	The 73rd and 74th Amendments transformed local governance by institutionalizing grassroots democracy in both rural and urban India. While challenges like inadequate devolution and financial dependence remain, these amendments represent a decisive

	step toward democratic decentralization and inclusive governance, fulfilling the vision of Gram Swaraj and citizen-led development.
Model Question	Describe the salient features of rural and urban local governance as provided under the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments. How do these provisions strengthen democratic decentralization?
Value Addition	**Article 243V of the Indian Constitution:** • The article talks about the grounds for the disqualification of members of the Municipality. It states that a person shall be disqualified on the following grounds: ✓ If he is disqualified under any law for the time being in force for elections to the legislature of the state concerned; or ✓ If he is disqualified under any law made by the State legislature. ✓ However, no person shall be disqualified on the ground that he is less than 25 years of age if he has attained the age of 21 years.
25. Critically examine the implementations of the 73rd and 74th Amendments. How far is it effective? (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Critically examine, How far
Approach	• Mention that implementations of the 73rd and 74th Amendments provided a framework for democratic decentralization. • Mention Achievements (representation, participation) vs challenges (funds, bureaucracy, weak urban bodies). • Mention how the amendments are effective in principle, weak in practice and reforms needed.
Introduction	The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992–93) provided constitutional recognition to Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), marking a historic step toward democratic decentralization. These reforms aimed to realize Mahatma Gandhi's vision of Gram Swaraj and improve participatory governance. However, their implementation has been uneven and faces several challenges.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The implementation of the 73rd and 74th Amendments:** • **Achievements in Implementation of the 73rd and 74th Amendments:** ✓ **Wider Representation:** Over 30 lakh elected representatives, including more than 14 lakh women, have entered grassroots politics. ▪ **Example:** Women Sarpanches in Rajasthan and Bihar are spearheading sanitation drives under Swachh Bharat Abhiyan. ✓ **Inclusive Governance**: Reservation for SCs, STs, and OBCs strengthened the political participation of marginalized groups. ✓ **Decentralized Planning**: Kerala's People's Plan Campaign (1996) is a successful model of PRI-led participatory planning. ✓ **Improved Service Delivery**: PRIs and ULBs now play key roles in implementing flagship schemes like MGNREGS, PMAY (Gramin & Urban), and Swachh Bharat Mission. • **Challenges in the Effective Implementation of the 73rd and 74th Amendments:** ✓ **Incomplete Devolution**: Despite the 11th and 12th Schedules, states hesitate to transfer the "3Fs"—Functions, Funds, and Functionaries to panchayats and urban local bodies. ✓ **Financial Constraints**: Local bodies remain dependent on central and state grants rather than their revenue. ✓ **Capacity Gaps**: Many elected representatives lack training in administration, finance, and digital governance.

	✓ **Urban Challenges**: Rapid urbanization has outpaced municipal capacities. ▪ For e.g., Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority faces resource and coordination issues. ✓ **Proxy Representation**: In rural areas, Sarpanch Pati culture undermines women's genuine participation. 
Conclusion	The 73rd and 74th Amendments have deepened democracy by institutionalizing local governance. Yet, their effectiveness remains partial due to limited devolution, financial dependence, and capacity deficits. Strengthening fiscal autonomy, enforcing real devolution of powers, and capacity-building are essential to make PRIs and ULBs the true "third tier of governance", ensuring responsive and participatory democracy.
Model Question	Critically examine the implementation of the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments. To what extent have they been effective in achieving democratic decentralization?
Value Addition	**Article 243U of the Indian Constitution:** • It deals with the duration of Municipalities. • It states that - ✓ Municipalities have been provided with a five-year term of office at every level. It can, however, be dissolved before the completion of its term. ✓ A municipality, if elected after the dissolution of the municipality, shall continue for the remaining period for which the dissolved municipality would have continued had it not been dissolved.
26. Panchayati Raj is a "God that failed"-Evaluate. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Rural and Urban Local Governance under 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment
Keyword	Evaluate
Approach	• Give an introduction on how high hopes were raised from the 73rd Amendment but mixed results. • Mention Achievements (representation, scheme delivery) vs failures (elite capture, lack of funds, proxy leadership). • Mention that Panchayat Raj is not a total failure, needs better 3Fs (funds, functions, functionaries).
Introduction	The Panchayati Raj System (PRS) was constitutionally recognized through the 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act of 1992 to realize Mahatma Gandhi's vision of Gram Swaraj. It was expected to empower rural citizens, ensure participatory democracy, and promote bottom-up planning. However, despite over three decades of existence, its performance has been mixed, leading some critics to describe it as a "God that failed."
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Achievements of Panchayati Raj:** ✓ **Democratization of Grassroots:** With over 30 lakh elected representatives, PRS is the world's largest democratic experiment.

	✓ **Women's Empowerment:** One-third reservation has enabled more than 14 lakh women leaders, with some states like Bihar extending it to 50%. ✓ **Social Justice:** Reservation for SCs, STs, and OBCs ensured representation of marginalized communities. ✓ **Local Service Delivery:** Panchayats play key roles in implementing MGNREGS, PMGSY, Swachh Bharat Mission, etc. • **Failures and Challenges in Panchayat Raj:** ✓ **Incomplete Devolution:** Many states have not transferred the 3Fs – Funds, Functions, and Functionaries. ▪ Example: Education, health, and water supply are still controlled by state departments. ✓ **Financial Dependence:** PRIs rely heavily on grants and have minimal own-source revenue. ✓ **Elite Capture and Proxy Representation:** Local elites and Sarpanch Patis often control decision-making, undermining democratic ideals. ✓ **Capacity Deficit:** Lack of training and awareness among representatives weakens effective governance. ✓ **Bureaucratic Interference:** State officials often dominate decision-making, reducing Panchayat autonomy. 
Conclusion	While Panchayati Raj has deepened democracy and broadened political participation, it has fallen short of expectations due to weak devolution, financial dependence, and social barriers. Thus, the metaphor of a "God that failed" reflects its unrealized potential. Strengthening fiscal autonomy, genuine devolution, and capacity-building are essential to make Panchayati Raj the foundation of rural self-governance as envisaged by the Constitution.
Model Question	The Panchayati Raj system, despite constitutional backing, is often described as a 'God that failed.' Evaluate this statement with reference to its achievements and limitations.
Value Addition	**Balwant Rai Mehta Committee:** • In 1957, the National Development Council constituted a committee headed by Balwant Rai Mehta to look into the working of the community development programme. • The team observed that the major reason for the failure of the CDP was the lack of people's participation. • The committee suggested a three-tier PRIs, namely, Grama Panchayats (GPs) at the village level, Panchayat Samiti (PSs) at the block level, and Zilla Parishad (ZPs) at the district level. • As a result of this scheme of democratic decentralization was launched in Rajasthan on October 2, 1959.

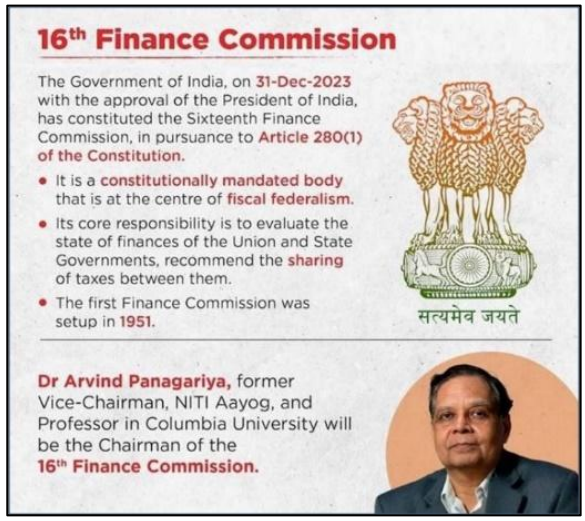
	• In Andhra Pradesh, the scheme was introduced on 1st November, 1959. The necessary legislation had also been passed and implemented in Assam, Gujarat, Karnataka, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Odisha, and Punjab etc.
27. The Finance Commission is considered the backbone of fiscal federalism in India. Examine its role and significance in maintaining the financial balance between the Union and the States. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Introduce the Finance Commission as a constitutional body under Article 280 and highlight its role in strengthening fiscal federalism in India. • Examine its key functions, mechanisms of resource devolution, performance-linked incentives, limitations, and recent developments affecting Union–State financial relations. • Conclude by emphasizing its continuing significance in balancing equity with efficiency.
Introduction	The Finance Commission, a constitutionally mandated body under Article 280, plays a pivotal role in India's fiscal federalism. Its mandate is to recommend how financial resources, especially tax revenues and grants, should be shared between the Centre and States. Over seven-decade history, it has evolved as the key institution for balancing vertical and horizontal equity in intergovernmental fiscal transfers.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role and significance of the Finance Commission:** • **Vertical Devolution: Balancing Centre–State Resources:** The Commission recommends the percentage share of states in the divisible pool under Article 270. ✓ The 15th Finance Commission maintained state share at 41% for 2021–26—reaffirming a steady fiscal transfer despite GST implementation. ✓ By periodically revising share, the Commission helps states manage their revenue needs in alignment with national imperatives. • **Horizontal Devolution: Ensuring Equity Among States:** The Commission formulates formulae to allocate funds among states based on criteria such as population, income distance, area, Forest& Ecology, Demographic performance, Tax Effort. ✓ 15th Finance Commission's parameters are largely unchanged from the 14th, ensuring continuity and comparability. ✓ States like Karnataka have criticized the weightage of "income distance" for disadvantaging well-performing states, pushing for a "growth-oriented" formula. • **Grants-in-Aid for Specific Needs:** Under Article 275, the Commission recommends non-plan grants, revenue-deficit support, and incentive grants tied to performance. ✓ The 14th FC emphasized fiscal discipline via conditional grants for local bodies. ✓ The 15th FC maintained focus on local self-governance support, post-Planning Commission abolition. • **Incentivizing Reform and Fiscal Responsibility:** The Finance Commission uses conditional grants to encourage fiscal prudence and governance reforms. ✓ The 15th FC advocated rewarding states that reduced populist outlays and improved fiscal consolidation. ✓ This conditional framework helped embed a culture of outcome-oriented fiscal discipline.



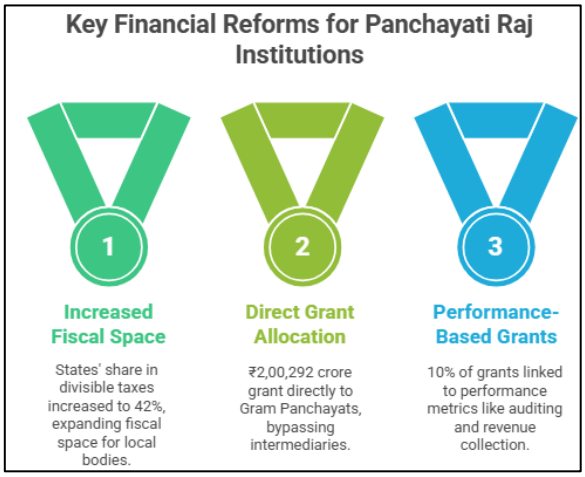
- **Sustaining Cooperative Federalism and Adaptability:**
  The Commission collaborates closely with central and state governments, reinforcing **cooperative federalism** through dialogue and data-driven policy.
  - ✓ With the introduction of GST, the Commission's role grew in importance amid shifting fiscal dynamics.
  - ✓ Policy and academic reviews highlight the Commission's evolving role in balancing fiscal federalism amid economic changes.
- **Challenges and Limitations:**
  - ✓ **Advisory Nature:** Its recommendations are non-binding, and their implementation depends on governmental acceptance.
  - ✓ **Perceived Bias:** Some states argue the formulas still penalize progressive states, calling for greater sensitivity. The use of the 2011 census for allocations, as opposed to the 1971 baseline, has raised alarms in states like Kerala and Tamil Nadu.

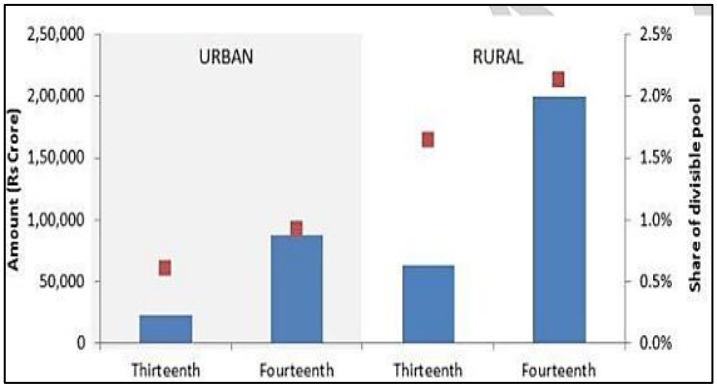
	✓ **Data and Governance Gaps**: Effective formulation hinges on updated and accurate fiscal data, often lacking. The **Reserve Bank of India** has cautioned that states must establish clear fiscal consolidation paths and improve liability reporting.
Conclusion	The Finance Commission is indeed the backbone of fiscal federalism, mediating financial equity and stability between the Union and the States. Through its balanced approach to vertical and horizontal devolution, grants, and conditional incentives, it sustains India's federal fiscal framework. To further strengthen its impact, there is a need for greater implementation of its recommendations, updated data systems, and evolving to address emerging challenges like GST-linked revenues and local governance financing.
Model Question	In the context of GST implementation, evaluate its impact on fiscal autonomy of States.
Value Addition	The 15th Finance Commission weightage for horizontal devolution: • Income Distance – 45% • Demographic Performance – 12.5% • Forest & Ecology – 10% • Tax & Fiscal Efforts – 2.5% • Area – 15% • Population – 15%
28. 'The Finance Commission, though not being a permanent body, has still maintained its credibility by promoting fiscal democracy in India, - Comment. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Introduce by mentioning the constitutional mandate of the Finance Commission, its constitutional mandate under Article 280, and the idea of fiscal democracy in India. • Discuss how despite being a temporary body, successive Finance Commissions have ensured credibility through formula-based transfers, promotion of cooperative federalism, empowerment of local bodies, and adaptability to reforms like GST. • Conclude by commenting that the Finance Commission, though non-permanent, remains a credible institution vital for sustaining fiscal federalism and democratic governance in India.
Introduction	While the Finance Commission (FC) is constitutionally a temporary body (established every five years under Article 280), it has steadfastly preserved its credibility and strengthened fiscal democracy through transparent, formula-based fiscal transfers, capacity enhancement of local governance, and institutional respect for federalism.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Design & Mechanism of Finance Commission:** • The Finance Commission is tasked with recommending the distribution of net tax proceeds between the Union and States, along with grants-in-aid to States and support to Panchayats and Municipalities (Article 280(3)). • Despite being non-permanent, its reports are systematically submitted to President of India and debated in Parliament, upholding accountability and transparency **Maintaining Credibility through Fiscal Democracy:** • **Formula-Based, Equitable Transfers:** ✓ The 15th Finance Commission (FC) adopted criteria like 2011 Census population (15%), area (15%), forest & ecology (10%), income distance (45%), and tax & fiscal effort (2.5% each) to ensure fairness. • **Promoting Cooperative Federalism & Local Governance:**

	✓ The 15th FC allocated ₹4.36 lakh crore to local bodies (2021–26), with 60% earmarked for basic services like sanitation, drinking water, and waste management. ✓ Example: Tied grants under this mechanism strengthened municipal capacities in urban sanitation, aligned with Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban 2.0. • **Institutional Credibility through Continuity and Adaptability:** ✓ The 14th FC recommended raising states' share in central taxes from 32% to 42%, a landmark shift that the 15th FC retained at 41% (post-J&K reorganization), showing continuity. ✓ Example: The FC incorporated GST compensation cess flows and devised strategies to offset volatility in state revenues post-GST implementation. **Contemporary Challenges & Responses:** • **Evolving Mandate and Institutional Constraints:** ✓ While its temporary status limits continuity, FC reports and recommendations are tabled in Parliament, fostering transparency. ✓ However, some experts suggest a permanent intergovernmental platform for managing conditional transfers • **Tensions in Tax Devolution:** ✓ Recent discussions indicate a proposal to reduce states' share from 41% to 40% in 2026–27, a development stirring debate over fiscal federal balance. ✓ Conversely, Uttar Pradesh has pushed for raising the share up to 50%, highlighting diverging state demands. • **Conditionalities vs Equity:** ✓ Nagpur Municipal Corporation's inability to comply with conditions (like elections and tax hikes) cost it FC grants worth ₹270 crore, raising equity concerns. ✓ Additionally, Karnataka seeks recalibration of allocation weights to reflect contribution rather than only backwardness.
Conclusion	Even as a non-permanent entity, the Finance Commission has consistently lived up to its constitutional promise, upholding fiscal democracy through impartial, formula-based transfers, advancing fiscal federalism, and enabling local self-governance. Its resilience and relevance, especially amid fiscal reforms like GST, affirm its role as a credible guardian of India's intergovernmental fiscal architecture.
Model Question	Discuss the relevance of the Finance Commission in the post-GST era.
Value Addition	**Terms of Reference for the Sixteenth Finance Commission:** The Finance Commission shall make recommendations as to the following matters, namely: • The distribution between the Union and the States of the net proceeds of taxes which are to be, or may be, divided between them under Chapter I, Part XII of the



	Constitution and the allocation between the States of the respective shares of such proceeds; • The principles which should govern the grants-in-aid of the revenues of the States out of the Consolidated Fund of India and the sums to be paid to the States by way of grants-in-aid of their revenues under article 275 of the Constitution for the purposes other than those specified in the provisos to clause (1) of that article; • The measures needed to augment the Consolidated Fund of a State to supplement the resources of the Panchayats and Municipalities in the State on the basis of the recommendations made by the Finance Commission of the State.
29. Briefly describe the recommendations of the 14th Finance Commission with regard to devolution of funds to rural local bodies (Panchayati Raj Institutions). What measures have been implemented by the Government of India for monitoring and auditing the finances of Panchayati Raj Institutions? (APPSC, 2017)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	Briefly describe, What
Approach	• Give an introduction on how the 14th FC enhanced fiscal federalism (Y.V. Reddy). • Mention that the 14th FC recommended 3% divisible pool for PRIs, grants, social audits, and state audit bodies. • Mention how 14th FC boosted fiscal space, but accountability remains key.
Introduction	The 14th Finance Commission (2015–2020), chaired by Dr. Y.V. Reddy, made significant recommendations to strengthen fiscal federalism and local self-governance. For the first time, it gave substantial importance to direct devolution of funds to Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs), thereby empowering them financially to fulfil their constitutional mandate under the 73rd Amendment.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Recommendations of the 14th Finance Commission for Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs):** • **Increased Share of States**: The commission recommended increasing states' share in divisible taxes from 32% to 42%, thereby expanding the fiscal space for local bodies. • **Grant to PRIs:** It recommended a grant of ₹2,00,292 crore to Gram Panchayats for 2015–20, marking a threefold increase over the 13th Finance Commission. • **Basic and Performance Grants:** ✓ **90% Basic Grant:** The commission gave unconditional support for basic services like sanitation, water supply, and street lighting. ✓ **10% Performance Grant:** It is linked to measures such as accounts auditing, revenue collection, and timely reporting. • **Direct Transfer to Gram Panchayats:** ✓ The Funds were released directly to Gram Panchayats, bypassing intermediaries, ensuring better accountability.



	✓ Example: States like Kerala and Karnataka effectively utilized these grants to strengthen solid waste management and e-governance in panchayats. **Measures implemented by the Government of India (GoI) for monitoring and auditing the finances of Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs):** • **Online Accounting Systems**: The GOI introduced the Panchayat Enterprise Suite (PES) under the e-Panchayat Mission Mode Project, including tools like PRIA Soft for financial reporting. • **Mandatory Audit:** All PRIs' accounts are subject to annual auditing by State Audit Departments. • **Social Audit:** The Indian government encouraged social audits under schemes like MGNREGS, ensuring community-based monitoring. • **Performance Benchmarks**: The Ministry of Panchayati Raj developed the Devolution Index to assess the extent of power and funds devolved to PRIs.
Conclusion	Thus, the 14th Finance Commission marked a landmark shift in empowering Panchayati Raj Institutions through enhanced fiscal transfers. With digital monitoring, mandatory audits, and social accountability mechanisms, PRIs are gradually becoming more transparent, accountable, and financially autonomous, thereby deepening grassroots democracy in India.
Model Question	Briefly describe the recommendations of the 14th Finance Commission regarding devolution of funds to Panchayati Raj Institutions. What monitoring and auditing measures has the Union Government implemented for the utilization of PRI finances?
Value Addition	**Fourteenth Finance Commission (FFC) and Local Government:** • The FFC has given the refreshing title "local governments" as against local bodies used by the previous commissions in the chapter dealing with grants to the third tier of government. • The 14th FC has given due consideration to the fiscal federalism framework in India by devolving a larger amount to local governments. • The 14th FC has recommended a grant-in-aid for local governments that is equal to an estimated 3% of the divisible pool. • This is higher than the recommended allocation of 2.5% by the 13th FC. • Equity is and should be the overarching concern of any federal polity worth the name. It is the underlying rationale for federalism.  • The choice of the 2011 population has adversely affected states like Kerala, Tamil Nadu, etc., which have undertaken family planning to contain population. • The effort of the Thirteenth Finance Commission to divide local government grants into basic unconditional grants and conditional performance grants was meant to incentivise the "laggards". • To avail of performance grants, the PRIs had to fulfil six conditionalities and urban local bodies nine. The FFC has not only reduced the share of performance grants to 10% from 34%, but the conditionalities are also made less demanding.

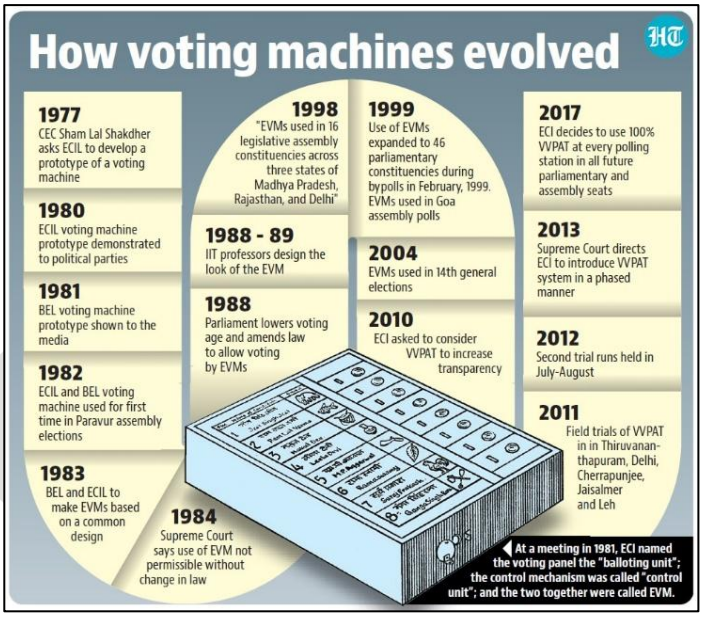
30. What is the difference between a National party and a Regional party, in case of parties recognised by the Election Commission of India? Explain the features of the Indian party system. (APPSC, 2017)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	What, Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining the recognition of political parties by the Election Commission of India and how the distinction between national and regional parties. • Explain the differences between national and regional parties based on criteria, symbols, and scope; then elaborate on the features of the Indian party system such as multi-party nature, coalition politics, role of regional aspirations, and electoral dynamics with examples. • Conclude by highlighting how the coexistence of national and regional parties ensures inclusivity and representation, strengthening Indian democracy.
Introduction	The Indian party system, among the world's most vibrant, is shaped by societal diversity and democratic constitutional framework. Under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, the Election Commission of India recognizes parties as national or state (regional) based on electoral performance. This distinction underscores the pan-Indian reach of some parties and the regional rootedness of others, reflecting pluralistic democracy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Difference between National and Regional Parties:** **National Party:** • Recognized across multiple states by the ECI. • Must secure at least 6% of valid votes in four or more states in a general election and win at least 4 seats in Lok Sabha, or win 2% of seats in Lok Sabha from at least 3 states. • Entitled to a reserved symbol across India. • **Present National Parties as on August 2025**: Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP), Indian National Congress (INC), Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP), Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), Communist Party of India (Marxist) (CPI (M)), National People's Party (NPP). **Regional (State) Party:** • Recognized within a particular state. • Must secure at least 6% of valid votes in that state and win at least 2 seats in the legislative assembly, or win 3% of the seats in assembly. • Reserved symbol applicable only within that state. • **Examples:** DMK (Tamil Nadu), TMC (West Bengal), TRS/BRS (Telangana), BJD (Odisha), JD(U) (Bihar), TDP (Andhra Pradesh). **Features of the Indian Party System:** • **Multi-party System with Federal Dynamics:** ✓ India has moved from Congress dominance in the 1950s–60s to a multi-party, coalition-oriented system since the late 1980s. ✓ Regional parties now play a decisive role in national politics. • **Dominance of National Parties alongside Strong Regional Parties:**

National Party	Regional Party
It influences the whole country.	It's influence is limited and region-based.
It takes national as well as international issues.	It is interested in promoting regional/state interest only.
It has to secure at least 6% of the total votes in the Lok Sabha elections or Assembly elections in 4 states and win at least 4 seats in the Lok Sabha.	It has to secure at least 6% of the total votes in an election to the Legislative Assembly of a state and win at least 2 seats in the State Assembly.

	✓ While BJP and INC remain the main pan-Indian contenders, regional parties wield significant influence in states and often shape coalition governments at the Centre (for example UPA, NDA alliances). • **Rise of Regional Aspirations:** ✓ Regional parties reflect linguistic, cultural, caste, and regional aspirations (Eg: DMK for Tamil identity, TMC in Bengal, BRS in Telangana). ✓ This has deepened democracy by making governance more representative. • **Coalition Politics and Federal Balance:** ✓ The coalition era (1990s–2014) highlighted the bargaining power of state parties, shaping central policies (Eg: GST negotiations, special category demands). ✓ Even after 2014, regional parties remain critical in the Rajya Sabha. • **Issue-based and Identity Politics** ✓ Parties mobilize voters on caste, religion, regional pride, or welfare policies. ✓ For instance, SP and BSP in Uttar Pradesh emerged from caste-based mobilization, while Shiv Sena grew around Marathi identity. • **Fragmentation and Electoral Volatility:** ✓ India's political landscape is marked by frequent realignments, defections, and shifting alliances, reflecting both the dynamism and instability of the system.
Conclusion	Thus, the distinction between national and regional parties underscores India's electoral diversity, while the features of the party system reflect its multi-layered federal democracy. Though fragmented, the system ensures that governance in India remains both inclusive and representative, balancing national integration with regional aspirations.
Model Question	The Model Code of Conduct (MCC) is more of a moral guideline than a legal instrument. Critically examine its effectiveness in ensuring free and fair elections.
Value Addition	**Some of the recommendations on simultaneous polls made by the high-level panel on simultaneous polls headed by Former President Ramnath Kovind are:** • The government must develop a legally-tenable mechanism in order to restore the cycle of simultaneous polls. • In the first stage, elections for the Lok Sabha and all state legislative assemblies can be held together. • In the second step, the elections to municipalities and panchayats will be synchronized with the Lok Sabha and state assemblies in such a way that the polls to municipalities and panchayats are held within 100 days of the holding of the parliamentary and Assembly elections. • For the purpose of synchronizing the Lok Sabha and Assembly elections, the president shall notify the date of the first sitting of the Lok Sabha after a general election as the "appointed date". • The tenure of all state assemblies formed via polls after the "appointed date" and before the expiry of the full term of the Lok Sabha will only be for the period ending up to the subsequent parliamentary polls. After this one-time transitory measure, all Lok Sabha and Assembly polls will be held simultaneously. • Fresh elections could be held to constitute a new Lok Sabha in the event of a hung House or a no-confidence motion or any such event.
31. Mention the important events in usage of Electronic Voting Machines (EVMs) in elections in India. Analyse the recent allegations on tampering of EVMs and suggest solutions. (APPSC, 2017)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role

Keyword	Analyse
Approach	• Introduce by briefly tracing the evolution of EVMs in India's electoral history and their intended role in strengthening democratic practices. • Explain key milestones in EVM usage, discuss recent allegations of tampering, evaluate their credibility, and suggest reforms or safeguards for transparency and trust. • Conclude by highlighting the balance between technological advancement and public confidence as vital for electoral legitimacy.
Introduction	India's electronic voting era began experimentally in 1982 and saw nationwide adoption by 2004, aimed at enhancing electoral transparency and efficiency. The introduction of VVPATs in 2013 further bolstered confidence, though recent allegations questioning EVM integrity cast doubts on their credibility.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Milestones in EVM Adoption:** • **1980s–1990s:** EVM prototypes by ECIL tested in 1982 Paravur by-election (Kerala); legal sanction introduced via the 1988 RFPA amendment; phased implementation began in 1998 and completed by 2004 for Lok Sabha polls. • **2013–2019:** VVPAT system rolled out in Noksen (2013), pilot-tested in multiple assembly and LS constituencies (2014), and mandated with 2% random verification after the Supreme Court's 2019 directive. • **2024 Supreme Court Ruling:** In *ADR vs ECI (2024)*, the apex court upheld EVM-VVPAT's credibility and rejected demands for full-scale cross-verification, while acknowledging the system's technical safeguards. **Analysis of Recent Tampering Allegations:** • **Election Commission's Rebuttal:** ✓ The ECI has reaffirmed EVM integrity across 42 judicial decisions. ✓ After the Maharashtra Assembly elections, checking and verification (C&V) of burnt memory showed no discrepancy between EVM counts and VVPAT slips. • **Technical Safeguards:** ✓ The Supreme Court highlighted neutral microcontrollers, hashed and burned firmware, and tamper-evident features (UADM) as strong preventive measures. • **Voices of Concern:** ✓ Despite these assurances, miscounts remain credible, such as the Haryana sarpanch recount at SC, which corrected a result after evidence of misattribution was found. ✓ Additionally, experts emphasize the lack of comprehensive audit trails in EVM-VVPAT systems, pointing to potential vulnerabilities.

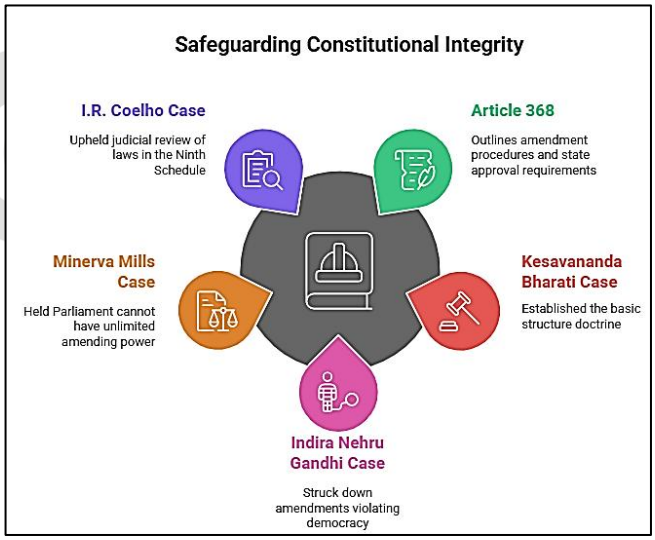


	Suggested Reforms to Strengthen Trust: • **Enhanced Audits:** Implement Risk-Limiting Audits (RLAs) and consider expanding VVPAT verification beyond the current 2–5% sampling. • **Technological Upgrades:** Explore AI-powered automated VVPAT counting, as researchers have proposed for efficient full-sample audits. • **Greater Transparency:** The ECI should proactively publish audit data—like mock poll results and C&V findings—and extend retention of EVM/VVPAT data until disputes are resolved. • **Judicial Oversight:** Judicial review of serious tampering claims, as seen in Haryana, provides vital redress. Additionally, simplifying verification protocols—as initiated in Maharashtra—can bolster credibility.
Conclusion	EVMs with VVPATs have undeniably enhanced India's electoral efficiency and integrity. However, continued transparency, technological innovation, and robust audit mechanisms are essential to safeguard voter trust. Balancing advanced electoral technology with public confidence remains critical to preserving the democratic legitimacy of elections.
Model Question	"Technology is a double-edged sword in electoral democracy." Comment in the context of the usage of EVMs in India.
Value Addition	**What is an Electronic Voting machine? In what way its functioning is different from the conventional system of voting?** • An Electronic Voting Machine consists of two Units: a Control Unit and a Balloting Unit, joined by a five-meter cable. The Control Unit is with the Presiding Officer or a Polling Officer and the Balloting Unit is placed inside the voting compartment. • Instead of issuing a ballot paper, the Polling Officer in-charge of the Control Unit will press the Ballot Button. This will enable the voter to cast his vote by pressing the blue button on the Balloting Unit against the candidate and symbol of his choice.
32. Discuss the powers and functions of the Election Commission of India and explain its role in protection of representative democracy in India. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	Discuss, Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining the Election Commission of India (ECI) as a constitutional body under Article 324 responsible for conducting free and fair elections in India. • Discuss its administrative, advisory, and quasi-judicial powers covering election management, party recognition, code of conduct enforcement, and dispute resolution. • Explain how ECI safeguards representative democracy through fair elections, voter awareness, inclusivity, and maintaining a level playing field. • Conclude by emphasizing its role as the guardian of India's electoral integrity and democratic legitimacy.
Introduction	The Election Commission of India (ECI), established under Article 324, is a constitutional body responsible for conducting free and fair elections in the country. It safeguards the democratic process by ensuring that the will of the people is reflected through transparent, impartial, and credible elections.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Powers and Functions of the Election Commission of India:** • **Administrative Powers:** ✓ Conduct of elections: The ECI prepares and revises electoral rolls, schedules elections, and ensures smooth conduct for Parliament, State Legislatures, and Presidential and Vice-Presidential elections.

	✓ Recognition of political parties: It registers political parties and grants them national or state status based on their performance. ✓ Allotment of symbols: The Commission allots election symbols and resolves disputes over party symbols in case of splits. ✓ Model Code of Conduct: It enforces the Model Code of Conduct (MCC) to ensure ethical campaigning and prevent misuse of power by ruling parties. ✓ Election observers: The ECI appoints observers to oversee polling and counting to maintain fairness and transparency. • **Quasi-Judicial Powers:** ✓ Settling disputes: It adjudicates disputes related to party recognition and election symbols. ✓ Advisory role: The Commission advises the President and Governors on disqualification of members under Articles 103 and 192. ✓ Cancelling polls: The ECI can countermand elections in cases of booth capturing, rigging, or electoral violence to preserve the sanctity of elections. • **Regulatory and Advisory Powers:** ✓ Monitoring expenditure: It regulates election expenditure to prevent the influence of money power. ✓ Law and order: It coordinates with state authorities to maintain security during elections. ✓ Technological innovations: The use of EVMs and VVPATs enhances accuracy and transparency in voting. **Role of the Election Commission in Protecting Representative Democracy:** • **Ensuring Free and Fair Elections:** ✓ By conducting periodic, transparent, and impartial elections, the ECI ensures that governments derive legitimacy from the people's mandate. The use of EVMs and VVPATs has strengthened public confidence in electoral integrity. • **Maintaining Level Playing Field:** ✓ Through the enforcement of the Model Code of Conduct, the ECI ensures equal opportunity for all political parties by curbing misuse of government resources and preventing unfair advantages to incumbents. • **Promoting Voter Awareness and Inclusivity:** ✓ Initiatives such as SVEEP (Systematic Voters' Education and Electoral Participation) encourage greater voter participation, especially among youth, women, and marginalized groups, thereby deepening the roots of democracy. • **Regulating Political Parties and Candidates:** ✓ By mandating financial disclosures and ethical conduct, the ECI promotes internal party democracy and accountability, which are essential for the health of representative institutions.
Conclusion	The Election Commission of India acts as the guardian of electoral democracy, ensuring that elections remain the true reflection of the people's voice. By maintaining transparency, fairness, and credibility in the electoral process, it reinforces the foundation of India's representative and participatory democracy.
Model Question	"Examine the significance of the Election Commission of India in ensuring free, fair, and transparent elections. How does it uphold the principles of electoral integrity and strengthen democratic governance in the country?"
Value Addition	• The present Chief Election Commissioner of India is Shri Gyanesh Kumar, who assumed charge on February 19, 2025.

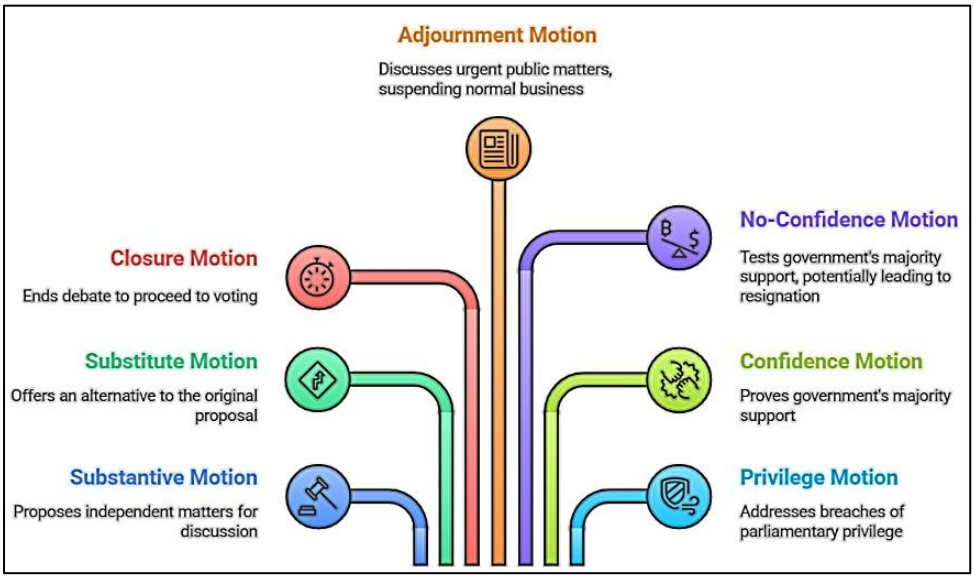
	• He is the 26th person to hold the post and previously served as an Election Commissioner. • Assumed office: February 19, 2025.
33. "The Comptroller and Auditor-General of India is a friend, philosopher and guide of Public Accounts Committee"-Discuss. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Constitutional Authorities and their Role
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by outlining the constitutional role of the CAG (Articles 148–151) and the mandate of the PAC in financial oversight. • Discuss how the CAG assists the PAC through audit reports, expert guidance, and independence, while also examining limitations in follow-up and executive compliance. • Conclude by emphasizing the symbiotic relationship between CAG and PAC, suggesting reforms to strengthen accountability and fiscal democracy.
Introduction	The Comptroller and Auditor-General (CAG) of India, established under Articles 148–151 of the Constitution, acts as the guardian of public finances. By auditing Union and State accounts, the CAG enforces executive accountability to the legislature. The Public Accounts Committee (PAC) relies on these audit findings for scrutiny, making the CAG rightly termed the "friend, philosopher, and guide" of the PAC.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role of CAG as a Friend of PAC:** • **Independent Audit Reports:** The CAG audits Union and State accounts, public enterprises, and government-funded schemes, providing the PAC with objective and detailed reports. • **Facilitating Legislative Oversight:** By bringing out irregularities, inefficiencies, and instances of wasteful expenditure, the CAG enables PAC to examine the executive effectively. ✓ Example: CAG's audit on Bihar's state finances (FY 2023-24) revealed GSDP growth of 14.47%, but also pointed to rising liabilities and underutilized budget allocations, insights crucial for PAC's fiscal review and budgetary accountability. • **Highlighting Accountability**: The CAG bridges the gap between executive action and parliamentary scrutiny, ensuring fiscal discipline. ✓ Example: The CAG's warning about Karnataka's five guarantee schemes burdening the exchequer leading to a ₹63,000 crore borrowing and reduced capital expenditure, is now under PAC scrutiny **Role of CAG as a Philosopher and guide:** • **Guiding Principles of Audit:** The CAG's audits are not limited to financial compliance but also focus on performance and efficiency audits, thus shaping broader parliamentary discussions on governance and resource utilization. ✓ CAG's audit of the Ayushman Bharat – PMJAY scheme flagged irregularities like ghost beneficiaries and improper claims, sparking discussions on healthcare accountability. • **Setting Standards:** The CAG's methodologies, transparency norms, and emphasis on propriety instill higher standards of governance. ✓ Example: Audit of GST compensation cess pointed out lapses in transfer to states, prompting greater scrutiny of Centre–State fiscal relations. • **Educative Role**: By exposing loopholes in financial administration, the CAG acts as a moral compass for PAC, steering it towards ethical and efficient oversight.

	• **Assisting PAC in Examinations:** PAC depends on the CAG's expert advice and technical guidance to interpret financial complexities. ✓ Example: CAG's audit of highway projects under Bharatmala Pariyojana exposed delays and cost overruns, enabling PAC to question implementation bottlenecks. • **Suggesting Reforms:** Audit recommendations often push PAC to demand structural reforms in financial and administrative systems. • **Capacity Building:** The CAG, through detailed audits, trains and informs legislators in the art of financial scrutiny, especially important given the technical nature of public finance. ✓ Example: PAC's mandate for follow-up action in Delhi's excise policy case, including summoning key officials, demonstrates CAG's guidance translating into accountability actions **Limitations in CAG–PAC Relationship:** • **Advisory Nature of CAG Reports**: The CAG can only highlight irregularities; enforcement depends on PAC and government action, reducing effectiveness. • **Delay in Examination:** PAC's examination of CAG reports is often delayed, undermining timely accountability. • **Overloaded Agenda:** PAC has a wide mandate but limited time and resources, which dilutes the impact of CAG's findings. • **Lack of Follow-Up:** Many CAG recommendations remain unimplemented, limiting their practical impact. In Karnataka, concerns over state finances despite warnings underscore this limitation. • **Political Constraints**: PAC decisions, though non-partisan in principle, may face political resistance in practice.
Conclusion	The CAG acts as a "friend, philosopher, and guide" to the PAC by strengthening parliamentary financial oversight and fostering fiscal democracy. Yet, its effectiveness depends on PAC's diligence and the executive's responsiveness to recommendations. Delays, weak follow-up, and political constraints limit impact. Strengthening accountability mechanisms and timely action can further enhance this vital institution of financial governance in India.
Model Question	"The CAG strengthens fiscal democracy, but its effectiveness depends on the seriousness of the legislature and executive." Analyse.
Value Addition	• Indian Railways utilized the profit from freight traffic to cross-subsidies losses on the operation of passenger and other coaching services during 2022-23, a latest Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) report has shown. • The CAG found that while the Railways, after working out its earnings and expenditures, presented a net profit of Rs 2,517.38 crore, when the loss in passenger services was compensated by the profit from freight services, it showed a net loss of Rs 5,257.07 crore. • The audit showed that Railways' total working expenditure (including appropriation to various funds) stood at Rs 2,37,659.58 crore, whereas its earnings from passenger, coaching, freight, and other services were Rs. 2,40,176.96 crore, generating a surplus of 2,517.38 crore.
4. Parliament and State Legislatures — structure, functioning, conduct of business, powers & privileges and issues arising out of these	
34. The powers of the Parliament to amend the Constitution of India is limited. Examine with examples. (TGPSC, 2024)	

Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Mention Article 368 and amending procedures. • Discuss Kesavananda Bharati's Basic Structure doctrine and limits - change to essential features like federalism, separation of powers, judicial review. • State that limits preserve constitutional identity.
Introduction	Article 368 of the Constitution empowers Parliament to amend the Constitution to meet evolving needs. However, this power is not absolute. Judicial interpretation, especially the Basic Structure Doctrine, has placed substantive limits to ensure that amendments do not alter the Constitution's fundamental identity.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The Powers of Parliament to Amend the Constitution are Limited:** • **Constitutional Provisions for Amendment:** ✓ Article 368: ▪ The article provides three procedures for amendment of the constitution, such as simple majority, special majority, and special majority, with ratification by states. ▪ The Parliament can amend most provisions, but certain federal features require state approval. • **Judicial Limitations on Amending Powers of the Parliament:** ✓ **Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973):** The case established that while Parliament can amend any part of the Constitution, it cannot alter the basic structure (e.g., supremacy of the Constitution, secularism, judicial review, federalism).  ✓ **Indira Nehru Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975):** It has struck down a constitutional amendment that sought to immunise the Prime Minister's election from judicial review, as it violated democracy, a basic structure element. ✓ **Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980):** The case held that Parliament cannot give itself unlimited amending power; harmony between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles is part of the basic structure. ✓ **I.R. Coelho v. State of Tamil Nadu (2007):** The Supreme Court upheld that Judicial review applies even to laws placed in the Ninth Schedule if they violate the basic structure doctrine. • **Implications of the Powers of Parliament to Amend the Constitution:** ✓ Protects constitutional values from transient political majorities. ✓ Balances flexibility with stability. ✓ Prevents misuse of the amending power to undermine democracy.

Conclusion	While Parliament enjoys wide amending powers under Article 368, the judiciary ensures that the Constitution's core principles remain inviolable. This limitation preserves India's democratic, secular, and federal character, ensuring that constitutional amendments strengthen rather than subvert the nation's foundational values.
Model Question	The powers of the Parliament to amend the Constitution of India are subject to limitations imposed by judicial interpretation. Examine this statement in the light of the Basic Structure Doctrine, citing relevant cases.
Value Addition	**The amendment procedure to amend the Constitution is as follows:** • Amendments can be initiated only by introducing a bill in either house of the Parliament. • The bill can be introduced either by a minister or by a private member and does not require the prior permission of the President. • The bill must be passed in each house by a special majority, that is, a majority of the total membership of the house and a majority of two-thirds of the members of the house present and voting. • Each house must pass the bill separately. If there is any disagreement, there is no provision for a joint sitting of the houses. • If the bill seeks to amend the provisions of the Constitution, it must be ratified by the legislatures of half of the states by a simple majority. • After the passage of the bill by both houses, it is presented to the President for his assent. • The president must give his assent to the bill. He can neither withhold his assent to the bill nor return the bill for reconsideration by the Parliament. • After the President's assent, the bill becomes a constitutional amendment act.
35. Briefly discuss the different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament. Comment on the difference between motions and resolutions. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	Briefly discuss, Comment
Approach	• Define motion in parliamentary procedure. • Explain substantive, substitute, closure, adjournment, and no-confidence motions; compare with resolutions (formal decisions). • Note motions are procedural triggers, resolutions are formal expressions.
Introduction	Motions are formal proposals made by a member to seek discussion and a decision on a specific matter in Parliament. They are essential tools of parliamentary control over the executive, enabling debates, scrutiny, and accountability. The Rules of Procedure in both Houses govern their types and use.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Different kinds of motions used to discuss matters in the Parliament:** • **Substantive Motion:** ✓ They are independent proposals dealing with important matters. ✓ Example: Motion of thanks to the President's Address. • **Substitute Motion:** It is moved as an alternative to the original motion, replacing it if passed. • **Closure Motion:** The motion seeks to cut short the debate and proceed to voting. • **Adjournment Motion:** ✓ The motion seeks to discuss a matter of urgent public importance, suspending normal business. ✓ Example: The motion was raised during the 2G spectrum controversy in 2010.

- **No-Confidence Motion (Article 75):**
  - ✓ It tests the Council of Ministers' majority support; if passed, the government must resign.
  - ✓ **Example:** The 2018 No-Confidence Motion against the NDA government.



- **Confidence Motion**: It is moved by the government to prove its majority.
- **Privilege Motion**: It is raised when there is a breach of parliamentary privilege.

Difference between Motions and Resolutions:

Motion	Resolution
They are initiated for discussion & decision-making.	They are a normal expression of opinion or will of the House.
They are procedural or substantive in nature.	They are usually substantive in nature.
They may or may not be binding.	They often carry persuasive or binding value depending on context.

Conclusion

Thus, the motions act as dynamic instruments for legislative oversight, while resolutions are formal declarations of the House's opinion or decision. Together, they uphold the principles of parliamentary democracy by fostering debate, ensuring executive accountability, and enabling informed decision-making.

Model Question

Briefly discuss the various types of motions available for the discussion of matters in Parliament. How do these differ from resolutions in purpose and procedure?

Value Addition

Closure Motion

- It is a motion moved by a member to cut short the debate on a matter before the House. If the motion is approved by the House, the debate is stopped and the matter is put to vote.
- There are four kinds of closure motions:
  - ✓ **Simple Closure**: It states that the 'matter, having been sufficiently discussed, be now put to a vote.
  - ✓ **Closure by Compartments:**
    - In this case, the clauses of a bill or resolutions are grouped into parts before the commencement of the debate.
    - The debate, then, covers the part as a whole, and the entire part is put to a vote.

	✓ **Kangaroo Closure:** Under this type, only important clauses are taken up for debate and voting, and the intervening clauses are skipped over and taken as passed. ✓ **Guillotine Closure:** This is one when the undiscussed clauses of a bill or a resolution are also put to a vote along with the discussed ones due to paucity of time.
36. Differentiate between the powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha based on the following parameters: functions and control over elections. Explain, with reasons, the powers that are exercised only by the Lok Sabha. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Briefly state that India's bicameral Parliament assigns different roles to Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha under the Constitution. • Compare their powers in legislation, financial control, executive accountability, and election-related functions, highlighting Lok Sabha's exclusive powers and reasons. • Sum up by noting that Lok Sabha's greater authority stems from its direct mandate and role in ensuring responsible government.
Introduction	The Indian Parliament is a bicameral legislature consisting of the Lok Sabha (House of the People) and the Rajya Sabha (Council of States). While both Houses share legislative responsibilities, the Constitution of India assigns certain distinct powers to each, especially in relation to functions and control over elections.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Functional Powers of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha** ✓ **Legislative Role:** Ordinary bills can be introduced in either House (Art. 107). However, Money Bills (Art. 110) can only originate in the Lok Sabha; the Rajya Sabha can only suggest amendments within 14 days. ✓ **Financial Control:** The Annual Budget is presented and voted upon only in the Lok Sabha. ✓ **Executive Control:** The Council of Ministers is collectively responsible only to the Lok Sabha (Art. 75(3)); it can be removed by a no-confidence motion, a power not given to the Rajya Sabha. ✓ **Rajya Sabha's Role:** Acts as a revisory chamber, discussing policies, moving censure motions, and providing federal representation. • **Control over the Election of the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha** ✓ **Presidential Election & Impeachment:** Both Houses participate in the impeachment of the President (Art. 61). ✓ **Vice-President Removal:** Both Houses pass the resolution for removal, but it originates in the Rajya Sabha. ✓ **Speaker's Election:** Only Lok Sabha members elect the Speaker and Deputy Speaker. ✓ **Representation:** Lok Sabha members are directly elected by the people, ensuring a stronger role in government formation, whereas Rajya Sabha members are elected by State Legislatures. • **Reasons for Exclusive Powers of Lok Sabha** ✓ **Direct Mandate:** Members are directly elected by citizens, ensuring greater democratic legitimacy. ✓ **Financial Accountability:** The principle of "no taxation without representation" gives the directly elected House control over finances. ✓ **Parliamentary Responsibility:** Government remains in power only with Lok Sabha's confidence.

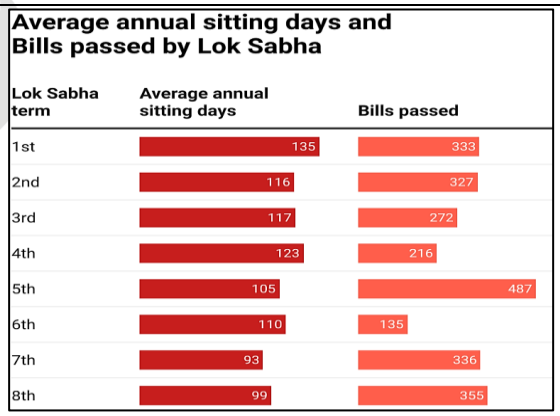
Conclusion	While both Houses play complementary roles in law-making and governance, the Lok Sabha holds greater authority in financial and executive matters due to its direct electoral mandate and its central role in sustaining a responsible parliamentary government.
Model Question	Explain the distinctive legislative, financial, judicial, electoral and constituent powers of the Indian Parliament. Illustrate each with suitable examples.
Value Addition	The Sarkaria Commission and Punchhi Commission have emphasized that while Rajya Sabha safeguards federal interests, Lok Sabha's supremacy in financial and executive matters upholds the principle of popular sovereignty, ensuring that the directly elected representatives control taxation, expenditure, and government stability in a parliamentary democracy.
37. What is an office of profit? Critically analyse the developments in India on this issue. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	What, Critically analyse
Approach	• Define the office of profit and link it to constitutional provisions ensuring legislative independence. • Explain the legal framework, highlight key judicial cases, recent developments, and critically analyse strengths and concerns. • Suggest reforms for clarity, transparency, and balanced application to preserve the doctrine's democratic intent.
Introduction	The concept of office of profit in India aims to ensure the independence of legislators by preventing them from being influenced by the executive through salaried or perk-bearing positions. Articles 102(1)(a) and 191(1)(a) of the Constitution provide for the disqualification of MPs and MLAs, respectively if they hold such an office under the government, except those exempted by law. This safeguard is rooted in the principle of separation of powers and prevention of conflict of interest.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Constitutional & Legal Framework for the office of profit** ✓ Disqualification questions are decided by the **President** (for MPs) under **Article 103** and by the **Governor** (for MLAs/MLCs) under **Article 192**, after seeking the **Election Commission's opinion**. ✓ Parliament and State legislatures may exempt certain posts through law — the **Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959** lists offices that do not attract disqualification. • **Key Developments & Judicial Pronouncements related to the office of profit** ✓ **Jaya Bachchan Case (2006):** Rajya Sabha member disqualified for chairing a state film body, reaffirming that even honorary posts with perks count. ✓ **Delhi "Parliamentary Secretaries" Case:** In 2018, 20 AAP MLAs faced disqualification, later set aside on procedural grounds, highlighting process lapses. ✓ Frequent amendments to exemption laws at both Union and State levels have drawn criticism for potentially diluting the doctrine. • **Critical Analysis** ✓ **Strengths:** Maintains legislative independence, prevents executive inducements, and adds neutrality via EC consultation. • **Concerns:** ✓ **Uncertain criteria**—tests on appointment, remuneration, and functions vary case-by-case. ✓ **Exemption misuse**—legislatures may shield politically convenient posts.

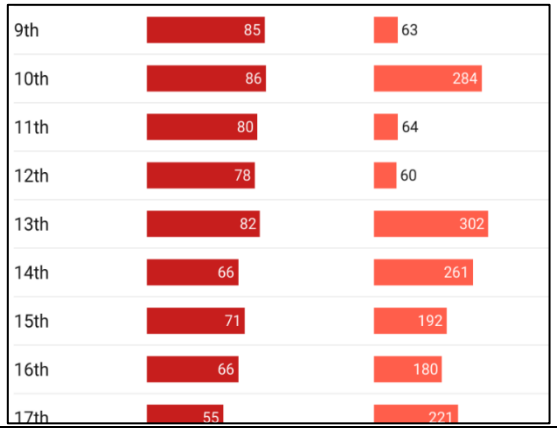
	✓ **Delayed processes**—decisions often come after political terms end, reducing deterrence
Conclusion	While the office of profit provision is a vital democratic safeguard, its inconsistent application and frequent political exemptions weaken its efficacy. A clear statutory definition, uniform guidelines by the Election Commission, and periodic review of exemptions can ensure the principle remains robust, preventing conflicts of interest without stifling legitimate public service by legislators.
Model Question	"Legislative privileges are essential for safeguarding parliamentary sovereignty—but their uncodified nature invites potential misuse." Critically examine this statement by discussing:
Value Addition	The UK Parliament's origin of the "office of profit" doctrine influenced India's Constitution, aiming to curb executive patronage. Comparative studies show Australia and Singapore maintain strict statutory lists, offering a model for India to adopt fixed, reviewable schedules to minimize political misuse and ensure uniform application nationwide.
38. What is the relative position of the Rajya Sabha as compared to the Lok Sabha in our political system? (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	What
Approach	• The Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha are the two Houses of the Indian Parliament, with distinct roles and powers, balancing representation of the people and states. • The Lok Sabha holds primacy in financial matters and executive accountability, while the Rajya Sabha acts as a revising chamber, providing a federal safeguard and equal authority in legislation (except for Money Bills). • While the Lok Sabha enjoys more power in financial and executive matters, the Rajya Sabha plays a crucial role in balancing federal interests and revising legislation, ensuring a comprehensive legislative process.
Introduction	The Indian Parliament consists of two Houses: the Lok Sabha (House of the People) and the Rajya Sabha (Council of States), established under Articles 79–122 of the Indian Constitution. While both Houses are integral to the legislative process, they have distinct roles and powers within the political system. The Lok Sabha represents the people of India directly, while the Rajya Sabha functions as a revising chamber, representing the states and union territories. The relative position of these two Houses varies in several aspects, including legislative powers, financial control, and their role in executive accountability.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Position of the Rajya Sabha as compared to the Lok Sabha** • **Legislative Powers** ✓ **Equality of Power in Legislation**: In terms of ordinary bills, the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha have equal powers. However, in case of a deadlock over a bill, a joint session is convened, where the Lok Sabha's larger membership usually prevails. ✓ **Money Bills**: The Lok Sabha has exclusive powers to introduce and approve Money Bills (Article 110). The Rajya Sabha can only recommend amendments, but it must return the bill within 14 days, with the final decision resting with the Lok Sabha. • **Financial Control** ✓ The Lok Sabha has more control over financial matters as the annual budget and other money-related bills can only be introduced in it. Rajya Sabha, while it

	can discuss and make recommendations, cannot amend money bills, emphasizing Lok Sabha's dominance in financial matters. • **Executive Accountability** ✓ The Council of Ministers is responsible to the Lok Sabha (Article 75). This means the Lok Sabha can pass a no-confidence motion, which has the power to remove the government. Rajya Sabha does not have this power, thus limiting its role in holding the executive accountable. • **Federal Role** ✓ The Rajya Sabha has a special role in preserving the federal structure of India. It can play a role in enabling Parliament to legislate on matters in the State List under national interest, as per Article 249. Furthermore, Rajya Sabha plays a role in the creation or abolition of All India Services (Article 312), which gives it a unique function in India's federal framework. • **Other Constitutional Powers** ✓ Both Houses have equal powers in the process of constitutional amendments (Article 368). ✓ During times of national emergency, both Houses must approve the proclamation, granting them an equal role in times of crisis.
Conclusion	The Lok Sabha holds a more prominent role in matters of finance and executive control, reflecting its direct connection with the people and its larger numerical strength. However, the Rajya Sabha performs essential functions as a revising chamber, protecting the interests of states, and ensuring a balance in the legislative process. Together, both Houses represent the dual principles of parliamentary democracy and federalism with the Lok Sabha ensuring direct representation and the Rajya Sabha providing a counterbalance for federal and state interests.
Model Question	Explain the core features of the parliamentary system as adopted in India and differentiate it from a presidential system.
Value Addition	The Rajya Sabha, with its role in revising legislation, offers a stabilizing force in India's parliamentary system. Its representation of states ensures that regional interests are safeguarded, while its power to influence policy through detailed debates and discussions strengthens the democratic process and enhances the quality of legislation.
39. There is no constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings. Explain regarding the leading cases. (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Mention Article 105 and parliamentary privileges. • Discuss cases like P.V. Narasimha Rao v. State and K. Anandan Nambiar v. Chief Secretary, showing limitations in criminal liability. • Immunity is functional, not a personal shield.
Introduction	Parliamentary privileges under Articles 105 (Parliament) and 194 (State Legislatures) ensure that legislators can perform their duties without undue interference. These include freedom of speech in the House and immunity from legal proceedings for anything said or done within parliamentary proceedings. However, this immunity is not absolute; it is functional and subject to constitutional limits, as clarified by judicial pronouncements.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Constitutional Basis of Immunity from Parliamentary Proceedings:** ✓ **Article 105(1) & (2):** Freedom of speech in Parliament and immunity from court proceedings for speeches/votes inside the House.

	✓ Scope: This applies to official parliamentary business, not to actions outside its scope. • **Judicial Interpretation of the constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings:** ✓ **P.V. Narasimha Rao v. State (1998)** ▪ **Issue:** Whether MPs accepting bribes for voting in Parliament are immune. ▪ **Judgment:** Members of Parliament (MPs) are immune from prosecution for their vote or speech in the House, but not immune from investigation/prosecution for acts like bribery before casting the vote. ✓ **K. Anandan Nambiar v. Chief Secretary, State of Madras (1966):** The Supreme Court held that legislative privilege does not override Fundamental Rights under Article 21; arrest outside the House for valid legal reasons is permissible. ✓ **Raja Ram Pal v. Lok Sabha (2007):** Judicial review applies to the exercise of parliamentary privilege if there is substantive illegality or unconstitutionality. • **Implications of the constitutional basis to claim absolute immunity from parliamentary proceedings:** ✓ Parliamentary immunity is intended to uphold uninhibited legislative debate, not to shield members from accountability for criminal actions. ✓ Legislative privileges must conform to the Constitution's basic structure and cannot override its foundational principles. ✓ Claims of parliamentary privilege are subject to judicial review to prevent misuse and ensure adherence to constitutional norms.
Conclusion	While parliamentary privileges are vital for legislative independence, they cannot serve as a shield for illegal acts. Judicial precedents affirm that immunity is functional, not personal, ensuring accountability while preserving legislative freedom in a constitutional democracy.
Model Question	Critically examine the constitutional provisions relating to parliamentary privileges. Do these privileges provide absolute immunity to members from legal proceedings? Discuss leading judicial pronouncements.
Value Addition	**List of Various Devices of Parliamentary Proceedings in India:** • **Question Hour:** ✓ It is a scheduled period where Members of Parliament (MPs) have the opportunity to ask questions to ministers regarding various matters of public interest during a parliamentary session. ✓ This period usually occurs at the first hour of every sitting in both the Lok Sabha (Lower House) and the Rajya Sabha (Upper House) of the Indian Parliament. ✓ The different types of questions asked to ministers during the Question Hour are as follows: • **Starred Questions:** ✓ These questions require oral answers from the ministers. ✓ MPs who submit starred questions are allowed to ask supplementary questions. ✓ These are printed in green colour. • **Unstarred Questions:** ✓ These questions require written answers from the ministers. ✓ MPs who submit unstarred questions do not have the opportunity to ask supplementary questions. ✓ These are printed in white. • **Short Notice Questions:** ✓ These questions can be asked by giving a notice of less than 10 days.

	✓ They are answered orally. ✓ These are printed in a light pink colour. ✓ In addition to ministers, questions can also be asked to private members regarding some matters related to them. ✓ These questions are printed in yellow. • **Zero Hour:** ✓ It refers to a scheduled period that starts immediately after the Question Hour and lasts until the agenda or the regular business for the day is taken up. ✓ It is used to raise matters without prior notice. ✓ It is not mentioned in the Rules of Procedure. Thus, it is an informal device. ✓ It is an Indian innovation in the field of parliamentary proceedings.
40. Comment on the declining trend of legislative debates. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Parliament- Structure, Powers and Functions
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• State the role of debates in democracy. • Show causes like time crunch, party whips, disruptions, media soundbite culture; use data from PRS Legislative Research. • Stress reforms for deliberative democracy.
Introduction	Legislative debates are central to parliamentary democracy, ensuring scrutiny of laws, policies, and the executive. Over the years, however, both the quantity and quality of debates in Indian legislatures have declined, raising concerns about informed law-making and democratic accountability.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The declining trend of legislative debates:** • **Evidence of a Declining trend of legislative debates:** ✓ **Reduced Sitting Days:** ▪ Data compiled by the PRS Legislative Research shows that, during its tenure in the first Lok Sabha (1952-1957), the average number of sitting days was 135 annually. ▪ In contrast, the 17th Lok Sabha (2019-2024) had an annual average of only 55 sitting days. ▪ The State Legislatures often meet for fewer than 30 days per year. ✓ **Shorter Debate Time on Bills:** Many bills are passed without detailed discussion; in the 2023 Monsoon Session, 25% of bills were passed within a day of introduction. ✓ **Disruptions and Adjournments:** ▪ Frequent disruptions over political issues reduce time for legislative business.





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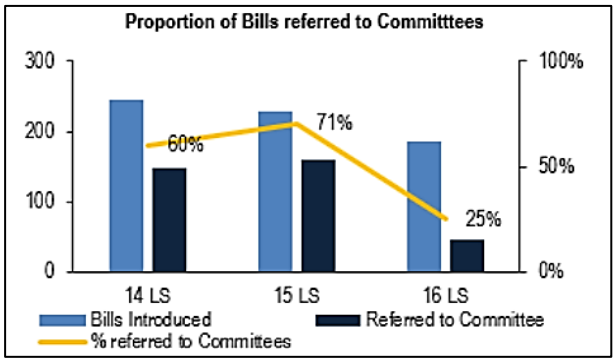
▪ Example: The 18th Lok Sabha (Winter 2024) has seen productivity further decline to 54.5% and 40% respectively.
✓ Decline in Committee Referrals: Standing Committees provide detailed scrutiny, but referral rates have dropped sharply from 71% in 2015 to around 16% in 2022 for central bills.

Causes for the declining trend in legislative debates:

✓ Partisan politics and weakening of consensus-building.
✓ Media and public pressure for quick action over deliberation.
✓ Overuse of ordinances, bypassing normal debate.
✓ Party whips are limiting the free expression of members.



Implications of a Declining trend of legislative debates:

✓ Poorly drafted laws leading to litigation (e.g., Farm Laws 2020).
✓ Weakening of legislative oversight on the executive.
✓ Reduced public trust in parliamentary effectiveness.

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<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>In this way, the decline in legislative debates undermines the deliberative essence of democracy. Strengthening committee work, ensuring mandatory discussion time, and curbing disruptions are essential to restoring Parliament and State legislatures as robust platforms of public reasoning and policy scrutiny.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>Legislative debates in the Indian Parliament and State Legislatures have been witnessing a decline in both quantity and quality in recent years. Comment on the causes and implications of this trend.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>
Role of Parliamentary Debates in Ensuring Transparency in Indian Democracy

Public Disclosure of Information:

✓ Ministers must provide detailed explanations about policies and decisions, making government operations transparent.
✓ Example: Debate on the Data Protection Act 2023 clarified its provisions and implications for privacy.

Revealing Government's Intentions and Plans:

✓ Parliamentary discussions expose the intentions behind government policies, ensuring the public is informed.
✓ Example: Debates on digitalization in Parliament have clarified the government's vision behind schemes like Digital India.

Enhancing Public Trust: Open debates on critical issues increase public trust in government actions by ensuring that decisions are not made behind closed doors.
Improving Governance through Critical Review:

✓ Debates encourage the review and revision of policies that may not be transparent or effective, leading to better governance.
✓ Example: Debates on the National Education Policy (NEP) led to revisions that made the policy more inclusive and transparent.

Encouraging Transparency in Policy-making:

✓ Debates allow opposition parties to demand transparency on sensitive issues, preventing corruption and abuse of power.

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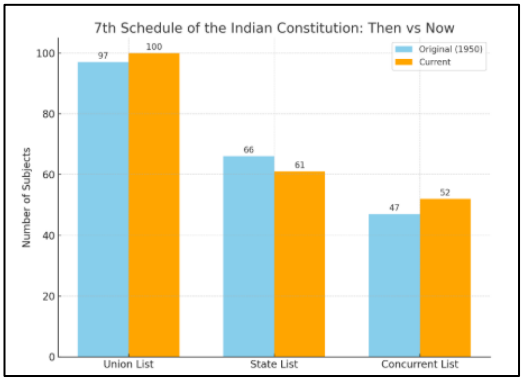
	✓ **Example:** The discussion on the Rafale deal in Parliament highlighted the need for transparency in defence contracts.
41. Although States have their separate list for law-making, this authority is not beyond the overarching legislative powers of the Parliament. Examine. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: State Legislature -Powers and Functions
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Introduce by explaining the division of powers under the Seventh Schedule and the existence of separate State and Union lists. • Examine constitutional provisions, judicial interpretations, and examples that show how Parliament can override or influence state law-making despite state autonomy. • Conclude by assessing the balance between federalism and national unity, noting the implications for Centre–State relations.
Introduction	The Constitution distributes legislative authority through the Seventh Schedule: Union, State, and Concurrent Lists. While States enjoy autonomy under the State List, their legislative powers are subject to Parliament's overriding authority via mechanisms such as the Concurrent List, residuary powers, and emergency provisions, reflecting India's quasi-federal character.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Framework for State Law-Making:** • **Article 246 & Seventh Schedule:** Three lists — Union, State, and Concurrent. • **State List (List II):** Subjects like public health, agriculture, and police are under exclusive state jurisdiction. • **Concurrent List (List III):** Both Parliament and State legislatures can legislate; however, Article 254 ensures central supremacy in case of repugnancy. • **Residuary Powers (Article 248)**: Entrusted exclusively to Parliament, limiting state innovation in new or emerging areas. On paper, List II appears autonomous, but overlapping entries, broad interpretation of Union powers, and residuary jurisdiction dilute this exclusivity.  **Mechanisms of Parliamentary Override:** • **Repugnancy Rule (Article 254):** ✓ *Article 254(1)*: Central law prevails over conflicting state law in Concurrent List subjects. ✓ *Article 254(2)*: State law with Presidential assent may prevail temporarily, but Parliament can override later. Judicial precedents (*Hoechst Pharmaceuticals case*, 1983) confirm Parliament's supremacy, showing that state advantage is conditional. **Special Powers to Parliament:** • ***Article 249*:** Rajya Sabha's "national interest" resolution enables Parliament to legislate on State List subjects. • ***Article 250*:** During a National Emergency, Parliament gains power over State List matters. • ***Article 252*:** States can voluntarily cede subjects; however, once ceded, the reversal depends solely on Parliament. • ***Article 253*:** International treaty obligations empower Parliament even in State List domains.

	• **Governor's Role (Articles 200 & 201):** Governors may reserve certain state bills for Presidential consideration, allowing central intervention in state legislative matters. **Judicial and Practical Examination:** • Courts have upheld a doctrine of pith and substance, allowing Parliament's broader interpretation of Union powers to encroach on state domains (State of W.B. v. Union of India, 1963). • In practice, GST Council, All-India Services and centrally sponsored schemes have influenced State List areas. • However, certain state-centric legislations (eg: Kerala's laws on agriculture, Tamil Nadu's NEET exemption attempts) reflect political resistance, but these efforts are often limited or stopped by the central government. **Implications for Federalism** • **Positive:** Ensures national unity, coherent economic policy, and quick legislative response during crises. • **Negative:** Risks undermining the spirit of cooperative federalism and state autonomy, particularly in politically sensitive areas. • **Recent Developments:** The farm laws controversy (2020–2021) and the Centre–Punjab conflict over police powers reignited debates over federal balance.
Conclusion	State legislative power, while constitutionally guaranteed, is not absolute. Parliament retains overarching authority through constitutional provisions, residuary powers, and emergency clauses. This asymmetry was deliberate, aimed at maintaining unity in a diverse nation. However, the challenge lies in ensuring that this power is exercised in the spirit of cooperative federalism, respecting the essence of state autonomy within India's quasi-federal framework.
Model Question	Discuss the legislative, executive, and financial powers of the Indian Parliament. How do these powers ensure checks and balances in governance?
Value Addition	At the time of its adoption, the Constitution allocated 98 subjects to the Union List, 66 to the State List, and 47 to the Concurrent List. Currently, the numbers stand at 100 subjects in the Union List, 59 in the State List, and 52 in the Concurrent List, reflecting the significant shifts over the decades. Among these changes, the 42nd Amendment Act of 1976 – often referred to as the "mini-Constitution" due to the extensive revisions it made – introduced the most substantial changes to the Seventh Schedule.
42. In what aspects is the Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) different from the Rajya Sabha, considering its role at the state level? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: State Legislature -Powers and Functions
Keyword	What
Approach	• Briefly introduce the concept of bicameralism in India, highlighting that both Rajya Sabha and Vidhan Parishad are upper houses but function at different governance levels. • Explain how Vidhan Parishad differs from the Rajya Sabha on parameters like constitutional status, composition, election method, powers, functions, and their role in legislative process. • Conclude by mentioning that Vidhan Parishad plays a limited, consultative role at the state level, unlike the more influential Rajya Sabha at the Union level.
Introduction	While both the Rajya Sabha and Vidhan Parishads serve as upper houses in bicameral legislatures, their scope and authority differ significantly. The Rajya Sabha operates at the national level, representing states in the federal structure with substantial legislative influence. In contrast, Vidhan Parishads function within individual states, holding more

<table>
<tr><td></td><td>restricted and largely advisory roles, aimed at providing review and scrutiny rather than decisive law-making power.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Body & Infographic Representation</td><td>
Legislative Council vs Rajya Sabha:
Constitutional Establishment and Permanence:
• Rajya Sabha is a permanent body established under Article 79; no dissolution, with one-third members retiring every two years.
• Vidhan Parishad exists in only six states (Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh) under Article 169, also permanent with similar retirement, but can be abolished by Parliament on a state assembly's resolution.
Composition & Membership:
• Rajya Sabha (max. 250 members):
✓ Elected by State Legislative Assemblies and nominated by the President for expertise in art, science, etc.
• Vidhan Parishad (max. one-third Assembly strength, min. 40 members):
✓ Elected by MLAs, local bodies, graduates, teachers, and nominated by the Governor for distinguished service. Delegates narrower interests than Rajya Sabha.
Electoral Process & Representation:
• Rajya Sabha uses single transferable vote via MLAs, representing states at the national level.
• Vidhan Parishad blends indirect election from MLAs, local bodies, graduates/teachers, and nominations—catering to local expertise, not federal balance.
Legislative Powers and Functions
• Rajya Sabha has co-equal powers with Lok Sabha (except financial bills) on all non-money legislation; it can amend, delay, and influence national policy.
• Vidhan Parishad has limited authority:
✓ Can delay ordinary bills (max 4 months) and suggest amendments but cannot block money bills or dismiss the government.
✓ The Governor may reserve bills for the President.
Role as Revising Chambers:
• Rajya Sabha acts as a robust revising chamber, enhancing legislation quality and maintaining continuity.
• Vidhan Parishad is primarily consultative, offering detailed scrutiny and regional/local insight, but lacks substantive power to alter legislative outcomes.
Federal vs State Dynamics:
• Rajya Sabha embodies federalism, allowing states to influence central policy.
• Vidhan Parishad does not reflect federal interests; it complements state governance by bringing expertise into the legislative process without central oversight.
<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Composition of a Legislative Council</th></tr>
<tr><th>Constituency</th><th>Number of Members to be elected</th></tr>
<tr><td>Graduates</td><td>One-Twelfth (1/12th)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Teachers</td><td>One-Twelfth (1/12th)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Local Authorities</td><td>Nearly One-Third (1/3rd)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Assembly Members</td><td>Nearly One-Third (1/3rd)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Nomination by Governor</td><td>Remaining</td></tr>
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</td></tr>
<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>The Vidhan Parishad differs markedly from the Rajya Sabha in scope, legitimacy, and influence. While both provide legislative checks, the state council serves more as a deliberative body with constrained powers, tailored to local needs. The Rajya Sabha, in contrast, functions as a powerful federal chamber shaping national legislation. Reform debates continue on whether Councils enrich state policy-making or merely add cost with limited impact.</td></tr>
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Model Question	Discuss the meaning and importance of parliamentary committees. How do they contribute to detailed legislative scrutiny?
Value Addition	**The composition of the Legislative Council is as follows:** • One-third members of the Council are elected by the members of the Vidhan Sabha. • One-third of the members of the Vidhan Parishad are elected by the electorates consisting of members of Municipalities, District Boards, and other local bodies in the State. • One-twelfth members are elected by the electorate consisting of graduates in the State with a standing of three years. • One-twelfth members are elected by the electorate consisting of teachers of educational institutions within the State not lower in standard than a secondary school, who have teaching experience of at least three years. • The remaining, i.e. about one-sixth members are nominated by the Governor from amongst the persons having special knowledge in the sphere of literature, science, arts, co-operative movement, and social service.
43. Describe the matters in which the Legislative Council stands equal with the Legislative Assembly, along with the matters in which it stands unequal with the Legislative Assembly. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: State Legislature -Powers and Functions
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Introduce by defining the Legislative Council as the upper chamber in certain states and briefly state its constitutional basis under Articles 169–212. • Describe a structured comparison of matters where the Council has parity with the Assembly and where the Assembly holds supremacy, citing constitutional provisions and examples. • Conclude by highlighting the Council's intended role as a revisory and deliberative body, ensuring checks without undermining Assembly primacy.
Introduction	A Legislative Council (Vidhan Parishad) exists as the upper chamber in a few Indian states. Established under Article 169 and detailed in Article 208 of the Constitution, it functions alongside the Legislative Assembly. While certain subjects permit Council parity, other areas delineate Assembly supremacy, ensuring a mix of deliberative and decisive governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY VS LEGISLATIVE COUNCIL:** **Instances of Equality with the Assembly:** • **Legislative Powers:** ✓ The Council can discuss and deliberate on any non-money bill passed by the Assembly. ✓ Both Houses share the authority to pass a resolution for creating or abolishing the Council (Article 169 requires Assembly resolution and Parliament's approval). • **Committees & Deliberations** ✓ Council members may be appointed to joint committees for analyzing state subjects, or to legislative scrutiny committees. • **Representation & Oversight** ✓ The Council overseers the government's progress of implementation, putting Assembly actions under qualitative review. **Instances Where It Remains Unequal:** • **Bills and Financial Matters:**

	✓ Money bills can originate only in the Assembly (Article 204(1)). The Council may recommend amendments, but the Assembly is not obligated to accept them. ✓ If the Council fails to act on a money bill within 14 days, it is deemed approved automatically. • **Ordinary Bills:** ✓ The Council can delay (2 months initially, plus another month) or propose amendments, but cannot reject or permanently block Assembly bills, nor demand re-voting. • **No Confidence Motions** ✓ Critical motions such as no-confidence or no-confidence against ministers can be moved and decided only in the Assembly. • **Budget and Supply:** ✓ Budget sessions and vote-on-account or grant sessions remain exclusive to the Assembly. The Council cannot delay or modify money allocation proposals. **Functional Implications of Inequality:** • **Deliberation vs Decision:** ✓ The Council serves mainly as a deliberative and consultative body, providing a platform for detailed debate rather than deciding matters of government formation or financial control. • **Safeguarding Quick Governance:** ✓ Assembly supremacy in money and confidence bills ensures executive efficiency and prevents upper-court-style legislative gridlock at the state level.
Conclusion	The Legislative Council shares deliberative responsibilities with the Assembly on non-financial legislation and governance oversight. However, it lacks decision-making power on money bills, non-confidence matters, and dissolution processes. This deliberate imbalance preserves the Council's role as a reflective chamber while safeguarding the Assembly's primacy in democratic governance.
Model Question	Examine the significance of collective responsibility in the functioning of the legislature. How does it strengthen parliamentary democracy in India?
Value Addition	• Like in the Lok Sabha, money bill is introduced first in Vidhan Sabha. It cannot be initiated in the Vidhan Parishad. The Speaker of the Vidhan Sabha certifies whether a particular bill is a money bill. After the bill is passed in the Vidhan Sabha, it is sent to the Vidhan Parishad. • The Vidhan Parishad gets 14 days' time to consider the bill. If the Parishad passes the bill, it is sent to the Governor for his assent. If the bill is not returned by the Vidhan Parishad within 14 days, it is deemed to have been passed by the Vidhan Parishad. • If it suggests certain changes in the bill and sends to Vidhan Sabha, the Vidhan Sabha may accept or reject the changes suggested by the Parishad. The bill is then sent to the Governor for his assent, who is bound to give his assent.
44. Explain the conflict resolution mechanism in case of deadlock between the two houses of a State legislature on a piece of legislation. (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: State Legislature -Powers and Functions
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining a legislative deadlock in a State legislature and highlighting its relevance under the Indian Constitution. • Explain the constitutional provisions, procedural steps, scope, limitations, and practical significance of the joint sitting mechanism for resolving such deadlocks.

	• Conclude by assessing how this mechanism balances legislative efficiency with democratic accountability in the State legislative process.
Introduction	Deadlocks between the State Legislative Assembly and Legislative Council are addressed by a constitutionally prescribed mechanism that ensures legislative continuity while preserving the supremacy of the directly elected Assembly. This process differs from Parliament's resolution but follows a similar principle of majority-led decision-making.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Conflict resolution mechanism in case of deadlock between the two houses of a State legislature:** **Nature of Deadlock: Where Do Disputes Arise?** • **A deadlock occurs when:** ✓ The Assembly passes a bill and forwards it to the Council, which either rejects it, amends it, or doesn't act within a specified timeframe. ✓ A Council-initiated bill is passed, but the Assembly rejects it. This can only happen with ordinary bills, not money bills or financial proposals. **Constitutional Remedy: Joint Sitting Procedure** • **Article 142 (State):** Governs joint sitting for resolving deadlocks. • **Initiation:** If, after three months from the Assembly's passage, the Council: ✓ rejects the bill, ✓ has amended but sent back to Assembly. ✓ Or neither passed nor returned, then a joint sitting may be summoned by the Governor at the Assembly or Council's request. • **Decision Metric:** If a majority of members of both houses (voting together) approves the bill, it is adopted and sent for the Governor's assent. **Rationale and Functionality:** • **Assembly Supremacy:** ✓ Since the Assembly's membership is larger, the joint majority generally favors its decision, protecting democratic legitimacy. • **Deliberative Opportunity:** ✓ The Council gets a platform to suggest amendments or raise objections in joint sittings, ensuring thorough scrutiny. • **Preventing Legislative Paralysis:** ✓ This mode prevents indefinite stalling while allowing for proportionate representation of both houses. **Limits to Joint Sittings:** • **Money Bills:** Not eligible; Council only has a limited role. • **No Private Member Bills:** Private members cannot request joint sittings. • **Governor's Discretion:** The Governor, as presiding authority, decides whether to convene a joint sitting after requisition. **Contemporary Context and Significance:** • **Rarity in Practice:** ✓ Deadlocks in state legislatures are uncommon; joint sittings at the State level are rare compared to Parliament. • **Preventive Role:** ✓ The possibility of joint sitting pressures parties in the Council to negotiate or cooperate before escalation. • **Comparative Insight:** ✓ Modeled after Article 108 of Parliament, but tailored to preserve the primacy of Assemblies at the State level.

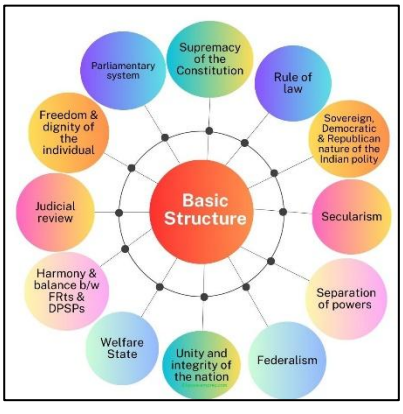
Conclusion	The joint sitting mechanism provides a fair yet Assembly-centric resolution to legislative standstills, balancing democratic authority with the Council's role in policy refinement. By combining both houses for final decision-making, the Constitution ensures legislative efficiency and respects representative legitimacy, reflecting India's nuanced federal architecture.
Model Question	Discuss the meaning and importance of parliamentary committees. How do they contribute to detailed legislative scrutiny?
Value Addition	Only the elected members of the Vidhan Sabha are entitled to participate in the election of the President of India. The members of the Vidhan Sabha do so in their capacity as the members of the Electoral College. But the members of the Vidhan Parishad are not entitled to vote in the election of the President. Members of the Rajya Sabha from each State are elected only by the members of the Assembly and not of the Council.
45. Define the Privileges of the state legislature and classify them into two broad categories. (APPSC, 2020).	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Legislative Privileges
Keyword	Define
Approach	• The State Legislature in India is granted certain privileges to ensure its autonomy and smooth functioning. • These privileges are categorized into Individual Privileges (e.g., freedom of speech, exemption from jury duty) and Collective Privileges (e.g., regulation of proceedings, disciplinary actions). • These privileges protect the legislature and its members, ensuring independent and effective legislative operations.
Introduction	The State Legislature in India holds significant authority under the Constitution of India. It is empowered to legislate on matters specified in the State List and Concurrent List of the Seventh Schedule. To effectively perform its functions, the State Legislature enjoys certain privileges. These privileges are essential to ensure its autonomy, the protection of its members, and the smooth functioning of legislative proceedings at the state level. These privileges can be broadly classified into Individual Privileges and Collective Privileges.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Individual Privileges** ✓ Individual privileges are rights granted to members of the state legislature, which protect them while discharging their duties. ✓ **Freedom of Speech**: Members of the state legislature are entitled to freedom of speech within the legislature, similar to members of Parliament (Article 105 of the Indian Constitution). This privilege ensures that legislators can speak freely during debates without the threat of legal action for anything said within the legislative chambers. ✓ **Exemption from Jury Duty**: Legislators are exempt from being called to serve on juries during their term. This ensures their availability to attend legislative duties without being encumbered by external commitments. • **Collective Privileges** ✓ Collective privileges refer to the powers and rights vested in the legislature as an institution. ✓ **Right to Regulate Internal Procedures**: The state legislature has the exclusive authority to regulate its own proceedings and functions. It can set its rules, procedures, and conduct, ensuring that legislative activities are not influenced by external bodies such as the executive.

	✓ **Power to Disciplinary Actions**: The state legislature can take disciplinary actions against its members if they violate rules or disrupt the proceedings. This includes suspension or expulsion from the house to maintain order and decorum within the legislature. ✓ **Protection of Legislative Reports and Records**: The legislature is authorized to protect its records, debates, and proceedings from outside scrutiny. This privilege safeguards the confidentiality of the legislature's internal working, promoting independence in its functioning.
Conclusion	In conclusion, the privileges of the state legislature serve to protect both individual members and the institution as a whole, ensuring smooth and independent legislative operations. By providing members with immunity for free speech and protecting the autonomy of the legislative process, these privileges are critical in maintaining a democratic balance and upholding the integrity of the state's legislative framework.
Model Question	Discuss the legislative, executive, and financial powers of the Indian Parliament. How are these powers different from those of the State Legislature?
Value Addition	The privileges of the state legislature uphold democratic values by fostering an environment where lawmakers can perform their duties without external pressure or fear of reprisal, ensuring a robust system of checks and balances. These privileges are essential for safeguarding legislative independence and maintaining the balance between state and central powers.
46. Explain the privileges and immunities of legislature under the Constitution of India. How far can the judiciary interfere with such privileges and immunities? (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Legislative Privileges
Keyword	Explain, How
Approach	• Introduce by defining legislative privileges and immunities as special rights granted to members of Parliament and State Legislatures to perform their duties freely, ensuring independence, freedom of speech, and integrity of law-making. • Explain individual and collective privileges with examples like freedom from arrest, regulation of proceedings, and publishing debates. Also explain judiciary interference. • Conclude by stating that judiciary can intervene only to prevent abuse, protect fundamental rights, and ensure privileges are not misused, maintaining a balance between legislative autonomy and rule of law.
Introduction	Parliamentary privileges and immunities are special rights granted to members of Parliament and State Legislatures to perform their legislative duties freely, without intimidation or fear of legal consequences. These privileges protect freedom of speech, independence of the legislature, and ensure smooth functioning of the law-making process.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Meaning and Constitutional Basis:** • Parliamentary privileges are the rights and immunities enjoyed by legislators to discharge their functions without external interference. For Parliament, these are provided under Articles 105 and 122, while for State Legislatures, Articles 194 and 212 apply. • They are further shaped by rules of procedure, parliamentary conventions, and judicial interpretations. **Classification of Privileges:** • **Individual Privileges:** ✓ Freedom of Speech: Members cannot be prosecuted in court for anything said or votes given in the legislature.

	✓ Freedom from Arrest: MPs or MLAs cannot be arrested 40 days before and after sessions, except for serious crimes. ✓ Exemption from Jury Service: Legislators are exempt from jury duties during sessions. • **Collective Privileges:** ✓ Regulation of Proceedings: Houses can make rules to conduct business efficiently. ✓ Exclusion of Strangers: Control over access to proceedings. ✓ Punishment for Breach: Right to punish members or outsiders for contempt or obstructing the legislature. ✓ Publishing Debates and Reports: The legislature has the authority to publish proceedings and reports. **Scope of Judicial Interference:** • **Protection Against Criminal Acts:** ✓ Courts have ruled that privileges do not protect MPs or MLAs from criminal liability for acts like vandalism or assault inside the legislature. ✓ Example: In K Anandan Nambiar vs. Union of India (1951), it was held that members cannot claim higher immunity than ordinary citizens for criminal acts. • **Freedom of Speech Limitations:** ✓ Members enjoy freedom of speech in the House, but it cannot be misused for defamation, hate speech, or baseless allegations. ✓ Courts can intervene if the speech violates fundamental rights of individuals or threatens public order. • **Judicial Review of Procedural Excesses:** ✓ While courts cannot question the validity of proceedings, they can examine cases of breach of privilege that violate the Constitution or fundamental rights. ✓ Example: In State of Kerala vs. K Ajith (2021), the Supreme Court held that privileges cannot exempt lawmakers from general criminal law.
Conclusion	Legislative privileges and immunities are essential for parliamentary independence, but they are subject to constitutional limits. Judicial oversight ensures accountability, prevents misuse, and protects fundamental rights, thereby maintaining a balance between legislative freedom and the rule of law in a democracy.
Model Question	"Examine the scope and significance of parliamentary privileges and immunities in India. Discuss the limitations imposed by the judiciary to ensure accountability and rule of law."
Value Addition	**Structure of the Indian Judiciary (Hierarchy)** • **Supreme Court of India:** The highest court, final court of appeal, with powers of judicial review and advisory jurisdiction (on presidential references). • **High Courts:** The principal courts in each state, overseeing subordinate courts and hearing appeals from them. • **Subordinate Courts (District Level & Below):** ✓ **District & Sessions Courts:** Highest in the district, handling major civil (District Judge) and criminal (Sessions Judge) cases. ✓ **Civil Judge (Junior Division) & Magistrate Courts:** Handle lesser civil and criminal matters, forming the base of the hierarchy. **Key Features & Functions:** • **Independent & Unified:** The Constitution ensures an independent judiciary, separate from the executive, with a single integrated system. • **Common Law Basis:** Primarily follows the British common law system, but incorporates civil and religious personal laws.

	• **Guardian of the Constitution:** Protects fundamental rights, upholds the Constitution, and ensures government operates within constitutional limits through judicial review. • **Jurisdiction:** Handles original (first instance), appellate (appeals), and advisory (Presidential references) matters.
5. Judiciary in India — Structure and functions, important provisions relating to emergency and constitutional amendments, judicial review, Public Interest Litigation	
47. Discuss any two constitutional amendments that have significantly affected the powers and functioning of the Indian Judiciary. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judiciary in India - Structure and functions
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Highlight the role of constitutional amendments in shaping the judiciary. • Discuss the 44th Amendment (restoring judicial review and rights) and the 99th Amendment (introducing NJAC for judicial appointments). • Emphasize their impact on judicial independence and the balance of powers.
Introduction	The Indian judiciary is a cornerstone of democracy, ensuring the protection of fundamental rights and upholding the Constitution. Certain constitutional amendments have played pivotal roles in shaping the judiciary's powers and functioning. Among them, the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978, and the 99th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2014, are significant.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978: Restoration of Judicial Independence** • The 44th Amendment Act was introduced to reverse the changes made during the Emergency under the 42nd Amendment, which curtailed judicial powers: • **Restoration of Judicial Review**: The Act restored the judiciary's power to review the constitutionality of laws, which had been weakened by the 42nd Amendment. • **Protection of Fundamental Rights**: It reinforced the protection of fundamental rights, ensuring they could only be suspended under emergency conditions, subject to judicial review. • **Limitation on Emergency Powers**: The amendment placed stricter conditions for declaring a national emergency, curbing executive powers. **The 99th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2014: National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC)** • The 99th Amendment sought to replace the collegium system with the NJAC, aimed at enhancing transparency in judicial appointments: • **NJAC Composition**: The NJAC included the Chief Justice of India, two senior-most Supreme Court judges, the Union Minister of Law and Justice, and two eminent persons. However, in *Supreme Court Advocates-on-Record Association v. Union of India* (2015), the Supreme Court declared the NJAC unconstitutional, asserting that it undermined judicial independence by increasing executive and legislative control.
Conclusion	The 44th Amendment enhanced judicial powers, reinforcing its independence, while the 99th Amendment sought reforms in judicial appointments but faced judicial resistance. Both amendments highlight the ongoing need to balance judicial autonomy and executive-legislative influence.
Model Question	Discuss the structure and composition of the Indian Judiciary. How does the principle of independence of judiciary ensure the balance of power in India's federal system?

Value Addition	The 44th and 99th Amendments highlight the tension between judicial independence and executive-legislative influence. While the 44th Amendment restored judicial review and fundamental rights protections, the 99th Amendment attempted judicial reforms that were challenged by the Supreme Court, underscoring the complex dynamics in maintaining a balance of powers.
48. The principle of Natural Justice plays a significant role in the adjudication of cases in administrative tribunals- Comment. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judiciary in India - Structure and functions
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Define Principles of Natural Justice and link them to fairness in administrative tribunals. • Explain core principles (right to be heard, rule against bias, reasoned decisions), cite key cases, and highlight their role and challenges in tribunal adjudication. • Emphasise Principles of Natural Justice as essential safeguards ensuring justice, accountability, and constitutional compliance
Introduction	The Principles of Natural Justice (PNJ) are foundational norms ensuring fairness, impartiality, and transparency in decision-making. In administrative tribunals, which exercise quasi-judicial powers, PNJ act as a safeguard against arbitrary state action and protect citizens' fundamental rights under Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Meaning of Natural Justice:** • **Based on two cardinal rules:** ✓ **Nemo judex in causa sua** – No one should be a judge in his own cause (rule against bias). ✓ **Audi alteram partem** – Right to be heard before adverse action is taken. • These rules ensure administrative fairness beyond strict statutory procedures. **Constitutional and Legal Basis of the Principle of Natural Justice:** • Though not expressly mentioned, Articles 14 and 21 of the Constitution embody natural justice by guaranteeing equality before law and fair procedure. • Articles 323A and 323B provide for administrative tribunals, which must follow fair procedure consistent with natural justice. **Application of principles of natural justice in Administrative Tribunals:** • Tribunals dealing with service matters (e.g., Central Administrative Tribunal) or tax disputes ensure parties are given notice, opportunity to present evidence, and reasoned orders. • In A.K. Kraipak v. Union of India (1969), the Supreme Court held that even administrative actions must follow natural justice. • In Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978), fair hearing was read into Article 21. • As per the Ministry of Law & Justice (2023), more than 3.6 lakh cases are pending before various tribunals, underlining the need for transparent and fair adjudication. • Lok Sabha Committee on Subordinate Legislation (2022) emphasized strengthening tribunal procedures to align with natural justice. **Challenges:** • Delays in providing hearings, lack of independence in appointments, and absence of appellate remedies sometimes dilute natural justice.
Conclusion	PNJ are indispensable to administrative justice. They uphold constitutional guarantees, protect against arbitrary rulings, and enhance tribunal credibility. As reiterated by the Supreme Court, any administrative action in breach of PNJ is invalid, making these principles a vital component of India's administrative adjudication framework.

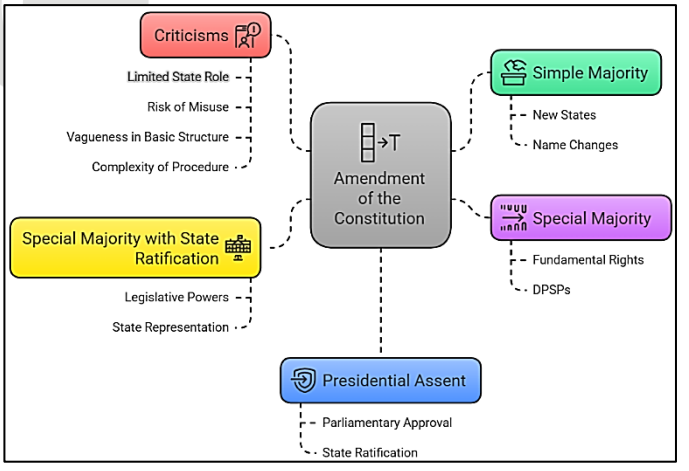
Model Question	Judicial accountability is as important as judicial independence. Critically examine this statement with reference to recent developments in India.
Value Addition	The 42nd Law Commission Report stressed that tribunals must adhere to PNJ to maintain judicial legitimacy. Recent rulings like Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank Ltd. (2019) reinforced that independence, impartial appointments, and procedural fairness are integral to tribunal effectiveness and constitutional trust.
49. What according to the Supreme Court, constitutes "the basic structure of our constitution? Please name a couple of important judgments of the Supreme Court on this issue? (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judiciary in India - Structure and functions
Keyword	What
Approach	• Briefly define the Basic Structure Doctrine and link it to its origin in Kesavananda Bharati (1973). • Discuss the salient features identified as part of the basic structure with examples from landmark judgments, highlighting their constitutional significance. • Conclude by summarise its role in preserving constitutional identity while balancing Parliament's amending power with judicial review.
Introduction	The basic structure doctrine delineates core constitutional principles that cannot be abrogated or altered through parliamentary amendments. Established by the Supreme Court in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), it acts as a safeguard against legislative overreach and protects the Constitution's foundational identity.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Core Components of the Basic Structure of the Constitution:** • While the Constitution doesn't explicitly define these components, the Supreme Court has identified several key features over time through judicial pronouncements: ✓ Supremacy of the Constitution ✓ Sovereign, democratic, and republican nature of the polity ✓ Secularism, federalism, unity and integrity of India ✓ Rule of law ✓ Federal character of the Constitution ✓ Separation of powers and independence of the judiciary ✓ Judicial review ✓ Harmonious balance between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles ✓ Free and fair elections. • These elements form the unamendable bedrock of the constitutional scheme. **Key Supreme Court Judgments highlighting the basic structure of the Constitution:** • **Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973):** ✓ It is a landmark 13-judge bench judgment that first articulated the doctrine. ✓ It held that although amendments under Article 368 are permissible, they must not destroy or emasculate the Constitution's basic structure. • **Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980):** ✓ The case struck down parts of the 42nd Amendment that attempted to bypass judicial review and imbalance the Directive Principles-Fundamental Rights relationship. ✓ It reinforced the inviolability of the basic structure. 

	• **S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994)** ✓ It declared federalism, secularism, and democracy as integral parts of the basic structure. ✓ It ruled that misuse of Article 356 (President's Rule) invites judicial scrutiny. • **Indira Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975):** ✓ It invalidated parts of the 39th Amendment relating to election disputes. ✓ It held free and fair elections as a basic structural requirement of the Constitution. • **Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980)**: ✓ It strengthened the doctrine by asserting a balance between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles. • **I.R. Coelho v. State of Tamil Nadu (2007)** : ✓ The Supreme Court held that laws placed in the Ninth Schedule come under judicial review if they violate the basic structure.
Conclusion	In essence, the Basic structure doctrine protects the core constitutional framework such as democratic governance, secularism, federalism, and judicial independence from being eroded by Parliament's amending powers. Judgments like Kesavananda Bharati, Minerva Mills, and S.R. Bommai reaffirm this principle, ensuring the Constitution remains resilient, rooted in fundamental values, and responsive to changing times without losing its identity.
Model Question	Discuss how the basic structure doctrine has acted as a safeguard against arbitrary constitutional amendments.
Value Addition	• The Supreme Court in November 2024 held that the validity of a law cannot be challenged for violating the Basic Structure of the Constitution. • A three-judge Bench headed by the Chief Justice of India, while upholding the State's power to legislate to regulate madrasas, was responding to whether the Basic Structure doctrine can be applied to invalidate ordinary legislation. • Authoring the judgment, the then Chief Justice Chandrachud said the Basic Structure doctrine was made up of "undefined concepts" such as democracy, federalism, and secularism. • Allowing courts to strike down legislation for violation of such concepts will introduce an element of uncertainty in our constitutional adjudication."
50. What are the principles adopted by the Courts in an irreconcilable conflict between a law made by the Parliament and a law made by the State legislature? (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judiciary in India - Structure and functions
Keyword	What
Approach	• Mention constitutional distribution of legislative powers and possibility of Centre–State conflicts • Explain constitutional provisions (Articles 246 & 254) and judicial principles (repugnancy, Presidential assent, pith and substance, harmonious construction) with case laws • Highlight how these principles uphold parliamentary supremacy while preserving federal balance.
Introduction	In the Indian federal structure, Parliament and State Legislatures derive legislative powers from the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution, divided into Union, State, and Concurrent Lists. Conflict arises when both enact laws on the same subject, particularly in the Concurrent List, or when Parliament legislates on a State subject under exceptional provisions. The courts have evolved guiding principles to resolve such irreconcilable conflicts, primarily under Article 246 and Article 254.

Body & Infographic Representation	• **Constitutional Framework of Conflict Resolution between a law made by the Parliament and a law made by the State legislature** ✓ Article 246: Distributes legislative subjects between Parliament and State legislatures. ✓ Article 254: Deals with inconsistencies between laws made by Parliament and those made by State legislatures on matters in the Concurrent List. ✓ **Seventh Schedule:** ▪ Union List – exclusive jurisdiction of Parliament. ▪ State List – exclusive jurisdiction of States. ▪ Concurrent List – both can legislate. **Judicial Principles adopted by Courts** • **Doctrine of Repugnancy (Article 254)** ✓ If a Central law and State law on a Concurrent List matter are inconsistent, the Central law prevails, and the State law is void to the extent of the repugnancy. ✓ Case Law: M. Karunanidhi v. Union of India (1979) – Laid down tests for repugnancy: ✓ Direct conflict between provisions. ✓ Both laws occupy the same field. ✓ Parliament intended to cover the entire field. • **Presidential Assent to State Law** ✓ Under Article 254(2), if a State law inconsistent with Central law receives Presidential assent, it prevails in that State. ✓ However, Parliament can later override it by enacting another law. • **Pith and Substance Doctrine** ✓ Courts examine the **true nature and character** of legislation to determine legislative competence. ✓ Case Law: State of Bombay v. F.N. Balsara (1951), if encroachment on another list is incidental, the law is valid. • **Harmonious Construction** ✓ Courts strive to interpret both laws so that they can operate together unless conflict is irreconcilable. • **Union Supremacy:** In case of an irreconcilable conflict between Union List and State List, Parliament's law prevails (*Ch. Tika Ramji v. State of U.P., 1956*).
Conclusion	When Parliament and a State legislature enact conflicting laws, courts apply Article 254, the Doctrine of Repugnancy, pith and substance, and harmonious construction to uphold constitutional federalism while ensuring legislative supremacy of Parliament in concurrent matters. These principles maintain balance between Centre–State relations and prevent legislative chaos.
Model Question	What is the significance of Public Interest Litigation (PIL) in the Indian judicial system? Has it strengthened democracy or led to judicial overreach?
Value Addition	The Law Commission's 42nd Report recommended clearer demarcation of legislative fields to reduce conflicts. The Sarkaria Commission stressed cooperative federalism in legislative matters, while the Punchhi Commission advised timely consultations between Centre and States before enacting overlapping laws to minimise constitutional disputes.
51. Discuss the constitutional provisions regarding state formation. Is a constitutional amendment necessary to bring a new State into existence? (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments

Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Briefly state that the Constitution provides a flexible framework for State formation under Articles 2 to 4. • Explain provisions, procedure, and judicial interpretation, emphasizing that Parliament holds the power with only consultative State input and no need for a constitutional amendment. • Conclude that State formation is a legislative function ensuring adaptability while maintaining parliamentary oversight.
Introduction	The Indian Constitution provides a clear framework for the creation of new States and alteration of existing ones to ensure flexibility in the Union's territorial organization. The relevant provisions—Articles 2, 3, and 4—empower Parliament to reorganize State boundaries while maintaining federal stability.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Constitutional Provisions regarding state formation:** ✓ Article 2 empowers Parliament to admit into the Union or establish new States, particularly from territories not part of India. ✓ Article 3 Authorizes Parliament to: ▪ Form a new State by separation or merger. ▪ Increase/diminish the area of any State. ▪ Alter boundaries or names of States. ▪ Introduce such Bills only on the President's recommendation, with mandatory reference to the concerned State Legislature for its views (consultative, not binding). ✓ Article 4 states that Laws under Articles 2 & 3 may amend the First Schedule (State list) and Fourth Schedule (Rajya Sabha seat allocation) and make incidental provisions. Such changes are not deemed constitutional amendments under Article 368. • **Procedure for state formation** ✓ Union Cabinet decision. ✓ Presidential reference to the concerned State Legislature. ✓ Introduction and passage of the Bill in Parliament. ✓ Presidential assent leading to formation/reorganization. **Provision of the Constitutional amendment to bring a new State into existence** • No constitutional amendment is required; an ordinary parliamentary law under Article 3 is sufficient for State creation or reorganization. • In Mangal Singh v. Union of India (1966), the Supreme Court held that Parliament's reorganization laws—even if they amend constitutional schedules—are valid under Article 4 and do not require the formal process of Article 368.
Conclusion	The Constitution makes State formation a legislative function of Parliament, with procedural safeguards like Presidential reference to affected States. This ensures both territorial flexibility and parliamentary oversight, without the rigidity of a constitutional amendment process, enabling the Union to adapt to political, administrative, and socio-cultural needs.
Model Question	"Discuss the constitutional powers, functions, and limitations of the State Government in India, with special reference to its role in cooperative federalism and State-specific administrative challenges."
Value Addition	The States Reorganisation Act, 1956, remains the most significant exercise under Articles 3–4, reorganizing States on linguistic lines. Later examples include Chhattisgarh, Uttarakhand, Jharkhand (2000), and Telangana (2014), demonstrating the constitutional mechanism's adaptability to regional aspirations and administrative efficiency.

52. Discuss how the 42nd Amendment, which introduced the clauses (4) and (5) to Article 368, prevents judicial review of Constitutional Amendments. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Briefly state that the 42nd Amendment added clauses (4) & (5) to Article 368 to make constitutional amendments immune from judicial review, challenging the basic structure doctrine. • Explain the provisions, their impact on judicial review, and the Supreme Court's Minerva Mills ruling striking them down for violating the basic structure. • Conclude by highlighting that the judgment reaffirmed Parliament's limited amending power and preserved constitutional checks and balances.
Introduction	The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976, enacted during the Emergency, sought to significantly alter the balance of power between Parliament and the Judiciary. By inserting clauses (4) and (5) into Article 368, it attempted to make constitutional amendments immune from judicial review and grant Parliament unlimited amending powers. This move directly challenged the basic structure doctrine laid down in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973).
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Provisions Introduced by Clauses (4) & (5)** ✓ **Article 368(4):** Stated that no constitutional amendment, including those affecting Fundamental Rights, could be questioned in any court on any ground. ✓ **Article 368(5):** Declared that there would be no limitation on Parliament's constituent power to amend the Constitution. • **Impact on Judicial Review** ✓ These provisions aimed to completely insulate constitutional amendments from court scrutiny, even if they violated core principles of the Constitution. ✓ They also sought to transform Parliament's limited amending power—as recognized in Kesavananda Bharati—into an unlimited authority, capable of altering or even destroying the Constitution's basic structure. • **Judicial Response – Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980)** ✓ The Supreme Court struck down clauses (4) and (5) as unconstitutional. ✓ The Court held that: ▪ Judicial review and limited amending power are basic features of the Constitution. ▪ Parliament cannot expand its amending power to the extent of damaging or destroying the Constitution's identity. ▪ Any provision barring judicial review of such amendments is void.
Conclusion	The 42nd Amendment's insertion of Article 368(4) and (5) represented an attempt to establish Parliamentary supremacy over the Constitution, undermining the doctrine of separation of powers. The Supreme Court's verdict in Minerva Mills reaffirmed that Parliament's amending power is neither absolute nor immune from judicial scrutiny. This ensured the continued protection of the basic structure and preserved the constitutional balance between the Legislature and the Judiciary.
Model Question	"The 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976 is often described as the 'Mini-Constitution' due to its far-reaching changes. Critically examine its provisions with special reference to its impact on the balance of power between the Legislature, Executive, and Judiciary."
Value Addition	The doctrine of basic structure, first evolved in Kesavananda Bharati (1973) has since been invoked in cases like I.R. Coelho (2007) and NJAC (2015) to strike down

	amendments violating core constitutional principles, reinforcing that no organ of the State holds unfettered constitutional authority.
53. Describe the procedure for amending the Constitution. What is the criticism against it? (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Mention Article 368; blend of rigidity & flexibility. • Describe three methods — simple majority, special majority, special majority + state ratification; cite Kesavananda Bharati. • Note criticisms like complexity, limited state role, and political misuse, but necessary for adaptability.
Introduction	The Constitution of India, while embodying the ideals of a democratic republic, recognizes the need for change over time. Article 368 provides the procedure for constitutional amendment, ensuring both stability and adaptability. The framers opted for a system that is neither completely rigid, like the U.S. Constitution, nor entirely flexible, like the U.K. Constitution, but a unique blend of both.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Procedure for Amendment of the Constitution:** • **Amendment of the Constitution by a Simple Majority of Parliament**: ✓ Amendments to certain provisions, such as the admission or establishment of new states (Articles 2 and 3), changes in the names of states, or matters in the Second Schedule, require only a simple majority of members present and voting. ✓ **Example:** Formation of Telangana (2014) under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014. • **Amendment of the Constitution by a Special Majority of Parliament:** ✓ It requires a majority of the total membership of each House and a two-thirds majority of members present and voting. ✓ It is used for amending most provisions, including Fundamental Rights and DPSPs. ✓ **Example:** The 42nd Amendment Act (1976) added "Socialist," "Secular," and "Integrity" to the Preamble.  • **Amendment of the Constitution by a Special Majority with ratification by Half of the States:** ✓ The provision is required for provisions affecting the federal structure, such as the distribution of legislative powers or representation of states in Parliament. ✓ **Example:** The 101st Amendment Act (2016) introduced Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India. • **Presidential Assent to the amendment of the Constitution:** After the amendment passes in Parliament and ratification by state legislatures (where applicable), the amendment bill must receive the President's assent to become law.

	Criticism of the Amendment Procedure of the Constitution: • **Limited role of states:** Most amendments do not require state consent, diluting federalism. • **Risk of misuse:** The Party in power with a strong majority can alter important provisions. • **Vagueness in "Basic Structure" Doctrine:** Doctrine from Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) lacks a precise definition, leading to judicial–legislative tension. • **Complexity of procedure:** The three-tier procedure can delay urgent reforms.
Conclusion	Thus, the amendment procedure balances flexibility and rigidity, ensuring constitutional stability while allowing change. However, political misuse and limited state involvement necessitate reforms to strengthen cooperative federalism and preserve constitutional values.
Model Question	Explain the procedure for amending the Constitution of India as laid down in Article 368. Discuss the criticisms levelled against this procedure in balancing rigidity and flexibility.
Value Addition	The amendment procedure to amend the Constitution is as follows: • Amendments can be initiated only by introducing a bill in either house of the Parliament. • The bill can be introduced either by a minister or by a private member and does not require the prior permission of the President. • The bill must be passed in each house by a special majority, that is, a majority of the total membership of the house and a majority of two-thirds of the members of the house present and voting. • Each house must pass the bill separately. If there is any disagreement, there is no provision for a joint sitting of the houses. • If the bill seeks to amend the provisions of the Constitution, it must be ratified by the legislatures of half of the states by a simple majority. • After the passage of the bill by both houses, it is presented to the President for his assent. • The president must give his assent to the bill. He can neither withhold his assent to the bill nor return the bill for reconsideration by the Parliament. • After the President's assent, the bill becomes a constitutional amendment act.
54. Analyse the Constitutional Amendments made so far in relation to the Fundamental Rights guaranteed under Part III of the Constitution. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Analyse
Approach	• Introduce by defining Fundamental Rights as essential freedoms guaranteed under Part III, protecting life, liberty, equality, and justice. • Explain the amendments timeline, highlighting key changes like First, Twenty-fourth, Forty-fourth, Eighty-sixth, and One Hundred Third Amendments, showing how Parliament balanced rights with Directive Principles and social welfare. • Conclude by noting that judicial review preserves the basic structure, ensuring rights are amended without undermining constitutional integrity.
Introduction	Fundamental Rights under Part III of the Constitution guarantee essential freedoms such as equality, freedom of speech, and protection of life and property. Over time, Parliament has amended these rights to balance individual liberties with social justice, Directive Principles, and public interest, reflecting the evolving nature of Indian democracy.

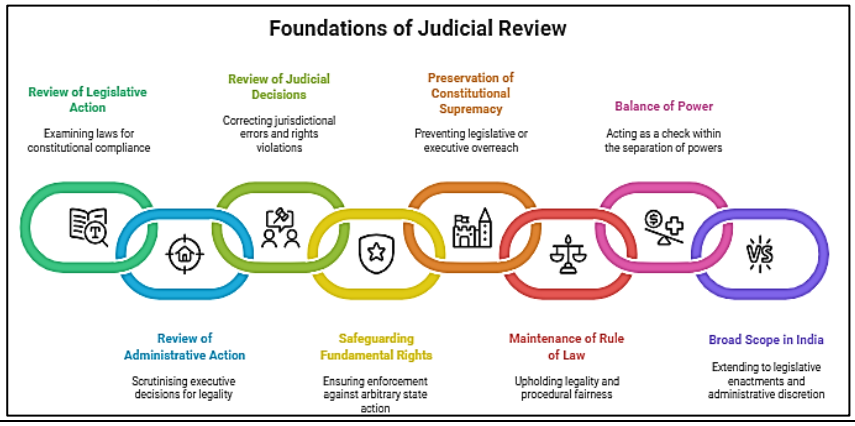
Body & Infographic Representation	**Amendability of Fundamental Rights:** • The Supreme Court in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) ruled that Parliament can amend any part of the Constitution, including Fundamental Rights, but cannot alter its basic structure. Amendments affecting rights require a special majority in both Houses and, in some cases, ratification by states. **Key Constitutional Amendments and Their Impact:** • **Balancing Rights and Public Order:** ✓ First Amendment Act (1951): Curtailed freedom of speech (Article 19) by adding "reasonable restrictions" and included the Ninth Schedule (Article 31B) to protect land reforms from judicial review. ✓ Fourth Amendment (1955): Limited property rights under Articles 31A and 31B to promote agrarian reforms. ✓ Seventeenth Amendment (1964): Expanded the Ninth Schedule, further strengthening land reform measures. • **Right to Property and its Transformation:** ✓ Twenty-Fifth Amendment (1971): Substituted "compensation" with "amount" for property acquisition, restricting judicial review. ✓ Forty-Fourth Amendment (1978): Abolished the Right to Property as a Fundamental Right, making it a legal right under Article 300A, ensuring primacy to socioeconomic justice. • **Reinforcement of Equality and Social Justice:** ✓ Forty-Second Amendment (1976): Empowered the state to implement Directive Principles even if inconsistent with Fundamental Rights (Article 31C). ✓ Eighty-Sixth Amendment (2002): Added Article 21A, making free and compulsory education a Fundamental Right for children aged 6-14 years. ✓ Ninety-Third Amendment (2005): Enabled reservation in private unaided educational institutions for socially and educationally backward classes. • **Strengthening Democratic and Individual Rights:** ✓ Forty-Fourth Amendment (1978): Protected the right to life and personal liberty (Article 21) from suspension even during an Emergency. ✓ Ninety-Seventh Amendment (2011): Recognized the right to form cooperative societies as a Fundamental Right under Article 19(1) (c).
Conclusion	Amendments to Fundamental Rights demonstrate India's constitutional dynamism, balancing individual freedoms with societal needs. Judicial review maintains the integrity of the Constitution, ensuring that while Parliament can bring reforms for social justice, it cannot erode the core framework of fundamental rights.
Model Question	"Successive constitutional amendments have sought to strike a balance between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy." Critically examine this statement in light of judicial pronouncements.
Value Addition	• Fundamental Rights in Indian Constitution Articles 12 to 35 in Part III of Indian Constitution provide for six Fundamental Rights of India. Six fundamental rights are mentioned below: ✓ Right to Equality (Articles 14-18) ✓ Right to Freedom (Articles 19-22) ✓ Right against Exploitation (Articles 23-24) ✓ Right to Freedom of Religion (Articles 25-28) ✓ Cultural and Educational Rights (Articles 29-30) ✓ Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32)

55. Write a critical note on the Emergency Powers under the Constitution and their misuse, if any. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Write
Approach	• Begin by defining Emergency Powers as constitutional provisions (Articles 352-360) enabling the Union to handle crises threatening national security or governance. • Explain types National, President's Rule, and Financial Emergencies with their scope, purpose, and constitutional safeguards. • Critically assess misuse during the 1975 Emergency and Article 356 cases, highlighting judicial reforms. • Conclude by stressing constitutional balance and accountability.
Introduction	The Emergency provisions under the Indian Constitution, contained in Articles 352 to 360, empower the Union to deal effectively with extraordinary situations threatening the nation's security, stability, or governance. While designed as safeguards for national integrity, their misuse in history has raised serious concerns about democratic accountability and federal balance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Framework of Emergency Powers:** • National Emergency (Article 352): Declared in cases of war, external aggression, or armed rebellion. It centralizes power and can suspend certain Fundamental Rights. • President's Rule (Article 356): Imposed when the constitutional machinery in a state fails, transferring executive and legislative powers to the Centre. • Financial Emergency (Article 360): Declared when the financial stability or credit of India is threatened, empowering the Centre to direct states' financial affairs. ✓ These provisions were included to safeguard national integrity and ensure continuity of governance in crises. **Positive Aspects and Necessity:** • Safeguard to the Constitution: Helps maintain unity and stability in times of war, rebellion, or financial collapse. • Swift Decision-making: Enables the Union to take decisive action during national crises. • Preservation of Order: President's Rule ensures constitutional governance when states fail to do so. **Misuse of Emergency Powers in India:** • While the Emergency provisions were framed as constitutional safeguards to preserve national security and stability. ✓ While history shows that they have occasionally been misused for political advantage, undermining the federal and democratic character of the Constitution. • **Misuse of National Emergency (1975–77):** ✓ Declared by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi on grounds of "internal disturbance," this Emergency was primarily political, not a genuine threat to national security. ✓ Fundamental Rights under Articles 19 and 21 were suspended, and dissenting voices, opposition leaders, and media were suppressed through censorship and arrests. ✓ The ADM Jabalpur vs Shivkant Shukla (1976) judgment upheld the suspension of habeas corpus, which became a dark phase in Indian democracy. ✓ Later, the 44th Amendment Act (1978) corrected this by ensuring that Article 20 and 21 rights cannot be suspended even during an Emergency.

	• **Misuse of President's Rule (Article 356):** ✓ Often used by the Union government to dismiss opposition-led state governments, weakening the spirit of federalism. ✓ Between 1950 and 1994, Article 356 was imposed over 90 times, frequently for political reasons rather than constitutional breakdown. ✓ In the landmark S.R. Bommai vs Union of India (1994) case, the Supreme Court ruled that such proclamations are subject to judicial review, restoring balance between the Centre and States.
Conclusion	Emergency powers are vital for national security and constitutional stability, but their misuse undermines democracy and federalism. The lessons from 1975-77 and judicial reforms highlight that such powers must always operate within the spirit of constitutionalism, accountability, and the protection of citizens' fundamental rights.
Model Question	"Discuss how the Emergency provisions in the Indian Constitution strike a balance between the need for national security and the protection of fundamental rights."
Value Addition	**Grounds of Declaration National Emergency:** • The President can declare a National Emergency if the security of India or any part is threatened by war, external aggression, or armed rebellion. • It can be declared even on imminent danger of such threats. • External Emergency like war/external aggression; Internal Emergency like armed rebellion. **Parliamentary Approval and Duration:** • Must be approved by both Houses within 1 month (earlier 2 months). • If Lok Sabha is dissolved, emergency continues until 30 days after the new House's first sitting (if Rajya Sabha approves). • Once approved, continues for 6 months, extendable with special majority (total majority + ⅔ present & voting). • Periodic approval every 6 months (44th Amendment). **Revocation:** • Can be revoked anytime by the President. • Must be revoked if Lok Sabha disapproves by resolution (44th Amendment). • 1/10th members of Lok Sabha can demand a special sitting to consider disapproval. • Disapproval needs simple majority of Lok Sabha; approval needs special majority of both Houses.
56. Explain the Constitutional guarantee to the Right to property in the light of the 44th Amendment Act. (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Briefly state the original constitutional status of the Right to Property and the reason for the change. • Explain the 44th Amendment changes, Article 300A guarantee, judicial interpretation, and impact. • Summarize the transformation and highlight the balance between individual rights and public welfare.
Introduction	The Right to Property was initially a Fundamental Right under Articles 19(1)(f) and 31 of the Constitution, guaranteeing citizens the freedom to acquire, hold, and dispose of property and protection from deprivation without due process. However, the need for socio-economic reforms, particularly land redistribution, led to frequent clashes between property owners and the State. The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978, significantly redefined this right.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional guarantee to the Right to property in the light of the 44th Amendment Act:** • **Key Changes by the 44th Amendment Act:** ✓ Omission of Articles 19(1)(f) and 31: Removed the fundamental right to property. ✓ Insertion of Article 300A: "No person shall be deprived of his property save by authority of law" — making it a legal/constitutional right instead of a Fundamental Right. ✓ Judicial Review: Courts can examine the legality of the law depriving property but cannot question the adequacy of compensation (Jilubhai Nanbhai Khachar v. State of Gujarat, 1995). • **Constitutional Guarantee under Article 300A:** ✓ Deprivation of property must be: ▪ Through a valid law passed by the legislature. ▪ Following due process prescribed in such law. ▪ Arbitrary executive action is barred (K.T. Plantation Pvt. Ltd. v. State of Karnataka, 2011). • **Impact and Rationale of Right to Property under the 44th Amendment Act** ✓ **Facilitated Land Reforms**: Reduced legal hurdles for agrarian and socio-economic reforms. ✓ **Balanced Approach:** Prioritized public welfare over absolute individual property rights. ✓ **Criticism:** Reduced protection for citizens against unjust acquisitions; remedies now lie in statutory laws like the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition Act, 2013.
Conclusion	The 44th Amendment Act transformed the Right to Property from a fundamental guarantee to a constitutional/statutory right, ensuring that deprivation is only by authority of law. This shift reflects the constitutional vision of aligning individual rights with collective socio-economic progress.
Model Question	"Discuss the evolution of the Right to Property in India with special reference to the 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978. How has the transformation from a Fundamental Right to a Constitutional Right impacted socio-economic reforms and individual rights?"
Value Addition	The Right to Property is now a constitutional right under Article 300A, not enforceable under Article 32. Landmark cases like K.T. Plantation (2011) affirm that deprivation must follow a valid law, ensuring procedural fairness while enabling socio-economic reforms like land redistribution and infrastructure development.
57. Article 356 is more misused than used. Comment. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Important provisions and Constitutional Amendments
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Define Article 356 and its intended exceptional use. • Highlight historical misuse, judicial checks (*Bommai*), and commission recommendations. • Assert its misuse history, note reforms, and stress need for vigilance to protect federalism.
Introduction	Article 356 of the Constitution empowers the President to assume the functions of a state government if there is a "failure of constitutional machinery." B.R. Ambedkar had hoped it would remain a "dead letter," used only in rare emergencies. However, its history reflects frequent partisan use, raising concerns over federal integrity.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Provision:** • Under Article 356, the President can assume functions of the state government if it cannot be carried on in accordance with the Constitution. • The proclamation must be approved by Parliament within two months and can last for a maximum of three years with periodic approvals. **Misuse of Article 356 in Practice:** • Intended for exceptional situations, it was often used to dismiss opposition-led state governments. • Between 1951 and 2016, Article 356 was invoked over 125 times (PRS data). • Example: ✓ 1959 – Kerala Government dismissed by Nehru citing law and order, though the reasons were political. ✓ 1977 & 1980 – Janata and Congress governments dismissed opposition states wholesale after a change at the Centre. ✓ 1992 – BJP state governments dismissed post-Babri Masjid demolition. **Judicial Interventions:** • **S.R. Bommai v. Union of India (1994):** Supreme Court held that misuse of Article 356 is subject to judicial review. President's Rule cannot be imposed for political reasons, and the majority should be tested on the floor of the Assembly. • Post-Bommai, the frequency of misuse has declined. **Criticism:** • The article is seen as violating federalism, undermining state autonomy, and centralizing power. • The Sarkaria Commission and Punchhi Commission recommended its use only in rare circumstances.
Conclusion	Article 356, while constitutionally valid as a safeguard for democracy, has historically been more misused than properly applied, undermining federalism. Judicial scrutiny post-*Bommai* and commission-led reform suggestions have reduced arbitrary use, but continued vigilance is essential to preserve the balance between Union authority and state autonomy.
Model Question	"Emergency provisions in the Constitution tilt the balance of power heavily in favour of the Centre." Discuss.
Value Addition	In *S.R. Bommai* (1994), the Supreme Court ruled that Article 356 is an exceptional measure, subject to judicial review. It mandated floor tests to verify majority, curtailed arbitrary dissolution of Assemblies, and upheld federalism as part of the Constitution's basic structure, ensuring Centre's power is not misused for political ends.
58. Define Judicial Review with special reference to the classification given by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri. Describe the importance and scope of Judicial Review. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judicial Review
Keyword	Define, Describe
Approach	• Define judicial review and its constitutional basis (Articles 13, 32, 226). • Explain Quadri's classification: review of legislative, administrative, and judicial actions. • Discuss its role in constitutional supremacy and safeguarding fundamental rights.
Introduction	Judicial review is the power of the judiciary to examine the constitutionality of legislative enactments, executive actions, and, in certain cases, judicial decisions. Rooted in the doctrine of constitutional supremacy, it ensures that all organs of government act within constitutional limits. In India, Articles 13, 32, and 226 provide the foundation for judicial review, upheld since Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) as part of the Basic Structure.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Classification of Judicial Review by Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri:** Justice Quadri in ITC Ltd. v. Agricultural Produce Market Committee (2002) classified judicial review into three categories: • **Review of Legislative Action**: Examining laws for compliance with the Constitution (e.g., Indira Nehru Gandhi v. Raj Narain, striking down of the 39th Constitutional Amendment). • **Review of Administrative Action**: Scrutinising executive decisions for legality, reasonableness, and adherence to natural justice (e.g., Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India). • **Review of Judicial Decisions:** Judicial Review is limited to correction of jurisdictional errors or violation of fundamental rights through appeal or writ jurisdiction. **The importance and scope of Judicial Review:** • **Importance of Judicial Review:** ✓ **Safeguarding of Fundamental Rights:** Judicial review ensures enforcement against arbitrary state action. ▪ Example: A.K. Gopalan case to Maneka Gandhi case. ✓ **Preservation of Constitutional Supremacy:** It prevents legislative or executive overreach. ✓ **Maintenance of Rule of Law:** It upholds legality and procedural fairness. ✓ **Balance of Power:** Judicial review acts as a check within the separation of powers framework. • **Scope of Judicial Review:** ✓ **Broad in India:** The scope of Judicial review is broad due to the written constitution, fundamental rights, and an integrated judiciary. ✓ **Extension:** It extends to legislative enactments, delegated legislation, administrative discretion, and, in rare cases, judicial pronouncements. ✓ **Evolving Nature:** It expanded through PIL, environmental jurisprudence (MC Mehta cases), and rights-based interpretations. 
Conclusion	Hence, Judicial review in India is not merely a legal procedure but a constitutional guarantee against arbitrary governance. The classification by Justice Quadri clarifies its operational domains, while its wide scope reflects the judiciary's role as the guardian of the Constitution. However, it must be exercised with restraint to maintain institutional balance in a democratic framework.
Model Question	Define Judicial Review. Discuss Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri's classification of judicial review and highlight its importance and scope in the Indian context.
Value Addition	**Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri:**

- He is a former Judge of the Supreme Court of India, born on April 5, 1938.
- He was a Part Time Lecturer in College of Law, Osmania University from December, 1972 to October 1980.
- He worked as Government Pleader in the High Court of Andhra Pradesh at Hyderabad from October 1981 to July 1986.
- He was appointed Judge of the High Court of Andhra Pradesh in July 1986.
- He was for some time Dean, Faculty of Law, Kakatiya University, A.P.
- He was also a Member of the Board of Governors, Andhra Pradesh Judicial Academy.
- He was Executive Chairman, Andhra Pradesh State Legal Services Authority.
- He worked as the Acting Chief Justice of the High Court of Andhra Pradesh from November 3, 1997, to December 3, 1997.
- He retired as the Judge of the Supreme Court of India on April 5, 2003.
- He was appointed as Chairman, Authority for Advance Ruling (Income-Tax) with full additional charge of Chairperson for Authority for Advance Rulings (Customs & Central Excise) on 27th January, 2004, and working as such from February 4, 2004.

59. Distinguish between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism, and also cite the important decisions of the Supreme Court on the two subjects. (APPSC, 2017)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judicial Review
Keyword	Distinguish
Approach	• Define both concepts and their constitutional/legal foundations. • Differentiate in scope, nature, and intent with a comparative table. • Cite landmark cases: Kesavananda Bharati, Indira Gandhi v. Raj Narain, Vishaka guidelines.
Introduction	Judicial Review and Judicial Activism are two significant functions of the judiciary that safeguard constitutional governance. While judicial review is a constitutionally mandated power to test the validity of legislative and executive actions, judicial activism is the judiciary's proactive role in interpreting laws and filling gaps where other organs have failed. Both are rooted in the need to uphold the Constitution but differ in scope, nature, and approach.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Distinction between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism:**

Aspect	Judicial Review	Judicial Activism
Definition	It has the power to examine the constitutionality of laws/executive actions.	It leads to proactive interpretation and expansion of constitutional provisions.
Nature	It is reactive, i.e., exercises power when a law/action is challenged.	It is proactive. It is often initiated by courts themselves (especially via PIL)
Constitutional Basis	Articles 13, 32, 226; Basic Structure Doctrine.	No explicit provision; It evolved through interpretation.
Purpose	Judicial review maintains constitutional supremacy and the rule of law.	Judicial Activism promotes justice, fills legislative/executive gaps.

	Risk	It may lead to Judicial supremacy.	It may lead to Judicial overreach.
	Example Cases	Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), Indira Nehru Gandhi v. Raj Narain (1975). Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980)	Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan (1997), MC Mehta v. Union of India (1987). Unnikrishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh (2000)

Conclusion	Hence, Judicial review is a constitutionally conferred safeguard against unconstitutional acts, while judicial activism is an interpretative tool for advancing justice. Though distinct, both strengthen democracy when exercised judiciously. However, overstepping constitutional limits risks upsetting the balance of powers, underscoring the need for judicial restraint alongside judicial courage.
Model Question	Distinguish between Judicial Review and Judicial Activism. Cite important decisions of the Supreme Court to show their operation in the Indian constitutional system
Value Addition	**The Doctrine of Judicial Review in India:** • **Origin:** The doctrine of judicial review originated and developed in the USA. It was propounded for the first time in the famous case of Marbury versus Madison (1803) by John Marshall, the then Chief Justice of the American Supreme Court. • **Constitutional Authority:** In India, the Constitution itself confers the power of judicial review on the judiciary, i.e., for both the Supreme Court as well as High Courts. • **Meaning of Judicial Review**: It is the power of the judiciary to examine the constitutionality of legislative enactments and executive orders of both the Central and State governments. • **Declaration of Invalidity**: ✓ If they are found to be violative of the Constitution (ultra vires), then they are declared illegal, unconstitutional, and invalid by the judiciary. ✓ Consequently, they cannot be enforced by the Government. • **Basic Feature of the Constitution**: The Supreme Court has declared the power of judicial review as a basic feature of the Constitution or an element of the basic structure of the Constitution. • **Inviolability of Judicial Review**: Consequently, the power of judicial review cannot be curtailed or excluded even by a constitutional amendment.

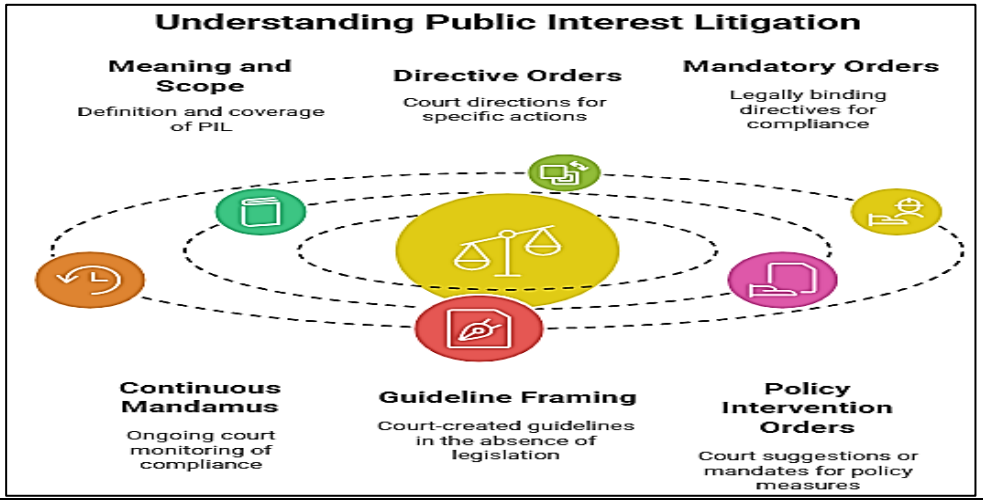
60. Discuss the grounds on which administrative action may be reviewed by the judiciary, and the various modes of such judicial review. (APPSC, 2012)

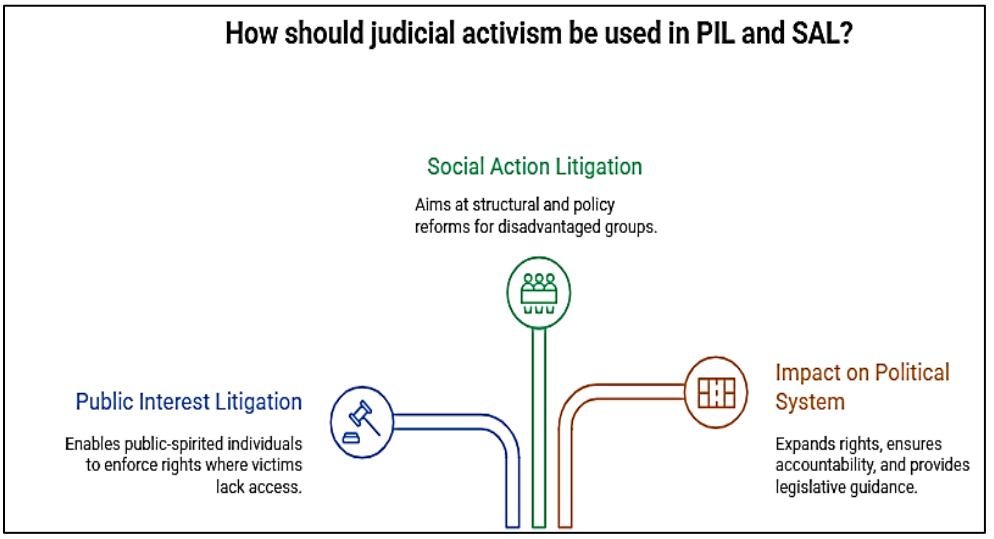
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judicial Review
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by defining judicial review of administrative action as the power of courts to examine decisions of administrative authorities to ensure they comply with law, constitution, and fundamental rights. • Explain grounds: illegality, irrationality, procedural impropriety, and proportionality with brief illustrations from landmark cases. Discuss various modes of such judicial review • Conclude by emphasizing that judicial review safeguards citizens' rights, ensures accountability, and upholds the rule of law.
Introduction	Judicial review of administrative action is the power of courts to examine decisions of administrative authorities to ensure they conform to law, constitutional provisions, and fundamental rights. It prevents misuse of authority and protects citizens from arbitrary, unfair, or illegal government actions.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Grounds for Judicial Review on administrative action:** • **Illegality:** Courts review decisions if the authority acts beyond its legal powers, with mala fide intentions, or for an improper purpose. For example, misuse of delegated legislation can be challenged as ultra vires. • **Irrationality/Unreasonableness:** Administrative decisions that are arbitrary or unreasonable may be struck down. In such cases, courts examine whether the action defies logic or is so absurd that no reasonable authority would have taken it. • **Procedural Impropriety:** Judicial review ensures adherence to due process and rules of natural justice. Decisions made without giving an affected person a fair hearing or violating prescribed procedures can be invalidated. • **Proportionality:** Courts assess whether the administrative action is proportionate to the intended objective. Actions causing excessive harm compared to the goal pursued may be curtailed, as seen in Ranjit Thakur v. Union of India. **Modes of Judicial Review:** • Writ Jurisdiction: Courts, under Articles 32 and 226, can issue writs like habeas corpus, mandamus, prohibition, certiorari, and quo warranto to correct illegal or arbitrary actions. • Statutory Remedies: Administrative decisions can also be challenged under specific statutes providing appeal or revision mechanisms. • Public Interest Litigation (PIL): Courts may intervene in matters affecting the public or large groups, especially when fundamental rights are threatened. **Case Illustrations:** • Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980): Judicial review invalidated arbitrary government action, reinforcing constitutional limits. • Laxmibai v. Collector, Nanded (2020): Doctrine of proportionality applied to ensure administrative action did not defy logic or fairness. • Reliance Energy Ltd. v. Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation: Courts emphasized reviewing the decision-making process rather than the outcome.
Conclusion	Judicial review of administrative action safeguards citizens' rights, enforces legality, and ensures accountability of public authorities. By scrutinizing actions for illegality, unreasonableness, procedural lapses, and disproportionality, it strengthens democratic governance and preserves the supremacy of the Constitution.
Model Question	"Examine the role of the judiciary in controlling administrative excesses. Highlight the principles and landmark cases that guide judicial review of administrative actions in India."
Value Addition	• Justice Syed Shah Mohamed Quadri has classified the judicial review into the following three categories ✓ Judicial review of constitutional amendments. ✓ Judicial review of legislation of the Parliament and State Legislatures and subordinate legislations. ✓ Judicial review of administrative action of the Union and State and authorities under the state.
61. What are the novel trends in Judicial Review? (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Judicial Review
Keyword	What
Approach	• Define judicial review and briefly trace its evolution in India. • Highlight novel trends: expansion through PIL/SAL, environmental jurisprudence, continuous mandamus, and rights-based interpretation. • Support with examples like MC Mehta cases, Vishaka guidelines, and Navtej Johar.

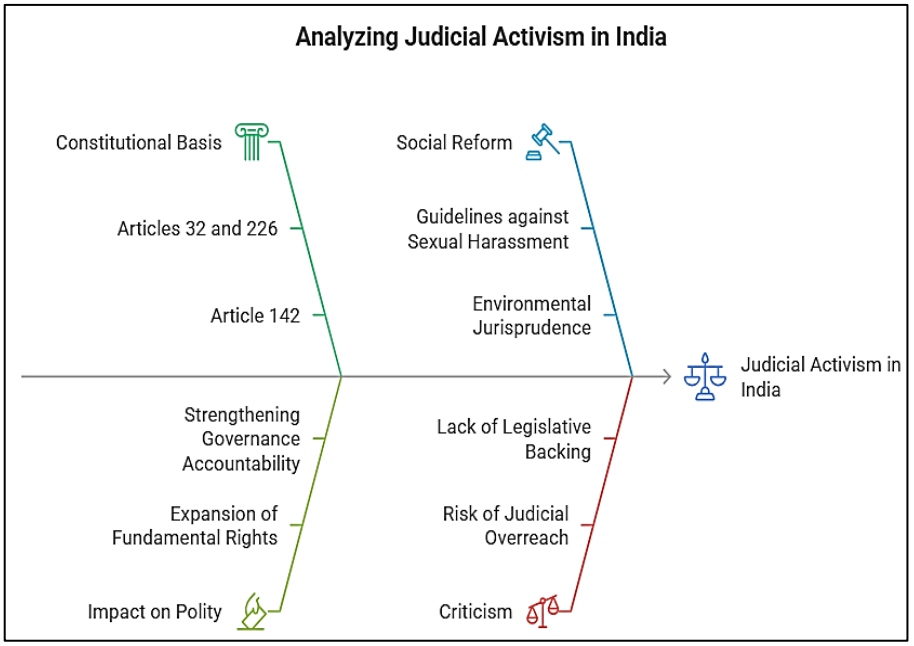
Introduction	Judicial review is the power of the judiciary to examine the constitutionality of legislative enactments, executive actions, and, in rare cases, judicial pronouncements. In India, it is rooted in Articles 13, 32, and 226, and recognised as part of the Basic Structure Doctrine in Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973). Over the past few decades, judicial review has evolved beyond its traditional role, embracing novel trends that reflect the changing needs of society and governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Emerging Trends in Judicial Review in India:** • **Expansion through Public Interest Litigation (PIL):** ✓ Judicial review has evolved beyond resolving individual grievances to addressing broader issues of public welfare. ✓ PILs have empowered the judiciary to intervene in matters affecting marginalized communities, environmental protection, and systemic governance failures. • **Continuous Mandamus:** ✓ Courts have adopted the practice of retaining jurisdiction over cases to ensure sustained compliance with their directives. ✓ This form of judicial oversight, as exemplified in the Delhi vehicular pollution control case, enables ongoing monitoring and accountability in complex public interest matters. • **Rights-Based Interpretation:** ✓ The judiciary has progressively expanded the scope of fundamental rights under Article 21 of the Constitution. ✓ Landmark rulings include: ▪ Right to Privacy (Justice K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India) ▪ Right to a Clean Environment ✓ These interpretations reflect a dynamic understanding of life and liberty in a modern constitutional framework. • **Review of Socio-Economic Policies:** ✓ Courts have scrutinized government schemes to uphold principles of fairness, equity, and non-discrimination. ✓ In the Right to Food case (PUCL v. Union of India), the judiciary ensured that welfare entitlements reached vulnerable populations, reinforcing the constitutional commitment to social justice. • **Environmental and Climate Jurisprudence:** ✓ Indian courts have integrated global environmental principles into domestic law, such as: ▪ Polluter Pays Principle (Vellore Citizens Welfare Forum v. Union of India, 1996) ▪ Sustainable Development • **Technology and Digital Rights Review:** ✓ The judiciary has begun to engage with the challenges posed by digital governance. ✓ In Anuradha Bhasin v. Union of India (2020), the Supreme Court examined the legality of internet shutdowns, emphasizing the need to balance national security with individual freedoms like access to information and expression.
Conclusion	In Conclusion, Judicial review in India has transitioned from a narrow legality check to a dynamic instrument for advancing constitutional morality, protecting collective rights, and promoting good governance. These novel trends reflect the judiciary's adaptive role in a complex, rights-conscious democracy. However, for its legitimacy to endure, judicial

	review must be exercised with restraint, ensuring harmony between judicial innovation and democratic accountability.
Model Question	Discuss the novel trends that have emerged in the field of Judicial Review in India. How have these trends expanded the scope of judicial intervention?
Value Addition	**Landmark Cases of Judicial Review by the Supreme Court:** The Supreme Court has used the power of judicial review in various cases, such as: • Golaknath case (1967) • Bank Nationalisation case (1970) • Privy Purses Abolition case (1971) • Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) • Minerva Mills case (1980) • Supreme Court Ruling on the 99th Constitutional Amendment: The Supreme Court in 2015 declared both the 99th Constitutional Amendment, 2014, and the National Judicial Appointments Commission (NJAC) Act, 2014, as unconstitutional and null and void.
62. What is meant by Public Interest Litigation (PIL)? Describe the nature of court orders that are passed by courts in PIL cases. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Public Interest Litigation
Keyword	What, Describe
Approach	• Define PIL, trace its emergence in S.P. Gupta v. Union of India and Hussainara Khatoon case. • Explain the nature of orders—directive, mandatory, continuous mandamus. • Cite examples in environmental, human rights, and governance reforms.
Introduction	Public Interest Litigation (PIL) is a legal innovation in India that allows any individual or organisation to approach the court for the enforcement of rights where the affected parties are unable to do so themselves. It emerged in the late 1970s and early 1980s as a judicial tool to promote access to justice, especially for marginalised groups. The Supreme Court in S.P. Gupta v. Union of India (1981) and Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar (1979) liberalised the rule of locus standi, paving the way for PIL jurisprudence.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Public Interest Litigation (PIL):** • **Meaning and Scope of PIL:** ✓ **Definition:** PIL is litigation undertaken to secure public interest, not for personal gain. ✓ **Scope:** It covers fundamental rights enforcement, environmental protection, human rights, governance reforms, and social justice. ✓ **Special Features of PIL:** Relaxed procedural rules, acceptance of letters or petitions, and consideration of broader public welfare. • **Nature of Court Orders in PIL Cases:** ✓ **Directive Orders:** Courts issue directions to authorities to take specific actions. ✓ **e.g.,** the right to a clean environment and the 'polluter pays' principle in the MC Mehta v. Union of India case, 1988. ✓ **Mandatory Orders:** Legally binding directives that require strict compliance, typically issued in response to violations of rights or legal obligations. ✓ **Continuous Mandamus:** Courts retain jurisdiction and monitor compliance over time, as in the Delhi vehicular pollution case. ✓ **Guideline Framing:** Courts create guidelines in the absence of legislation, such as the Vishaka Guidelines on sexual harassment.

	✓ **Policy Intervention Orders:** In exceptional cases, courts may suggest or mandate policy measures, especially in health, education, and the environment. 
Conclusion	Therefore, the PIL has transformed the judiciary into a catalyst for social change, bridging the gap between constitutional ideals and ground realities. Through directive, mandatory, and continuous monitoring orders, courts have addressed systemic injustices. However, for PIL to remain effective, it must avoid becoming a tool for frivolous litigation or judicial overreach, ensuring that it continues to serve as a guardian of public interest.
Model Question	What is Public Interest Litigation (PIL)? Examine its significance and explain the nature of court orders generally passed in PIL cases with suitable illustrations.
Value Addition	**History of PIL in India:** • **Mumbai Kamagar Sabha vs. Abdul Thai (1976):** ✓ In this case, Justice Krishna Iyer argued that PIL had an important role to play in ensuring that the legal system served the interests of the poor and the oppressed. ✓ He emphasized that PIL was not a substitute for traditional litigation but rather to complement it. • **Hussainara Khatoon vs. State of Bihar case (1979):** ✓ It was the first reported instance of PIL, which brought attention to the inhuman conditions of prisoners and under-trial prisoners. ✓ This case established the right to speedy justice as a basic fundamental right. • **S.P. Gupta vs. Union of India (1981):** ✓ It was presided over by Justice P.N. Bhagawati, which led to a new era for PIL. ✓ The decision held that any individual member of the public or a social action group can invoke the jurisdiction of the High Courts (Article 226) or the Supreme Court (Article 32) and seek remedies for violations of legal or constitutional rights for those who are unable to do so due to social, economic, or other disabilities.
63. Define judicial activism with special reference to PIL and SAL. Judicial activism has had a manifold impact on the political system. Justify the statement by adding suitable examples. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Public Interest Litigation
Keyword	Define, Justify
Approach	• Define judicial activism and its link with PIL and Social Action Litigation (SAL). • Show positive impacts: expansion of rights, accountability (MC Mehta cases, Right to Education).

	• Highlight criticisms like policy interference and conclude with the need for self-restraint.
Introduction	Judicial activism refers to the proactive role of the judiciary in interpreting and expanding constitutional provisions to address contemporary issues, often stepping beyond traditional adjudication. It gained prominence in India from the late 1970s, especially through Public Interest Litigation (PIL) and Social Action Litigation (SAL), which liberalised access to justice for marginalised groups. Landmark cases like Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar marked its beginning, shifting focus from individual disputes to collective rights.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Judicial Activism in PIL and SAL with its impact on the political system:** • **Judicial Activism in PIL and SAL** ✓ **Public Interest Litigation (PIL):** Judicial activism enables any public-spirited person to approach the court for the enforcement of rights where victims lack access (▪ Ex: S.P. Gupta v. Union of India (1981), MC Mehta v. Union of India (1987). ✓ **Social Action Litigation (SAL):** A branch of PIL aimed at structural and policy reforms for disadvantaged groups ▪ Example: Bonded labour liberation in People's Union for Democratic Rights (PUDR) v. Union of India (1982).  ✓ **Purpose:** Judicial Activism in PIL and SAL bridges the gap between constitutional ideals and ground realities by relaxing procedural barriers. • **Impact of Judicial Activism on the Political System:** ✓ **Expansion of Rights:** Right to education (Unnikrishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh, 1993), right to a clean environment (MC Mehta case, 1987) were expanded. ✓ **Accountability of State**: In Sheela Barse v. State of Maharashtra, 1983, the High Court ruled that the mistreatment of female prisoners violated their right to life and dignity under Article 21 ✓ **Legislative Guidance:** Framing of Vishaka Guidelines on sexual harassment in the absence of legislation. ✓ **Governance Reforms**: It upheld the electoral disqualification of convicted legislators (Lily Thomas v. Union of India, 2000), mandatory asset disclosure by candidates, and so on.

	✓ **Criticism:** Risk of judicial overreach, blurring the separation of powers, and policy intrusion.
Conclusion	In this way, Judicial activism through PIL and SAL has transformed the judiciary into a catalyst for social reform, expanding the scope of governance accountability and rights protection. While it has strengthened democratic values by empowering citizens, it must operate within constitutional boundaries to avoid undermining the roles of the legislature and executive. A balanced approach ensures activism remains a constructive force in India's political system.
Model Question	Define Judicial Activism with special reference to PIL and Social Action Litigation (SAL). Critically analyse its impact on India's political system with suitable case laws
Value Addition	**Features of PIL:** • **Access to Justice for Marginalized Communities**: ✓ It brings justice within the reach of the poor masses, who constitute the low-visibility area of humanity. ✓ PIL is a different kind of litigation from ordinary traditional litigation. Intended to promote and vindicate public interest. • **Addressing Systemic Injustices:** PIL demands that violations of constitutional and legal rights of large numbers of people, who are socially and economically disadvantaged, should not go unnoticed and unredressed. • **Collaborative Advocacy:** A cooperative effort on the part of the petitioner upon the vulnerable sections of the community. • **Aim and Scope**: ✓ Litigation undertaken to redress public injury, enforcing public duty, protecting social, collective, diffused rights and interests, or vindicating public interest. ✓ Role of PIL is creative rather than passive, and it assumes a more positive attitude in determining acts. • **No Individual Rights:** Unlike traditional dispute resolution mechanisms, there is no determination on adjudication of individual rights.
64. What is meant by "judicial activism"? What is its impact on the Indian polity? (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section A: Indian Polity and Constitution: Public Interest Litigation
Keyword	What
Approach	• Define judicial activism with origins in the Indian context. • Examine its influence on governance, rights expansion, and institutional checks. • Provide examples and conclude on its balanced role in democracy.
Introduction	Judicial activism is the approach wherein the judiciary takes an active role in interpreting and expanding the scope of constitutional provisions to address emerging socio-political challenges. Unlike traditional adjudication, it involves creative law-making, filling legislative gaps, and ensuring justice where other organs have failed. In India, judicial activism became prominent post-Emergency (1975–77), supported by instruments like Public Interest Litigation (PIL) and Social Action Litigation (SAL).
Body & Infographic Representation	**Judicial Activism and its impact on the Indian Polity:** • **Meaning and Constitutional basis of Judicial activism:** ✓ **Meaning:** Judicial activism is s proactive judicial philosophy aimed at protecting rights, ensuring governance accountability, and advancing social justice. ✓ **Basis:** It is based on Articles 32, 226 (writ jurisdiction), and 142 (complete justice) of the Indian Constitution. ✓ **Emergence:** Landmark judgments in Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar (1979) and S.P. Gupta v. Union of India (1981) widened access to courts. • **Impact of judicial activism on Indian Polity:**

	✓ **Expansion of Fundamental Rights**: It expanded the Right to livelihood (Olga Tellis v. Bombay Municipal Corporation, 1985), right to education (Unnikrishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh, 2000), and so on.  ✓ **Strengthening Governance Accountability:** Judicial activism aimed at curbing corruption in cases such as Vineet Narain v. Union of India, 1969. ✓ **Social Reform and Equality:** Vishaka v. State of Rajasthan, 1997, has provided guidelines against sexual harassment that happens at the workplace. ✓ **Environmental Jurisprudence:** n M.K. Ranjitsinh & Others v. Union of India & Others (2021), the Supreme Court recognized the Right to be protected from the harmful impacts of climate change as an essential component of the right to life under Article 21 of the Constitution. ✓ **Electoral Reforms:** As per the Lily Thomas judgment, a conviction which carries a sentence of two years or more will automatically result in the disqualification of MPs/MLAs. ✓ **Criticism:** Risk of judicial overreach in policy matters such as administrative appointments, bans, and environmental directives without legislative backing.
Conclusion	To sum up, Judicial activism has profoundly shaped the Indian polity by deepening democracy, protecting citizen rights, and compelling governance reforms. While it has often bridged legislative and executive shortcomings, excessive intervention risks blurring the separation of powers. A balance between activism and restraint ensures the judiciary remains a catalyst for justice without undermining democratic institutions.
Model Question	What is meant by Judicial Activism? Evaluate its impact on Indian polity with the help of landmark judgments.
Value Addition	**Some issues related to Judicial activism:** • The line between Judicial activism and Judicial Overreach is very narrow. When Judicial activism crosses its limits it lead to Judicial Overreach. • It may interfere with the proper functioning of the legislative or executive organs of government. • It destroys the spirit of separation of powers. Thus damage balance between various organs of government. • Judicial activism may lead to inactivity of legislature and executive, leading to running away from duties and responsibilities which they hold for people of India.

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Thematic Area	Mains PYQs | Paper-III	Marks	Year
B. Public Administration and Governance			
6. Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration — Evolution in India — Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal administration; Legacy of British rule			
(i) Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration	1. In what ways can the implementation of a code of ethics in public administration help in resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decision-making?	10	APPSC 2025
	2. Define public administration and explain its evolution in India.	10	APPSC 2020
(ii) Evolution in India —Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal Administration	3. The administrative system of the Gupta dynasty was, in many ways, similar to that of the Mauryan Empire. Discuss the key similarities and differences between the two administrative structures.	10	APPSC 2025
	4. 'The concept of the welfare state had been crystallised in Kautilya's ideas long before it came to be envisioned in Western Europe' - Examine this statement.	10	APPSC 2023
	5. Differentiate between the administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra and the Mughal administration.	10	APPSC 2020
(iii) Legacy of British Rule	6. What features of British administration have influenced the Indian administrative system?	10	APPSC 2025
	7. It is observed that much of present-day Indian bureaucracy is a result of British administration. In this connection, explain the evolution of Civil Service in India.	10	APPSC 2023
7. Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues and problems of implementation			
(i) Government Policies and Interventions for Development	8. Education is a vital sector for boosting the development of any nation. Highlight the recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government.	10	APPSC 2025
	9. Although policies formulated by departments are prepared by experts, the results often fall short of expectations. What are the major issues responsible for this gap between policy formulation and implementation?	10	APPSC 2025
	10. The National Food Security Act, 2013 marks a paradigm shift from welfare to Rights based approach in ensuring food security. Analyse.	10	TGPSC 2024
	11. Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission aims to create a robust digital health eco-system and enhance health service delivery. Comment.	10	TGPSC 2024
	12. 'Despite Limitations and Challenges, Poverty Alleviation Programmes ensure socio-economic development in Urban Areas' – Examine.	10	TGPSC 2024
	13. Analyse briefly various schemes initiated by the Centre and State governments for the welfare of senior citizens.	10	TGPSC 2024
	14. Policy on Education is essential for Nation's growth. Discuss how National Education Policy,2020 can be implemented to meet the requirements of education in India.	10	TGPSC 2024

	15. National Education Policy (2020) has been criticized as denuding the autonomy of states'. In this connection' examine the rationale behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list.	10	APPSC 2023
	16. Government's intervention in development has seen a long way of impressive outcomes in India. In this connection, discuss the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission aimed at making India Self-Reliant.	10	APPSC 2023
	17. Explain the major governmental interventions in the social sector with special reference to Health and education.	10	APPSC 2020
	18. Bring out the politics of Women's Reservation Bill.	10	APPSC 2008
8. Development processes - the role of civil society, NGOs and other stakeholders			
(i) Development processes	19. Define 'development' as explained by Prof. Amartya Sen. Explain the characteristics of the new development thinking, and also mention the four areas where the government has to play a crucial role.	10	APPSC 2020
(ii) The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders	20. What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and the limitations it faces in a democratic system.	10	APPSC 2025
	21. In what ways can the role of NGOs be enhanced in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, with a focus on the key challenges they encounter.	10	APPSC 2025
	22. "NGOs play a critical role in promoting human rights, defending the marginalized, and creating a more just and equitable society." Comment on the role of NGO's in India.	10	APPSC 2023
	23. Describe the role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy.	10	APPSC 2020
	24. Give the reason for the UN to partner with the civil society. Explain the importance of civil societies. Under which Acts are the NGOs in India legally registered?	10	APPSC 2020
9. Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial authorities – Role of Civil Services in Democracy			
(i) Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities	25. Which constitutional provisions empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities in India? Explain with suitable examples.	10	APPSC 2025
	26. Under which Act was the National Commission for Women (NCW) established? Describe its main features and limitations.	10	APPSC 2025
	27. Describe the work of the statutory bodies with example and mention in which countries they are set up. Explain quasi-judicial bodies, providing two examples from India.	10	APPSC 2020
	28. What are the Constitutional guarantees given to women? Explain the role of the National Commission for Women in protecting the rights of the women.	10	APPSC 2012
	29. What are the functions of the National Commission for Women?	10	APPSC 2011
	30. Explain the powers and functions of the Human Rights Commission.	10	APPSC 2011
	31. Analyse the functions and functioning of National Commission for Scheduled Castes.	10	APPSC 2008

(ii) Role of Civil Services in Democracy	32. Public servants often face situations where personal values conflict with public responsibilities. Examine how a strong ethical foundation can help resolve such dilemmas while maintaining accountability.	10	APPSC 2025
	33. "The Mission Karmayogi initiative of Government of India will revitalize the Civil Services in India and equip, them to face the challenges of Governance". Examine.	10	TGPSC 2024
	34. Explain the scope of civil service reforms in India with a brief note on Mission Karmayogi.	10	APPSC 2023
	35. What are the reasons for decline of integrity in civil services? Also' discuss the institutional mechanism to check corruption in India'.	10	APPSC 2023
10. Good governance and e-governance- Transparency, accountability and responsiveness in governance — Citizen's Charter. RTI, Public Service Act and their implications, Concept of Social Audit and its importance			
(i) Governance and Good Governance	36. Define good governance. How does the Right to Information (RTI) Act promote the principles of good governance in India?	10	APPSC 2025
	37. Decentralisation is a necessary tool for good governance. Elaborate.	10	TGPSC 2024
	38. What are the different dimensions of governance? Briefly explain the administrative dimension of governance and its key components.	10	APPSC 2023
(ii) Transparency, Accountability	39. Discuss the significance of integrity, transparency and accountability in leadership. How can public leaders demonstrate these values in their decision-making process?	10	APPSC 2025
	40. Whistle blowers are guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Discuss the ethical and institutional importance of whistle blower protection in ensuring integrity in public service.	10	APPSC 2025
	41. Define Accountability. Discuss the factors that have led to weakening of accountability in civil services. Suggest ways to improve the mechanisms for accountability in civil services.	10	APPSC 2023
(iii) Citizen's Charter	42. Discuss the Indian experience of Citizen Charter movement and suggest solutions to improve its impact in India.	10	APPSC 2023
(iv) RTI	43. "The making of the Right to Information Act, 2005 in India has been largely attributed to the success of civil society movement. Comment.	10	APPSC 2023
	44. What is RTI? What rights are available under RTI Act 2005? If RTI is a Fundamental Right, then why do we need an Act to give us this Right?	10	APPSC 2020
	45. "The Right to Information Act is meant only for providing information but not grievance redressal." Comment	10	APPSC 2017
(v) Public Service Act and their Implications	46. 'The promise of decentralisation of public service delivery is based on the hope that the local bodies will promote required standards of accountability. Examine.	10	TGPSC 2024
(vi) Concept of Social Audit and its importance	47. Social audit helps to narrow gaps between vision and reality. Examine the statement and also discuss the impediments in the institutionalisation of social audit in India.	10	APPSC 2025

Mains PYQs | Paper-III | Section-B | Model Answers

B. Public Administration and Governance

6. Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration — Evolution in India — Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal administration; Legacy of British rule

1. In what ways can the implementation of a code of ethics in public administration help in resolving conflicts of interest and promoting ethical decision-making? (APPSC, 2025)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration
Keyword	In what ways
Approach	• Define code of ethics as guiding principles for civil servants. • Show how it prevents conflict of interest (transparency, impartiality, accountability) and promotes ethical decisions (Nolan Principles, 2nd ARC). • Conclude that the Ethical code strengthens trust and legitimacy in governance.
Introduction	A Code of Ethics refers to a set of principles that guide the moral conduct of public servants in their professional duties. In a democracy like India, where civil servants are entrusted with authority and discretion, a well-defined ethical framework helps in resolving conflicts of interest and ensuring citizen-centric governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Implementation of a code of ethics in public administration:** • **Implementation of a code of ethics in public administration resolves Conflicts of Interest:** ✓ **Clarity in Decision-Making:** ▪ A code ensures officials separate personal interests from official duties. ▪ Example: Disclosure of assets and restrictions on post-retirement jobs prevent misuse of office. ✓ **Promoting Impartiality:** ▪ Ethical guidelines mandate neutrality in dealing with citizens irrespective of caste, religion, or political pressure. ▪ Example: Upholding fairness in recruitment or welfare scheme distribution. ✓ **Preventing Corruption:** ▪ Ethical codes highlight integrity and accountability, discouraging bribery and favouritism. ▪ Reference: Nolan Principles (UK) and Second ARC Report (India) stress transparency and selflessness. • **Implementation of a code of ethics in public administration promotes Ethical Decision-Making:** ✓ **Citizen-Centric Governance:** ▪ Ethics ensure decisions prioritise public interest over personal or political gains.

	▪ Example: During the COVID-19 pandemic, officers followed their ethical duty by ensuring equitable vaccine distribution. ✓ **Strengthening Public Trust:** ▪ Ethical conduct builds credibility and legitimacy of the administration. ▪ Example: Lal Bahadur Shastri's resignation as Railway Minister after a train accident is a model of accountability. ✓ **Guiding in Ethical Dilemmas:** In complex situations (e.g., land acquisition vs. tribal rights), ethics help balance developmental goals with social justice.
Conclusion	A Code of Ethics acts as a moral compass for civil servants, helping them avoid conflicts of interest, resist undue influence, and uphold fairness. By institutionalising ethical standards, public administration can ensure transparency, accountability, and citizen welfare, thereby strengthening democratic governance.
Model Question	Examine how the implementation of a Code of Ethics in public administration can help in resolving conflicts of interest and ensuring ethical decision-making.
Value Addition	Seven Principles of Public Life, also known as the Nolan principles: • **Selflessness:** Take decisions in the public interest • **Integrity:** No financial or other obligation to outside individuals • **Objectivity:** Make choices on merit • **Accountability:** Submit yourself to the scrutiny of different authorities • **Openness:** Give reasons for your decisions • **Honesty:** Declare any private interest in their public duties • **Leadership:** Lead by example
2. Define public administration and explain its evolution in India. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Meaning, Nature and Scope of Public Administration
Keyword	Define and explain
Approach	• Define public administration as the implementation of policies and delivery of public services. • Trace evolution: ancient (Arthashastra), Mughal, colonial ICS, post-Independence democratic administration. • Conclude with present-day New Public Management & e-governance.
Introduction	Public administration is the study and practice of implementing government policies and delivering services for public welfare. It acts as the instrument of governance that translates laws into action. In India, it has evolved through ancient, medieval, colonial, and modern phases, adapting to socio-political changes.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Definition of Public Administration** • Public administration refers to the organization, management, and implementation of government functions to ensure efficiency, justice, and citizen welfare. • According to Woodrow Wilson, it is the "detailed and systematic execution of public law." • In the Indian context, it is deeply influenced by constitutional values like justice, equality, and accountability. **Evolution of Public Administration in India** • **Ancient Period:** ✓ It was rooted in the Arthashastra by Kautilya (4th century BCE), which emphasized revenue collection, espionage, and the welfare of people. ✓ The Mauryan and Gupta administrations were highly centralized with a focus on taxation, law, and order. • **Medieval Period:**

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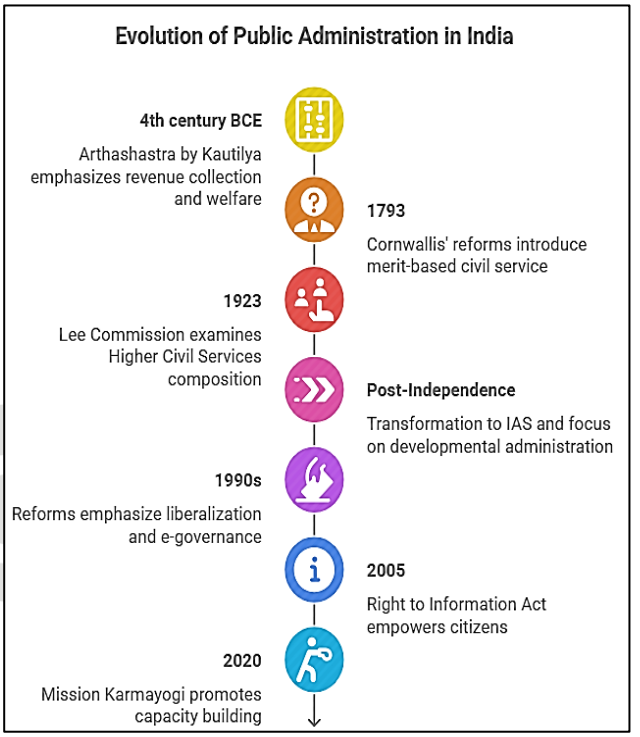
✓ Under the Delhi Sultanate and Mughals, administration revolved around a land revenue system (Example: Raja Todar Mal's Bandobast system).
✓ The period saw a strong central authority with provincial governance through Mansabdars and Jagirdars.

Colonial Period (British Rule):

✓ The British introduced the Indian Civil Service (ICS), which became the steel frame of colonial governance.
✓ The administration focused on law and order, revenue collection, and maintaining imperial control.
✓ The British Government established the Lee Commission in 1923 to examine the composition of the Higher Civil Services of India.
✓ Example: Cornwallis' reforms (1793) introduced merit-based civil service.

Post-Independence Period:

✓ The ICS was transformed into the Indian Administrative Service (IAS) and allied services.
✓ The Focus shifted to developmental administration, planning, and welfare programs.
✓ From the 1990s, reforms emphasized liberalization, e-governance, the Right to Information (RTI Act 2005), and citizen-centric governance.
✓ Recent initiatives like Mission Karmayogi (2020) and Digital India reflect the modern evolution.



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<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>Public administration in India has journeyed from monarchy-centric control to democratic and citizen-oriented governance. Its evolution reflects the country's socio-political transformation across centuries. Today, it stands as a vital instrument for achieving good governance and inclusive development.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>"Define public administration and trace its historical evolution in India from the ancient period to the modern era. How has it adapted to socio-political changes over time?"</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>Lee Commission:

The Commission was headed by Lord Lee from Fareham; he ensured the equal representation of both British and Indian members.
In the Lee Commission Report in 1924, they recommended the future recruitment to higher civil services where the ratio should be 40% British, 40% directly recruited Indians, and 20% promoted from provincial services.
Since the commission only focused on the recruitment of the top-tier recruitment for higher services, they also referred to the Royal Commission on the Superior Civil Services in India.
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	• One of the most significant recommendations was the establishment of a Public Service Commission, which is considered essential to ensure fair and efficient administration. • The commission also described this idea as a "cardinal feature" of its report and important to the future structure of the services. • By the time of the Independence of India in 1947, over half of the roughly 1000 members of the civil services were Indian, from whom many held senior and vital positions for the future of the services
3. The administrative system of the Gupta dynasty was, in many ways, similar to that of the Mauryan Empire. Discuss the key similarities and differences between the two administrative structures. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Evolution in India- Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal Administration
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by mentioning that both the Mauryan and Gupta empires represent important phases of ancient Indian polity and administration. • Explain similarities—monarchical rule, ministerial council, three-tier structure, revenue system, and village administration. • Present differences in a table showing centralisation vs decentralisation, bureaucracy, economy, and military. • Conclude by highlighting the evolution from a centralised to a semi-feudal administrative pattern.
Introduction	Both the Mauryan and Gupta empires represent two important phases of ancient Indian polity. While the Mauryan administration was highly centralised under Chandragupta and Ashoka, the Gupta system combined central authority with regional autonomy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Similarities in Administrative Systems of the Mauryas and Guptas:** • **Monarchical Governance:** Both empires followed a monarchical system where the King was the supreme authority responsible for policy, justice, and defence. • **Council of Ministers:** The King was assisted by a Mantriparishad or council of ministers for administrative decisions. • **Hierarchical Structure:** Both had a three-tier administration are Central, Provincial, and Local ensuring efficient governance across vast territories. • **Revenue System:** Land revenue was the main source of state income, ranging from one-sixth to one-fourth of the agricultural produce. • **Local Self-Governance:** Villages were the basic administrative unit, led by headmen (Gramani in Mauryan and Gramadhyaksha in Gupta period). • **Dharma and Justice:** Both rulers emphasized righteous rule (Dharma) and welfare of subjects as the king's foremost duty. **Differences between Mauryan and Gupta Administration:**

Aspect	Mauryan Administration	Gupta Administration
Nature of Rule	Highly centralised with tight control from the capital	More decentralised, allowing local autonomy
King's Position	King as guardian of Dharma, not divine	King considered divine; used titles like Paramabhattaraka
Bureaucracy	Large and complex; several departments under Adhyakshas	Smaller bureaucracy with fewer officials
Provincial Governance	Governors (Kumaras) directly appointed by King	Provinces (Bhuktis) under Uparikas, many local rulers retained

	Military Organization	Large standing army maintained by state	Relied more on feudatory troops and allies
	Taxation	Extensive, regulated taxation system	Fewer and simpler taxes, mainly land-based

Conclusion	In essence, the Mauryan administration reflected strong centralised control guided by state socialism, while the Gupta system evolved toward feudal decentralisation with growing regional powers. Both, however, upheld order, prosperity, and dharmic governance, leaving a lasting legacy in the evolution of Indian administrative traditions.
Model Question	"Compare and contrast the administrative systems of the Mauryan and Gupta Empires. How did the changing nature of polity reflect the socio-economic transformations of ancient India?"
Value Addition	**About the Mauryan Empire:** • The Mauryan Empire (322–185 BCE), founded by Chandragupta Maurya, was the first pan-Indian empire, uniting almost the entire subcontinent under one centralized authority. • It had a highly organized administrative structure with an extensive bureaucracy and strong military system. • Kautilya's Arthashastra provided detailed insights into statecraft, taxation, espionage, and economic regulation. • Under Ashoka, the empire adopted Dhamma-based governance promoting Buddhism, moral values, and welfare measures. • The Mauryan model laid the foundation of political unity and imperial administration in India. **About the Gupta Empire:** • The Gupta Empire (320–550 CE), founded by Sri Gupta, marked the Golden Age of India due to immense progress in science, art, architecture, and literature. • It followed a more decentralized administration, granting autonomy to local and provincial units while maintaining central supervision. • Cultural figures like Kalidasa, scientists like Aryabhata and Varahamihira, and advancements in metallurgy and mathematics flourished. • The Guptas promoted Hindu revivalism, temple architecture, and Sanskrit literature, shaping the classical Indian identity. • Their rule reflected stability, prosperity, and intellectual growth, influencing later Indian polities.

4. The concept of the welfare state had been crystallised in Kautilya's ideas long before it came to be envisioned in Western Europe' - Examine this statement. (APPSC, 2023)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Evolution in India- Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal administration
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Introduce by defining the concept of a welfare state as one where the government ensures citizens' social and economic well-being, linking it to Kautilya's Arthashastra which emphasised public welfare as the ruler's duty. • Explain Kautilya's welfare measures economic fairness, social justice, disaster relief, and ethical governance, showing early welfare principles. • Conclude by highlighting that Kautilya's vision predated modern European welfare ideas, reflecting India's ancient governance wisdom.
Introduction	The idea of a welfare state, where the government takes responsibility for the social and economic well-being of its citizens, was deeply embedded in Kautilya's Arthashastra written in the 4th century BCE. Kautilya's concept of governance emphasised that people's welfare was central to state policy, much before modern Europe visualised it.

Body & Infographic Representation

Kautilya's Idea of Welfare State:

- **Centrality of Public Welfare:**
  - ✓ Kautilya held that "In the happiness of his subjects lies the happiness of the king". The ruler's duty was to promote Yogakshema the security and welfare of the people. This reflects a state-centered welfare approach, not merely as charity but as dharma (duty).
- **Economic and Social Welfare Measures:**
  - ✓ The Arthashastra details measures like fair taxation, protection of agriculture and trade, and prevention of exploitation by officials. Economic activities were regulated to ensure fair prices, prevention of adulteration, and protection of traders and artisans, showing awareness of consumer and labour welfare.
- **Protection of the Weak and Vulnerable:**
  - ✓ Kautilya's policies included state support for widows, orphans, aged persons, and the disabled. He promoted humane treatment of prisoners and slaves, welfare of women, and even animal protection, reflecting a comprehensive vision of social justice.
- **Disaster and Calamity Management:**
  - ✓ During famines and natural disasters, Kautilya directed tax remissions, distribution of grains from state stores, and public works employment—practices similar to modern social security mechanisms.
- **Ethical Governance and Accountability:**
  - ✓ Kautilya insisted that corruption and misuse of power be checked and that the king remain accountable for citizens' welfare, laying the foundation for good governance principles found in modern democratic welfare states.

Aspect	Kautilya's Welfare State	Modern Welfare State (Europe)
Time Period	4th century BCE	19th –20th century CE
Core Principle	King's happiness lies in people's welfare	State ensures citizens' well-being
Social Welfare	Support for women, aged, poor, prisoners	Universal health, education, pension
Ethical	Foundation Dharma and justice	Rights and equality

Conclusion

Thus, Kautilya's Arthashastra embodies the core principles of a welfare state centuries before Europe's conception of it. His vision of a state ensuring social justice, economic security, and moral responsibility illustrates that the roots of the welfare ideal lie deep in ancient Indian political thought.

Model Question

"Examine how Kautilya's ideas of economic management and social welfare in the Arthashastra reflect the early foundations of a welfare-oriented state in ancient India."

Value Addition

About Kautilya:

- Kautilya, also known as Chanakya or Vishnugupta (c. 350–275 BCE), was a philosopher, economist, and statesman who played a key role in the formation of the Mauryan Empire. His treatise, the Arthashastra, remains one of the earliest comprehensive texts on governance, economics, and political ethics in the world.
- **Political Philosophy and Statecraft:**
  - ✓ Advocated Realpolitik — a pragmatic and result-oriented approach to governance.
  - ✓ Believed the primary duty of the ruler is to ensure the security and prosperity of the state.

	✓ The ruler should be wise, disciplined, and assisted by efficient ministers and a strong bureaucracy. ✓ Emphasized espionage, intelligence networks, and diplomacy as vital tools of governance. ✓ Advocated a balance between dharma (ethics) and artha (economic strength) in statecraft. • **Economic Thought:** ✓ Proposed a mixed economy — state regulation with private participation. Highlighted the importance of agriculture, trade, and taxation for economic stability. ✓ Advocated fair taxation, preventing monopolies, and promoting welfare through economic equity. ✓ Stressed on resource management and market regulation to prevent exploitation. ✓ Linked economic prosperity with political stability. • **Governance and Administration:** ✓ Suggested a centralized administration headed by a competent king supported by councils. ✓ Emphasized efficiency, accountability, and loyalty among officials. Advocated a surveillance system for maintaining internal security. ✓ Defined justice as rule-based, impartial, and aimed at maintaining order.
5. Differentiate between the administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra and the Mughal administration. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Evolution in India- Administrative ideas in Kautilya's Arthashastra; Mughal administration
Keyword	Differentiate
Approach	• Introduce by mentioning that both Kautilya's Arthashastra and the Mughal administration represent distinct yet advanced governance systems in Indian history. • Explain the key differences in their administrative features—centralization of power, bureaucracy, revenue system, law and justice, and local governance by highlighting Kautilya's rational, centralized model versus the Mughals' hierarchical, partly decentralized setup. • Conclude by emphasizing that both aimed at efficient governance and public welfare despite differing in scope and approach.
Introduction	Kautilya's Arthashastra and the Mughal administrative system represent two remarkable models of governance in ancient and medieval India. While Kautilya emphasized a highly centralized, rational, and welfare-based monarchy, the Mughal administration evolved as a blend of Persian, Indian, and Turko-Mongol traditions with practical decentralization.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Difference between the administrative ideas of Kautilya's Arthashastra and the Mughal administration:** • **Nature of Authority:** ✓ Kautilya's system was monarchical and highly centralized, where the king was the supreme authority responsible for both governance and welfare. ✓ In contrast, the Mughal Emperor shared authority through a structured hierarchy of officials, allowing limited decentralization in provincial administration. • **Bureaucratic Organization:** ✓ Kautilya designed a merit-based bureaucracy with strict accountability and surveillance through spies. Officials were frequently transferred to prevent corruption.

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✓ The Mughals used the Mansabdari system, ranking officers (both military and civil) based on Mansabs, but loyalty often outweighed merit.

Revenue and Economic Administration:

✓ In the Arthashastra, Kautilya proposed a scientific revenue system based on land, trade, and taxation, ensuring welfare and state prosperity.
✓ The Mughal Zabt and Bandobast systems under Todar Mal emphasized land surveys, productivity-based assessment, and efficient collection, reflecting flexibility and adaptation.

Law and Justice:

✓ Kautilya's system followed secular and codified laws, focusing on deterrence and fairness.
✓ The Mughal legal system was influenced by Sharia and local customs, where the emperor was the supreme judge, assisted by Qazis and local officials.

Local Governance:

✓ Kautilya's administration had local functionaries like Sthaniks and Gopas maintaining order and revenue records.
✓ The Mughals retained traditional local institutions such as panchayats and zamindars, integrating them into their imperial system.

<table>
<tr><th>Feature</th><th>Kautilya's Arthashastra</th><th>Mughal Administration</th></tr>
<tr><td>Centralization</td><td>Highly centralized monarchy</td><td>Centralized but partly decentralized through provinces</td></tr>
<tr><td>Bureaucracy</td><td>Merit-based and strictly supervised</td><td>Mansabdari system with mixed merit and loyalty</td></tr>
<tr><td>Revenue System</td><td>Based on land, trade, and taxes</td><td>Land revenue through Zabt and Bandobast systems</td></tr>
<tr><td>Law and Justice</td><td>Secular, codified, and rational</td><td>Based on Sharia and imperial discretion</td></tr>
<tr><td>Local Governance</td><td>Officials like Sthaniks and Gopas</td><td>Village panchayats and zamindars integrated</td></tr>
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<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>While Kautilya's Arthashastra reflects a highly organized, rational, and centralized model for a smaller polity, the Mughal administration blended central authority with regional diversity. Both aimed at stability and welfare, yet differed in structure, scope, and the balance between control and flexibility.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>Examine how the principles of governance and administrative efficiency outlined in Kautilya's Arthashastra influenced later Indian empires, particularly in comparison with the Mughal administrative system.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>Administration of Mughals Empire:

Central Administration:

✓ The Mughal Empire was a centralized monarchy, with the Emperor (Badshah) holding supreme authority over civil, military, and judicial matters.
✓ He was assisted by a council of ministers (Diwan-i-Kul).
✓ Key officials included the Wazir (Prime Minister overseeing general administration), Diwan (Head of Finances and Expenditure), Mir Bakshi (Head of Military and intelligence), Sadr-us-Sadur (Head of Religious Affairs and charities), and Mir Saman (In charge of royal workshops or Karkhanas).

Administrative Divisions:

✓ The empire was divided into Subas (provinces) governed by Subahdars, further subdivided into Sarkars (districts) and Parganas (groups of villages).

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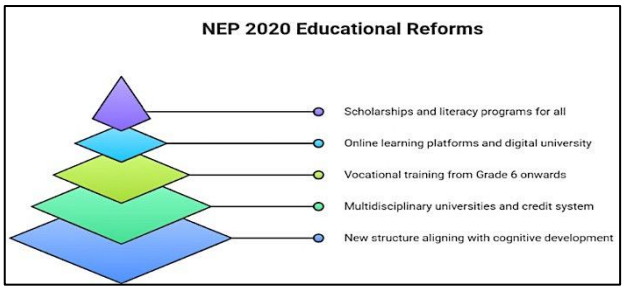
	✓ Each level had officers like Faujdars who maintained law and order, ensuring a smooth chain of command from the Emperor to the village level. • Provincial Administration: ✓ At the provincial level, the Sipahsalar represented the Emperor, acting as both civil and military head. ✓ The Diwan handled revenue administration, the Bakshi managed provincial military affairs, and the Sadr supervised judicial and religious functions. • District and Village Administration: ✓ At the district level, Fauzdars maintained peace, while Amalguzars managed land revenue. ✓ In villages, Muqaddams acted as headmen overseeing local governance, and Patwaris maintained land and revenue records.
6. What features of British administration have influenced the Indian administrative system? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Legacy of British Rule
Keyword	What
Approach	• Begin by introducing that the British colonial rule laid the foundation for India's modern administrative structure, shaping its governance and institutions. • Explain the main features influenced by the British such as parliamentary democracy, civil services, rule of law, district administration, legal system, police structure, and financial accountability mechanisms. • Conclude by highlighting that India adapted these colonial features to suit democratic, welfare-oriented governance after independence.
Introduction	The British colonial administration in India laid the foundation for modern governance structures. Many features of today's Indian administrative system such as bureaucracy, rule of law, and parliamentary democracy are deeply influenced by British institutions, practices, and principles that evolved during nearly two centuries of colonial rule.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Features of British administration that influenced the Indian administrative system:** • **Parliamentary Democracy and Rule of Law:** ✓ The British introduced a parliamentary form of government based on the Westminster model, which continues to define India's political structure. ✓ The concept of the rule of law, independent judiciary, and constitutional supremacy were borrowed from British administrative traditions and are now core features of Indian democracy. • **Bureaucratic Framework and Civil Services:** ✓ The Indian Civil Service (ICS), often called the "steel frame" of British administration, provided an efficient and merit-based bureaucracy. After independence, it evolved into the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), retaining its neutrality, hierarchy, and commitment to public service. ✓ Recruitment through competitive examinations and emphasis on administrative accountability are continuations of the British legacy. • **Legal and Judicial Systems:** ✓ The British introduced a codified legal system, including laws such as the Indian Penal Code (1860) and Criminal Procedure Code (1861), which continue to govern India's judicial framework. ✓ The system of hierarchical courts, judicial review, and professional legal practices are direct inheritances from British administration. • **Financial and Audit Institutions:** ✓ The British system emphasized budgetary control, public accounts, and audit mechanisms.

	✓ Institutions like the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) are rooted in colonial administrative practices aimed at ensuring fiscal responsibility and transparency. • **Police and Law Enforcement:** ✓ The Police Act of 1861, introduced after the 1857 Revolt, laid the foundation for modern policing in India. ✓ The hierarchical command structure and focus on maintaining internal security remain significant features of the current Indian police system. • **Local Self-Government:** ✓ The concept of local self-governance, initiated through Lord Ripon's 1882 reforms, continues in the form of Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies, promoting grassroots democracy and citizen participation in governance.
Conclusion	The Indian administrative system, though reoriented toward democratic and welfare goals after independence, still carries strong imprints of the British legacy. By retaining useful administrative structures while adapting them to national needs, India successfully transformed a colonial framework into a democratic and development-oriented governance system.
Model Question	"Discuss how the legacy of British colonial administration continues to influence the structure and functioning of modern Indian bureaucracy."
Value Addition	**Military under British Administration:** • The army served as the second most significant pillar of British Administration in India, after the civil services. • The army fulfilled four important functions: ✓ It served as a tool used to subdue the Indian powers. ✓ It defended the British Empire in India against outside enemies. ✓ It protected British supremacy from the constant risk of internal uprising. ✓ It served as the main tool for defending and expanding the boundaries of the British Empire in Asia and Africa.
7. It is observed that much of present-day Indian bureaucracy is a result of British administration. In this connection, explain the evolution of Civil Service in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Legacy of British Rule
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Begin with a contextual introduction highlighting how India's present bureaucracy has colonial roots. • In the body, trace the civil service evolution chronologically: start with the East India Company's patronage-based system, then explain Lord Cornwallis's key reforms and mention Indianization reforms such as the Aitchison Commission and PSC establishment. • Finally, explain post-independence continuity and transformation into IAS, concluding with its democratic and developmental role today.
Introduction	The present-day Indian bureaucracy largely retains the foundational structure, principles of administration, and rule of law established during the British colonial period. The evolution of the civil service in India reflects a transformation from a commercial enterprise's staff to a structured, merit-based administrative machinery.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Evolution of Civil Service in India:** • **East India Company Era: From Traders to Administrators** ✓ Before the formal civil service, the East India Company's servants were primarily commercial agents who engaged in private trade and were often corrupt.

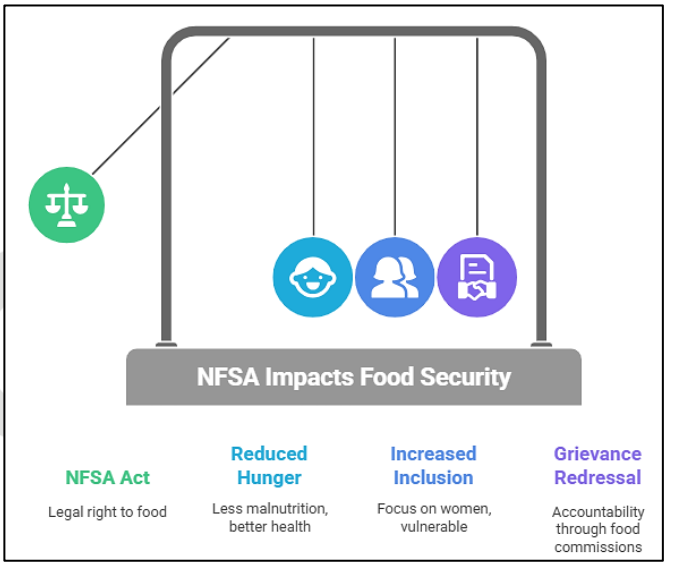
	✓ This system was based on patronage, where appointments were made through the favour of the Company's Directors in London. • **Foundation under Lord Cornwallis (1786-1793):** Lord Cornwallis is regarded as the "Father of Civil Services in India". His reforms were crucial in shaping a structured administrative body by: ✓ **Abolition of Private Trade:** He banned company servants from engaging in private trade and accepting gifts to reduce corruption. ✓ **Enhanced Salaries:** To compensate for the ban on private trade and ensure integrity, he persuaded the Company's Directors to pay handsome salaries to civil servants. ✓ **Establishment of Covenanted and Uncovenanted Services:** He created the Covenanted Civil Service (CCS) for higher administrative posts (e.g., District Collector), which were initially reserved exclusively for Europeans, while Indians were largely limited to lower, "uncovenanted" positions. ✓ **Separation of Powers:** The Cornwallis Code of 1793 formally separated the revenue administration from the judicial functions, laying the groundwork for a more structured governance. • **Shift to Merit-Based Recruitment (Post-1853):** The system evolved from pure patronage to meritocracy with subsequent legislative changes: ✓ **Charter Act of 1853:** This Act abolished the patronage system and introduced an open, merit-based competition for recruitment into the Covenanted Civil Service. ✓ **Macaulay Committee Report (1854):** Lord Macaulay's committee recommended a a formal system of competitive examinations held in London for entry into the ICS (Indian Civil Service, the successor to the CCS). ✓ **Indian Civil Service Act, 1861:** This Act gave a legal basis to the new system. However, examinations held only in London and other discriminatory criteria (like age limits) effectively limited Indian participation. ✓ **First Indian ICS Officer:** Despite the barriers, Satyendranath Tagore became the first Indian to join the ICS in 1864. • **Indianization and Formal Structure (Late 19th and Early 20th Century):** ✓ **Aitchison Commission (1886):** This commission recommended a three-tier service classification: Imperial (all-India), Provincial, and Subordinate, increasing opportunities for Indians in the lower two tiers. ✓ **Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919) and Lee Commission (1923):** These recommended simultaneous examinations in India and London, which began in India from 1922. ✓ **Public Service Commission:** The establishment of the Public Service Commission in 1926 (which became the Federal Public Service Commission under the Government of India Act, 1935) laid the institutional foundation for modern recruitment bodies like the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC). • **Post-Independence Transformation:** ✓ After independence, the ICS was replaced by the Indian Administrative Service (IAS) and other services (e.g., IPS, IFS). The new framework, strongly supported by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel as the "steel frame" of the nation, retained the professional, merit-based, and politically neutral character of its colonial predecessor, but reoriented it towards the goals of an independent, democratic, and welfare-oriented nation.
Conclusion	The Indian Civil Service has transitioned from a colonial instrument of control to a vital pillar of democratic governance and national development. While the structural

	continuity from British rule remains such as hierarchical procedures and district administration the purpose and ethos of the service have evolved to reflect the aspirations of independent India, aiming for efficient, accountable, and citizen-oriented administration.
Model Question	Examine the significance of the Charter Act of 1833 in the development of merit-based civil services in India.
Value Addition	**Constitutional Provisions:** • **Retention of All India Services (Article 312)** ✓ The Constitution provided for the continuation of the All India Services (AIS) such as the Indian Administrative Service (IAS) and Indian Police Service (IPS). These were seen as essential for maintaining administrative unity, national integration, and standardized governance across states. • **Role of UPSC (Articles 315–323)** ✓ To maintain merit-based recruitment, the Constitution established the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) and State Public Service Commissions. ▪ They conduct examinations, ▪ Ensure impartiality, ▪ Prevent political influence in appointments. ▪ This structural continuity preserved administrative professionalism. • **Protection of Service Conditions (Article 309, 310 and 311)** ✓ Civil servants were given security of tenure, allowing them to perform duties without fear of political retribution. • **Article 311, for instance, protects civil servants from arbitrary dismissal.**
7. Government policies and interventions for development in various sectors and issues and problems of implementation	
8. Education is a vital sector for boosting the development of any nation. Highlight the recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development
Keyword	Highlight
Approach	• Establish the link between education, human capital, and national growth. • Summarise NEP 2020 features, Samagra Shiksha 2.0, PM SHRI Schools, digital initiatives like SWAYAM & PM eVidya. • Emphasise how these reforms can create an equitable, skilled, and knowledge-based economy.
Introduction	Education is the cornerstone of human capital formation, driving economic growth, social mobility, and innovation. India, with its demographic advantage, recognises that quality education is critical for becoming a knowledge-driven economy. Recent reforms, particularly the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and allied programmes, aim to make education more inclusive, skill-oriented, and globally competitive.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Recent developments in the education policy of the Indian government:** • **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020:** ✓ **School Education Transformation:** ▪ The traditional 10+2 system is being replaced by a 5+3+3+4 structure, aligning education stages more closely with a child's cognitive development. ▪ Strong focus on Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE) to build foundational skills and nurture holistic growth from a young age. ✓ **Higher Education Reforms:**

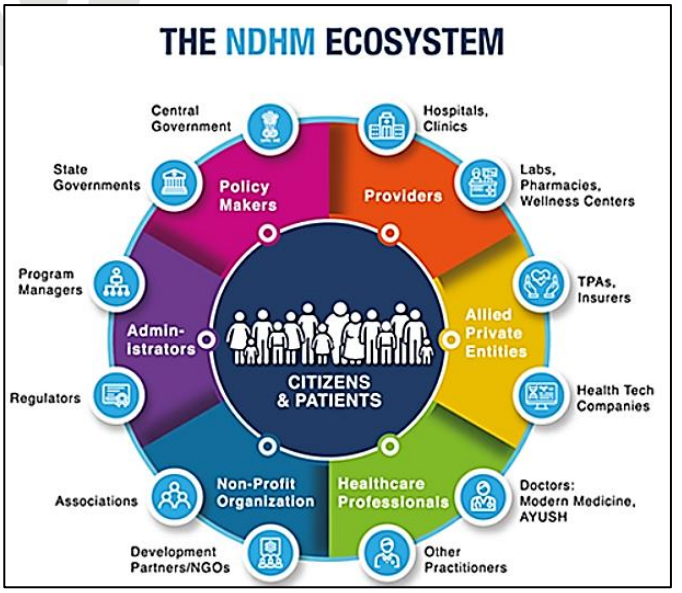
	▪ Promotion of multidisciplinary universities and colleges to encourage diverse learning pathways. ▪ Introduction of the Academic Bank of Credits (ABCs), allowing students to accumulate and transfer credits across institutions. ▪ India's Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) in higher education stands at 27.3% (AISHE 2021-22), with a target of 50% by 2035.  ✓ **Skill Development & Vocational Training:** Vocational education will be integrated from Grade 6 onwards, equipping students with practical skills and preparing them for real-world challenges early on. • **Samagra Shiksha Yojana 2.0:** It is an integrated scheme for school education covering infrastructure, digital learning, and teacher training. • **PM SHRI Schools (2022):** Development of 14,500 schools as model institutions showcasing NEP practices. • **Digital Initiatives in the education field:** ✓ Initiatives like SWAYAM, DIKSHA, and PM e-Vidya platforms promote online learning. ✓ National Digital University expanded access to flexible higher education. • **Research and Innovation Support in Education:** The National Research Foundation (NRF) strengthened research funding and collaboration. • **Inclusive Education:** ✓ Schemes like NIPUN Bharat for foundational literacy and numeracy. ✓ Scholarships for SC, ST, OBC, and girl students to reduce dropouts.
Conclusion	Therefore, the recent educational reforms aim to create a flexible, skill-oriented, and learner-centric system aligned with global standards. While implementation faces challenges such as digital divide, teacher readiness, and funding, effective Centre–State cooperation, robust monitoring, and community participation can transform India's vast human resource base into a competitive advantage in the global economy.
Model Question	Education is critical to national development. Critically evaluate the recent initiatives and reforms undertaken by the Government of India in the education sector, with special reference to NEP 2020 and allied programmes
Value Addition	**Schemes for Elementary Education:** • **Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan (SSA)** ✓ It was launched in 2001 as a flagship programme to achieve Universalisation of Elementary Education (UEE) for children aged 6-14. ✓ It focuses on school access, infrastructure, teacher training, and inclusive education. ✓ It was now subsumed under Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan since 2018. • **Mid-Day Meal Scheme (MDMS)** ✓ The scheme provides nutritious cooked meals to children in government and aided schools to improve enrolment, retention, and nutrition. ✓ It was launched in 1995 as the National Programme of Nutritional Support to Primary Education. ✓ It was now expanded as the PM POSHAN scheme covering pre-primary to Class 8.

	• **Mahila Samakhya Programme** ✓ It was initiated in 1988 to promote women's empowerment through education, especially in rural and marginalised communities. ✓ The programme encourages women's collectives, literacy, and participation in local governance. ✓ It was implemented in partnership with State Resource Centres and NGOs. • **Scheme for Providing Quality Education in Madrasas (SPQEM)** ✓ The Scheme aims to modernise madrasas by introducing subjects like Science, Mathematics, Social Studies, and Hindi/English. ✓ It provides financial assistance for teachers' salaries, training, and infrastructure. ✓ It promotes integration of traditional religious education with mainstream curriculum.
9. Although policies formulated by departments are prepared by experts, the results often fall short of expectations. What are the major issues responsible for this gap between policy formulation and implementation? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development
Keyword	What
Approach	• Introduce by highlighting the paradox between expert-driven policy formulations and recurring failures in achieving intended outcomes on the ground. • Analyze the key reasons for the policy-implementation gap, such as administrative bottlenecks, poor resource allocation, lack of accountability, political interference, and weak stakeholder participation. • Conclude by suggesting reforms like decentralized planning, participatory governance, real-time monitoring, and capacity building to ensure effective policy outcomes.
Introduction	While policy formulation in India is guided by subject experts, think tanks, and consultative mechanisms, there remains a persistent gap between policy formulation and implementation. This issue is evident across sectors, from education and agriculture to health and welfare at both national and state levels. In Telangana, schemes such as Mission Kakatiya, KCR Kit, and Housing for All demonstrate how well-intentioned policies can fall short if not backed by robust execution.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Major issues responsible for this gap between policy formulation and implementation:** • **Institutional and Administrative Weaknesses:** ✓ Despite expert-led designs, lack of field-level capacity hinders implementation. ✓ For instance, Arogya Lakshmi, Telangana's maternal nutrition scheme, suffered from poor Anganwadi outreach in tribal areas (Socio-Economic Outlook, 2023). ✓ The NITI Aayog's 2021 report on governance noted that India's lower bureaucracy often lacks outcome orientation, affecting last-mile delivery. ✓ Frequent transfers of field officers, especially in departments like agriculture and health, break continuity and accountability. • **Disconnection from Ground Realities:** ✓ Many policies are urban-centric or generic, ignoring regional diversity. ✓ For example, PMFBY (crop insurance) in Telangana failed to adequately address rain fed farmers in Mahbubnagar and Adilabad due to lack of granular risk zoning (ICRISAT, 2020). ✓ Similarly, schemes for water-intensive crops like paddy were introduced in dryland zones, leading to ecological distress. • **Financial Constraints and Delay in Fund Flow**

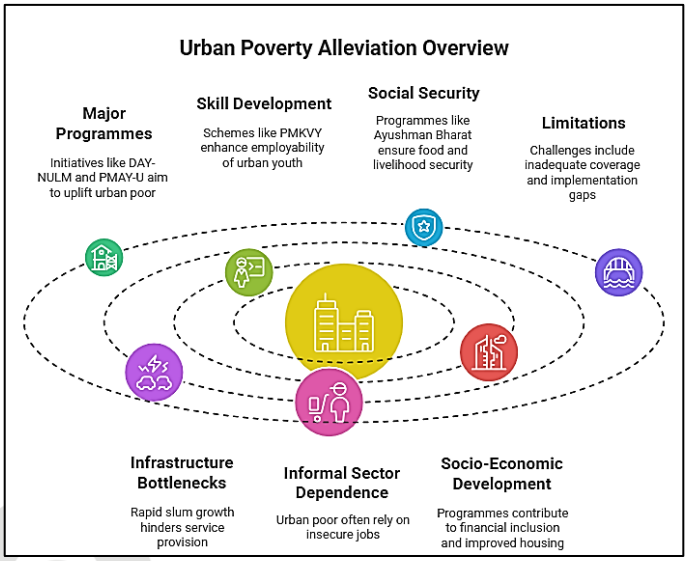
	✓ Policies such as Mission Bhagiratha (drinking water) faced delays due to irregular fund disbursals, especially during COVID-19 years. ✓ The CAG Report 2022 observed that delayed financial sanctions and underutilization of funds were major issues across central and state schemes. • **Weak Monitoring and Lack of Real-Time Feedback** ✓ The Telangana State Development Planning Society (TSDPS) noted the absence of real-time tracking in rural welfare schemes. ✓ For instance, despite digital dashboards for Rythu Bandhu, feedback from small and tenant farmers is not consistently integrated into redesigning the scheme. ✓ Lack of third-party audits and overdependence on internal reviews distort impact assessment. • **Political Interference and Populist Shifts:** ✓ Policies often undergo abrupt changes based on electoral calculus. ✓ The Dalit Bandhu scheme, though progressive, saw implementation skewed toward select constituencies before elections. ✓ Populist measures often take precedence over long-term structural reforms, creating inconsistency. • **Limited Beneficiary Involvement and Awareness:** ✓ In many Telangana rural programs, beneficiary awareness is low leading to under-enrollment, misuse, or lack of grievance redressal.
Conclusion	The gap between expert-driven policy design and on-ground results is a systemic issue, stemming from administrative inertia, poor feedback systems, and lack of adaptive governance. Bridging this requires strengthening institutional capacity, promoting participatory models, transparent fund flows, and outcome-based monitoring. Telangana's mixed experiences show that technology and community ownership, when combined with political will, can significantly narrow this execution deficit.
Model Question	How do political interference and administrative inertia contribute to policy failures in India? Suggest reforms to bridge the formulation–execution divide.
Value Addition	• Various techniques are involved in reaching sound and rational policy decisions and in converting policy proposals into policy. A variety of techniques and tools are used for improving and enhancing the policy formulation process. • Some of the techniques include ✓ Cost-benefit Analysis ✓ Economic Forecasting ✓ Operations Research and Systems Analysis ✓ PPBS Approach.
10. The National Food Security Act, 2013, marks a paradigm shift from welfare to rights-based approach in ensuring food security. Analyse. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Food Security
Keyword	Analyse
Approach	• Highlight food security as a constitutional and human right. • Analyse provisions (75% rural & 50% urban coverage, maternity entitlements, mid-day meals) and shift from welfare doles to legal entitlement. • NFSA marks a rights-based paradigm but faces challenges in implementation, storage, and nutrition diversification.
Introduction	Food security has been a central goal of India's welfare state since Independence. Earlier programmes like the Public Distribution System (PDS) and Antyodaya Anna Yojana provided subsidised food but lacked universal legal backing. The National Food Security Act (NFSA), 2013, marks a paradigm shift by transforming food distribution from a

	discretionary welfare measure to a legal right, ensuring dignity and entitlements to citizens.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Features of the National Food Security Act, 2013:** • **Coverage:** The act provides subsidised food grains to 75% of the rural and 50% of the urban population. • **Legal Entitlement**: 5 kg of rice, wheat, or coarse grains per person per month at highly subsidised prices (₹3, ₹2, ₹1 per kg) are entitled to every individual under the act. • **Special Focus Groups**: ✓ Pregnant and lactating mothers get ₹6,000 maternity benefits. ✓ Children (6 months–14 years) are entitled to nutritious meals under the Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) and Mid-Day Meal schemes. • **Grievance Redressal:** The act establishes State Food Commissions and grievance mechanisms for accountability. **Significance of the National Food Security Act, 2013 – A Rights-Based Shift:** ✓ **From Charity to Entitlement**: Citizens now have a justiciable right to food under the law. ✓ **Inclusivity:** It focuses on women (as ration card heads) and vulnerable groups. ✓ **Human Development:** ▪ It contributes to the reduction of hunger, malnutrition, and improvement in child health.  ▪ Example: During the COVID-19 lockdown, NFSA enabled free grain distribution under PM-GKAY, preventing large-scale hunger. **Challenges in the Implementation of the National Food Security Act, 2013:** • **Exclusion Errors**: Migrants and informal workers are often left out due to outdated beneficiary lists. • **Leakages**: Diversion of food grains in PDS continues despite reforms. • **Nutritional Concerns:** Focus is largely on cereals; pulses, oils, and proteins remain neglected. • **Fiscal Burden**: Subsidy bill strains government finances.
Conclusion	The NFSA, 2013 has indeed shifted India's food security policy towards a rights-based framework, strengthening social justice and human dignity. However, effective implementation, inclusion of migrants, and diversification towards nutritional security are crucial to realize the Act's transformative potential.
Model Question	"The National Food Security Act, 2013 marks a paradigm shift from a welfare-based to a rights-based approach in ensuring food security." Analyse its major provisions, significance, and challenges in implementation.
Value Addition	**Provisions under the National Food Security Act, 2013:**

	• 5 Kgs of food grains per person per month at Rs.3/2/1 per Kg for rice/wheat/coarse grains. • The existing AAY household will continue to receive 35 Kgs of food grains per household per month. • Meal and maternity benefit of not less than Rs.6000 to pregnant women and lactating mothers during pregnancy and six months after the child birth. • Meals for children up to 14 years of age. • Food security allowance to beneficiaries in case of non-supply of entitled food grains or meals. • Setting up of grievance redressal mechanisms at the district and state level.
11. Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission aims to create a robust digital health ecosystem and enhance health service delivery. Comment. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Introduce ABDM as a component of Ayushman Bharat to digitise healthcare records. • Describe features like ABHA ID, Health Facility Registry, Telemedicine integration, and potential benefits. • Note digital divide challenges and suggest capacity-building for nationwide adoption.
Introduction	The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM), launched in September 2018, is a flagship initiative of the Government of India to create a unified digital health ecosystem. It aims to improve healthcare accessibility, transparency, and efficiency by leveraging digital technology for health data management and service delivery.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM): Building a Robust Digital Health Ecosystem** • **Key Components of ABDM:** ✓ **Ayushman Bharat Health Account (ABHA):** It is a unique 14-digit health ID for every citizen to store and share medical records securely. ✓ By July 2025, around 80 crore ABHA IDs were created (MoHFW). ✓ **Health Facility Registry (HFR):** It is a comprehensive database of all public and private health facilities in India. ✓ **Healthcare Professionals Registry (HPR);** It is a Centralised information on verified medical practitioners for transparency and trust. ✓ **Unified Health Interface (UHI):** It is a Digital platform enabling telemedicine, e-pharmacy services, and health consultations. • **Benefits and Impact of the ABDM:**



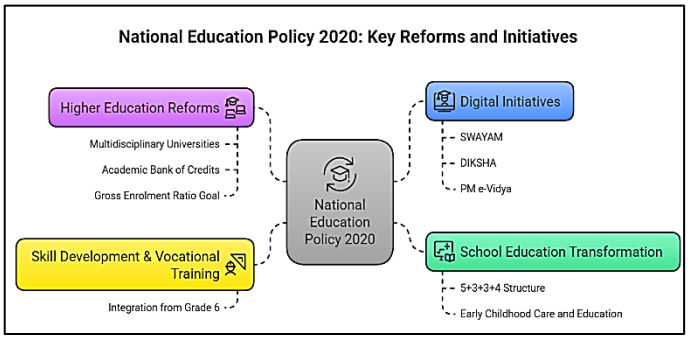
	✓ **Improved Access:** The scheme enables remote consultations, especially in rural areas. ✓ **Efficiency:** It reduces paperwork, duplication, and medical errors. ✓ **Portability:** Citizens can access their medical history anywhere in the country under the scheme. ✓ **Transparency:** The scheme facilitates monitoring of health services and insurance claims. ✓ **Integration with PMJAY:** It enhances claim processing and beneficiary tracking. • **Challenges in Implementation of the ABDM:** ✓ **Digital Divide**: Limited internet and device penetration in rural areas. ✓ **Data Privacy Concerns:** Need for strong cybersecurity and legal safeguards. ✓ **Capacity Building:** Training healthcare providers in digital tools.
Conclusion	To sum up, the ABDM has the potential to transform India's healthcare delivery into an accessible, patient-centric, and technology-driven system. However, its success will depend on bridging the digital divide, ensuring robust data protection laws, and fostering Centre–State collaboration to make quality healthcare a universal reality.
Model Question	Discuss the objectives, key components, and expected impact of the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission in creating a robust digital health ecosystem in India
Value Addition	**Achievements of Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM):** • **ABHA ID**: ✓ By September 2024, over 67 crore ABHA IDs have been created, providing citizens with unique digital health IDs for secure access to and sharing of their health records. ✓ More than 42 crore health records have been linked to ABHA, allowing seamless access to medical histories and improving healthcare delivery. • **Integration:** ✓ Over 236 private entities, including labs, pharmacies, and digital solution companies, have integrated with the ABDM ecosystem to support interoperability. ✓ Public institutions like AIIMS Delhi and AIIMS Bhopal are top performers in generating Scan and Share OPD registrations. ✓ Leading private healthcare chains have also played a major role in the success of the ABDM. • **National Healthcare Providers Registry (NHPR):** ✓ The launch of the NHPR has resulted in the registration of 3.3 lakh health facilities and 4.7 lakh healthcare professionals. ✓ NHPR is a comprehensive repository of registered healthcare professionals and health facilities.
12. Despite Limitations and Challenges, Poverty Alleviation Programmes ensure socio-economic development in Urban Areas - Examine. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Poverty Alleviation Programmes
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Mention growing urban poverty & slums due to migration and lack of employment. • Examine schemes like DAY-NULM, PMAY (Urban), skill development, and challenges like exclusion, leakages, and lack of awareness. • Despite limitations, programmes contribute to socio-economic inclusion but need better convergence and monitoring.
Introduction	Urban poverty in India is a growing concern due to rapid urbanisation, migration, and the expansion of slums. While rural poverty has shown a declining trend, nearly one-fourth

	of urban residents still live in poverty, facing inadequate housing, unemployment, and lack of basic services. To address this, the government has launched several poverty alleviation programmes that, despite limitations, have contributed to urban socio-economic development.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Poverty Alleviation Programmes:** • **Major Poverty Alleviation Programmes in Urban Areas:** ✓ **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana – National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM):** The scheme provides skill training, microcredit, and promotes Self-Help Groups for urban poor women. ✓ **Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (Urban):** It ensures affordable housing through beneficiary-led construction, slum redevelopment, and credit-linked subsidies. ✓ **Skill Development Initiatives**: Schemes like Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) and Digital India enhance the employability of urban youth. ✓ **Social Security Schemes**: It is covered through Ayushman Bharat, PM-SVANidhi for street vendors, and the National Food Security Act ensures food and livelihood security.  • **Limitations and Challenges of Poverty Alleviation Programmes:** ✓ **Inadequate Coverage:** Large sections of migrants and informal workers remain excluded due to a lack of documentation. ✓ **Implementation Gaps:** Delays in project execution, corruption, and overlapping schemes reduce effectiveness. ✓ **Infrastructure Bottlenecks:** Rapid growth of slums makes provision of housing and services difficult. ✓ **Dependence on Informal Sector**: Most urban poor remain in insecure jobs, beyond the safety net of schemes. • **Contribution of Poverty Alleviation Programmes to Socio-Economic Development:** ✓ **Women-led Self-Help Groups (SHGs):** ▪ Under DAY-NRLM, over 10.05 crore women have been mobilised into 90.87 lakh SHGs by October 2024. ▪ These groups have accessed significant financial support—₹48,290 crore in capitalisation funds, enabling them to leverage bank credit totaling ₹9.71 lakh crore until November 2024. ▪ In Andhra Pradesh and Telangana combined, SHGs now number 16.9 lakh, with 1.7 crore women members; AP leads with ₹18,606 crore in savings, while Telangana stands at ₹5,156 crore. ✓ **Slum Redevelopment under PMAY-U:**

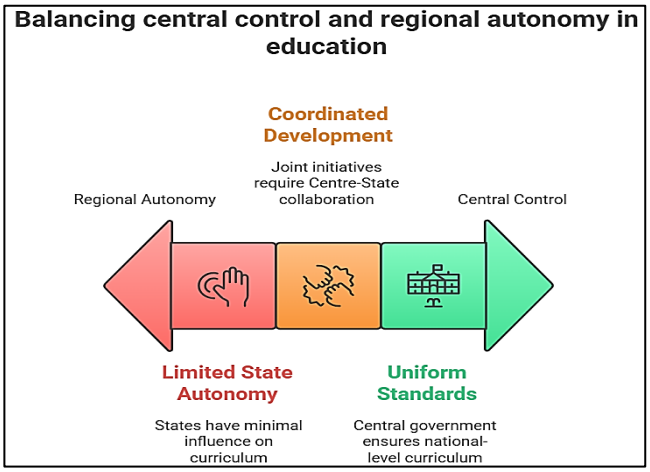
	▪ As of March 3, 2025, 90.60 lakh houses have been completed and delivered to slum-dwellers under PMAY-Urban. ▪ Telangana, specifically, has seen over 2.24 lakh houses built since 2015, along with ₹3,314 crore sanctioned. ✓ Skill training and street-vendor support created sustainable livelihoods, reducing vulnerability.
Conclusion	Urban poverty alleviation programmes, though constrained by inadequate coverage, administrative hurdles, and infrastructural challenges, have played a significant role in improving housing, livelihoods, and social security for the poor. Strengthening implementation, better urban planning, and inclusive policies will ensure sustainable socio-economic development in India's cities.
Model Question	"Urban poverty presents new challenges due to migration, slum growth, and unemployment. Despite these challenges, poverty alleviation programmes ensure socio-economic development." Examine with examples of recent urban welfare schemes.
Value Addition	**Poverty Alleviation Programmes since Independence:** • Since the early 1950s, the government of India has initiated, sustained, and refined various planning schemes to help the poor attain self-sufficiency in the acquisition of food and overcome hunger and poverty • All the Five-Year Plans introduced in India had elements in them to reduce Poverty, of which the following Five-Year Plans (FYP) had explicit provisions in them aimed at Poverty alleviation: • **Fifth Plan (1974–1978):** ✓ It laid stress on employment, poverty alleviation (Garibi Hatao), and justice ✓ It also assured a minimum income of Rs. 40 per person per month, calculated at 1972-73 prices • **Seventh Plan (1985–1990):** ✓ The thrust areas of the Seventh Five-Year Plan were: social justice, removal of oppression of the weak, using modern technology, agricultural development, anti-poverty programmes, full supply of food, clothing, and shelter, increasing productivity of small- and large-scale farmers, and making India an independent economy ✓ From the perspective of Poverty, it aimed at improving the living standards of the poor with a significant reduction in the incidence of poverty. • **Eighth Plan (1992–1997):** The major objectives included controlling population growth, poverty reduction, employment generation, etc. • **Ninth Plan (1997–2002):** It offered strong support to the social spheres of the country to achieve the complete elimination of poverty • **Tenth Plan (2002–2007):** One of the main objectives of the plan was the Reduction of the poverty rate by 5% by 2007 • **Eleventh Plan (2007–2012):** It aimed at Rapid and Inclusive growth(Poverty reduction) • **Twelfth Plan (2012–2017):** The government intended to reduce poverty by 10% during the tenure of the plan
13. Analyse briefly various schemes initiated by the Centre and State governments for the welfare of senior citizens. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Senior citizens
Keyword	Analyse
Approach	• Define "senior citizen" as per the law and explain the need for welfare measures due to ageing population.

	• Briefly describe major Central schemes (e.g., IGNOAPS, Annapurna Scheme, NPHCE) and Telangana/AP state schemes (e.g., Aasara Pensions, Vrudha Ashram support). • Highlight challenges like low awareness and suggest measures for inclusive ageing policies.
Introduction	Senior citizens, as defined under the Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Act, 2007, are individuals aged 60 years and above. With India's elderly population projected to reach 193.4 million by 2031, welfare measures have become a priority. The Centre and State governments have introduced various schemes to ensure financial security, healthcare, and social inclusion for the elderly.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Various schemes initiated by the Centre and State governments for the welfare of senior citizens:** • **Central Government Initiatives for the welfare of senior citizens:** ✓ **Rashtriya Vayoshri Yojana (RVY):** This scheme provides physical aids and assisted living devices to senior citizens, especially those in the BPL category. ✓ **National Programme for the Health Care of the Elderly (NPHCE):** Under this scheme, the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare provides comprehensive healthcare facilities to elderly persons at primary, secondary, and tertiary levels. ✓ **Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme (IGNOAPS)**: A Monthly pension for the elderly aged 60-79 years is given under the scheme. ✓ **Atal Pension Yojana (APY):** Under the scheme, the Ministry of Finance provides a guaranteed pension to all citizens, especially poor and unorganised sector workers, upon reaching 60 years of age. ✓ **Housing for All Mission/Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana:** The scheme prioritises senior citizens for ground or lower-floor housing allotments. • **State Government schemes for the welfare of senior citizens:** ✓ **NTR Bharosa Pension Scheme:** The Andhra Pradesh state government provides Rs.4000 per month to senior citizens from poor households. ✓ **NTR Canteens** in Andhra Pradesh offer subsidised meals, indirectly benefiting the elderly poor. ✓ Andhra Pradesh government introduced **'Stree Shakti'** scheme for free bus travel for senior women citizens. ✓ **NTR Vaidya Seva programme**, senior citizens will be eligible for free medical treatment up to ₹25 lakh per year for a family.
Conclusion	Hence, the welfare of senior citizens is vital for ensuring dignity in ageing. While various schemes address financial, health, and social needs, challenges such as low awareness, delayed payments, and digital exclusion persist. Strengthening outreach, improving service delivery, and promoting community-based care will be essential to make ageing in India safe, secure, and dignified.
Model Question	Analyse the various schemes introduced by the Union and State governments for the welfare of senior citizens in India, highlighting their scope, coverage, and challenges in implementation
Value Addition	**Challenges Faced by Senior Citizens** • **Health Care Challenges**: Senior citizens face chronic illnesses, limited geriatric care, rising mental health issues, and high healthcare costs. • **Economic Challenges**: The Elderly face insufficient pensions, financial dependency, income insecurity, and difficulties finding post-retirement employment, leading to economic instability. • **Social Challenges**: Isolation, elder abuse, social exclusion, and the digital divide create significant challenges for senior citizens in modern society.

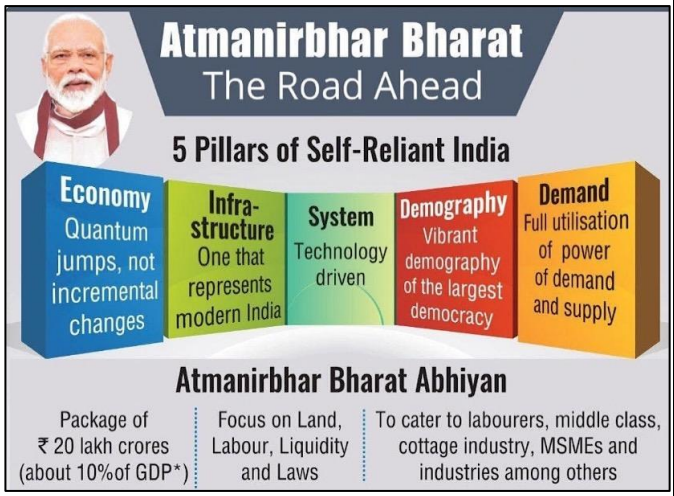
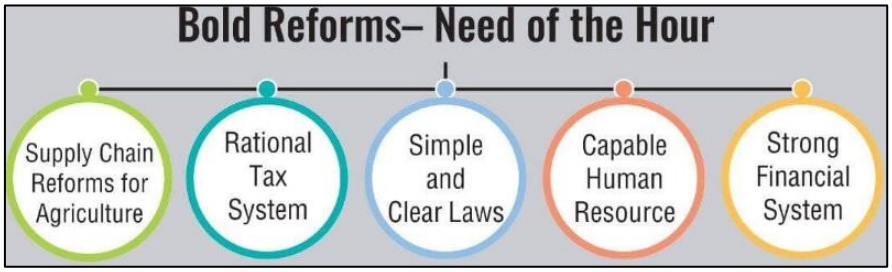
	• **Infrastructure and Accessibility**: Inadequate housing, elder-unfriendly public spaces, and limited mobility options hinder senior citizens' quality of life. • **Legal and Policy Challenges:** Weak legal protection, lack of awareness, and bureaucratic hurdles prevent the elderly from accessing necessary services and support. **Key statistics of India's ageing population and senior citizen support:**
14. Policy on Education is essential for the Nation's growth. Discuss how the National Education Policy, 2020, can be implemented to meet the requirements of education in India. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Policy on Education
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Mention NEP 2020 as a transformational policy addressing 21st-century educational needs. • Discuss implementation strategies—curriculum changes, teacher training, digital infrastructure, funding models, and state–centred coordination. • Stress the need for phased roll-out, monitoring, and localised adaptations for inclusivity.
Introduction	Education policy serves as a blueprint for building a skilled, innovative, and socially responsible citizenry. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, the first comprehensive reform since 1986, seeks to make India's education system holistic, flexible, and future-ready. Effective implementation is critical to meet the diverse requirements of the Indian context.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Strategies for Effective Implementation of NEP, 2020, to meet the requirements of education in India:** • **Strengthening School Education:** ✓ Adopt the 5+3+3+4 structure with emphasis on Early Childhood Care and Education (ECCE). ✓ Expand Anganwadi-modernisation and integrate pre-primary learning with foundational literacy and numeracy goals under NIPUN Bharat. • **Teacher Capacity Building:** ✓ Continuous professional development through the DIKSHA platform. ✓ Revamp teacher recruitment with a focus on merit, training, and multilingual pedagogy.

	✓ For example, India needs 15 lakh new teachers to meet NEP targets (UNESCO 2021). • **Digital and Physical Infrastructure:** ✓ Expand internet connectivity to rural schools. ✓ Establish PM SHRI model schools in every district to showcase NEP practices.  ✓ For example, Telangana launched the Digital Classrooms Project under Samagra Shiksha to aid NEP digital vision. • **Higher Education Reform:** ✓ Promote multidisciplinary universities and the Academic Bank of Credits (ABCs). ✓ Encourage autonomy for institutions to design flexible curricula aligned to local needs. • **Skill and Vocational Integration:** ✓ Integrate vocational training from Grade 6 with industry partnerships. ✓ Promote internships and entrepreneurship in higher education. • **Equity and Inclusion:** ✓ Target scholarships, hostels, and special education support for disadvantaged groups. ✓ Develop learning material in mother tongues for inclusivity. ✓ For example, about 65% of schools in India lack internet access (DISE 2021-22), posing a major digital divide barrier.
Conclusion	Thus, the NEP 2020 has the potential to transform India into a knowledge superpower, but its success hinges on phased roll-out, adequate funding, cooperative federalism, and robust monitoring. By blending traditional strengths with modern skills, India can prepare a generation capable of meeting 21st-century socio-economic challenges.
Model Question	Discuss the strategies and challenges in implementing the National Education Policy, 2020, to meet the diverse educational requirements of India's population
Value Addition	**Salient features of NEP 2020** • Ensuring Universal Access at All Levels of schooling from pre-primary school to Grade 12; • Ensuring quality early childhood care and education for all children between 3-6 years; • New Curricular and Pedagogical Structure (5+3+3+4); • No hard separations between arts and sciences, between curricular and extra-curricular activities, between vocational and academic streams; • Establishing National Mission on Foundational Literacy and Numeracy; • Emphasis on promoting multilingualism and Indian languages; The medium of instruction until at least Grade 5, but preferably till Grade 8 and beyond, will be the home language/mother tongue/local language/regional language. • Assessment reforms - Board Exams on up to two occasions during any given school year, one main examination and one for improvement, if desired; • Setting up of a new National Assessment Centre, PARAKH (Performance Assessment, Review, and Analysis of Knowledge for Holistic Development);

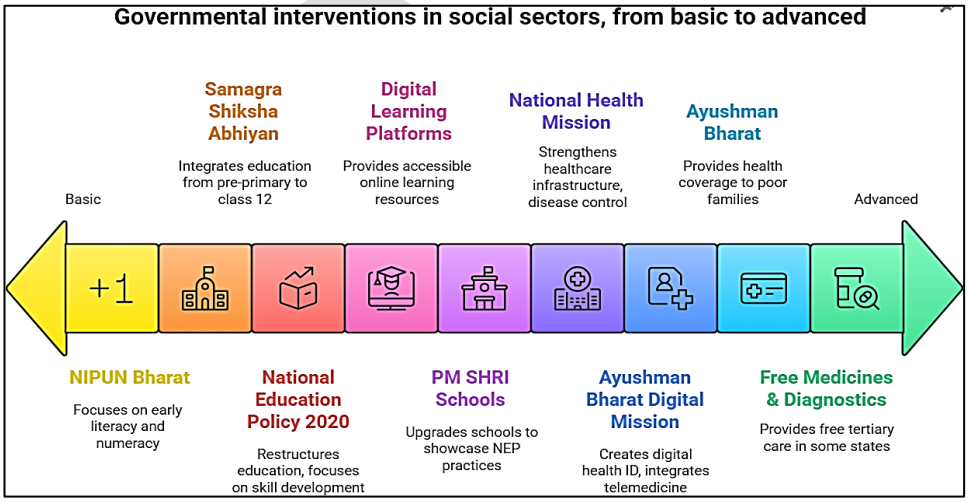
	• Equitable and inclusive education - Special emphasis given on Socially and Economically Disadvantaged Groups (SEDGs); • A separate Gender Inclusion fund and Special Education Zones for disadvantaged regions and groups; • Robust and transparent processes for recruitment of teachers and merit-based performance; • Ensuring availability of all resources through school complexes and clusters;
15. National Education Policy (2020) has been criticised as denuding the autonomy of states. In this connection, examine the rationale behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Policy on Education
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Outline the constitutional division of powers in education before and after the 42nd Amendment (1976). • Examine arguments for centralisation—uniform standards, national integration, and quality control versus federal concerns of states. • Advocate balanced cooperative federalism to protect diversity while ensuring educational quality.
Introduction	Education in India was originally a State subject under the Government of India Act, 1935. However, the 42nd Constitutional Amendment (1976) shifted it to the Concurrent List, enabling both the Union and States to legislate on education. The NEP 2020, with its broad reforms, has reignited debates about federal balance and the autonomy of States in education governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The rationale behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list:** • **Uniform Standards in Education:** The Central government's involvement ensures national-level curriculum frameworks, teacher standards, and evaluation systems to maintain educational quality across states. • **National Integration:** Education plays a crucial role in promoting unity in diversity through common values, citizenship education, and shared historical narratives. • **Mobility and Equivalency:** A central government's role helps maintain equivalence of degrees and certificates, enabling student and labour mobility across states. • **Coordinated Development:** The central government allows joint initiatives like Samagra Shiksha, PM SHRI Schools, and digital education platforms (SWAYAM, DIKSHA), which require Centre–State collaboration. • **Addressing Regional Disparities:** States with weaker education infrastructure can benefit from central funding, capacity building, and policy guidance. **Criticism and Concerns behind the transfer of matters from the State list to the Concurrent list:**



	• **Over-centralisation Risks:** Excessive central control could sideline regional diversity, potentially neglecting local languages, cultural contexts, and community-specific teaching methods. • For example, In State of Tamil Nadu v. Union of India (2014), Tamil Nadu challenged NEET as an encroachment on state powers. • **Limited State Autonomy:** States express concern over having minimal influence in shaping curriculum frameworks and allocating educational resources, which may hinder effective implementation. For example, The Sarkaria Commission (1988) and Punchhi Commission (2010) cautioned against excessive centralisation in Concurrent List subjects. • **Dependence on Central Funding:** The reform's success hinges on central financial support, raising fears that policy flexibility and state-level innovation could be compromised.
Conclusion	While the transfer to the Concurrent List was intended to ensure uniformity, equity, and quality, the spirit of cooperative federalism must guide implementation. The NEP 2020's success will depend on meaningful State participation, flexible policy adaptation, and respect for regional diversity in educational content and delivery.
Model Question	The transfer of education from the State List to the Concurrent List has implications for federal balance in policy-making. Examine this shift in the context of the National Education Policy, 2020, and the criticism regarding the erosion of State autonomy
Value Addition	• NEP, 2020 aim to increase the GER to 100% in preschool to secondary level by 2030, whereas GER in Higher Education, including vocational education from 26.3% (2018) to 50% by 2035. • The Central Sector Scheme Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya National Mission on Teachers and Teaching (PMMMNMTT) was launched in 2014 to address comprehensively all issues related to Teacher Training/ Capacity Building and Professional Development of Teachers. • Under the components, a total of 95 Centres were established throughout the country through which faculties/Teachers have been trained. • Currently, the Standing Finance Committee has appraised the Scheme and recommended for continuation till 2025-2026 with a total outlay of Rs. 493.68 crore. • Under the PMMMNMTT Scheme, Centres are established based on the proposals received from education institutions, their screening by the Screening Committee and approval by the Project Approval Board.
16. Government's intervention in development has seen a long way in impressive outcomes in India. In this connection, discuss the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission aimed at making India Self-Reliant. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Define Atmanirbhar Bharat and its launch context post-COVID-19. • Explain key pillars like Economy, Infrastructure, System, Demography, Demand, and sectoral initiatives in manufacturing, MSMEs, defence, and agriculture. • Stress on sustained reforms, skill development, and global competitiveness.
Introduction	The Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan, launched in May 2020 amid the COVID-19 pandemic, is a comprehensive vision to make India self-reliant in critical sectors while integrating with global supply chains. It emphasises economic resilience, domestic manufacturing, innovation, and reduced import dependence to ensure sustainable and inclusive growth.

Body & Infographic Representation	**The Atmanirbhar Bharat mission: Towards a Self-Reliant India** • **Pillars of the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission:** ✓ **Economy:** The mission focuses on structural reforms to promote investment, ease of doing business, and innovation. ✓ Example: PLI scheme boosted mobile manufacturing with Apple & Samsung expanding units in India. ✓ **Infrastructure:** National Infrastructure Pipeline (NIP) and PM Gati Shakti integrate logistics and connectivity. ✓ Example: PM Gati Shakti linked highways, ports, and rail under the ₹111 lakh crore National Infrastructure Pipeline.  ✓ **System:** The mission leads to technology-driven governance, digital platforms for services, and simplification of laws. ✓ Example**:** GST, Insolvency Code, and Digital India platforms simplified compliance and improved transparency. ✓ **Vibrant Demography:** It harnesses India's youth through skill development initiatives like PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana. ✓ Example: PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana trained youth for sectors like electronics, healthcare, and logistics. ✓ **Demand:** It stimulates domestic demand through MSME support, credit guarantees, and rural employment schemes. ✓ Example: Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) for MSMEs and MGNREGA rural jobs spurred consumption. • **Major Initiatives under the AtmaNirbhar Mission:** ✓ **Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Schemes:** The mission provides Incentives for sectors like electronics, pharmaceuticals, textiles, and solar manufacturing. ✓ **Make in India 2.0:** The mission is to strengthen the domestic manufacturing base.  ✓ **Agricultural Reforms:** It provides for the Infrastructure Fund, Kisan Rail, and food processing incentives. ✓ **Digital India Push:** The mission promoting indigenous platforms, UPI, and AI-based innovations.

	• **Challenges in the implementation of the AtmaNirbhar Bharat Mission:** ✓ Need for skilled workforce and advanced technology adoption. ✓ Global competition and supply chain dependencies. ✓ Balancing self-reliance with export competitiveness.
Conclusion	Thus, the Atmanirbhar Bharat mission is not about isolationism, but about building domestic capacity, global competitiveness, and resilience. Its success will require public–private partnerships, continuous reforms, and skill upgradation to position India as a strong, self-reliant player in the global economy.
Model Question	Evaluate the objectives, pillars, and major initiatives of the Atmanirbhar Bharat Mission, and analyse its role in enhancing India's self-reliance in the global economic context.
Value Addition	**The Potential of Atmanirbharata (Self-reliance):** • Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyaan or Self-reliant India campaign is the vision of the new India. In the year 2020, the Prime Minister raised a clarion call to the nation, giving a kick start to the Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyaan (Self-reliant India campaign) and announced the Special economic and comprehensive package of INR 20 lakh crores - equivalent to 10% of India's GDP. • The aim is to make the country and its citizens independent and self-reliant in all senses. Five pillars of Atma Nirbhar Bharat – Economy, Infrastructure, System, Vibrant Demography and Demand have been outlined. • It aims towards cutting down import dependence by focusing on substitution while improving safety compliance and quality goods to gain global market share. • The Self-Reliance signifies neither any exclusionary nor isolationist strategies but involves the creation of a helping hand to the whole world. • The Mission focuses on the importance of promoting "local" products. • Along with the Atma Nirbhar Bharat mission, the government took several bold reforms such as Supply Chain Reforms for Agriculture, Rational Tax Systems, Simple & Clear Laws, Capable Human Resources and a Strong Financial System, which will help in achieving self-reliance in a faster way.
17. Explain the major governmental interventions in the social sector with special reference to Health and education. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development: Policy on Health and Education
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Define the social sector and its role in human development. • Explain flagship interventions—Health (Ayushman Bharat, NHM, ABDM) and Education (NEP 2020, Samagra Shiksha, Mid-Day Meal). • Highlight improved indicators and stress the need for sustained funding and monitoring.
Introduction	The social sector, comprising health, education, and welfare forms the backbone of human development. The Indian Constitution, through Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSPs), mandates the State to ensure adequate healthcare and universal education. In recent years, the Government of India and State governments have launched several targeted interventions to improve social outcomes.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Major Governmental Interventions in the Social Sector with Special Reference to Health and Education:** • **Health Sector Interventions in the social sector:** ✓ **Ayushman Bharat: Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (PMJAY):** The scheme provides ₹5 lakh annual health coverage to poor families for secondary and tertiary care.

	✓ **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM):** The mission creates a unified digital health ID (ABHA) and integrates telemedicine, health records, and facility registries. ✓ **National Health Mission (NHM):** This mission strengthens rural and urban healthcare infrastructure, maternal and child health, and disease control programmes. ✓ **Free Medicines & Diagnostics Schemes:** State-led schemes like Aarogyasri (Telangana & AP) provide free tertiary care. For instance, Ayushman Bharat and the NTR Vaidya Seva programmes, each family will be eligible for free medical treatment up to ₹25 lakh per year, irrespective of their economic status. • **Education Sector Interventions in the social sector:** ✓ **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020:** The policy restructures school and higher education and also focuses on multidisciplinary learning and skill development. ✓ **Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan:** It is an integrated scheme for school education from pre-primary to Class 12, focusing on infrastructure and teacher training. For example, India's literacy rate rose from 64.8% in 2007 to 77.7% in 2021 (NSO data). ✓ **PM SHRI Schools:** It upgrades model schools to showcase NEP practices. ✓ **Digital Learning Platforms:** Platforms like ePathshala, NPTEL, and E-shodhsindhu provide for accessible online learning. ✓ **NIPUN Bharat:** The scheme focuses on foundational literacy and numeracy in early grades. 
Conclusion	In this way, Government interventions in health and education have significantly improved literacy rates, life expectancy, and service coverage. However, challenges like regional disparities, funding gaps, and digital divide persist. A sustained focus on equity, quality, and last-mile delivery will be crucial to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and inclusive growth.
Model Question	Explain the major interventions made by the Government of India in the social sector, with special emphasis on health and education programmes, and assess their impact on human development indicators.
Value Addition	**Other existing social Security Policies in India:** • **The Code on Social Security, 2020**: This is a comprehensive law that consolidates and simplifies nine previous laws related to social security. It covers employees in both the organised and unorganised sectors, and provides for retirement pension,

	provident fund, life and disability insurance, healthcare and unemployment benefits, sick pay and leaves, and paid parental leave. • **The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO):** This is a statutory body that administers the Employees' Provident Fund Scheme, the Employees' Pension Scheme, and the Employees' Deposit Linked Insurance Scheme. These schemes provide retirement pension, provident fund, and life and disability insurance to employees in the organised sector. • **The Employees' State Insurance (ESI):** This is a self-financing social security scheme that provides medical care and cash benefits to employees in case of sickness, maternity, disability, and unemployment. It covers employees in the organized sector who earn less than a certain threshold. • **The National Pension System (NPS):** This is a voluntary, defined contribution pension scheme that allows individuals to save for their retirement. It is open to all citizens of India, including those working in the unorganised sector. It offers multiple investment options and tax benefits.
18. Bring out the politics of Women's Reservation Bill. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Government Policies and Interventions for Development
Keyword	Bring out
Approach	• Introduce with the Women's Reservation Bill as a long-standing legislative effort to address gender imbalance in political representation. • Analyze the political complexities around the bill such as legislative delays, inter-party and intra-party contradictions, caste-based sub-quota demands, and delayed implementation. • Conclude by critically evaluating whether the bill truly advances gender justice or remains a symbolic gesture unless implemented inclusively and promptly.
Introduction	The Women's Reservation Bill, formally known as the Constitution (One Hundred and Twenty-Eighth Amendment) Bill, 2023, seeks to reserve 33% of seats for women in the Lok Sabha and state legislative assemblies. Though first introduced in 1996 and repeatedly debated in various forms including the 108th Amendment Bill, 2008, the bill has been politically contentious for decades. Its eventual passage in 2023, though historic, has reignited debates on the intersection of gender justice, electoral reform, and political intent.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Politics of Women's Reservation Bill:** • **Delayed Political Consensus and Legislative History:** ✓ Although the demand for women's representation dates back to the 73rd and 74th Amendments (1992–93), which enabled over 1.45 million women to participate in Panchayati Raj Institutions, national-level efforts were repeatedly stalled. ✓ The bill was first introduced in 1996 and failed multiple times until the Rajya Sabha passed it in 2010 (as the 108th Amendment Bill). ✓ Yet, it lapsed due to lack of political consensus in the Lok Sabha. This pattern reflects the lip-service politics, where parties support women's empowerment in principle but hesitate in practice.

Country wise data on women representation*

Women representation in parliament varies across different democracies

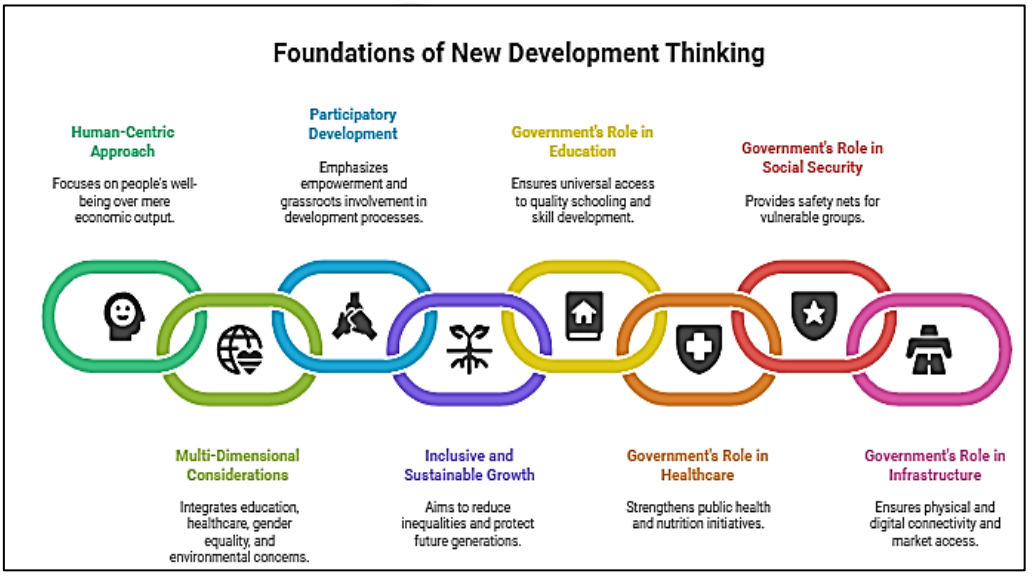
Moving forward: Trinamool Congress MPs take selfies at the Parliament House complex during the first session of the 18th Lok Sabha, on June 25. PTI

Country	% of elected women	Quota in Parliament	Quota in political parties
Sweden	46%	No	Yes
South Africa	45%	No	Yes
Australia	38%	No	Yes
France	38%	No	Yes
Germany	35%	No	Yes
U.K.	40%	No	Yes
U.S.	29%	No	No
Pakistan	16%	Yes	No
Bangladesh	20%	Yes	No

	• **Vote Bank Politics and Intra-Party Contradictions** ✓ Major parties often struggle between electoral winnability calculations and support for women's representation. ✓ Internal resistance stems from concerns over displacing sitting male MPs in strongholds. ✓ The 18th Lok Sabha, which commenced in June 2024, has 74 women members, representing approximately 13.6% of the total 543 members. This is a slight decrease from the 78 women members in the 17th Lok Sabha. • **Caste Dynamics and Sub-Quota Demands:** ✓ Parties like RJD, SP, BSP, and AIMIM have demanded sub-reservation for OBCs and minorities within the 33% quota, arguing that upper-caste women would dominate otherwise. ✓ Dalit, Adivasi, and OBC women face triple discrimination and are severely underrepresented even within women's leadership structures. ✓ The current version of the bill does not address this, adding fuel to caste-based political dissent. • **Delayed Implementation Clause: A Political Calculation?** ✓ The 2023 bill mandates implementation only after the next delimitation exercise (post-2026 census), effectively pushing actual rollout beyond the 2029 general elections. ✓ Critics argue that this timing shows a symbolic rather than transformative intent, especially as it was introduced just ahead of key state and national elections. • **Global and National Representation Gaps:** ✓ India ranks 143 out of 185 countries in terms of women's representation in the lower house of Parliament. ✓ Countries like Rwanda (61%) and Nepal (33%) have far outpaced India, even though India pioneered female franchise since 1950. ✓ This stark underrepresentation highlights the urgent need for systemic correction rather than conditional promises.
Conclusion	The Women's Reservation Bill has long been a site of political negotiation and compromise, more symbolic than substantial until now. While its 2023 passage in Parliament is a milestone, the delayed implementation and lack of sub-quota clarity reveal unresolved questions about inclusive representation. True empowerment will require timely, inclusive, and enforceable mechanisms, not just legislation.
Model Question	What is the significance of linking women's reservation to the delimitation exercise in the 128th Constitutional Amendment Bill, 2023?
Value Addition	India as a sovereign republic provided the right to vote for all its women right from the first general elections in 1952. While the right to vote was provided to all women since the commencement of the Constitution, the representation of women in the Lok Sabha and State legislative assemblies has been far from satisfactory. The percentage of women MPs in the Lok Sabha had been very low between 5% and 10% till 2004. It rose marginally to 12% in 2014 and currently stands at 14% in the 18th Lok Sabha. The representation in State Legislative Assemblies is even poorer with the national average being around 9%. The 73rd and 74th amendments of the Constitution in 1992/1993, provided for one-third reservation for women in panchayats and municipalities. However, attempts between 1996 and 2008 to provide similar reservation in the Lok Sabha and assemblies were unsuccessful.
8. Development processes - the role of civil society, NGOs and other stakeholders	

19. Define 'development' as explained by Prof. Amartya Sen. Explain the characteristics of the new development thinking, and also mention the four areas where the government has to play a crucial role. (APPSC, 2020)

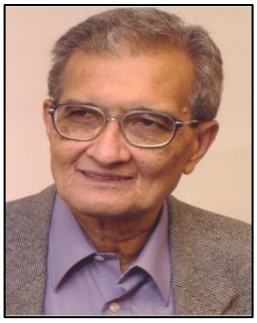
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Development processes
Keyword	Define, Explain, Mention
Approach	• Define development as the expansion of freedoms and capabilities. • Characteristics of new thinking: human-centric, participatory, and inclusive. Role of the government in education, healthcare, social security, and infrastructure. • Development is not just GDP growth but the enhancement of human freedoms and opportunities.
Introduction	Traditional notions of development were linked to GDP growth, industrialisation, and per capita income. However, Nobel Laureate Prof. Amartya Sen redefined development as a process of expanding human freedoms and capabilities, making people the centre of the growth process. His approach, reflected in the UNDP Human Development Index (HDI), revolutionised global development discourse.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Development According to Amartya Sen:** • Development is not merely economic growth but freedom from deprivations such as poverty, illiteracy, ill-health, and social exclusion. • True development occurs when people gain the ability to lead the kind of life they value. • Example**:** Kerala's high literacy and health outcomes despite modest income levels illustrate Sen's "capabilities" approach.



Characteristics of New Development Thinking:

- **Human-Centric**: It focuses on people's well-being, not just output.
- **Multi-Dimensional:** It considers education, healthcare, gender equality, environment, and democracy.
- **Participatory**: It leads development through empowerment and grassroots participation.
- **Inclusive and Sustainable**:
  - ✓ Growth must reduce inequalities and protect future generations.
  - ✓ Example: Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) reflect this holistic thinking.

Four Areas where the government has to play a crucial role in New Development Thinking:

	• **Education:** Universal access to quality schooling and skill development (e.g., Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan). • **Healthcare:** Strengthening public health and nutrition (e.g., Ayushman Bharat, Poshan Abhiyaan). • **Social Security**: Providing safety nets for vulnerable groups through pensions, MGNREGS, and food security. • **Infrastructure & Opportunities:** Ensuring physical and digital connectivity, irrigation, electricity, and markets to expand choices.
Conclusion	Amartya Sen's vision shifted the discourse from income-led growth to freedom-led growth, making development a means to enhance human dignity and choices. For India, achieving this vision requires sustained public investment in education, health, social protection, and infrastructure, ensuring that growth translates into genuine human development.
Model Question	"Prof. Amartya Sen defines development as an expansion of human freedoms and capabilities." Explain the characteristics of this new development thinking and highlight the four crucial areas where government intervention is essential.
Value Addition	**Key Ideas of Amartya Sen's Development Approach:**  • **Capability:** Sen defines capabilities as the substantive freedoms individuals have to pursue their desired lives and function effectively. This includes access to healthcare, education, political freedom, and social inclusion. • **Functioning:** These are the actual achievements or outcomes that people can realize, like being healthy, educated, or having a political voice. • **Freedom:** Sen emphasizes that freedom is both a means and an end of development. Expanding people's freedoms allows them to make choices and shape their own lives, which in turn contributes to development. • **Beyond GDP:** Sen's approach critiques the over-reliance on GDP as a measure of development, arguing that it doesn't capture the full picture of human well-being. • **Poverty as Capability Deprivation**: Sen redefines poverty as a lack of basic capabilities needed to lead a minimally acceptable life, rather than solely a lack of income, according to a blog post.
20. What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and the limitations it faces in a democratic system. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders
Keyword	What, Discuss
Approach	• Define civil society as voluntary organizations, associations, and pressure groups outside government and the market. • Mention Key features such as pluralism, advocacy, watchdog role; Mention Limitations like fragmentation, funding issues, and co-option by politics. • Conclude that civil society is vital for democracy, but effectiveness depends on autonomy, inclusivity, and accountability.
Introduction	Civil society refers to the space between the state and the individual, consisting of voluntary organizations, community groups, social movements, professional associations, NGOs, and citizens' collectives. In the Indian context, it has played a vital role in strengthening democracy, empowering marginalized groups, and holding the state accountable. From the freedom struggle under Mahatma Gandhi's mass mobilization to present-day movements like RTI campaigns, civil society has been central to India's socio-political evolution.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Features of Civil Society in India:** • **Pluralism:** The Civil Society comprises diverse groups like religious, cultural, linguistic, caste-based, and professional associations. • **Advocacy Role**: It acts as a pressure group influencing government policies (e.g., Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) and the Right to Information movement). • **Watchdog Function:** It monitors corruption, human rights violations, and misuse of power (e.g., Lokpal movement led by India Against Corruption). • **Service Delivery:** NGOs and community groups supplement state efforts in education, health, and disaster relief. • **Democratic Participation:** The civil societies in India encourage public debates, mobilization, and grassroots participation. **Limitations of Civil Society in India** • **Fragmentation:** Deep social divisions (caste, religion, region) often weaken collective action. • **Funding Issues**: Dependence on foreign or state funds may compromise autonomy. • **Accountability Concerns**: Lack of transparency and misuse of NGO platforms in some cases. • **Political Co-Option:** Many organizations are influenced by political parties, reducing neutrality. • **Urban-Centric**: Civil society initiatives are often concentrated in cities, leaving rural areas underserved.
Conclusion	Civil society in India remains a pillar of democracy, amplifying citizen voices, empowering weaker sections, and enhancing accountability. However, for it to function effectively, there is a need for greater transparency, internal democracy, and independence from political/financial pressures. Strengthened civil society can ensure that democracy in India is not merely electoral, but also participatory and inclusive.
Model Question	What do you understand by civil society in the Indian context? Discuss its key features and evaluate the limitations it faces in strengthening democracy.
Value Addition	**Civil Society Regulations:** • **Societies Registration Act, 1860**: Established for nonprofit activities like literary, scientific, and charitable purposes and requires at least seven persons for registration. • **Indian Trusts Act, 1882**: State-specific public trust acts. It is established for public, religious, or charitable purposes, and requires at least two persons for registration. • **Companies Act, 2013**: Established for nonprofits promoting arts, science, education, social welfare, and environmental protection, and profits must be utilized for organizational objectives, not personal gains. • **Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), 2010:** The FCRA mandates NPOs to register with the central government, use designated banks, maintain separate accounts for foreign funds, and renew registration every five years. • **Indian Companies Act, 2013 (CSR Provision):** Section 135 requires eligible companies to allocate 2% of net profits to CSR activities, focusing on hunger eradication, education, health, gender equality, and other social causes.

21. In what ways can the role of NGOs be enhanced in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, with a focus on the key challenges they encounter. (APPSC, 2025)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders
Keyword	What, Discuss
Approach	• Define Women's empowerment as a key goal of social justice. • Mention NGOs provide literacy, microfinance, SHGs, legal aid, and advocacy, but face funding scarcity, state control, and lack of scale. • Conclude that strengthening NGOs through capacity-building and policy support can deepen gender empowerment.
Introduction	Women's empowerment is a key pillar of inclusive development and social justice. While the State plays a crucial role through constitutional provisions and welfare schemes, Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) have emerged as important partners in bridging gaps, mobilizing communities, and empowering women at the grassroots. Their contribution spans literacy, livelihood, health, legal awareness, and leadership.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role of NGOs in Women's Empowerment and Welfare in India:** • **Education & Literacy:** NGOs like Pratham and SEWA Bharat run literacy and skill-training programmes for rural and urban women. • **Economic Empowerment**: NGOs promote Self-Help Groups (SHGs), microfinance, and entrepreneurship, especially in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, where SHGs have transformed women into economic agents. • **Health & Nutrition:** NGOs supplement government schemes by spreading awareness on maternal health, sanitation, and nutrition (e.g., CARE India's reproductive health campaigns). • **Legal & Social Awareness**: NGOs conduct workshops on rights, domestic violence, dowry, and workplace harassment. • **Leadership & Participation**: NGOs nurture women leaders in Panchayats and community forums, enhancing decision-making power. **Challenges Faced by NGOs in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India:** • **Funding Constraints:** Heavy dependence on external funding; restrictions under FCRA impact sustainability. • **Capacity Limitations:** Many grassroots NGOs lack trained manpower and organizational capacity. • **Political & Bureaucratic Hurdles:** Excessive regulation, delays in fund release, and lack of recognition hinder their work. • **Fragmentation**: Lack of coordination among NGOs reduces collective impact. • **Credibility Issues:** Instances of misuse of funds erode public trust.
Conclusion	NGOs complement state efforts in women's empowerment by reaching the most vulnerable, innovating at the grassroots, and amplifying women's voices. Strengthening their role requires transparent funding, capacity building, partnership with government, and accountability mechanisms. A robust NGO sector can ensure that women in India achieve not just welfare, but true empowerment and equality.

Model Question	In what ways can NGOs play a stronger role in promoting women's empowerment and welfare in India? Discuss, highlighting both their contributions and the challenges they encounter.
Value Addition	**Roles and Responsibilities of NGOs in India:** • **Governance:** ✓ **Strengthening democracy and governance:** ▪ E.g., the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) works in the area of Electoral and Political Reforms. ▪ Their Public Interest Litigation (PIL) resulted in the Supreme Court of India directing candidates to disclose their criminal records, educational qualifications, and financial assets during elections. ✓ **Supplementing Government Efforts:** E.g., Akshaya Patra Foundation implements PM POSHAN Initiative to solve malnutrition. • **Social upliftment and reforms:** ✓ **Protecting Human Rights**: E.g., Bachpan Bachao Andolan, founded by Nobel Peace Laureate Kailash Satyarthi, for protecting children from exploitation. ✓ **Women empowerment:** E.g., SEWA (Self-Employed Women's Association) supports women workers in the informal sector through training, financial services, and legal aid. ✓ **Representation of marginalized sections**: ▪ E.g., Naz foundation supports people living with HIV/AIDS (PLWHA) and the LGBTQIA+ community. ▪ Naz Foundation v. Govt. of NCT of Delhi judgment eventually led to decriminalisation of homosexuality in India. ✓ **Poverty alleviation:** E.g., NGO-Goonj. • **Human resource development:** ✓ **Education & Capacity Building:** E.g., Pratham NGO, works for quality education for underprivileged children in India. ✓ **Improving Health:** E.g., Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF) runs programmes in India for tuberculosis (TB), HIV, and other infectious diseases etc.
22. "NGOs play a critical role in promoting human rights, defending the marginalised, and creating a more just and equitable society." Comment on the role of NGO's in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Define NGOs and their role in democracy and social justice. • Explain contributions in human rights, women's empowerment, RTI, and environment (with examples like PUCL, SEWA). • Highlight challenges and suggest strengthening the partnership with the government.
Introduction	Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) are voluntary, non-profit, citizen-based groups that work independently of the state. In India, they have emerged as crucial actors in bridging gaps between government policies and ground-level realities. They play a pivotal role in promoting human rights, defending marginalised groups, and strengthening democratic governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role of NGOs in India:** • **Promoting Human Rights:** ✓ NGOs like People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) and Amnesty International India have worked for the protection of civil liberties, rights of undertrials, and against custodial violence.

<table>
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✓ They create awareness about rights enshrined in the Constitution, e.g., campaigns on the Right to Information Act, 2005.
• Defending the Rights of the marginalised:
✓ Organisations such as SEWA (Self-Employed Women's Association) empower women in the informal sector.
✓ Tribal rights NGOs like Vanavasi Kalyan Ashram and Narmada Bachao Andolan defend the rights of displaced communities.
• Social Service Delivery:
✓ NGOs complement the state in fields of health, education, and environment.
✓ For example,
▪ Smile Foundation runs education programs for underprivileged children;
▪ HelpAge India works for elderly welfare.
• Advocacy and Policy Interventions:
✓ NGOs act as pressure groups influencing policymaking.
✓ Centre for Science and Environment (CSE) has been instrumental in pushing for environmental regulations and pollution control.
• Challenges Faced by NGOs in India:
✓ Issues of funding, accountability, and government restrictions under laws like the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), 2010.
✓ Concerns about the lack of transparency in some NGOs.

</td></tr>
<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>NGOs in India play a complementary and corrective role in promoting justice, equity, and rights of the vulnerable. While challenges of regulation and accountability persist, their partnership with the state and international organisations is essential for inclusive development and strengthening democracy.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>Critically examine the role of NGOs in India in promoting human rights and social justice. Illustrate with suitable examples.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>Characteristics of NGOs
• Non-Profit Nature: NGOs operate to create social value rather than generate profit. Any surplus income is reinvested in the organisation's activities.
• Voluntary Participation: Members, staff, and volunteers contribute to the work of NGOs, often driven by a shared passion for the cause they serve.
• Independence: NGOs are independent of government influence, although they may receive funding or support from governments or international bodies.
• Diverse Structures: NGOs can vary greatly in size and scope, from small local initiatives to large international organisations.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">23. Describe the role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy. (APPSC, 2020)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Syllabus</td><td>Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders</td></tr>
<tr><td>Keyword</td><td>Describe</td></tr>
<tr><td>Approach</td><td>• Define NGOs and civil services as non-state and state actors in democracy.
• Discuss complementary roles such as policy implementation, social audit, service delivery, and mobilisation of people.
• Stress synergy between NGOs and civil services for participatory democracy.</td></tr>
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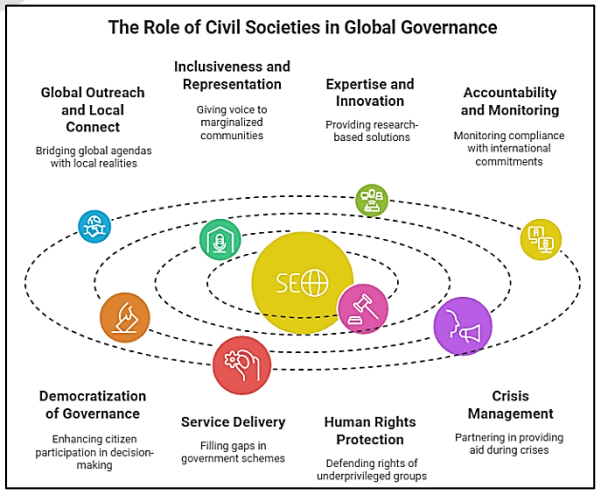
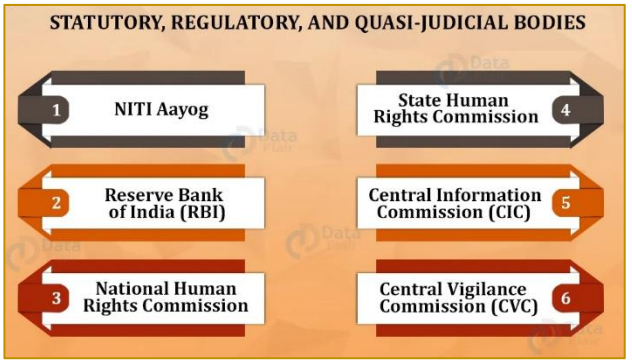
Introduction	Democracy thrives not only on elections and institutions but also on the active role of non-state actors like NGOs and the efficiency of the state machinery, i.e., civil services. While civil services act as the backbone of governance, NGOs provide participatory platforms for citizens. Together, they enhance accountability, inclusiveness, and effectiveness of democracy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy:** • **Role of NGOs in Democracy:** ✓ **Voice of the People:** ▪ NGOs articulate the needs of marginalised communities. ▪ For example, Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS) spearheaded the movement for the Right to Information Act (2005). ✓ **Social Mobilisation and Awareness:** ▪ Organisations like SEWA empower women workers; ▪ Pratham works for universal education through community participation. ✓ **Watchdogs of Democracy:** NGOs act as pressure groups, ensuring government accountability on issues like the environment (e.g., Centre for Science and Environment's work on pollution control). • **Role of Civil Services in Democracy:** ✓ **Policy Implementation:** ▪ Civil servants translate laws and policies into action. ▪ For example, implementation of schemes like MGNREGA and PM Poshan depends on the efficiency of bureaucracy. ✓ **Upholding the Rule of Law:** They ensure neutrality, justice, and fair application of laws without bias. ✓ **Bridging State and Society:** Civil services are the primary interface between the government and people, especially in crises like the COVID-19 pandemic relief operations. • **Complementary Roles of NGOs and Civil Services in Democracy:** ✓ NGOs supplement state efforts through grassroots reach, while civil services provide administrative machinery. ✓ Example: During natural disasters, NGOs provide relief, while civil services coordinate and regulate distribution.
Conclusion	NGOs and civil services together form the twin pillars of participatory and service-oriented democracy. By synergising people's aspirations with state capacity, they ensure inclusiveness, transparency, and social justice, thereby deepening democratic governance in India.
Model Question	Discuss how NGOs and the Civil Services complement each other in strengthening democracy in India. Highlight their challenges and scope for synergy.

Value Addition	**Collaboration between NGOs and Governments:** While NGOs operate independently, they often collaborate with governments to maximise their impact. Some areas of collaboration include: • **Public-Private Partnerships:** NGOs often partner with the government to implement public health programs, education initiatives, and social welfare projects. • **Policy Advocacy:** NGOs work alongside governments to promote and advocate for policies that align with their goals, such as improving public health, reducing poverty, and enhancing human rights. • **Disaster Relief:** NGOs and governments often work together in the aftermath of natural disasters to provide humanitarian assistance, rehabilitation, and rebuilding efforts.

24. Give the reason for the UN to partner with civil society. Explain the importance of civil societies. Under which Acts are the NGOs in India legally registered? (APPSC 2020)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: The Role of Civil Society, NGOs and other stakeholders
Keyword	Give, Explain, Which
Approach	• Mention the UN's global goals and need for civil society participation. • Give Reasons: inclusiveness, local outreach, accountability; Importance: voice of marginalised, awareness, innovation; Legal basis in India: Societies Registration Act, Trusts Act, and Companies Act (Sec 8). • Conclude that civil society is crucial for the UN's SDGs and democratic governance.
Introduction	Civil society comprises voluntary organisations, NGOs, community groups, and social movements working beyond state and market domains. The United Nations (UN) recognises that achieving its goals, like peace, human rights, and sustainable development, requires active collaboration with civil society actors. In India, NGOs are legally recognised under specific Acts, ensuring their accountability and legitimacy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Reasons for UN–Civil Society Partnership:** • **Global Outreach and Local Connect:** ✓ Civil societies bridge the gap between global agendas and grassroots realities. ✓ Example: NGOs working with the UN on Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). • **Inclusiveness and Representation:** They give voice to marginalised communities, ensuring "leave no one behind.  • **Expertise and Innovation:** ✓ NGOs often provide research-based solutions. ✓ Example: Greenpeace and climate change advocacy at UN platforms. • **Accountability and Monitoring:** Civil societies act as watchdogs, monitoring states' compliance with international commitments. **Importance of Civil Societies:** • **Democratization of Governance:** They enhance citizen participation in decision-making.

	• **Service Delivery:** NGOs like Pratham (education) and Smile Foundation (healthcare) fill gaps in government schemes. • **Human Rights Protection:** Organizations like Amnesty International India and PUCL defend rights of underprivileged groups. • **Crisis Management:** During the COVID-19 pandemic, NGOs partnered with UN agencies to provide food and medical aid. **Legal Registration of NGOs in India:** NGOs gain legal recognition and regulation under: • Societies Registration Act, 1860 • Indian Trusts Act, 1882 • Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013 • Additionally, foreign funding is regulated under the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act (FCRA), 2010.
Conclusion	Civil societies are indispensable partners of the UN in building a just and inclusive global order. In India, legal frameworks ensure their accountability, while their grassroots activism strengthens democracy, sustainable development, and human rights protection.
Model Question	Why does the United Nations seek partnership with civil society? Explain the importance of civil societies in governance. Under which Acts are NGOs registered in India?
Value Addition	**Ideas of various thinkers on the State-Civil Society interplay:** • **Thomas Hobbes and John Locke:** A functioning civil society would be impossible without protection from the state. • **Thomas Paine:** The State is seen as the anti–pole of civil society. Paine warned against the despotism of the state and stressed that both the individual citizens and the people as a collective unit would benefit immensely from a state which keeps its influence over civil society to a minimum. • **Hegel:** Civil society is a sphere situated between the family and the state, inhabited by individuals and associations, but which does not necessarily contribute to the general development of society. Therefore, the state must supervise and control the civil society. • **Tocqueville:** Although the state in general works for the benefit of all, it constitutes a threat towards both individuals and civil society, and the democratic state may be extra dangerous as it has both the urge and capacity to control all spheres of social life.
9. Statutory, regulatory and various quasi-judicial authorities – Role of Civil Services in Democracy	
25. Which constitutional provisions empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities in India? Explain with suitable examples. (APPSC, 2025).	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	Which, Explain
Approach	• Define quasi-judicial authorities (bodies performing adjudicatory functions without being courts). • Cite provisions like Art. 32, 323A, 323B, Seventh Schedule entries enabling tribunals (e.g., CAT, NGT). • Emphasize their role in reducing judicial burden and ensuring speedy justice.
Introduction	Quasi-judicial authorities are bodies vested with powers to adjudicate disputes and enforce decisions, though they are not regular courts. They combine administrative and judicial functions to ensure speedy and specialized justice. The Indian Constitution provides a framework empowering its formation to strengthen justice delivery and regulatory governance.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Provisions Enabling Quasi-Judicial Bodies in India:** • **Article 32 & 226 – Judicial Review:** ✓ Courts can delegate adjudicatory functions to quasi-judicial bodies to reduce their burden. ✓ Example: National Green Tribunal (NGT) adjudicates on environmental disputes. • **Article 323A – Administrative Tribunals:** ✓ The article provides for tribunals to adjudicate service-related disputes of public servants. ✓ Example: Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT) (1985) deals with civil service disputes.  • **Article 323B – Other Tribunals:** ✓ It empowers Parliament and state legislatures to establish tribunals for taxation, labour, land reforms, elections, and industrial disputes. ✓ Example: Income Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT) comes under this provision. • **Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV of the Indian Constitution):** ✓ It indirectly mandates the setting up of regulatory bodies to implement socio-economic justice. ✓ Example: Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019, align with Article 38 (social justice) of the Constitution. **Examples of Quasi-Judicial Authorities in India:** • **Election Commission of India (Article 324):** It exercises quasi-judicial powers in deciding disputes over the recognition of political parties and the disqualification of candidates. • **Competition Commission of India (CCI):** It regulates anti-competitive practices and has powers akin to a civil court. • **Central Information Commission (CIC):** Under the Right to Information Act, 2005, decides appeals and complaints relating to access to information. • **National Green Tribunal (NGT):** In the Sterlite Industries Case (2013, Tamil Nadu), NGT ordered the closure of the copper plant for violating environmental norms. • **Significance of Quasi-Judicial Bodies in India:** ✓ Reduce burden on regular courts. ✓ Provide specialized and technical expertise. ✓ Enhance access to justice for citizens at lower costs.
Conclusion	Quasi-judicial authorities bridge the gap between executive action and judicial remedies. Empowered by constitutional provisions like Articles 323A and 323B, they ensure speedy, specialized, and citizen-centric justice. Strengthening them with independence and accountability will make governance more responsive and efficient.
Model Question	Which provisions of the Indian Constitution empower the formation of quasi-judicial authorities? Explain their significance in governance with suitable examples of such bodies functioning in India.
Value Addition	**Income Tax Appellate Tribunal (ITAT):** • It is a quasi-judicial institution set up in January 1941 and specializes in dealing with appeals under the Direct Taxes Acts.

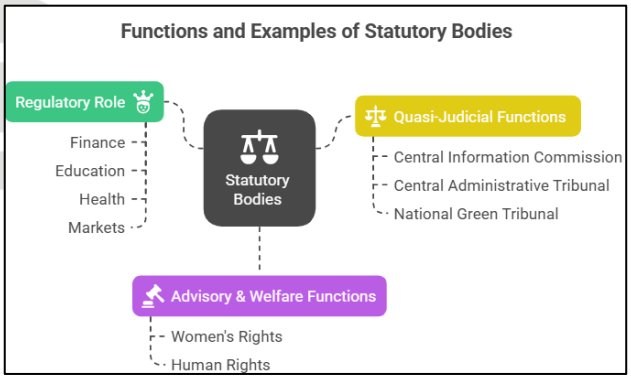
	• Starting in 1941 with six Members constituting three Benches – one each at Delhi, Kolkata (Calcutta), and Mumbai (Bombay), the number of Benches has progressively increased, and presently ITAT has 63 Benches at 27 different cities, covering almost all the cities having a seat of the High Court. • Each bench has an accountant member and a judicial member. • The President of the ITAT constitutes a bench from among the members of the ITAT. • In some cases, a special bench with three or more members may be constituted to dispose of income tax appeals. • ITAT serves as the final fact-finding body in tax disputes, offering both taxpayers and the income tax authorities a convenient platform to resolve disputes. • It adjudicates appeals made under the Income Tax Act of 1961. • It functions under the Ministry of Law and Justice.
26. Under which Act was the National Commission for Women (NCW) established? Describe its main features and limitations. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	Which and Describe
Approach	• Introduce with the establishment of NCW under National Commission for Women Act, 1990 as a statutory body to safeguard and promote women's rights. • Describe its composition, powers, and functions followed by its limitations such as advisory nature, lack of enforcement, and resource constraints. • Conclude by stressing the need to strengthen NCW with greater autonomy and authority to ensure effective gender justice.
Introduction	The National Commission for Women (NCW) was established under the National Commission for Women Act, 1990 to safeguard women's rights and address issues of discrimination, violence, and inequality. It acts as a statutory body ensuring constitutional and legal protections for women, while also recommending policy changes to the government.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Main Features of NCW:** • **Statutory Basis** ✓ Established through the NCW Act, 1990. ✓ Comprises a Chairperson, five Members, and a Member-Secretary, appointed by the Central Government. • **Advisory and Investigative Role** ✓ Examines legal and constitutional safeguards for women and suggests amendments. ✓ Investigates complaints of deprivation of women's rights and cases of gender-based violence. ✓ Can summon individuals, call for records, and make recommendations, though not enforceable like judicial orders. • **Quasi-Judicial Powers** ✓ Functions like a civil court in certain cases (Eg: summoning witnesses, examining evidence). ✓ Recommends action to appropriate authorities, including registration of FIRs. • **Awareness and Capacity Building** ✓ Conducts studies, research, and gender sensitization programs.

	✓ Recently launched initiatives like the "Gender Sensitization and Legal Awareness Programme" in colleges. • **Outreach and Grievance Redressal** ✓ Organizes public hearings such as the Mahila Maha Jansunwai Camp to directly address women's complaints. • In **Benazeer Heena v. Union of India (2023),** the Supreme Court emphasized the role of NCW in assisting victims of sexual violence and trafficking, reiterating the need to strengthen its powers. **Limitations of NCW:** • **Advisory Nature** ✓ Recommendations are not binding on the government or other authorities, limiting impact. ✓ Example: NCW's advice to curb deepfake misuse against women, awaits comprehensive government action. • **Lack of Enforcement Powers** ✓ The NCW cannot prosecute directly and relies on police or state agencies, often causing delays, as seen in its intervention in the Manipur violence cases • **Resource Constraints** ✓ With limited budget and staff, outreach in rural and tribal areas remains weak. ✓ A 2024 Parliamentary Standing Committee noted NCW's underfunding despite rising complaints (over 30,000 annually). • **Overlapping Jurisdiction** ✓ Duplication of work with other bodies like State Commissions for Women and NHRC. • **Dependence on Political Will** ✓ Effectiveness hinges on government responsiveness. ✓ For example, NCW's push for stricter marital rape recognition (2023–24) saw little progress due to lack of political consensus.
Conclusion	The NCW has emerged as a vital institution for amplifying women's voices and addressing grievances. However, its limited enforcement powers and dependency on state action restrict its effectiveness. Strengthening NCW with greater autonomy, binding authority in specific cases, and adequate resources is essential to transform it from an advisory body into a robust guardian of women's rights, thereby advancing the constitutional vision of gender justice.
Model Question	"Despite being the apex statutory body for women's rights, the National Commission for Women has been criticized for its limited powers. Discuss."
Value Addition	**NCW introduces Yashoda AI, aims to expand women's access to AI and Cybersecurity training:** • Led by the National Commission for Women (NCW), the Yashoda AI Abhiyan wants to stand as India's effort to empower women, especially from rural and semi-urban communities, with essential skills in Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, and Digital Safety. • The program aims to go beyond traditional learning by hosting in-depth discussions on critical issues such as AI-driven crimes, digital privacy, and practical safety strategies.

Violence against women

State-wise number of complaints received by National Commission for Women so far

State	Complaints
Uttar Pradesh	6,492
Delhi	1,119
Maharashtra	764
Bihar	586
M.P.	516
Haryana	509
Rajasthan	409
West Bengal	307
Karnataka	305
Tamil Nadu	304
Others	1,337

	• Yashoda AI is the initiative of the National Commission for Women (NCW) in collaboration with Future Shift Labs (FSL).
27. Describe the work of the statutory bodies with examples and mention in which countries they are set up. Explain quasi-judicial bodies, providing two examples from India. (APPSC, 2020).	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	Describe, Mention, Explain
Approach	• Define statutory bodies (established by Acts of Parliament/State legislatures). • Give examples like SEBI (India), BBC (UK); explain quasi-judicial bodies like CCI, NGT. • Highlight their importance in specialized regulation and dispute resolution, balancing the executive and judiciary.
Introduction	Statutory bodies are autonomous institutions created by an Act of Parliament or State Legislature to perform regulatory, advisory, or welfare functions. They derive their powers from statutes rather than directly from the Constitution. Alongside, quasi-judicial bodies act as dispute-resolution authorities that combine administrative and judicial functions.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Work of Statutory Bodies:** • **Regulatory Role:** ✓ Statutory bodies regulate sectors like finance, education, health, and markets. ✓ Example: Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI, 1992) regulates stock markets and investor protection. • **Advisory & Welfare Functions:** ✓ National Commission for Women (NCW, 1992) recommends policies and safeguards women's rights. ✓ National Human Rights Commission (NHRC, 1993) investigates human rights violations.  • **Quasi-Judicial Functions:** ✓ Some statutory bodies also act as adjudicators. ✓ Example: Central Information Commission (CIC, 2005) decides appeals under the RTI Act. **Statutory Bodies in Other Countries:** • **United States (US)**: Federal Communications Commission (FCC), Federal Trade Commission (FTC). • **United Kingdom (UK):** Office of Communications (Ofcom), Equality and Human Rights Commission. • **India:** ✓ SEBI, University Grants Commission (UGC), NHRC, Election Commission (though constitutional, it exercises statutory powers under the RPA, 1951). ✓ These bodies ensure independent regulation, citizen welfare, and democratic accountability across sectors. • **Meaning of Quasi-Judicial Bodies:** ✓ Quasi-judicial bodies are empowered to adjudicate disputes, interpret law in specific areas, and impose penalties, though they are not regular courts.

	✓ They derive powers either from the Constitution or statutes, ensuring speedy, specialized, and low-cost justice. • **Examples Quasi-Judicial Bodies from India:** ✓ **Central Administrative Tribunal (CAT, 1985)** ▪ It was established under Article 323A to resolve service disputes of civil servants. ▪ Example: CAT disposed of over 50,000 cases (2015–2020), reducing the burden on High Courts. ✓ **National Green Tribunal (NGT, 2010):** ▪ It adjudicates environmental disputes and enforces the "polluter pays" principle. ▪ Example: In Sterlite Copper Plant Case (2013, Tamil Nadu), NGT ordered closure of the plant for environmental violations.
Conclusion	Statutory bodies act as the backbone of modern governance by ensuring regulation, rights protection, and welfare across diverse sectors. Quasi-judicial bodies complement them by providing citizen-centric justice in specialized domains. Together, they enhance accountability, efficiency, and democratic governance in India and across the world.
Model Question	Discuss the functions of statutory bodies with examples and mention their existence in other countries. Further, explain the role of quasi-judicial bodies in India by citing two prominent examples.
Value Addition	**National Human Rights Commission (NHRC):** • The National Human Rights Commission is an independent statutory body, established on October 12, 1993, under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993. • The commission serves as a guardian of human rights in India, overseeing the rights associated with life, liberty, equality, and the dignity of individuals. • These rights are guaranteed by the Constitution of India and are also reflected in international covenants, like the Paris Principles on Human Rights • **Composition:** It consists of a chairperson and five members, each bringing a wealth of experience and expertise to the commission. ✓ **Full-Time Members**: The chairperson should be either a retired Chief Justice of India or a judge of the Supreme Court. ✓ Members include a sitting or retired judge of the Supreme Court, a sitting or retired Chief Justice of a High Court, and three individuals (with at least one being a woman) who possess knowledge or practical experience in human rights. ✓ **Seven Ex officio Members**: In addition to these full-time members, the commission includes seven ex officio members, comprising the chairpersons of various national commissions.
28. What are the Constitutional guarantees given to women? Explain the role of the National Commission for Women in protecting the rights of women. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	What, Explain
Approach	• Start with the constitutional vision of gender equality and justice under the Preamble. • Explain key provisions (Art. 14–16, 39(a), 42, 51A(e)), and analyse NCW's statutory role (grievance redressal, legal reforms, awareness). • Conclude on how constitutional and institutional safeguards collectively empower women.

Introduction	The Constitution of India enshrines gender equality as a fundamental right and provides special safeguards to protect women from discrimination and exploitation. It ensures women's empowerment through legal, social, and political measures. The National Commission for Women (NCW), established in 1992, acts as a statutory body to uphold and monitor these constitutional guarantees.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Guarantees for Women** The Indian Constitution ensures equal rights and opportunities for women under various provisions: • **Equality before law (Article 14):** Guarantees equal protection of law to all citizens irrespective of gender. • **Prohibition of discrimination (Article 15):** Prohibits discrimination based on sex; Article 15(3) allows the State to make special provisions for women and children. • **Equality of opportunity (Article 16):** Ensures equal employment opportunities in public offices. • **Directive Principles of State Policy:** ✓ **Article 39(a) & (d):** Mandates equal right to livelihood and equal pay for equal work. ✓ **Article 42:** Directs the State to provide humane working conditions and maternity relief. ✓ **Fundamental Duties (Article 51A(e)):** Calls upon citizens to renounce practices derogatory to women. ✓ **Political Empowerment**: 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments reserve one-third of seats in local bodies for women, currently extended to 50% in many states, including Andhra Pradesh and Telangana. ▪ Empirical data show that women's literacy increased from 8.86% (1951) to 70.3% (2023), reflecting constitutional and policy-driven progress. **Role of the National Commission for Women (NCW) in protecting women's rights** • The NCW, established under the National Commission for Women Act, 1990, functions as a watchdog of women's rights. • **Grievance Redressal:** ▪ It receives complaints on issues such as domestic violence, dowry harassment, and workplace discrimination. ▪ Between 2020–2023, over 90,000 complaints were registered, according to NCW reports. • **Legal Reforms:** The Commission reviews existing laws and recommends amendments—for example, its active role in reforms related to sexual harassment (POSH Act, 2013) and domestic violence (2005). • **Awareness and Research:** Conducts gender sensitisation campaigns and legal literacy programmes across India. • **Advisory Role:** Advises government bodies and assists in the formulation of women-centric policies like Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (2015) and Nirbhaya Fund (2013).
Conclusion	The constitutional guarantees lay a robust foundation for gender justice, while the NCW operationalises these ideals through advocacy, monitoring, and intervention. However, continued gender-based violence and wage disparity highlight the need for stronger implementation mechanisms. Ensuring effective coordination between constitutional ideals and institutional efforts remains the key to women's true empowerment.
Model Question	Examine the constitutional provisions that ensure gender equality in India. How far has the National Commission for Women been effective in safeguarding women's rights?

Value Addition	✓ The NCW is the statutory body of the Government of India, generally concerned with advising the government on all policy matters affecting women. ✓ It was established in January 1992 under the provisions of the Indian Constitution, as defined in the 1990 National Commission for Women Act. ✓ The objective of the NCW is to represent the rights of women in India and to provide a voice for their issues and concerns. ✓ The subjects of their campaigns have included dowry, politics, religion, equal representation for women in jobs, and the exploitation of women for labour. ✓ The NCW also receives and investigates complaints from women who are victims of violence, discrimination, harassment, or deprivation of their rights.
29. What are the functions of the National Commission for Women? (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	What
Approach	• Introduce with the NCW as a statutory body established in 1992 under the NCW Act to safeguard and promote women's rights. • Discuss its key functions like advisory role, reviewing laws, investigating complaints, legal aid, policy advocacy, and awareness generation, citing examples. • Conclude by highlighting its significance in strengthening gender justice while stressing the need for reforms to enhance its effectiveness.
Introduction	The National Commission for Women (NCW) is a statutory body set up under the National Commission for Women Act, 1990 and constituted in January 1992. It is mandated to protect and promote the rights and interests of women in India, acting as an advisory and quasi-judicial body to address gender-based grievances and influence policy reforms.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Functions of the NCW:** • **Reviewing Legal and Constitutional Safeguards:** ✓ NCW examines existing legal provisions affecting women and recommends reforms. ✓ It has reviewed acts such as the Dowry Prohibition Act, PNDT Act, and more recently, proposed amendments under Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita to enhance protections against gender-based offences. • **Investigating Complaints and Taking Suo Motu Cognizance:** ✓ The Commission receives complaints related to discrimination, domestic violence, workplace harassment, dowry, trafficking, and more. ✓ Example: The NCW's NRI Cell intervened in cases of abandonment of Indian wives abroad, such as cases in the UK and Canada, and coordinated with MEA to help victims return and seek legal remedies. • **Grievance Redressal and Mediation:**

	✓ NCW addresses grievances through conciliation and mediation, helping women pursue cases through State Commissions or courts. ✓ The Legal Cell supports complainants with advice and follows up with concerned authorities. ✓ Example: The NCW partnered with State Commissions for Women to address workplace harassment complaints under the **POSH Act**, ensuring redressal in private sector firms and universities. • **Awareness, Studies, and Capacity Building:** ✓ The Commission conducts gender sensitization programs, workshops, campaigns, and public hearings. ✓ It regularly organizes initiatives like "Parivarik Mahila Lok Adalats" and publishes research to build awareness about women's rights. ✓ Example: The NCW launched the Digital Shakti 4.0 campaign in collaboration with CyberPeace Foundation to empower women against cyber harassment. • **Specialized Cells and Outreach:** ✓ NCW maintains dedicated cells such as Legal Cell, NRI Cell, and Investigation Cell, as well as Digital Shakti Kendra, Training, and Women Empowerment Cells, to provide varied services.
Conclusion	The NCW plays an important role in protecting women's rights through legal review, grievance redressal, awareness, and capacity-building. Recent steps like Yashoda AI and community counselling show its expanding reach. For greater impact, it needs stronger powers, steady funding, and better coordination with state commissions to safeguard vulnerable women across India.
Model Question	"Despite being a statutory body, NCPCR faces structural and functional limitations in protecting child rights." Analyze with suggestions for reform.
Value Addition	**Recent Initiatives Enhancing NCW Functions:** • **"Yashoda AI" Initiative (2025):** ✓ NCW launched this AI literacy and cybersecurity training initiative to digitally empower over 2,500 rural and semi-urban women including SHG members, ASHA workers, policewomen, and elected representatives under the "Viksit Bharat" vision. • **"Tere Mere Sapne" Counselling Programme (2025):** ✓ In Bihar, NCW is setting up district-level counselling centres for pre-marital guidance, aiming to reduce divorce-related distress and domestic unrest. • **Intervention in Jharkhand (2025):** • In Ranchi, due to absence of a functional State Women's Commission, NCW stepped in to manage around 4,000 pending women-related cases and push for timely FIR registrations and justice.
30. Explain the powers and functions of the Human Rights Commission. (APPSC, 2011)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Introduce with Statutory nature of NHRC and its establishment under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, mandated to safeguard rights guaranteed by the Constitution. • Explain its powers (civil court powers, suo-moto cognizance, recommendations, and interventions) and functions (inquiries, prison inspections, awareness, research, safeguards). • Conclude with a balanced view on its role as a watchdog, highlighting its importance despite non-binding recommendations, and suggest strengthening mechanisms.

Introduction	The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), established under the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, is a statutory body entrusted with safeguarding the rights related to life, liberty, equality, and dignity of individuals, as guaranteed by the Constitution and international covenants. It acts as a statutory watchdog to uphold human rights within India.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Powers of the NHRC:** • **Legal and Investigative Powers** ✓ While inquiring, the NHRC enjoys powers equivalent to a civil court, including summoning and examining witnesses, requisitioning documents, receiving evidence on affidavits, and issuing commissions for examination. ✓ It can call for reports from central, state, or subordinate authorities and proceed with enquiries even if no response is provided. ✓ Example: In May 2025, NHRC issued a second notice to Odisha's Principal Secretary on alleged fraud in old-age pensions in Kendrapada and Jajpur, warning it may invoke Section 13 of the Protection of Human Rights Act. • **Suo-moto Cognizance and Court Intervention** ✓ It can initiate inquiries on its own (suo-moto) or based on petitions. ✓ Example: NHRC takes suo motu cognizance of moneylender 'beating woman' in Kuppam of Andhra Pradesh. ✓ The Commission may intervene in judicial proceedings concerning human rights violations, with court approval. • **Recommendation and Compensation Authority** ✓ NHRC can recommend compensation or damages for victims, suggest prosecution of offenders, and call for interim relief in urgent cases. ✓ It can approach High Courts or the Supreme Court for enforcement actions or directions. • **Autonomy and Administrative Control** ✓ The Commission can regulate its procedures and conduct inquiries independently. **Functions of the NHRC:** • **Inquiry into Violations and Negligence:** Investigate violations or negligence in prevention by public servants. ✓ Example: In August 2025, NHRC issues notice to Punjab government over assault of a journalist by two police officers • **Inspection of Detention Facilities:** Visit prisons and similar institutions to assess living conditions and recommend improvements. • **Review and Recommend Safeguards:** Examine constitutional or legal safeguards and recommend measures for enforcement. • **Human Rights Awareness:** Promote human rights literacy via publications, seminars, media campaigns, and collaboration with NGOs. ✓ Example: NHRC Launches Two-Week Online Internship Programme for University Students • **Research and International Instruments:** Study global treaties and instruments; recommend their effective implementation. • **Annual Reports:** Present yearly reports to the President, which are then laid before Parliament.
Conclusion	The NHRC, with its quasi-judicial powers and mandate to investigate and promote awareness, is central to India's human rights framework. Though its recommendations lack binding force, its role in exposing violations and ensuring accountability remains

	vital. Strengthening monitoring and securing prompt governmental response are essential to enhance its effectiveness.
Model Question	"Human Rights Commissions in India are often described as watchdogs without teeth. Do you agree? Substantiate your answer with relevant cases and examples."
Value Addition	• India's NHRC faces a downgrade from 'A' to 'B' status after GANHRI's Sub-Committee on Accreditation (March 2025) flagged concerns over its independence, transparency, and effectiveness. • This change highlights persistent gaps in addressing rights violations, threatening NHRC's global standing and credibility in safeguarding human rights. • A' status signifies full compliance with the Paris Principles, international standards adopted by the UN defining the minimum requirements for the independence, pluralism, and effective functioning of human rights bodies. • B' status indicates only partial compliance; NHRIs with 'B' status may attend UN sessions but lack voting rights and speaking privileges
31. Analyse the functions and functioning of National Commission for Scheduled Castes. (APPSC, 2008)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Statutory, Regulatory and various Quasi-Judicial Authorities
Keyword	Analyse
Approach	• Introduce by explaining the constitutional status and mandate of the NCSC under Article 338. • Analyse its functions, working mechanisms, recent interventions, and also its achievements and limitations. • Conclude by highlighting its significance for social justice while suggesting measures to strengthen its effectiveness.
Introduction	The National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) is a constitutional body established under Article 338 of the Indian Constitution, tasked with safeguarding the rights and interests of Scheduled Castes (SCs). As the successor of the erstwhile SC/ST Commission (separated in 2004 into NCSC and NCST), the NCSC plays a crucial role in monitoring implementation of safeguards, redressing grievances, and promoting socio-economic justice.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The Functions of NCSC:** As per Article 338(5), the functions of NCSC include: • **Monitoring Safeguards:** To investigate and monitor the safeguards provided for SCs under the Constitution and other laws. • **Inquiry into Complaints:** To inquire into specific complaints regarding deprivation of rights and safeguards of SCs. • **Advisory Role:** To advise the Union and State governments on socio-economic development planning for SCs. ✓ Example: NCSC has advised states like Bihar and MP to strengthen skill-development schemes for SC youth under PM-DAKSH Yojana (2023-24) for better employability.

- **Evaluation of Progress:** To evaluate the working of development programs and welfare schemes for SCs.
- **Reporting to the President:** To present annual and special reports on the condition of SCs, which are tabled in Parliament.
  - ✓ Example: The NCSC's Annual Report 2022–23, submitted to the President in July 2023, highlighted gaps in scholarships, atrocities against SCs, and misuse of funds.
- **Recommending Measures:** To suggest steps to improve the socio-economic and educational status of SCs.
  - ✓ Example**:** In 2024, NCSC urged stronger monitoring of POCSO cases involving Dalit minors and pressed for timely, full disbursal of post-matric scholarships to SC students.

Functioning of the NCSC:

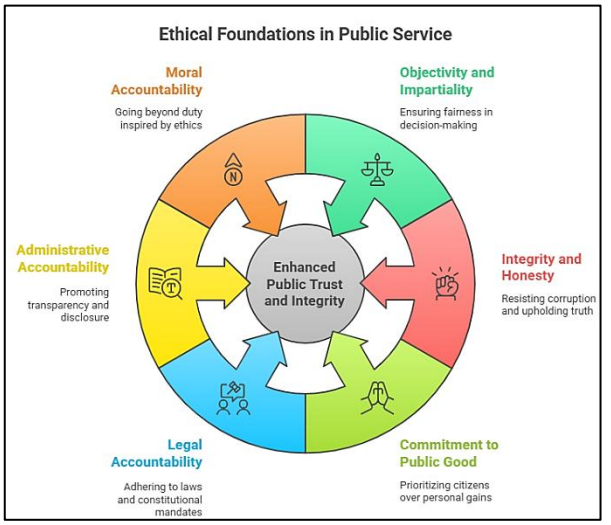
The NCSC operates as a **watchdog institution** for SC rights through:

- **Quasi-Judicial Powers:**
  - ✓ It has the powers of a civil court while investigating matters (summoning, examining witnesses, and requisitioning documents).
  - ✓ Example: In 2025, it issued notices to Rajasthan police for delays in filing charge sheets in caste atrocity cases.
- **Complaint Redressal:**
  - ✓ Platforms like the NCSC Complaint Management Information System (CMIS) enable citizens to lodge grievances related to atrocities, discrimination, and service delivery.
  - ✓ Example: CMIS registered over 25,000 grievances in 2023–24, ranging from land disputes to denial of reservations, showing increasing citizen reliance.
- **Proactive Interventions:**
  - ✓ Recently, NCSC issued a show-cause notice over the death of three BSNL contract workers in Pune and sought reports on caste discrimination cases in universities
- **Policy Influence**:
  - ✓ Through its reports, NCSC influences policies on reservation, education, and welfare measures.
  - ✓ For example, its recommendations contributed to strengthening the SC Sub-Plan mechanism.
- **Awareness and Outreach**:
  - ✓ Organizes seminars, hearings, and field visits to sensitize officials and marginalized communities.

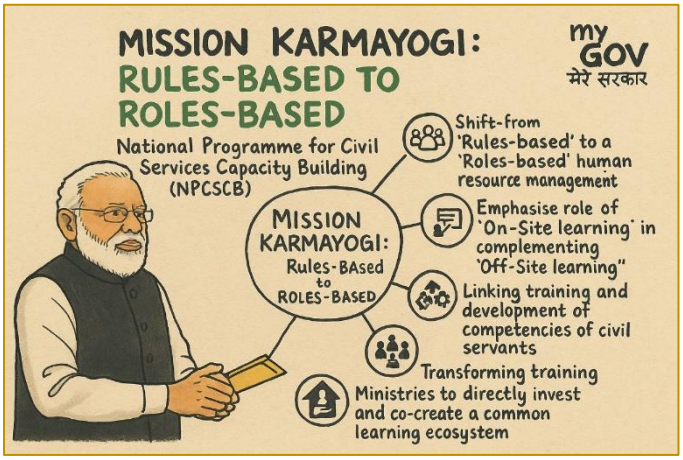
Limitations of NCSC:

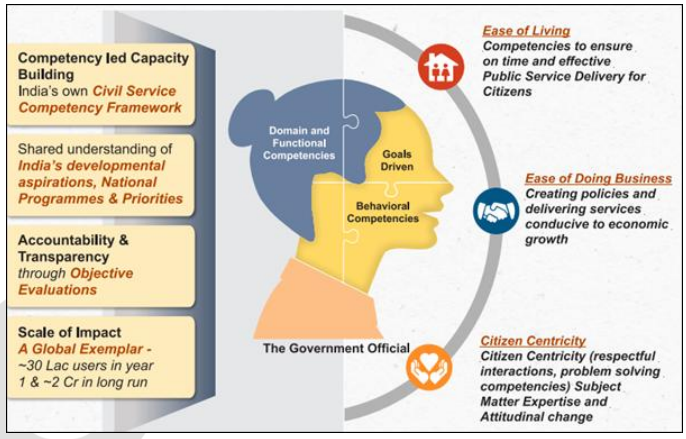
- **Advisory nature:** Recommendations are not binding on governments, limiting enforcement.
  - ✓ Example: NCSC advised the Bihar government on improving SC student hostels, but the recommendations were not acted upon, highlighting the non-binding nature of its advice.
- **Delayed Reports:** Annual reports often get delayed in submission and discussion in Parliament, reducing policy impact.
  - ✓ Example: The NCSC's 2018–19 annual report was tabled in Parliament only in 2022, showing how delayed submissions reduce its policy impact.
- **Resource Constraints:** Inadequate manpower and financial resources affect reach and effectiveness.

	• **Overlapping Jurisdictions:** Coordination issues with other bodies like NCST, NHRC, and State SC Commissions. ✓ Example: In 2024, a land dispute case in Madhya Pradesh involving SC forest dwellers saw both NCSC and NCST intervening, creating confusion over jurisdiction. • **Limited deterrence**: Despite powers of a civil court, its decisions are not enforceable like a regular court.
Conclusion	The NCSC safeguards the rights of Scheduled Castes, upholding justice, equality, and dignity. Yet, its advisory nature, limited capacity, and weak implementation reduce its impact. Strengthening powers, ensuring timely report action, and improving coordination with states are vital to make it a stronger guardian of social justice.
Model Question	Do you think overlapping jurisdictions of various Commissions like NCSC, NCST, NCW dilute their effectiveness? Substantiate with suitable examples.
Value Addition	The evolution of the National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) is rooted in the constitutional framework, which gradually expanded through significant amendments: • Initially, Article 338 provided for a Commissioner for Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, tasked with investigating safeguards and submitting reports to the President. • Later, Article 338 was amended to create a National Commission for SCs and STs, thereby elevating the role into a constitutional authority. • With growing demands for a focused institutional mechanism, this Commission was bifurcated into two separate bodies: ✓ NCSC under Article 338 ✓ NCST under the newly inserted Article 338 - A • Finally, in 2004, the NCST was constituted as an independent constitutional body, dedicated exclusively to safeguarding the rights, welfare, and development of Scheduled Tribes in India.
32. Public servants often face situations where personal values conflict with public responsibilities. Examine how a strong ethical foundation can help resolve such dilemmas while maintaining accountability. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Role of Civil Services in Democracy
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Introduce the conflict between personal morality and official duty. • Explain how the ethical foundation (objectivity, impartiality, and integrity) helps in balancing dilemmas. • Conclude with examples like Satyendra Dubey, ensuring accountability through ethics.
Introduction	Public servants frequently encounter dilemmas where their personal beliefs, cultural values, or emotions clash with their duty to the Constitution and citizens. Such conflicts, if unresolved, can erode trust in governance. A strong ethical foundation equips officers with moral clarity to balance individual values with public responsibilities.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Nature of Personal Value Conflicts in Public Services:** • Public servants face conflicting pressures, such as the need to balance political influence with impartiality, compassion with rule enforcement, or personal morality with official policy. • For example, an officer may feel empathy towards encroachers but must uphold the law to protect public land. **Role of Ethical Foundation in Resolving Personal Value Conflicts in Public Services:**

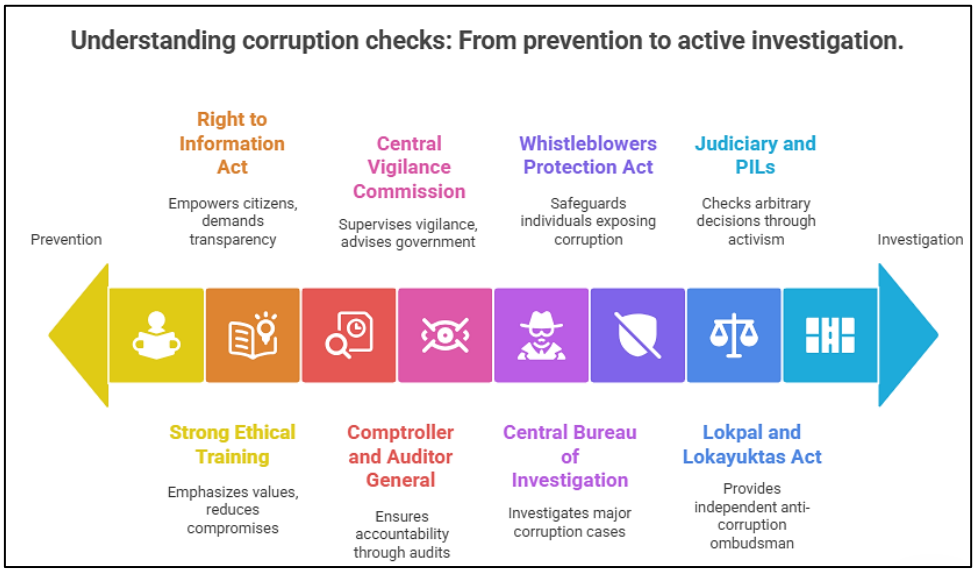
	• **Objectivity and Impartiality:** ✓ Ethical values ensure decisions are guided by fairness rather than bias. ✓ For instance, election officials adhere to neutrality to safeguard democracy. • **Integrity and Honesty:** Strong integrity helps officers resist bribery or nepotism, as seen in the case of Ashok Khemka (Haryana IAS), who cancelled a Gurugram land deal involving Robert Vadra and realty giant DLF in 2012.  • **Commitment to Public Good**: A moral compass directs officers to prioritize citizens over personal or political gains, thereby enhancing the legitimacy of governance. Public Servants maintaining accountability through Ethical Conduct: Ethics not only resolve dilemmas but also strengthen accountability mechanisms: • **Legal Accountability:** Following laws, service rules, and constitutional mandates prevents misuse of power. • **Administrative Accountability:** Ethical officers proactively uphold transparency, e.g., using RTI norms to disclose information. • **Moral Accountability:** Inspired by Gandhian ethics, many officers go beyond duty, such as Armstrong Pame (IAS), also called the Miracle Man of Manipur took the bold initiative of building a 100 km road, called the "People's Road," which connected the remote hill areas of Manipur to Nagaland and Assam. **Examples of Public servants whose ethical foundations strengthen both personal integrity and public trust:** • **Satyendra Dubey:** He exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project, demonstrating courage despite personal risk in Bihar in 2003. • **Kiran Bedi:** While serving as Deputy Commissioner of Police of North Delhi, she launched a campaign against drug abuse that later transformed into the Navjyoti Delhi Police Foundation. • These cases show that ethical foundations strengthen both personal integrity and public trust.
Conclusion	A strong ethical foundation acts as a compass for public servants navigating value conflicts. By aligning personal morality with constitutional responsibility, officers can ensure both effective governance and accountability. Ultimately, ethics transforms dilemmas into opportunities for public trust.
Model Question	"Public servants often face situations where their personal morality comes in conflict with their constitutional responsibilities. Examine how an ethical foundation helps in resolving such dilemmas while upholding accountability."
Value Addition	**Several measures to ensure individual and collective accountability of public servants:** • **Code of Conduct:** Developing a code of conduct for public servants can help set standards for ethical behaviour and promote accountability. The code of conduct should outline the responsibilities of public servants, the consequences of unethical behaviour, and the reporting mechanisms for violations.

	• **Performance Metrics**: Establishing performance metrics can help assess the performance of public servants and hold them accountable for their actions. The metrics should be based on specific objectives and outcomes, and regularly evaluated to ensure that they are being met. • **Oversight and Monitoring**: Implementing oversight and monitoring mechanisms can help ensure that public servants are following the rules and regulations. This can include regular audits, inspections, and investigations to identify areas of non-compliance. • **Whistle-blower Protection**: Protecting whistle-blowers who report unethical behaviour or wrongdoing can help promote accountability and transparency. Whistle-blower protection should include safeguards against retaliation and confidentiality. • **Training and Development**: Providing regular training and development opportunities for public servants can help promote ethical behaviour and accountability. This can include training on code of conduct, compliance, and ethics. • **Transparent communication**: Ensuring transparent communication between public servants and the public can help build trust and promote accountability. This can include regular reporting on the actions and decisions of public servants, and public access to information.
33. "The Mission Karmayogi initiative of the Government of India will revitalize the Civil Services in India and equip them to face the challenges of Governance". Examine. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Role of Civil Services in Democracy
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Mention the need for civil service reforms in changing governance environment. • Highlight Mission Karmayogi's features: capacity-building, continuous learning, behavioural and functional training. • Conclude with its potential in creating a future-ready bureaucracy.
Introduction	Civil services are the backbone of governance in India, yet they face challenges of outdated skillsets, red tapism, and a lack of citizen-centric orientation. To overcome these, the Government launched Mission Karmayogi (2020), a National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB). It seeks to transform bureaucracy into a future-ready, adaptive, and accountable workforce.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Need for Revitalizing Civil Services in India:** • **Changing Governance Landscape**: ✓ Complex issues like climate change, AI, and cybersecurity require new competencies. • **Citizen-Centric Demands**: ✓ Citizens expect efficiency, transparency, and participatory governance. ✓ More than 4 lakh government employees across ministries and states have enrolled in the "Overview of Viksit Bharat 2047" course on iGOT-Karmayogi, with 3,78,798 completions, showing a shift towards participatory and accountable governance. • **Global Best Practices**: ✓ Indian bureaucracy must align with modern, competency-based systems. **Core Features of Mission Karmayogi:** • **Competency-Based Approach:** ✓ The mission moves away from rule-bound functioning to skill- and role-based governance.

	✓ 46 lakh central government employees are being mapped under FRAC for personalized training. • **iGOT-Karmayogi Digital Platform**: ✓ It is a hub for continuous online learning for all government employees. ✓ The platform usage is monitored through an M&E dashboard capturing KPIs like course completion and feedback.  • **Uniform Training Framework**: It ends departmental silos; ensures every officer learns leadership, ethics, and digital governance. • **Focus on Behavioural, Functional, and Domain Competencies**: ✓ Balancing technical expertise with leadership and ethical decision-making. ✓ For example, in NITI Aayog, officers averaged 25 courses per person, balancing policy, leadership, and ethics. **The role of Mission Karmayogi equipping Officers for Governance:** • **Agility and Adaptability:** Officers gain real-time knowledge to respond to emerging challenges like pandemics (COVID-19 management). • **Ethical and Transparent Governance**: Mandatory modules on ethics strengthen accountability. • **Innovation and Technology Use**: It empowers civil servants to use AI, big data, and digital tools for smart governance.
Conclusion	Mission Karmayogi is a paradigm shift from rule-based to role-based bureaucracy. By enhancing skills, ethics, and adaptability, it prepares civil servants to meet 21st-century governance challenges. If effectively implemented, it can usher in a citizen-centric, accountable, and future-ready bureaucracy.
Model Question	"The Mission Karmayogi initiative is considered a game-changer for capacity building of Indian civil services. Critically analyse its significance in equipping the bureaucracy to meet 21st-century governance challenges."
Value Addition	Mission Karmayogi aims to deliver on its goals through: • New National Architecture for Civil Services Capacity Building • Comprehensive reform of the capacity building apparatus at individual, institutional, and process levels for efficient public service delivery • PM led HR Council to approve and monitor Civil Service Capacity Building Plans • Capacity Building Commission to harmonize training standards, create shared faculty and resources, and have a supervisory role over all Central Training Institutions • Wholly owned SPV to own and operate the online learning platform and facilitate a world-class learning content marketplace
34. Explain the scope of civil service reforms in India with a brief note on Mission Karmayogi. (APPSC, 2023)	

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Role of Civil Services in Democracy
Keyword	Explain, Brief note on
Approach	• Define reforms: recruitment, training, performance evaluation, and citizen-centricity. • Explain Mission Karmayogi as a digital, competency-driven learning program. • Conclude with its role in professionalizing Indian bureaucracy.
Introduction	Civil services form the steel frame of India, but challenges like red-tapism, lack of innovation, and declining integrity demand urgent reforms. Civil service reforms aim to enhance efficiency, accountability, and citizen-centric governance. The Mission Karmayogi (2020) is a landmark step in this direction.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Mission Karmayogi:** • **Competency-Based Training**: ✓ It shifts focus from rule-bound to role-based governance. ✓ Under the FRAC framework (Functions–Roles–Activities–Competencies), over 46 lakh Central Government employees are being mapped to competencies ✓ Initiatives like Digital India, JAM Trinity, and e-Sanjeevani highlight how trained officers are delivering citizen-centric governance through technology.  • **iGOT Karmayogi Platform:** ✓ It is a digital hub enabling continuous learning for nearly 3 crore government employees. ✓ As per the NITI Aayog Annual Report 2024-25, more than 4 lakh employees enrolled in the "Overview of Viksit Bharat 2047" course, with 3,78,798 completions. • **Holistic Approach:** ✓ The mission covers behavioural, functional, and domain skills essential for dynamic governance. ✓ During the COVID-19 pandemic, Mission Karmayogi's digital modules helped officers learn crisis management remotely. • **Breaking Silos:** ✓ It promotes cross-departmental learning and collaboration. ✓ The Monitoring & Evaluation dashboard on iGOT tracks progress across ministries, reducing duplication and ensuring standardized training. ✓ Singapore Civil Service College and UK Civil Service Learning models were studied before Mission Karmayogi's launch. **Scope of Civil Service Reforms in India:** • **Recruitment Reforms:** ✓ Shift from memory-based testing to aptitude, problem-solving, and ethics-focused examinations. ✓ Example: Introduction of CSAT and Ethics Paper in UPSC.

	Training and Capacity Building: ✓ Moving towards continuous learning and role-based training. ✓ LBSNAA and state ATIs are adopting blended learning methods. • **Performance Appraisal:** Replacing seniority-based promotions with a 360-degree appraisal system, ensuring merit-based evaluation. • **Technology and E-Governance:** Adoption of Digital India initiatives such as e-office, UMANG app, and e-Samiksha to improve efficiency. • **Citizen-Centric Governance:** ✓ Over 2.4 crore RTI applications filed since 2005 show the role of RTI in transparency. ✓ Citizen Charters and the Sevottam model are mandated in central ministries. • **Ethics and Integrity:** ✓ Focusing on transparency, whistleblower protection, and reducing corruption. ✓ The Whistleblower Protection Act (2014) and compulsory ethics modules on iGOT are steps toward ensuring integrity.
Conclusion	Civil service reforms in India are essential to align bureaucracy with modern governance demands. Mission Karmayogi stands as a transformative initiative, enabling a professional, ethical, and technology-driven civil service. With effective implementation, it can make Indian administration more responsive, transparent, and citizen-oriented.
Model Question	"Civil service reforms are essential to ensure responsive, citizen-centric governance in India. Discuss the scope of such reforms with a brief note on the Mission Karmayogi initiative."
Value Addition	**Six Pillars of Mission Karmayogi:** • Policy Framework • Institutional Framework • Competency Framework • Digital Learning Framework (iGOT-Karmayogi) • electronic Human Resource Management System (e-HRMS) • Monitoring and Evaluation Framework
35. What are the reasons for the decline of integrity in civil services? Also, discuss the institutional mechanisms to check corruption in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Role of Civil Services in Democracy
Keyword	What, Discuss
Approach	• State reasons: political interference, red-tapism, lack of accountability, greed. • Mention institutional checks: CVC, CBI, Lokpal, Vigilance Commissions, RTI, whistle-blower Act. • Conclude with the need for systemic reforms and ethical training.
Introduction	Integrity is the cornerstone of civil services, ensuring trust and accountability in governance. However, civil servants often face pressures that compromise their moral standards, leading to corruption and inefficiency. India has developed multiple institutional mechanisms to restore integrity and curb corruption.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Reasons for the Decline of Integrity in Civil Services:** • **Political Interference:** ✓ Frequent transfers, undue pressures, and nexus with vested interests undermine neutrality. ✓ Example: Frequent transfers of honest officers like Ashok Khemka (Haryana IAS). • **Red-Tapism and Bureaucratic Discretion:** Excessive procedures create scope for rent-seeking behaviour.

	• **Low Accountability Mechanisms:** Seniority-based promotions and weak appraisal reduce motivation for ethical conduct. • **Societal and Economic Pressures:** Rising cost of living, nepotism, and peer influence foster unethical practices. • **Lack of Strong Ethical Training:** Training often emphasizes procedures over values, leaving officers vulnerable to compromises. **Institutional Mechanisms to Check Corruption in India:** • **Central Vigilance Commission (CVC, 1964**): It is an apex body to supervise vigilance activities and advise the government. • **Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI**): ✓ It is a Premier investigative agency handling major corruption cases. ✓ Example: 2G spectrum and coal block allocation scams. • **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013):** They provide an independent anti-corruption ombudsman at the central and state levels. • **Right to Information Act (2005):** It empowers citizens to demand transparency in governance. • **Whistleblowers Protection Act (2014):** The act safeguards individuals exposing corruption. • **Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG):** It ensures financial accountability through audits. • **Judiciary and PILs:** Judicial activism ensures checks on arbitrary decisions (e.g., Vineet Narain vs. Union of India, strengthening CVC-CBI independence).  **Need for Strengthening Civil Services in India:** • Despite these institutions, corruption persists due to delays, political influence, and weak enforcement. • Strong ethical training under Mission Karmayogi and public vigilance through social audits can complement institutional checks.
Conclusion	The decline of integrity in civil services stems from systemic, political, and societal factors. Institutional mechanisms like CVC, CBI, Lokpal, and RTI play a critical role in combating corruption. Strengthening these with ethical training and citizen participation can restore faith in governance.
Model Question	"Integrity is declining in Indian civil services due to systemic, political, and societal factors. Identify the causes for this decline and evaluate the effectiveness of institutional mechanisms to curb corruption in India."

Value Addition	**Central Bureau of Investigation Supreme Court Judgements:** • **Vineet Narain vs. Union of India (1997):** The Court introduced measures for the appointment of the Director by a high-powered committee and a fixed tenure of two years. • **Subramanian Swamy vs. Director, CBI (2014):** This judgment declared Section 6A of the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act unconstitutional, removing the requirement of government approval for investigating senior civil servants. • **Common Cause vs. Union of India (2018):** The Court upheld the selection process for the CBI Director by a selection committee consisting of the Prime Minister, the Leader of the Opposition, and the Chief Justice of India (or nominee).
10. Good governance and e-governance- Transparency, accountability and responsiveness in governance — Citizen's Charter. RTI, Public Service Act and their implications, Concept of Social Audit and its importance	
36. Define good governance. How does the Right to Information (RTI) Act promote the principles of good governance in India? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Governance and Good Governance
Keyword	Define, How
Approach	• Define good governance and briefly highlight its core principles as per UNESCAP. • Describe the provisions of the RTI Act and analyze how it promotes transparency, accountability, citizen participation, and rule of law with examples and judicial references. • Conclude by emphasizing RTI's role in strengthening good governance and suggest measures to overcome challenges for making it more effective.
Introduction	Good governance implies the transparent, accountable, and participatory exercise of authority in managing a nation's political, social, and economic affairs. As per UNESCAP (2009), it rests on principles like participation, rule of law, transparency, responsiveness, equity, effectiveness, accountability, and inclusiveness. In India, the Right to Information Act, 2005 empowers citizens to access public information, thereby deepening democracy and fostering good governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Good Governance – Meaning & Principles:** As per NIOS and IGNOU, good governance goes beyond mere government functioning and involves the manner in which power is exercised to manage resources and ensure inclusive growth. Its key principles are: • **Transparency** – openness in decision-making and policy implementation. • **Accountability** – government officials are answerable for their actions. • **Rule of Law** – fair and impartial enforcement of laws. • **Participation** – citizen engagement in governance processes. • **Effectiveness & Efficiency** – optimal use of resources to deliver public services. • **Equity & Inclusiveness** – ensuring no section of society is left behind. **Right to Information Act, 2005 – An Overview:** • Enacted after a long civil society campaign (notably by Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan). • Provides citizens the right to seek information from public authorities within 30 days.

	• Covers Union, State, and local bodies, enhancing citizen oversight of governance. • Supported by Supreme Court judgments that linked the right to know with Article 19(1)(a) (Freedom of Speech and Expression). ✓ *State of UP v. Raj Narain (1975)* – people have the right to know how government works. ✓ *Union of India v. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002)* – candidate disclosure case. **RTI and Promotion of Good Governance** • **Transparency**: ✓ Citizens can demand records on public spending, recruitment, and decision-making. ✓ Example: RTI applications exposed irregularities in the 2G spectrum allocation and Commonwealth Games scam. • **Accountability**: ✓ Public officials must justify decisions, reducing scope for corruption. ✓ According to a PRS Legislative Research analysis, RTI has led to greater compliance in service delivery, from ration shops to MGNREGA wages. • **Citizen Participation**: ✓ Encourages active engagement in governance. Local communities have used RTI to monitor *PDS, school funds, and Gram Panchayat expenditures*. • **Rule of Law**: ✓ Strengthens democratic checks and balances by empowering citizens against arbitrary state action. ✓ Supreme Court in *CBSE v. Aditya Bandopadhyay (2011)* upheld students' right to access evaluated answer sheets. • **Equity & Inclusiveness**: ✓ Marginalized groups, including women and SC/ST communities, have used RTI to claim entitlements under welfare schemes. • **Recent Developments**: ✓ Digital RTI portals (2023 expansion to all States/UTs) increased accessibility. ✓ Proactive disclosures under Section 4 of the RTI Act promote suo motu transparency. ✓ Concerns remain about RTI dilution after the RTI (Amendment) Act, 2019, which gave the central government control over Information Commissioners' tenure and salary. **Challenges in Implementation:** ✓ Delays and pendency in information requests (over 3 lakh pending cases, CIC data 2023). ✓ Threats and attacks on RTI activists (highlighting need for whistle-blower protection). ✓ Lack of awareness among citizens, especially rural areas.
Conclusion	Good governance is vital for a healthy democracy, and the RTI Act has strengthened transparency, accountability, and citizen participation in India. Despite challenges like pendency and dilution of provisions, it remains crucial for responsive governance. Strengthening RTI through digital innovations, activist protection, and proactive disclosures can further ensure accountability and align India with global standards of good governance.
Model Question	The Supreme Court has often upheld the right to information as part of Article 19(1)(a). Explain how judicial interpretations have shaped the framework of RTI and its contribution to good governance.

Value Addition

Provision	RTI Act, 2005	RTI Rules, 2019
Term	The CIC and ICs (at the central and state level) will hold office for a term of five years.	The CIC and ICs (at the central and state levels) will hold office for a term of three years
Salary	The salary of the CIC and ICs (at the central level) will be equivalent to the salary paid to the Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners (Rs 2,50,000 per month)	The CIC and ICs (at the central level) shall receive a pay of Rs. 2,50,000 and Rs. 2,25,000 per month, respectively.

37. Decentralisation is a necessary tool for good governance. Elaborate. (TGPSC, 2024)

Syllabus

Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Governance and Good Governance

Keyword

Elaborate

Approach

- Define decentralization and link it to the principles of good governance as enshrined in the Constitution and UNESCAP framework.
- Elaborate on how decentralization ensures participation, transparency, accountability, effectiveness, fiscal empowerment.
- Conclude by emphasizing decentralization role as a tool for grassroots democracy.

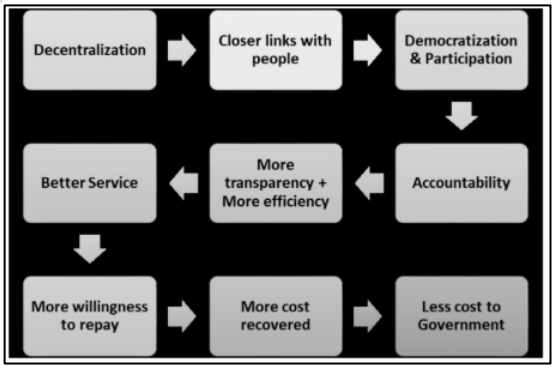
Introduction

Decentralization—political, administrative, and fiscal brings government closer to citizens, enabling participation, transparency, accountability, responsiveness and equity, the core principles of good governance highlighted by UNESCAP. In India, the 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments institutionalized rural and urban local self-government to realize these principles.

Body & Infographic Representation

How decentralization advances good governance?

- **Participation & inclusion:**
  - ✓ Elected panchayats/municipalities and Gram Sabhas/Nagar Sabhas deepen voice and oversight in planning and implementation across constitutionally listed subjects.
  - ✓ Evidence reviews of 30 years of PRI/ULB reforms show expanded civic engagement but uneven depth across states.
  - ✓ Example: Village and Ward Secretariat system and what's App Governance in Andhra Pradesh.

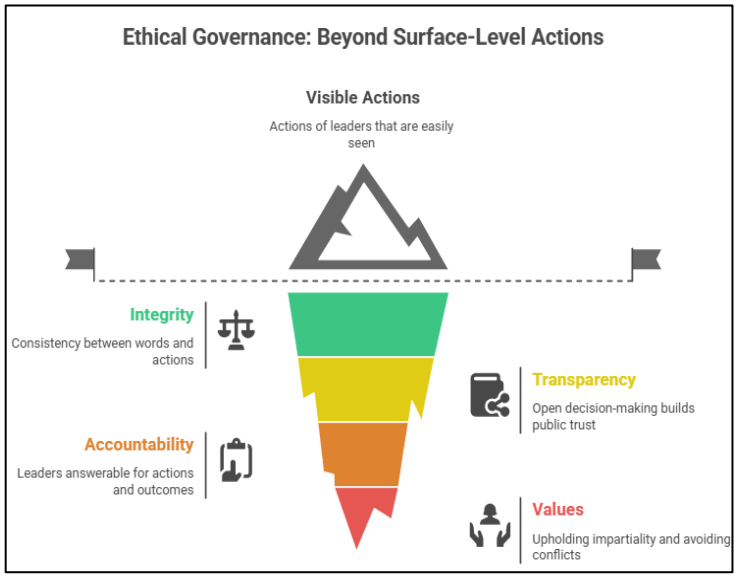


- **Transparency & accountability:**
  - ✓ Localization shortens feedback loops; digital platforms like eGramSwaraj publish plans, accounts and payments, with 2024–25 updates (Bhashini integration) improving multilingual access.
  - ✓ District-level rollouts of QR/biometric checks for panchayat payments show tech-enabled fiduciary control.
- **Effectiveness & responsiveness:**
  - ✓ Decision-making at the point of service (water, sanitation, local roads) improves fit to local needs.

	✓ **SVAMITVA** uses drones/GIS to confer property rights, reduce disputes, and enable village-level planning—strengthening evidence-based decisions. • **Rule of law & continuity:** ✓ The Supreme Court in Kishan Singh Tomar v. MCD (2006) underscored holding timely municipal elections, guarding against executive delays that hollow local democracy. ✓ In Union of India v. Rajendra N. Shah (2021), the Court protected federal procedure (ratification) while commenting on the constitutional architecture of decentralization, reinforcing constitutionalism as a guardrail. **Fiscal decentralization: the missing middle** • Local bodies need predictable, adequate funds and buoyant own-revenues. • The 14th and 15th Finance Commissions scaled up untied grants and linked releases to audited accounts/property tax reforms; non-compliance or absence of elected bodies has cost cities significant funds (Eg: Nagpur). • Various Parliamentary committees urged time-bound devolution and performance-linked incentives. **Challenges that blunt decentralization:** • Incomplete devolution of the 29/18 subjects and staff to PRIs/ULBs; weak Gram/Nagar Sabha functioning. • Thin fiscal autonomy and dependence on scheme funds; property-tax reforms uneven. • Capacity and accountability gaps, including irregular meetings and low attendance.
Conclusion	Decentralization strengthens good governance by ensuring participation, transparency, accountability, and responsiveness at the grassroots. Courts have upheld its constitutional mandate, while Union finance transfers and digital tools enhance integrity. The way forward lies in full devolution of functions and staff, predictable fiscal transfers, empowered local revenues, and active Gram/Nagar Sabha oversight, making local governments the first mile of governance.
Model Question	The success of decentralisation depends not only on devolution of power but also on capacity building of local bodies. Analyse.
Value Addition	**Top 10 States in Panchayat Devolution Index (DI Score > 55) as per "Status of Devolution to Panchayats in States" report:** • Kerala • Tamil Nadu • Maharashtra • Uttar Pradesh • Gujarat • Tripura • Rajasthan • West Bengal • Chhattisgarh
38. What are the different dimensions of governance? Briefly explain the administrative dimension of governance and its key components. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Governance and Good Governance
Keyword	What, Explain
Approach	• Define governance and outline its multiple dimensions as per ARC and UN frameworks.

	• Elaborate on the administrative dimension by explaining its key components—policy implementation, efficiency, accountability, inclusiveness, reforms, and recent developments with examples and judicial references. • Conclude by emphasizing Administrative Governance central role in operationalising good governance.
Introduction	Governance is the process of decision-making and implementation across political, economic, and social spheres. The Second Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC) defines it as the exercise of power in managing economic and social resources for development. Good governance is multi-dimensional—political, economic, social, administrative, legal, and environmental. Among these, the administrative dimension is most crucial as it translates policy into action at the grassroots.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Different Dimensions of Governance** • **Political Dimension:** Ensures democracy, rule of law, electoral integrity, and citizen participation. • **Economic Dimension:** Concerns resource allocation, inclusive growth, fiscal management, and economic reforms. • **Social Dimension:** Focuses on social justice, equity, education, health, and welfare policies. • **Legal Dimension:** Ensures access to justice, judicial accountability, and rights protection. • **Environmental Dimension:** Promotes sustainable development and climate action. • **Administrative Dimension:** Relates to efficiency, transparency, and accountability in public administration. **Administrative Dimension of Governance:** The administrative dimension acts as the bridge between policy intent and citizens' lived experiences. Its key components include: • **Policy Implementation:** ✓ Execution of laws, schemes, and policies framed by the legislature. ✓ Example: Implementation of PM-Awas Yojana, Jal Jeevan Mission, and National Health Mission. • **Efficiency and Service Delivery** ✓ Focus on citizen-centric, timely, and cost-effective services. ✓ Example**:** Digital platforms like DigiLocker and UMANG App have streamlined access to government services. • **Accountability and Transparency** ✓ Instruments such as the Right to Information Act (2005), e-governance, and social audits (Eg: MGNREGA) enhance administrative accountability. ✓ The Supreme Court in Union of India vs. Association for Democratic Reforms (2002) emphasized transparency as vital for good governance. • **Responsiveness and Inclusiveness** ✓ Ensuring marginalized groups, women, and weaker sections are included in governance processes. ✓ Example: SECC-based targeting for welfare schemes. • **Rule of Law and Ethical Administration** ✓ Upholding impartiality, integrity, and adherence to procedures. ✓ Civil Services are expected to maintain neutrality and uphold constitutional values, as reaffirmed in *Prakash Singh vs. Union of India (2006)* on police reforms. • **Administrative Reforms and Capacity Building**

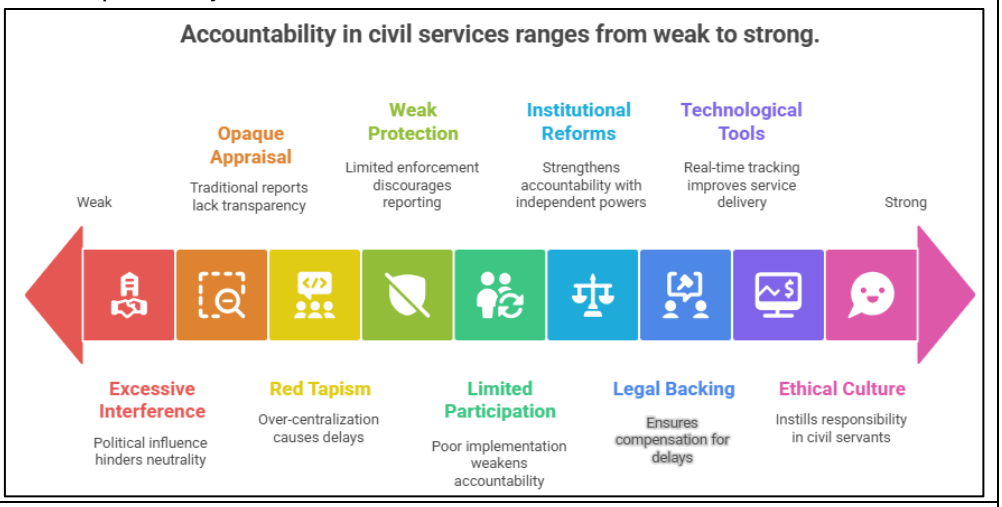
	✓ Recommendations of ARC for simplification of procedures, citizen charters, and grievance redressal mechanisms. ✓ Recent initiatives like Mission Karmayogi focus on capacity building of civil servants. **Recent Developments Strengthening Administrative Governance** ✓ Digital India and e-Governance: Use of JAM trinity (Jan Dhan–Aadhaar–Mobile) to plug leakages. ✓ Civil Service Reforms: Introduction of lateral entry to infuse expertise. ✓ NITI Aayog's Aspirational Districts Programme: Improving governance outcomes through data-driven monitoring.
Conclusion	The administrative dimension is the heart of governance, translating policy into citizen outcomes. It demands a professional, transparent, and accountable bureaucracy, strengthened by technology and citizen participation. As held in Olga Tellis vs. Bombay Municipal Corporation *(1985)*, governance must balance efficiency with dignity and rights. A responsive administration is thus vital to realize the ideals of good governance.
Model Question	Evaluate the effectiveness of recent administrative reforms such as Mission Karmayogi, e-Governance, and the Aspirational Districts Programme in strengthening the administrative dimension of governance
Value Addition	**National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (Mission Karmayogi):** • NPCSCB envisioned by the Government, addresses the changing needs and aspirations of the citizen. Anchored by an apex body and headed by the Prime Minister, it is designed to enhance the civil services under a national programme. • The NPSCSB aims to embark on a learning transformation program that will address the capacity building issues of the Civil Services through a comprehensive online platform - iGOT Karmayogi. • iGOT Karmayogi aims to provide online, face-to-face and blended learning and manage lifelong learning records of the officials. • Linkages between these two aspects will pave the way to; ✓ AI enabled assessment of competency levels ✓ Competency gaps in an individual ✓ Data driven strategic HR decision making, both leading to Strategic HR management of the Government.
39. Discuss the significance of integrity, transparency, and accountability in leadership. How can public leaders demonstrate these values in their decision-making process? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Transparency, Accountability
Keyword	Discuss, how
Approach	• Define values as the core of ethical governance. • Show how leaders demonstrate them: disclosure, participatory decision-making, fair enforcement. • Conclude with examples like E. Sreedharan (Delhi Metro).
Introduction	Leadership in public life is not merely about authority but about ethical responsibility towards citizens. Integrity, transparency, and accountability form the triad of good governance and ensure that decisions are made in the public interest. Leaders embodying these values foster trust, legitimacy, and effective service delivery.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Significance of Integrity in Leadership:** • Integrity ensures consistency between words and actions, preventing misuse of power. • Leaders with integrity resist corruption and uphold constitutional values.

	• Example: E. Sreedharan ("Metro Man"), known for incorruptible integrity, delivered the Delhi Metro on time and within budget. **Importance of Transparency in Governance:** • Transparency builds public trust by making decision-making open to scrutiny. • It minimizes rumours, arbitrariness, and bureaucratic secrecy. • Example: RTI Act (2005) institutionalized transparency, forcing leaders and administrators to disclose information to citizens.  **Role of Accountability in Leadership:** • Accountability ensures leaders remain answerable for their actions and policy outcomes. • It strengthens democratic legitimacy and prevents misuse of authority. • Example: The CAG reports on 2G Spectrum and Coal Block allocations held leadership accountable for policy failures. **Demonstration of Values in Decision-Making** • **Integrity:** Leaders must avoid conflicts of interest and uphold impartiality. (e.g., IAS officer Armstrong Pame mobilizing resources for a public road project without personal gain). • **Transparency:** Leaders should use digital dashboards, public consultations, and open data portals before policy rollout. • **Accountability:** Leaders can set clear performance targets, publish outcomes, and submit to audits or citizen feedback. **Global and Indian Parallels:** • New Zealand's transparent COVID-19 response showed high citizen compliance due to open leadership communication. • In India, Kiran Bedi displayed integrity and accountability in prison reforms at Tihar Jail.
Conclusion	Integrity, transparency, and accountability are indispensable to ethical leadership and good governance. Public leaders can demonstrate these values by aligning personal conduct with constitutional morality. Ultimately, these principles create a governance culture rooted in trust, justice, and service to citizens.
Model Question	"Integrity, transparency, and accountability are considered the hallmarks of ethical leadership. Discuss their significance in public administration and illustrate how public leaders can demonstrate these values in decision-making."
Value Addition	**Government-endorsed Importance of Integrity, Transparency, and Accountability:** While India's own government portals may not directly consolidate these principles in a single narrative, global standards and institutional frameworks, endorsed by India, strongly reinforce their importance:

	• **United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC, 2004):** As a signatory to this landmark international pact, India upholds "core values such as honesty, respect for the rule of law, accountability and transparency in promoting development". • **U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA)**: In its guidelines on public participation, the EPA underscores that a "climate of integrity: trust and credibility of government are essential" for genuine public involvement. It states that public participation will not succeed where authorities are corrupt or insincere.
40. Whistle blowers are guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Discuss the ethical and institutional importance of whistle-blower protection in ensuring integrity in public service (APPSC, 2025).	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Transparency, Accountability
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Define whistle-blowers and their role in exposing corruption and maladministration. • Discuss ethical values (integrity, courage, accountability) and institutional need (whistle-blower Protection Act 2014, CVC). • Stress robust legal protection and cultural change to safeguard whistle-blowers as pillars of ethical governance.
Introduction	Whistleblowers play a vital role in exposing corruption, maladministration, and abuse of power in governance. They embody ethical courage and public integrity by prioritizing the larger public good over personal risks. Protecting whistle-blowers is therefore essential for fostering trust, transparency, and accountability in democratic governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Ethical and institutional importance of whistle-blower protection in ensuring integrity in public service:** • **Ethical Importance of whistle-blower Protection:** ✓ **Guardians of Integrity:** ▪ Whistleblowers uphold values like honesty, courage, and integrity by revealing wrongdoing. ▪ For instance, Satyendra Dubey, an NHAI engineer, exposed corruption in the Golden Quadrilateral project, reflecting ethical commitment despite risks. ✓ **Promoting Public Interest:** They ensure that the rights of citizens are protected and resources are not siphoned off by vested interests. ✓ **Moral Courage against Wrongdoing**: Whistleblowers inspire a culture of responsibility and duty in civil services, strengthening ethical governance. • **Institutional Importance of whistle-blower Protection:** ✓ **Legal Safeguards:** ▪ The Whistleblowers Protection Act, 2014, provides a statutory framework for reporting corruption while ensuring confidentiality. ▪ However, its limited implementation remains a challenge. ✓ **Strengthening Accountability Mechanisms**: Institutions like the Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) and Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) depend on whistle-blower disclosures to audit and investigate malpractices. ✓ **Encouraging Transparency**: ▪ By reducing fear of reprisals, strong protections encourage more officers and citizens to come forward, reducing systemic corruption. ▪ For example, the Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System (CPGRAMS) under DARPG allows anonymous reporting of grievances.

	✓ **International Best Practices**: Countries like the USA (Whistle-blower Protection Act, 1989) and the UK (Public Interest Disclosure Act, 1998) offer comprehensive protection, showing that institutional backing enhances governance integrity. • **Examples of Ethical and institutional importance of Whistle-blower protection in ensuring integrity in public service:** ✓ According to Transparency International (2024 Corruption Perception Index), India ranked 96th out of 180 countries, reflecting persistent governance gaps. Strong Whistle-blower protection can help bridge these. ✓ The CVC Annual Report (2022) highlighted that over 30,000 complaints were received, many through Whistle-blower mechanisms, proving their institutional importance.
Conclusion	Whistleblowers act as the ethical conscience of public service, ensuring honesty and transparency. Strengthening institutional safeguards is vital to protect them from reprisals and to embed accountability in governance. Only then can Whistle-blowers truly serve as guardians of ethical integrity in India's democracy.
Model Question	Whistle blowers are often regarded as the guardians of ethical accountability in governance. Critically examine the ethical and institutional importance of protecting whistle blowers in ensuring transparency and integrity in Indian public services. Support your answer with examples
Value Addition	**Whistle-blower Protection Act, 2014** • The act establishes a mechanism to receive complaints related to disclosure of allegations of corruption or wilful misuse of power or discretion, against any public servant, and to inquire or cause an inquiry into such disclosure. • The act also provides adequate safeguards against victimization of the person making such complaints. • It allows any person, including a public servant, to make a public interest disclosure before a Competent Authority. The law has elaborately defined various competent authorities. For instance, the competent authority to complain against any union minister is the Prime Minister. • The law does not allow anonymous complaints to be made and clearly states that no action will be taken by a competent authority if the complainant does not establish his/her identity. • The maximum period for making a complaint is seven years. • The act does not apply to the Special Protection Group (SPG) personnel and officers, constituted under the Special Protection Group Act, 1988. • Any person aggrieved by any order of the Competent Authority can appeal to the concerned High Court within sixty days from the date of the order. • Any person who negligently or malafide reveals the identity of a complainant will be punishable with imprisonment for a term extending up to 3 years and a fine which may extend up to Rs.50,000.

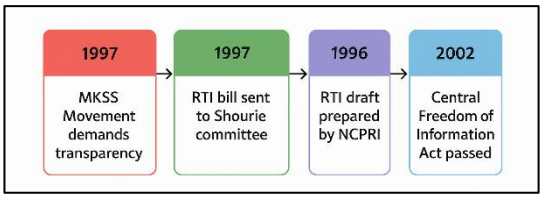
	• If the disclosure is done mala fide and knowingly that it was incorrect or false, or misleading, the person will be punishable with imprisonment for a term extending up to 2 years and a fine extending up to Rs.30,000. • The Competent Authority prepares a consolidated annual report of the performance of its activities and submits it to the Central or State Government which will be further laid before each House of Parliament or State Legislature, as the case may be. • The Whistleblowers Act overrides the Official Secrets Act, 1923, and allows the complainant to make a public interest disclosure before a competent authority, even if they are violative of the latter act but not harming the sovereignty of the nation. • In 2015, an amendment bill was moved that proposes, Whistle-blowers must not be allowed to reveal any documents classified under the Official Secrets Act of 1923, even if the purpose is to disclose acts of corruption, misuse of power, or criminal activities. This dilutes the very existence of the 2014 Act.
41. Define 'Accountability'. Discuss the factors that have led to the weakening of accountability in civil services. Suggest ways to improve the mechanisms for accountability in civil services. (APPSC, 2023).	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Good governance and e-governance- Transparency, accountability and responsiveness in governance
Keyword	Define. Discuss, Suggest
Approach	• Define accountability (answerability of officials for actions/decisions to people & institutions). • Explain weakening factors such as political interference, lack of performance appraisal, bureaucratic secrecy, and corruption. • Suggest reforms such as citizen charters, RTI, performance-based appraisal, technology-driven monitoring.
Introduction	Accountability is the obligation of public servants to answer for their actions, decisions, and performance to the citizens, legislature, and oversight institutions. It ensures transparency, efficiency, and ethical governance in a democracy. However, in India, accountability mechanisms in civil services face significant challenges that weaken their effectiveness.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Accountability Definition:** • Accountability means being answerable for actions and decisions, ensuring that authority is exercised responsibly. • **Dimensions:** It includes political accountability (to elected representatives), administrative accountability (to rules, laws, and superiors), and social accountability (to citizens). **Factors Weakening Accountability in Civil Services:** • **Excessive Political Interference:** ✓ Frequent transfers and political patronage weaken neutrality. ✓ Example: Sanjiv Chaturvedi, IFS officer, faced 12 transfers in 5 years for exposing corruption. • **Opaque Performance Appraisal:** ✓ Traditional Annual Confidential Reports (ACRs) lack transparency and objectivity. ✓ ARC reports (2nd ARC, 2008) highlighted this as a major flaw. • **Bureaucratic Red Tapism:** ✓ Over-centralization leads to delays and a lack of responsiveness. ✓ Citizens often face procedural hurdles in schemes like PMAY and ration delivery under NFSA.

	• **Weak Whistleblower Protection:** Despite the Whistleblower Protection Act, 2014, limited enforcement discourages reporting of corruption. • **Limited Citizen Participation:** Poor implementation of tools like Citizen Charters and Social Audits weakens grassroots accountability. **Ways to Improve Accountability Mechanisms in Civil Services:** • **Institutional Reforms:** ✓ Implement 360-degree appraisal systems with feedback from peers, subordinates, and citizens. ✓ Strengthen Lokpal and CVC with independent powers. • **Legal Backing:** Enact a Right to Services Act at the national level (like Karnataka Sakala Services Act, 2011, ensuring compensation for delays). • **Technological Tools:** ✓ Expand e-Office, CPGRAMS, and UMANG app for real-time tracking of service delivery. ✓ Example: Passport Seva Project reduced timelines through digital accountability. • **Promoting Ethical Culture:** Integrate ethics training under Mission Karmayogi to instil responsibility in civil servants. 
Conclusion	Accountability in civil services is the cornerstone of good governance. Strengthening institutional, legal, and citizen-centric mechanisms can bridge the gap between authority and responsibility. A transparent and accountable bureaucracy will ensure trust, efficiency, and integrity in India's democratic administration.
Model Question	Define the concept of 'Accountability' in public administration. What are the key factors responsible for the weakening of accountability mechanisms in Indian civil services? Suggest reforms and innovative measures to strengthen accountability.
Value Addition	**Mission Karmayogi:** • It is also known as the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB), which is a Central Sector Scheme, is being implemented by the Department of Personnel and Training. • The objective of the Mission is to build a future-ready and citizen-centric civil service by shifting from a rule-based to a role-based and competency-driven capacity building framework. • A key component of this initiative is the iGOT Karmayogi digital learning platform, which provides access to online training courses across behavioural, functional, and domain competencies, enabling anytime-anywhere learning for government employees.

	• Two institutions - the Capacity Building Commission (CBC) and the Karmayogi Bharat Special Purpose Vehicle (KB-SPV) - were set up in the year 2021 and 2022, respectively as part of the implementation of Mission Karmayogi. • CBC aids Ministries/Departments and Organizations in the formulation and implementation of the Capacity Building Plans, while the KB-SPV owns and operates the i-GoT digital learning platform. • The Mission is being implemented across all Ministries and Departments of the Government of India through the existing Civil Service Training Institutions and the digital learning platform - iGOT Karmayogi. • Capacity building interventions are being facilitated primarily through the digital platform and the Capacity Building Plans of respective Ministries/Departments.
42. Discuss the Indian experience of the Citizen Charter movement and suggest solutions to improve its impact in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Citizen Charters
Keyword	Discuss, Suggest
Approach	• Explain the origin in 1997, based on the UK model, aiming for service accountability. • Highlight shortcomings: poor awareness, lack of grievance redressal, weak enforcement. • Suggest reforms: legal backing, training, tech integration.
Introduction	Citizen Charters represent a commitment by public institutions to provide quality, transparent, and accountable services. India adopted this concept in 1997, inspired by the UK's Citizen Charter initiative (1991). While the movement has created awareness about service delivery, its impact remains limited due to weak enforcement.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Objectives of the Citizen Charter movement:** • To enhance transparency, efficiency, and accountability in public service delivery. • To empower citizens by clearly defining service standards, timelines, and grievance redressal mechanisms. • According to the Department of Administrative Reforms & Public Grievances (DARPG), over 1,500 Citizen Charters have been adopted by Central Ministries, Departments, and State Governments since their launch in 1997. **Indian Experience with Citizen Charters:** • Introduced in 1997, at present, over 1,000 charters exist across central and state departments. • **Achievements of the Citizen Charter Movement in India:** ✓ It promoted a shift towards customer-oriented governance. ✓ It created awareness about service timelines in sectors like railways, banking, and municipal services. ✓ Example: Passport Seva Project improved timelines by integrating Citizen Charter principles with e-governance. • **Limitations of Citizen Charters:** ✓ Charters are often non-binding, lacking legal enforceability. ✓ Poor awareness among citizens; many rural beneficiaries remain excluded. ✓ Absence of effective grievance redressal and accountability for delays. • **Suggested Solutions to Strengthen the impact of the citizen charters:** ✓ **Legal Backing:** Enact laws like the Right of Citizens for Time-Bound Delivery of Services Act (already implemented in states like Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka). ✓ **Awareness Campaigns:** ▪ Conduct public outreach, especially in rural areas.

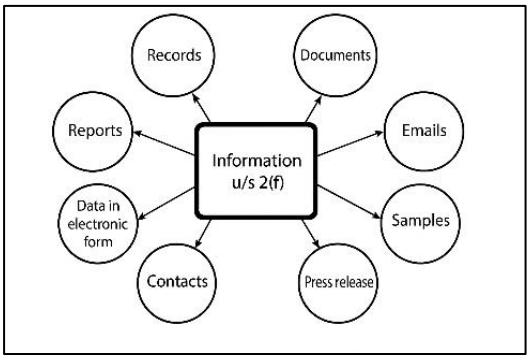
	▪ Example: States like Maharashtra and MP use Jan Sunwai (public hearings) and outreach programs to spread awareness. ✓ **Integration with Digital Platforms**: ▪ Linking charters with RTI Act, e-Samadhan, and online dashboards for real-time tracking. ▪ Example: CPGRAMS handled over 20 lakh grievances in 2023, with a disposal rate of 95%, as per DARPG's Monthly Dashboard. • **Capacity Building**: Train officials in citizen-centric service delivery and ethical governance. • **Regular Monitoring and Social Audits:** ✓ Independent evaluations with citizen participation. ✓ Example: Karnataka Sakala Services Act (2011) ensures compensation for delays in the delivery of notified government services.
Conclusion	The Citizen Charter movement in India has laid the foundation for people-centric governance, but its potential remains underutilized. By providing legal enforceability, awareness, and digital integration, India can transform charters into a powerful tool of accountability. Strengthening them is key to achieving Good Governance.
Model Question	"The Citizen Charter movement was introduced in India to make governance transparent and accountable. Discuss India's experience with this initiative and suggest measures to enhance its effectiveness."
Value Addition	• The concept of the Citizens' Charter enshrines the trust between the service provider and its users. • The concept was first articulated and implemented in the United Kingdom by the Conservative Government of John Major in 1991 as a national Programme with a simple aim: to continuously improve the quality of public services for the people of the country so that these services respond to the needs and wishes of the users. • The Programme was re-launched in 1998 by the Labour Government of Tony Blair, which rechristened it Services First. • The basic objective of the Citizens' Charter is to empower citizens about public service delivery. • Six principles of the Citizens Charter movement, as originally framed, were: ✓ **Quality:** Improving the quality of services; ✓ **Choice:** Wherever possible, ✓ **Standards:** Specify what to expect and how to act if standards are not met; ✓ **Value**: For the taxpayers' money; ✓ **Accountability:** Individuals and Organisations; and ✓ **Transparency:** Rules/ Procedures/ Schemes/Grievances.

43. "The making of the Right to Information Act, 2005 in India has been largely attributed to the success of civil society movement. Comment. (APPSC, 2023)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: RTI
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Introduce by highlighting RTI Act, 2005 as a landmark in deepening democracy, rooted in civil society struggles for transparency and accountability. • Discuss the pivotal role of civil society movements (MKSS, NCPRI, Anna Hazare), but also balance it with judiciary's constitutional backing, government's political intent, and administrative readiness. • Conclude by commenting that RTI emerged from a synergy of grassroots activism and institutional responsiveness, making it a product of both citizen demand and state intent.
Introduction	The Right to Information Act, 2005 (RTI) is often hailed as India's most empowering democratic reform, giving citizens the legal right to seek information from public authorities. While grassroots struggles and civil society mobilizations significantly shaped its enactment, the law also reflected the state's willingness to institutionalize transparency, thereby balancing activism with governance intent.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Civil Society Roots of the RTI Act:** • **Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS):** In the 1980s, MKSS pioneered Jan Sunwais (public hearings) in Rajasthan, exposing wage fraud in government works by demanding muster rolls. This grassroots assertion of "information is power" became the seed for RTI.  • **National Campaign for People's Right to Information (NCPRI):** Formed in 1996, it prepared model legislations, lobbied Parliament, and created a national discourse around transparency. • **Activists like Anna Hazare:** State-level RTI laws in Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Goa, and Delhi were achieved through activism, proving feasibility and strengthening the demand for a central law. • **Media Support:** Campaigns such as India against Corruption and investigative reports by national dailies kept the issue in public view. **Role of Judiciary in Legitimizing RTI:** • **Supreme Court Precedents:** In State of U.P. v. Raj Narain (1975) and S.P. Gupta v. Union of India (1982), the Court linked access to information with Article 19(1)(a) (freedom of speech and expression). • These judgments gave constitutional legitimacy, reinforcing civil society demands and obligating the State to legislate. **Government's Intent and Institutional Push:** While civil society spearheaded the campaign, the government's intention was also evident: • **Legislative Process:** The **UPA Government (2004–2005)** prioritized RTI within its National Common Minimum Programme. PM Manmohan Singh described it as a tool for "*inclusive governance*." • **Administrative Reforms Commission (ARC):** Its 2nd report emphasized transparency and recommended robust information regimes. • **State Precedents:** Early adoption of RTI laws by states (Tamil Nadu 1997, Goa 1997, Delhi 2001) had full government support, demonstrating political readiness. • **Digital Governance:** The launch of the RTI Online Portal (2013, expanded in 2023) reflects the State's continued intent to simplify access. **Recent Developments Strengthening RTI:**

	• **Judicial Clarifications (2024):** Supreme Court reaffirmed CIC's institutional autonomy, curbing executive delays in appointments. • **Digital Proactive Disclosure:** Maharashtra and Gujarat SICs mandated uploading of RTI replies online, with Gujarat resolving 10,000 pending cases through tech-enabled systems. • **Grassroots Awareness:** Campaigns in Andhra Pradesh empowering tribal women to file RTIs on welfare schemes show continued collaboration between NGOs and government. • **Challenges:** The Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 raised concerns about limiting access to officials' personal details; civil society criticized it as diluting RTI's scope, but government defended it as balancing privacy and transparency.
Conclusion	The RTI Act was undoubtedly driven by grassroots activism MKSS, NCPRI, and state-level campaigns, but attributing it solely to civil society overlooks other crucial factors. Judicial recognition of RTI as part of Article 19(1)(a), along with the government's political will and administrative preparedness, were equally vital. Thus, the Act's making was a synergy of citizen demand and institutional intent, reflecting participatory democracy in action.
Model Question	The effectiveness of the RTI Act depends not only on citizen activism but also on institutional efficiency. Evaluate the functioning of Information Commissions in ensuring transparency.
Value Addition	• Some of the exemptions from Disclosure under RTI: Section 8 • No obligation to disclose: ✓ Information affecting sovereignty, integrity, security, strategic, scientific, or economic interests; relations with foreign states; or incitement of offences. ✓ Information barred by courts or leading to contempt. ✓ Matters breaching privilege of Parliament/State Legislature. ✓ Commercial confidence, trade secrets, or IPR, unless larger public interest justifies disclosure. ✓ Fiduciary information, unless public interest warrants.
44. What is RTI? What rights are available under RTI Act 2005? If RTI is a Fundamental Right, then why do we need an Act to give us this Right? (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: RTI
Keyword	What, Why
Approach	• Introduce by defining RTI and linking it to its constitutional foundation under Article 19(1)(a) and the RTI Act, 2005. • Discuss rights under the Act, and explain why statutory backing was required despite RTI being a Fundamental Right. • Conclude by emphasizing RTI's role in deepening democracy while underlining challenges and the need for continuous strengthening.
Introduction	The Right to Information (RTI) is a cornerstone of democratic governance, allowing citizens to demand transparency and accountability. Though judicially recognized as part of Article 19(1)(a), its practical realization came with the RTI Act, 2005, which institutionalized procedures, safeguards, and remedies.
Body & Infographic Representation	**What is RTI?** • RTI is the legal entitlement of citizens to access information from public authorities, ensuring open governance. • The Supreme Court in *State of UP vs Raj Narain (1975)* held that "the people of this country have a right to know every public act," thereby affirming transparency as a democratic necessity.

	• This principle was reinforced in *S.P. Gupta vs Union of India (1982)*, where the Court declared the right to know as part of freedom of speech and expression. **Rights under the RTI Act, 2005** The Act grants citizens: • **Access to information** from public authorities in print, electronic, or digital form. • **Inspection of works, documents, and records**—as used by villagers in Rajasthan to verify muster rolls under NREGA, exposing wage delays and corruption. • **Obtaining certified copies** of official documents—for instance, activists used RTI to obtain documents that revealed irregularities in the Adarsh Housing Society scam. • **Proactive disclosure obligations (Sec. 4)**—Delhi citizens accessed ration shop stock registers online through RTI, curbing PDS leakages. • **Appeal and grievance redressal** mechanisms, with penalties for officials who delay or deny information. The Supreme Court in *PUCL vs Union of India (2003)* further strengthened this by mandating disclosure of candidates' criminal and financial records, ensuring informed electoral choices. **Why an Act if RTI is a Fundamental Right?** Although RTI flows from Article 19(1)(a), legislation was essential to: • **Specify procedures:** For example, a citizen can file an RTI application, and the authority must respond within 30 days (or 48 hours in life-and-liberty cases). • **Define exemptions:** Section 8 balances transparency with confidentiality—covering areas like national security, cabinet papers, or personal privacy. • **Establish institutions:** Central and State Information Commissions act as watchdogs; in *Secretary General, Supreme Court vs Subhash Chandra Agarwal (2019),* even the Chief Justice of India's office was brought under RTI, showing the law's institutional reach. • **Provide remedies:** Appeals and penalties ensure enforceability, making the right meaningful. Without the Act, RTI would remain an abstract judicial recognition, lacking the administrative machinery for citizens to exercise it.
Conclusion	The RTI Act, 2005 represents the transformation of a judicially recognized Fundamental Right into an enforceable statutory regime. Its impact is evident in empowering citizens to expose scams, demand service delivery, and hold institutions accountable. Yet, challenges like delays, vacancies in Information Commissions, and attempts at dilution require continuous vigilance. Civil society, judiciary, and proactive governance must work together to preserve this hard-won democratic instrument.
Model Question	"RTI has empowered the marginalized by democratizing information." Substantiate with examples from success stories across Indian states.
Value Addition	• The Supreme Court slammed the chronic delay shown by the Centre and States in appointing Information Commissioners to decide citizens' rights under the Right to Information Act, asking what was the use of creating the transparency-in-governance institution in the country if there were no people to work for the law. • A Bench headed by Justice Surya Kant noted that the Central Information Commission (CIC) has eight vacancies in the posts of the Information



	Commissioners, with 23,000 pending appeals filed by citizens seeking information from various government departments. Several Information Commissions in States have been defunct since 2020, and some have stopped accepting petitions under the Right to Information (RTI) Act.
45. "The Right to Information Act is meant only for providing information but not grievance redressal." Comment. (APPSC, 2017)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: RTI
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Introduce by explaining the objective of the RTI Act, 2005 as a tool for promoting transparency and accountability in governance. • Critically analyze the scope of RTI by highlighting that while it empowers citizens with access to information (Sec. 2(f)), it does not provide mechanisms for grievance redressal, citing examples and judicial clarifications. • Conclude by emphasizing that RTI complements grievance redressal mechanisms by enabling informed citizens but cannot substitute them, thus requiring strengthening of parallel accountability institutions.
Introduction	The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 is a pivotal instrument for transparency in governance, granting citizens the statutory right to inspect and receive government-held information. However, its mandate is limited to disclosure, not grievance redressal. The true strength of RTI lies in enabling informed pursuit of rights through other mechanisms while promoting accountability.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Legislative Purpose: Information, Not Redressal** • Section 2(f) defines "information" narrowly—as records, documents, memos, emails, etc. but does not mandate authorities to resolve grievances or provide explanations. • The Supreme Court in *CBSE v. Aditya Bandopadhyay (2011)* affirmed that RTI does not obligate a public body to create or interpret new information or opinions, nor to resolve citizen complaints. **Judicial Clarification through Practice:** • In practice, RTI must remain a tool for transparency, not adjudication. • For instance, in *Yogesh Kumar vs. CPIO, DoPT*, the CIC directed that seeking implementation status for a promotion benefit was more of a grievance than a transparency query, and fell outside Section 2(f)'s scope. **Preventing Administrative Overload:** • Conflating RTI with grievance mechanisms overloads PIOs and dilutes the Act's core purpose. • Institutions like CPGRAMS, Lokpal, and consumer courts exist precisely for grievance redressal, RTI simply empowers citizens by providing relevant information needed to file grievances. • Kerala's new guidelines (2025) for health-sector inspections highlight the structured separation of information access and grievances. **RTI in Action: Fueling Accountability, Not Redressal** • RTI has exposed malpractices by revealing data and patterns, without directly resolving grievances. Examples include: ✓ Punjab SIC directing transport officials to enforce compliance and recover penalties in a delayed RTI case. ✓ RTI uncovering Andhra meter scam, where activists exposed malpractices in Punjab's power utility.

	✓ RTI revealing that 60% of Mumbai motorists' e-challan grievances were rejected, highlighting systemic issues without resolving individual cases. ✓ These demonstrate how RTI facilitates accountability through information, not adjudicating the complaint itself. **Balancing Transparency & Privacy:** • Amendments via the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023 updated Section 8(1)(j) to emphasize that privacy must be balanced against public interest. • The government clarified that disclosure may proceed if the public interest outweighs potential harm.
Conclusion	The RTI Act is designed as a sunshine law ensuring citizens' access to existing government-held information, not as a grievance redressal framework. By illuminating governance processes, RTI enables corrective action through appropriate redressal forums. For democracy to thrive, RTI must remain robust as a tool of transparency and not be burdened with adjudicatory functions it was never meant to serve.
Model Question	Critically analyze whether the exemptions under Section 8 of the RTI Act strike the right balance between transparency and national interest.
Value Addition	**What is the eligibility criteria and what is the process of appointment of CIC/IC?** • Section 12(3) of the RTI Act 2005 provides as follows. ✓ The Prime Minister, who shall be the Chairperson of the committee ✓ The Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha ✓ A Union Cabinet Minister to be nominated by the Prime Minister. • Section 12(5) of the RTI Act 2005 provides that the Chief Information Commissioner and Information Commissioners shall be persons of eminence in public life with wide knowledge and experience in law, science and technology, social service, management, journalism, mass media or administration and governance. • Section 12(6) of the RTI Act 2005 provides that Chief Information Commissioner or an Information Commissioner shall not be a Member of Parliament or Member of the Legislature of any State or Union Territory as the case may be, or hold any other office of profit or connected with any political party or carrying on any business or pursuing any profession.

THEN AND NOW

TERM

2005 ACT: Chief Information Commissioner (CIC) and Information Commissioners (ICs) at central and state levels will serve for five years.

2019 BILL: Central government will notify the term of office.

SALARY

2005 ACT: At central level, salary of CIC and ICs equivalent to salary of Chief Election Commissioner and Election Commissioners, respectively. At state level, equivalent to salary of Election Commissioners and Chief Secretary, respectively.

2019 BILL: Salaries, allowances, and other terms and conditions of service of central and state CIC and ICs will be determined by the central government.

DEDUCTIONS

2005 ACT: At the time of appointment, if CIC and ICs (at central and state levels) are receiving pension or any other retirement benefits for previous government service, their salaries will be reduced by an amount equal to that pension. Previous government service includes service under: (i) the central government, (ii) state government, (iii) corporation established under a central or state law, and (iv) company owned or controlled by the central or state government.

2019 BILL: The Bill removes these provisions.

Source: PRS Legislative Research

46. The promise of decentralization of public service delivery is based on the hope that the local bodies will promote the required standards of accountability. Examine. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Public Service Act and their Implications
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Link decentralisation to 73rd & 74th Amendments. • Show how local bodies promote participation, responsiveness, and transparency but face capacity, finance, and political interference challenges.

	• Conclude that with capacity-building and fiscal devolution, decentralisation ensures accountable public service delivery.
Introduction	Decentralisation refers to the transfer of powers, responsibilities, and resources from higher levels of government to local self-governing institutions. The 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendments (1992–93) institutionalised Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs), envisaging participatory governance and accountable service delivery. The promise of decentralisation rests on the idea that local bodies, being closer to citizens, are better positioned to ensure transparency, responsiveness, and accountability.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Decentralisation and Public Service Delivery:** • **Proximity to People:** Local representatives understand local needs better, leading to context-specific solutions in education, sanitation, health, and water supply. • **Citizen Participation:** Gram Sabhas and Ward Committees act as forums for monitoring decisions and demanding accountability. • **Inclusive Development**: Reservation for women, SCs, and STs ensures that marginalised voices are represented. **Challenges and Limitations of Decentralisation and Accountability in Public Service Delivery:** • **Financial Dependence:** Local bodies often rely heavily on state/central grants, limiting autonomy. • **Capacity Deficits:** Lack of skilled manpower and training affects effective service delivery. • **Political Interference**: State governments sometimes supersede or delay elections to local bodies. • **Weak Accountability Mechanisms:** ▪ Gram Sabhas and social audits are not uniformly effective. ▪ Example: Many ULBs in Telangana and Andhra Pradesh struggle with solid waste management due to inadequate funds and manpower.
Conclusion	Decentralisation has created opportunities for accountable and people-centric governance, but its promise remains only partially realised. Strengthening fiscal devolution, building administrative capacity, empowering Gram Sabhas, and institutionalising social audits and e-governance platforms are essential to ensure that

	local bodies uphold the standards of transparency and accountability envisioned by the Constitution.
Model Question	The promise of decentralisation of public service delivery lies in enhancing accountability through empowered local bodies. Critically examine the role of Panchayati Raj and Urban Local Bodies in ensuring this accountability.
Value Addition	**Significance of Public Services in India:** • In developing societies, public services are an important tool for political modernization. • Before electoral democracy, there must be a well-knit and well-organized public bureaucratic structure. • It ensures the stability and continuity of the government system. • Civil servants, particularly All India Service officials, contribute to fostering a sense of belonging to a single nation, India. • Civil servants must commit to building an inclusive society in which the poor and vulnerable are also beneficiaries of economic growth. • It has a role to play in undoing years of colonial misrule. It promotes a welfare-oriented approach. • It functions as an unbiased development agent in a heterogeneous, fissiparous, pluralistic, and diverse society. It advocates for democratic socialism. • It works to ensure the rule of law by balancing political direction and legal provisions. It is useful for conflict resolution, change management, and crisis management.
47. Social audit helps to narrow gaps between vision and reality. Examine the statement and also discuss the impediments in the institutionalisation of social audit in India. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section B: Public Administration and Governance: Concept of Social Audit and its importance
Keyword	Examine, Discuss
Approach	• Define social audit as community oversight in schemes (e.g., MGNREGA). • Explain how it bridges gap between policy intent and ground reality. • Discuss impediments: lack of awareness, bureaucratic resistance, and inadequate institutionalisation.
Introduction	Social audit is a participatory tool that allows citizens to evaluate the implementation of policies and programs against their stated objectives. It bridges the gap between the vision of welfare schemes and their ground-level outcomes. In India, while social audits have shown positive results, institutionalisation faces significant challenges.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Role of Social Audit in Narrowing Gaps between Vision and Reality:** • **Ensuring Accountability**: It brings transparency by exposing misuse of funds and poor implementation. • **Empowering Citizens:** It enables direct participation in monitoring, making governance bottom-up. • **Improving Service Delivery:** ✓ It provides feedback to authorities for course correction. ✓ Example: The Standing Committee on Rural Development (2021-22) observed that "despite provisions, irregularities like non-payment of wages, ghost beneficiaries, and inflated bills are common in MGNREGA works. **Vision vs. Reality – Empirical Evidence:** • **Vision**: Government schemes like MGNREGA, PMAY, and NFSA promise inclusive growth. • **Reality**: Leakages, corruption, and lack of awareness hinder outcomes. • Social audits uncover these discrepancies and push administrators to align implementation with objectives. **Impediments in Institutionalisation of Social Audit in India:** • **Lack of Awareness:**

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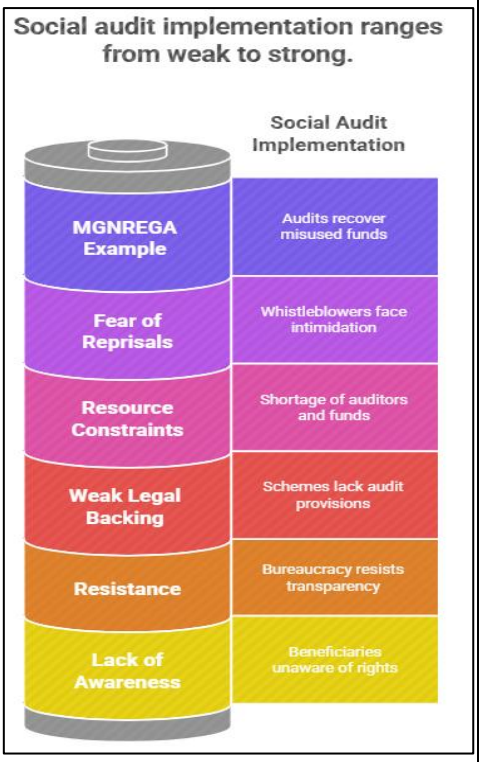
✓ Beneficiaries often lack knowledge of their rights and entitlements.
✓ MoRD noted in its 2022 Evaluation Report that awareness of entitlements remains below 40% among rural beneficiaries.

Resistance from Bureaucracy and Politicians: Officials often view social audits as threats exposing corruption.
Weak Legal Backing: Except for MGNREGA (2005), most schemes lack a statutory provision for audits.
Resource Constraints: Shortage of trained auditors and financial resources affects quality.
Fear of Reprisals:

✓ Whistleblowers and community members face intimidation.
✓ Example: In Bihar, reports show local vested interests suppress audit findings.

Way Forward:

Provide legal mandate for social audits across all major welfare schemes.
Establish independent social audit units with citizen participation.
Integrate technology tools (GIS mapping, online dashboards) to strengthen credibility.
Promote capacity building and awareness through civil society and NGOs.



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<td>Conclusion</td>
<td>Social audits are crucial in transforming paper promises into lived realities by ensuring accountability and citizen participation. However, institutionalisation requires stronger legal frameworks, awareness, and administrative will. Strengthening social audits will make governance more transparent, inclusive, and people-centric.</td>
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<td>Model Question</td>
<td>"Social audit is a tool to bridge the gap between policy vision and ground-level outcomes. Examine this statement and discuss the challenges in institutionalising social audits in India."</td>
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<td>Value Addition</td>
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Social Audit in the National Social Assistance Program (NSAP):

With an aim to promote transparency, accountability, and people's participation in the National Social Assistance Programme, the conduct of Social Audits was highlighted in its guidelines (NSAP Guidelines, 2014). In order to formalize the process and ensure its smooth implementation, these guidelines are now being issued.
Objectives of NSAP Social Audit:

✓ Awareness generation for all stakeholders
✓ Pro-active disclosure of the information about the scheme
✓ Beneficiary Verification
✓ Identification of ineligible beneficiaries
✓ Identification of eligible beneficiaries based on NSAP/State eligibility criterion
✓ Providing a platform for recording grievances and forwarding them to the appropriate authorities for their quick redressal
✓ Identify issues being faced by the beneficiaries in the implementation of NSAP

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Assistant Commissioner of State Tax

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Assistant Prohibition & Excise Superintendent

Ms. Thanuja
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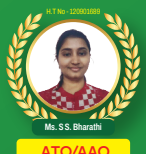

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ATO/AAO

Ms. Jyothi
ATO/AAO

Ms. R. Sahaja
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Ms. Navya Sree
Deputy Registrar in A.P. Cooperative Service

Ms. Yegavinti Nithyasri
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Thematic Areas	Mains PYQs | Paper-III	Marks	Year
C. Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law			
11. Ethics and Human Interface: Essence, determinants and Consequences of Ethics in Human actions: dimensions of Ethics: Ethics in Private and Public relationships, Ethics-integrity and Accountability			
(i) Ethics and Human Interface	1. What is meant by 'International Ethics'? Explain the significance of ethics in international dispute resolutions and environmental cooperation among nations.	10	APPSC 2023
(ii) Ethics in Private and Public relationships	2. Does Popular democracy breed distrust in the public towards their representatives? Discuss the scope of ethical leadership in democracy and politics.	10	APPSC 2023
	3. "Ethics in public service is an essential component of parliamentary democracy" - In this connection, discuss the pathway towards a 'Naitik Bharat'.	10	APPSC 2023
	4. How does time and space effect ethics in private and public relationships? Illustrate	10	APPSC 2020
12. Human values: Understanding the Harmony in existence Human relationships in the society and in the Nature. Gender Equability in the relationships- Role of family, society and Educational Institutions in imparting values to citizens, lessons from the lives and teachings of great leaders, reformers and administrations			
(i) Human values	5. Discuss the significance of values in the development of personality and socio-cultural systems. Add a brief note on the hierarchy of values in India.	10	APPSC 2023
(ii) Role of family, society and Educational Institutions in imparting values to citizens	6. What is the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating values?	10	APPSC 2020
(iii) Lessons from the lives and Teachings of great leaders	7. Vinoba Bhave's reform ideology had helped to nurture an ethical atmosphere in Indian public life. In this connection, evaluate the relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in modern times.	10	APPSC 2023
13. Attitude: Content, Functions, its influence and relation with thought and behaviour, Moral and Political attitudes, role of social influence and persuasion. Emotional intelligence Concepts and their utilities and application in Administration and Governance			
(i) Attitude-its influence and relation with thought and behaviour	8. Define attitude. How does attitude affect the behaviour of public servants?	10	APPSC 2025
	9. Explain the difference between cognitive, affective and behavioural components of attitude with suitable examples in the public service context.	10	APPSC 2025
(ii) Moral and Political attitudes	10. Do attitudes influence behaviour? Discuss the polarization of political attitudes in India.	10	APPSC 2023
	11. Define moral attitude and explain the four qualities of moral attitude. What are the factors that shape political attitude?	10	APPSC 2020
(iii) Role of Social influence and persuasion	12. Define Persuasion and its constructs. Can the power of Persuasion be used by civil servants in order to realize the ends and objectives of a New India? Substantiate.	10	APPSC 2023

(iv) Emotional intelligence Concepts and their utilities and application in Administration and Governance	13. Explain the concept of emotional intelligence with special reference to the three main models of emotional intelligence. How are emotional intelligence applied in administration and governance?	10	APPSC 2020
14. Concept of Public Service, "Philosophical basis of Governance professional Ethics in the light of right understanding and Vision for Holistic Technologies, Codes of Ethics, codes of Conduct, RTI, Public Service Act, Leadership Ethics, Work culture, Ethical principles within an Organizational content. - Ethical and moral values in governance, Ethical issues in international relations, corruption, Lokpal, Lokayukta			
(i) Concept of Public Service	14. Define public service broadly. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. Suggest three preventive measures of corruption.	10	APPSC 2020
Basic Knowledge of Laws in India			
15. Constitution of India: Nature and salient features – Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy – Bifurcation of powers between centre and state (state list, union list and concurrent list) – Powers of judiciary, executive and legislature. Civil and Criminal laws: hierarchy of civil and criminal courts in India – difference between substantial and procedural laws – order and decree - new developments in criminal laws, Nirbhaya Act.Labour Law: Concept of social welfare legislations in India, changing trends in employment and necessity for new labour laws.Cyber Laws: Information Technology Act – Cyber Security and Cyber Crime – difficulties in determining competent jurisdiction of courts in case of cyber-crimes.Tax Laws: Laws relating to income, Profits, Wealth Tax, Corporate Tax – GST			
(i) Fundamental Rights	15. The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights?	10	APPSC 2025
	16. 'Article 21 of the Indian Constitution facilitates the expansion of the scope of Fundamental Rights'. Comment.	10	TGPSC 2024
	17. 'Indian Constitution promotes rule of law. Examine in the light of constitutional provisions.	10	TGPSC 2024
	18. Examine the scope of 'reasonable restrictions' and the 'test of reasonableness' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution.	10	APPSC 2023
	19. Describe the various special provisions in the constitution relating to scheduled castes, scheduled tribes, backward classes and Anglo- Indians.	10	APPSC 2016
	20. Discuss the scope and nature of Freedom of speech and Expression in India. Explain the emerging dimensions of the freedom.	10	TGPSC 2016
	21. Discuss if the right to vote is statutory, constitutional or fundamental right.	10	TGPSC 2016
	22. Discuss the scope of special provisions for Backward classes and the test to determine Backward classes.	10	TGPSC 2016

	Discuss the difference in the scope of provisions under Article 15(4) and 16(4).		
	23. Explain the Right to Equality guaranteed under the Constitution of India in-the light of the doctrine of reasonable classification.	10	APPSC 2012
(ii) Constitution of India and salient features	24. Critically Examine different models of Secularism in India.	10	TGPSC 2024
(iii) Directive (iv) Principles of State Policy	25. Analyse the effectiveness of implementation of Directive Principles of State policy and suggest ways to improve it.	10	APPSC 2016
	26. Discuss the right to legal aid and whether it is a Fundamental Right or Directive principle of State policy.	10	TGPSC 2016
	27. Analyse the concept and importance of Directive Principles of State Policy. Explain the relationship and difference between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles.	10	APPSC 2012
	28. Trace the genesis and development of Uniform Civil code in India. Cite authoritative judgments on this issue.	10	APPSC 2011
(v) Civil and Criminal laws	29. Analyse the aims and objectives of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989. Explain whether such objectives have been achieved.	10	APPSC 2012
(vi) Cyber Crime	30. What do you understand by cyberstalking? What are the various other cyber offences recognised under Information Technology Act, 2000?	10	APPSC 2025
	31. Explain the different types of cybercrimes and the importance of cyber laws in India.	10	APPSC 2020
(vii) Tax Laws-GST	32. What is GST? Discuss the regulatory framework of GST in India, including Constitutional provisions applicable to GST.	10	APPSC 2025

Mains PYQs | Paper-III | Section-C | Model Answers

C. Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law

11. Ethics and Human Interface: Essence, determinants and Consequences of Ethics in Human actions: dimensions of Ethics: Ethics in Private and Public relationships, Ethics-integrity and Accountability

1. What is meant by 'International Ethics'? Explain the significance of ethics in international dispute resolutions and environmental cooperation among nations. (APPSC, 2023)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Ethics and Human Interface
Keyword	What, Explain
Approach	• Begin by defining International Ethics as moral principles guiding relations among nations beyond legal obligations. • Explain its role in promoting peaceful dispute resolution, supported with one or two examples. Next, discuss its significance in environmental cooperation. • Conclude by emphasizing its necessity for global peace and sustainable development.
Introduction	International ethics refers to the study and application of moral principles, norms, and standards that guide interactions among nations, international organizations, and non-state actors in the global context. It addresses the moral dimensions of global challenges such as human rights, global justice, the use of force, and environmental sustainability, seeking to create a fairer and more just international community beyond national self-interest.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Significance of Ethics in International Dispute Resolutions:** • **Promotes Peaceful Conflict Settlement:** ✓ Institutions like the International Court of Justice (ICJ) and the Permanent Court of Arbitration rely on principles like fairness, sovereignty recognition, and peaceful coexistence. ✓ Example: The ICJ verdict in the maritime dispute between India and Bangladesh (2014) was accepted peacefully by both nations, demonstrating ethical respect for international legal decisions. • **Strengthens Trust and Cooperation:** ✓ Ethical conduct increases mutual trust among states, making agreements more sustainable. Trust reduces security dilemmas and promotes stable diplomatic relations. ✓ Example: The India-Sri Lanka Maritime Boundary Agreements (1974, 1976) reflected mutual trust and respect for sovereignty. • **Prevents Power Exploitation:** ✓ They ensure equal participation and protect smaller countries from unfair political or economic pressure. ✓ Example: The UN Charter emphasizes equality of all member nations, regardless of power and wealth. • **Upholds Humanitarian Values:** ✓ Ethics guides responses to crises such as war, genocide, and refugee emergencies. ✓ Example: International pressure against apartheid in South Africa was rooted in the global ethical stance against racial discrimination. **Significance of Ethics in Environmental Cooperation:** • **Addresses Global and Shared Challenges:**

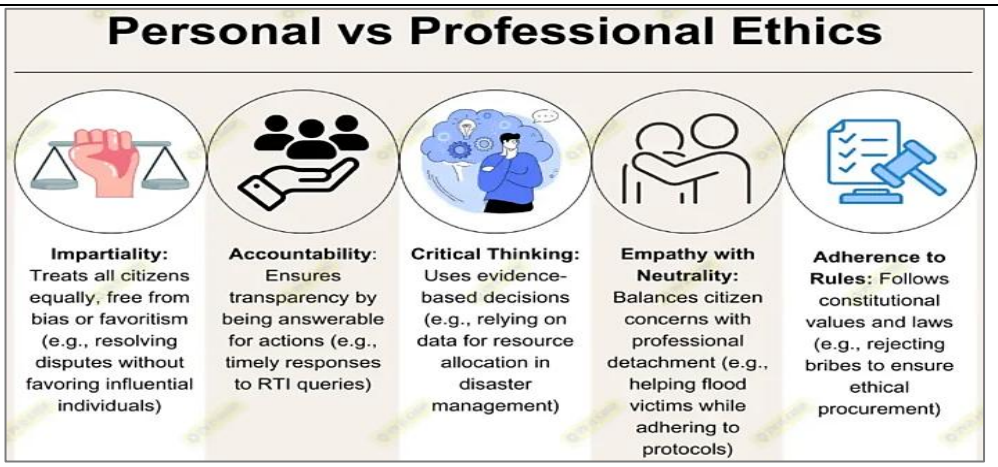
	✓ Issues like climate change, ozone depletion, biodiversity loss, and marine pollution transcend borders. Ethical responsibility fosters collective action. ✓ Example: The Paris Climate Agreement (2015) is based on the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities", recognizing fairness between developed and developing nations. • **Ensures Intergenerational Justice:** ✓ Environmental ethics emphasize sustainability—meeting present needs without harming future generations. ✓ Countries are encouraged to adopt green energy, reduce emissions, and conserve ecosystems. • **Promotes Equitable Resource Sharing:** ✓ Ethics ensures fair access to global commons such as oceans, forests, and atmosphere. ✓ Example: The Antarctic Treaty (1959) preserves Antarctica for peaceful scientific use, preventing militarization and over-exploitation. • **Encourages Corporate and Civil Accountability:** ✓ Transnational corporations and civil society groups are expected to act responsibly. Principles such as ESG (Environmental, Social, Governance) promote ethical business practices globally.
Conclusion	International Ethics forms the moral backbone of global interactions, ensuring that power is exercised responsibly and disputes are resolved peacefully. Its role is crucial in fostering trust, protecting human dignity, and promoting sustainable development. In an interconnected world facing global challenges from conflicts to climate change ethical cooperation among nations is not merely idealistic, but essential for global peace, justice, and shared prosperity.
Model Question	What is meant by "Global Justice"? Discuss how global justice shapes international relations and contributes to peace-building among nations.
Value Addition	**Global Justice:** • Global justice is the concept that fairness, human rights, and resources should be distributed equitably among all individuals worldwide, regardless of their nationality. • It shifts the focus from justice between states (international justice) to justice for individual human beings, addressing global issues like poverty, inequality, environmental concerns, and human rights through shared moral obligations.
2. Does popular democracy breed distrust in the public towards their representatives? Discuss the scope of ethical leadership in democracy and politics. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Ethics in Private and Public relationships
Keyword	Does, Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by linking democracy with representation and trust, and highlight how failures in governance can create distrust. • Discuss causes of distrust in popular democracy and examine how ethical leadership through integrity, accountability, justice, and inclusiveness can bridge the gap. • Conclude by emphasizing that ethical leadership is essential to sustain trust, strengthen democratic institutions, and ensure citizen-centric governance.
Introduction	Popular democracy, built on the principles of representation, accountability, and public trust, seeks to empower citizens through elected representatives. However, increasing corruption, populist politics, unfulfilled promises, and erosion of values often create distrust between people and their representatives. The role of ethical leadership thus becomes central in bridging this gap and ensuring the health of democracy.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Popular Democracy and Public Distrust:** • **Erosion of trust:** As per a Lokniti-CSDS survey, nearly half of Indian voters expressed doubt over their representatives' sincerity in addressing citizens' concerns. • **Causes of distrust:** ✓ **Populism and short-termism:** Leaders often resort to populist schemes for electoral gains rather than long-term public welfare. ✓ **Corruption and nepotism:** Reports from Transparency International highlight how corruption erodes credibility of institutions. ✓ **Weak accountability:** Despite mechanisms like RTI and Lokpal, lack of transparency in decision-making breeds suspicion. ✓ Recent examples: Instances like electoral bond controversies and delayed action in public scandals have intensified public doubts about representative intent. **Scope of Ethical Leadership in Democracy and Politics:** Ethical leadership is essential to restore public trust and ensure democratic resilience. Its scope can be examined under: • **Promoting Integrity and Transparency:** ✓ Leaders who uphold moral courage, honesty, and transparency help restore credibility. ✓ Example: E. Sreedharan ("Metro Man"), known for ethical leadership, upheld transparency in Delhi Metro projects without political interference. • **Ensuring Accountability:** ✓ Ethical leaders are guided by principles of responsibility, accepting consequences of decisions. ✓ Example: IAS officer Armstrong Pame, who built a road in Manipur with community participation, demonstrated accountability and responsiveness. • **Upholding Rule of Law and Justice:** ✓ Democratic ethics demand fairness, inclusiveness, and protection of rights. ✓ Example: Dr. B.R. Ambedkar's emphasis on constitutional morality continues to guide ethical leadership in ensuring justice. • **Long-Term Vision over Populism:** ✓ Ethical leadership moves beyond electoral cycles and addresses structural issues like climate change, inequality, and education. ✓ Example: Leaders like Lal Bahadur Shastri, with his "Jai Jawan Jai Kisan" slogan, emphasized long-term national integration rather than populism. • **Promoting Participatory Democracy:** ✓ By promoting citizen engagement and inclusivity, ethical leaders can reduce the gap between representatives and the public. ✓ Example: Initiatives like participatory budgeting in Kerala highlight the role of ethics in inclusive governance. **Challenges in Practicing Ethical Leadership:** • Political pressures and electoral compulsions. ✓ Example: The 2024 Lok Sabha elections saw widespread use of populist schemes and targeted freebies, raising concerns about fiscal prudence and ethical governance • Influence of money and muscle power in elections. ✓ Example: The seizure of over ₹8,889 crore worth of cash, liquor, and freebies during the 2024 Lok Sabha elections (the highest ever) highlighted how the nexus of money and power undermines ethical leadership and fair competition. • Media sensationalism and misinformation undermining genuine efforts.

Conclusion	While popular democracy may sometimes breed distrust due to failures of representation, ethical leadership provides a corrective pathway. Leaders rooted in integrity, justice, accountability, and public service can transform democracy into a system of genuine trust and participation. Strengthening institutional ethics, promoting civic education, and nurturing ethical leaders are crucial for sustaining democracy in India.
Model Question	Evaluate the importance of ethical values such as transparency, integrity, and empathy in addressing the challenges of distrust in popular democracy.
Value Addition	• The Former Vice-President of India, Shri Jagdeep Dhankhar underscored the importance of core values in leadership, and cautioned the youth against succumbing to temptations and unethical shortcuts. "Ethical leadership is non-negotiable; compromising ethics cannot make you a winner of the kind that the world will salute. • Vice-President highlighted youth role as 'torchbearers of India's future' and urged them to be harbingers and ambassadors of a society where there is scrupulous and meticulous adherence to rule of law.
3. "Ethics in public service is an essential component of parliamentary democracy" - In this connection, discuss the pathway towards a 'Naitik Bharat'. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Ethics in Private and Public relationships
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by highlighting the significance of ethics in public service as the moral foundation of parliamentary democracy. • Discuss how ethical governance, institutional mechanisms, and citizen participation can shape the pathway towards a Naitik Bharat, citing examples of leaders and practices. • Conclude by emphasizing that blending constitutional ideals with timeless ethical values is essential for building a just and moral democracy.
Introduction	Ethics in public service is the moral backbone of parliamentary democracy, ensuring governance rests on fairness, integrity, and justice beyond mere procedures. Without ethical conduct, democracy risks corruption, populism, and declining public trust. Building a *Naitik Bharat* (Moral India) requires nurturing a political and administrative culture rooted in accountability, transparency, and service to the people.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Ethics in Public Service and Democracy:** • **Accountability and Trust:** ✓ Ethical behavior in public service strengthens citizens' faith in parliamentary democracy. ✓ Instances of corruption scandals undermine this trust, while examples like E. Sreedharan's integrity in the Delhi Metro project illustrate ethical leadership. • **Constitutional Mandate:** ✓ The ideals of justice, equality, and liberty enshrined in the Preamble and Fundamental Duties highlight that democracy is inseparable from morality. • **Gandhian Ideals:** ✓ Mahatma Gandhi's emphasis on *Sarvodaya* and truth (*Satya*) stressed the role of ethical conduct in politics, which remains a guiding principle for *Naitik Bharat*. **Challenges to Ethical Governance:** • **Erosion of Values:** Rising corruption, nepotism, and criminalization of politics weaken moral governance. ✓ Example: Nearly 44% of Lok Sabha MPs (2024) faced criminal charges, with 29% facing serious allegations like murder and kidnapping; Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Bihar have over 50% of MPs with criminal cases.

	• **Populism vs. Policy:** Short-term populist promises often undermine long-term ethical policymaking. • **Decline of Civic Morality:** As seen in increasing distrust in elected representatives, the gap between people's aspirations and actual governance widens. ✓ Only 30% trust political parties, while Election Commission, CBI, and Parliament fare higher, per the Ipsos IndiaBus survey (2024). **Pathway to a Naitik Bharat:** • **Institutional Strengthening:** ✓ Stronger enforcement by bodies like Lokpal, CVC, and CAG ensures ethical oversight. ✓ Parliamentary committees (PAC, Ethics Committee) must actively monitor misconduct. • **Value-Based Leadership:** ✓ Leaders like Lal Bahadur Shastri, who embodied simplicity and honesty, set models for ethical political culture. ✓ In June 2025, Arpit Sagar, District Collector of MahiSagar of Gujarat, imposed a daily fine of ₹500 on an NHAI official for failing to fix potholes on NH-47. Her decisive action ensured swift repairs and demonstrated accountability. • **Citizen-Centric Governance:** ✓ Policies like Right to Information (RTI) and Digital India enhance transparency. ✓ E-governance reduces human discretion, curbing corruption. • **Ethics in Education and Training:** ✓ Inclusion of ethics in civil services training (like at LBSNAA) builds a culture of integrity. ✓ Example: Village Immersion Programmes", by LBSNAA, where Officer Trainees directly engage with grassroots communities, helping them internalize values of empathy, humility, and accountability. ✓ Civic education in schools fosters moral citizenship from a young age. ✓ Example: Kendriya Vidyalayas conduct "Integrity Clubs" • **Cultural and Spiritual Anchors:** ✓ Teachings from Indian philosophy like Dharma in the Bhagavadh Gita, Buddha's Middle Path—provide ethical grounding for governance. ✓ Values of compassion and service from figures like Mother Teresa highlight universal moral responsibility.
Conclusion	A Naitik Bharat emerges when leaders, public servants, and citizens uphold integrity, transparency, and service. Ethics in governance, supported by strong institutions, civic participation, and education, ensures accountability in parliamentary democracy. Blending constitutional ideals with ethical values transforms democracy into not just governance, but a way of life rooted in justice, fairness, and moral responsibility.
Model Question	"Moral leadership is cultivated, not inherited." Examine this statement in the context of ethics in civil services training and civic education.
Value Addition	• Ethics of Public Service should be the cornerstone of all trainings of Union Government and State Governments. Civil Servants should be told that they should endeavour to go beyond their normal duty to serve public better, that ethics makes their duty bigger, it makes their duty more meaningful, it makes their duty more uplifting. • Ethics of Public Service urges us to do more than what is expected of us. Popular discontent with the conduct of civil services has a universal dimension when the citizen is asked to wait for legitimate rights from Government, and there is dilution of integrity of institutions.

	• This happens when civil servants begin to consider themselves bigger than the institution to which they belong, showing a contempt for the service in which they spend their life.
4. How does time and space effect ethics in private and public relationships? Illustrate (APPSC 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Ethics in Private and Public relationships
Keyword	How, Illustrate
Approach	• Begin with defining ethics and introduce how context shapes ethical behaviour. • Use time and space as analytical lenses. Divide discussion into private relationships (emotion, trust, long-term bonding) and public relationships (formal rules, neutrality, accountability) and Provide brief, relatable examples in each section. • Conclude by emphasizing the need for balance, guided by constitutional and professional values.
Introduction	Ethics is not practiced in isolation; it is shaped by the context in which individuals interact. The dimensions of time (duration of relationships) and space (the environment in which relationships operate) significantly influence how ethical values are formed, expressed, and sustained in both private and public spheres. Understanding these influences becomes essential for evaluating human behaviour in family settings as well as in institutions, governance, and society.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Ethics in Private Relationships:** • Private relationships such as those within families, friendships, or close communities are shaped by intimacy, emotional bonding, and trust. • **Here, time plays a major role:** ✓ Long-term memories and shared experiences deepen emotional ties and expectations of loyalty and empathy. ✓ Ethical decisions in private spaces are often influenced by affection, compassion, and forgiveness. ✓ Example: Parents often make sacrifices for children driven not by formal duty, but by long-term emotional bonds strengthened over time. • **Space also influences the nature of ethical behaviour:** ✓ Private spaces allow informal interactions, enabling emotional expression and flexibility in judgment. ✓ Mistakes are more easily forgiven, and moral standards may be personalized rather than universal. • However, time can also erode ethical values if relationships become transactional or strained. Similarly, when private spaces are dominated by hierarchy (e.g., patriarchal households), ethics may be shaped by power rather than equality. **Ethics in Public Relationships:** • Public relationships such as those among colleagues, administrators, citizens, or strangers are shaped by formal rules, institutions, and social expectations. • **Here, time influences reputation, credibility, and professional trust**. ✓ Long-term consistent ethical behaviour increases respect and reliability, while even a single unethical act can damage public trust permanently. ✓ Example: A civil servant who consistently displays integrity over the years earns public respect and becomes a role model. • **Space in public settings promotes objectivity, fairness, and impartiality.** ✓ Ethical conduct must be based on universal values like justice, equality, and transparency rather than personal bias or emotional attachment. ✓ This is why civil servants must distinguish between personal sympathy and rules.

	✓ **For example**, a public official cannot favour a relative in job recruitment. Public space demands neutrality, unlike the emotional flexibility of private settings. **Intersection and Ethical Dilemmas:** • Conflicts arise when private ethics clash with public ethics. • For instance: ✓ A police officer may face pressure to shield a family member involved in wrongdoing, where private loyalty clashes with the public duty of upholding law. ✓ A doctor treating a relative may unintentionally let emotional closeness cloud professional judgment. • In such cases, ethical frameworks like constitutional morality, professional codes of conduct, and public accountability guide the individual to prioritize public ethics.
Conclusion	Time builds trust in both private and public relationships, but the ethical expectations differ. Private ethics emphasize compassion and personal loyalty, while public ethics demand impartiality and fairness. Space further shapes how these values are expressed: intimate spaces allow emotional flexibility, while public spaces require objective adherence to rules. A morally mature individual balances both spheres, ensuring neither personal affection nor professional responsibility undermines ethical integrity.
Model Question	"Emotional values guide private life, whereas rational values guide public life." Discuss with suitable illustrations.
Value Addition	
12. Human values: Understanding the Harmony in existence Human relationships in the society and in the Nature. Gender Equability in the relationships- Role of family, society and Educational Institutions in imparting values to citizens, lessons from the lives and teachings of great leaders, reformers and administrations	
5. Discuss the significance of values in the development of personality and socio-cultural systems. Add a brief note on the hierarchy of values in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Human values
Keyword	Discuss, Add a brief note
Approach	• Begin by defining values and linking them to personality development. • Explain how values shape moral behaviour, identity, decision-making, and motivation in individuals. Then discuss their role in socio-cultural systems. Finally, add a brief note on the Indian hierarchy of values, highlighting the primacy of spiritual and ethical values over material pursuits. • Conclude with a balanced closing statement.
Introduction	Values are fundamental beliefs that guide an individual's actions and judgments about what is desirable or undesirable. They are the moral compass that shapes a person's character and serve as the ethical bedrock of societal institutions.

Body & Infographic Representation	**Significance of Values in Personality Development:** • **Moral Foundation:** ✓ Values such as honesty, integrity, compassion, and responsibility build a moral base for individuals. A person guided by ethical values develops self-discipline and emotional maturity, leading to a stable and positive personality. • **Identity and Self-Concept:** ✓ Values contribute to shaping one's identity. For example, a person who values hard work and perseverance sees challenges as opportunities for growth. This influences self-confidence and self-esteem. • **Behavioural Regulation:** ✓ Values act as internal regulators of conduct. They help individuals control impulses, make thoughtful decisions, and behave appropriately in various social contexts. For instance, the value of respect encourages polite and empathetic behaviour. • **Motivation and Goal Setting:** ✓ Values provide direction in life. If an individual values education, they set academic goals and work consistently to achieve them. Thus, values influence priorities and long-term aspirations. **Significance of Values in Socio-Cultural Systems:** • **Social Harmony and Integration:** ✓ Values such as cooperation, tolerance, and justice help maintain social order. They reduce conflicts and promote mutual trust among diverse groups. • **Preservation of Culture and Traditions:** ✓ Values are transmitted across generations through family, religion, and educational systems. This ensures cultural continuity. For example, the Indian value of Guru-Shishya Parampara preserves learning traditions. • **Collective Identity and Unity:** ✓ Shared values bind people into a collective identity. National values like sovereignty, patriotism, and unity strengthen social solidarity. • **Social Change and Reform:** ✓ Values also drive reform when societies recognize the need for equality and justice. For example, the value of gender equality is reshaping modern Indian social practices. **Hierarchy of Values in India:** • **Spiritual Values (Paramarthika values):** ✓ Emphasis on truth (Satya), non-violence (Ahimsa), compassion (Karuna), and self-realization. These are inspired by traditions like Hinduism, Jainism, and Buddhism. • **Social and Ethical Values (Vyavaharika values):** ✓ Respect for elders, family loyalty, hospitality, duty (Dharma), and community service. These values regulate social life. • **Material Values (Arthika values):** ✓ Economic well-being, career aspirations, and comfort. These are important but traditionally placed below moral and spiritual values.
Conclusion	Values are the foundation of both individual personality and socio-cultural systems. They shape behaviour, guide social relationships, and ensure harmony within society. In India, the hierarchy of values places spiritual and ethical principles above material pursuits, reflecting a holistic approach to human development.
Model Question	Explain how values influence the formation of personality. Illustrate with suitable examples.

Value Addition	• The concept of "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam" (The world is one family) reflects core Indian cultural values by emphasizing universal brotherhood, interconnectedness, compassion, and respect for all living beings. • It promotes a worldview where all of humanity and all life forms are part of a single, interdependent family, which fosters peace, cooperation, tolerance, and shared responsibility for the planet.
6. What is the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating values? (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Indian Society, Structure, Issues and Social Movements: Role of family, society and Educational Institutions in imparting values to citizens
Keyword	What
Approach	• State that value formation is foundational to character building and social harmony. • Explain how family, society, and educational institutions each contribute uniquely to inculcating values. • Emphasize the need for a collaborative, lifelong approach to nurture ethically responsible citizens.
Introduction	Values are guiding principles that shape human behaviour and social harmony. The family, society, and educational institutions play a crucial role in nurturing these values, especially in a culturally diverse and democratic nation like India.
Body & Infographic Representation	• **Role of Family: The First School of Values** ✓ Primary socialisation occurs within the family. It shapes early moral and emotional development. ✓ Parents instil core values such as truth, empathy, discipline, respect, and responsibility. ✓ The National Curriculum Framework (NCF 2005) highlights the role of family in value inculcation during foundational years. ✓ For example, in joint families, children often learn collectivism, cooperation, and care for elders through daily interactions. • **Role of Society: Cultural and Social Reinforcement** ✓ Society—through customs, peer interactions, media, and religious institutions—reinforces or challenges family-taught values. ✓ Community practices like festivals, social service, and local governance introduce values of secularism, unity, and participation. ✓ As per Gandhian philosophy, society must promote values like non-violence (Ahimsa), truth (Satya), and self-restraint. ✓ Negative influences like materialism or caste bias may also emerge, requiring critical engagement. • **Role of Educational Institutions: Structured Value Education** ✓ Schools and colleges offer structured environments for citizenship education, ethical reasoning, and empathy. For example, Andhra Pradesh's Mana Badi Mana Bhavishyathu scheme emphasizes value based education. ✓ The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 emphasizes developing constitutional values, scientific temper, and environmental ethics. ✓ Co-curricular activities, moral science, and community projects promote democracy, equality, and sustainability. ✓ Legal mandates like Article 51A (Fundamental Duties) guide institutions in inculcating civic responsibilities.
Conclusion	A synergistic role of family, society, and educational institutions is essential to build morally responsible, empathetic, and constitutionally aware citizens. Inculcating values is not a one-time process but a lifelong societal responsibility.

Model Question	Discuss the role of family, society and educational institutions in inculcating moral and civic values among citizens. How do these institutions contribute to the development of a value-based society?
Value Addition	As per NEP 2020, education must promote values like empathy, integrity, and constitutional duty. UNESCO's Global Citizenship Education emphasizes holistic value formation. Article 51A of the Indian Constitution outlines Fundamental Duties, reinforcing civic ethics. Gandhian ideals of truth and non-violence remain timeless. Integrating stories, role models, and community projects enhances value internalization across all domains.

7. Vinoba Bhave's reform ideology had helped to nurture an ethical atmosphere in Indian public life. In this connection, evaluate the relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in modern times. (APPSC, 2023)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Lessons from the lives and Teachings of great leaders
Keyword	Evaluate
Approach	• Briefly introduce Vinoba Bhave and his reform movements like Bhoodan and Sarvodaya. • Explain his core values: non-violence, trusteeship, selflessness—and their ethical influence on public life. • Evaluate their modern relevance in promoting sustainable, equitable, and ethical governance.
Introduction	Vinoba Bhave, the spiritual successor of Mahatma Gandhi, propagated an ethical reform ideology rooted in Sarvodaya (welfare of all), Bhoodan (land gift), and Ahimsa (non-violence). His movements sought to harmonise social justice with moral integrity. In modern times, his philosophy continues to inspire ethical governance, participatory democracy, and sustainable development.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Core Tenets of Vinoba Bhave's Reform Ideology** • Vinoba Bhave's ideology emphasised the ethical transformation of society rather than mere political reform. • His Bhoodan Movement (1951) urged landowners to voluntarily donate surplus land for redistribution to the landless, an early example of peaceful social equity. • He also promoted trusteeship, where wealth and resources were to be used as a social trust for the collective good. • Empirical evidence: By 1969, over 47 lakh acres of land were reportedly collected under the Bhoodan movement (Ministry of Rural Development report, 2011). **Ethical Influence on Indian Public Life** • Bhave's reformist thought infused moral values into post-independence public life by emphasising simplicity, honesty, and self-restraint. • His Sarvodaya Samaj inspired leaders like Jayaprakash Narayan and social activists such as Anna Hazare and Medha Patkar in later decades. • His approach linked spiritual ethics with civic responsibility, shaping an ethical ethos among public servants and citizens alike. • It strengthened community-based decision-making, a precursor to participatory democracy seen in Gram Sabhas and the PESA Act (1996).

	Relevance of Vinoba Bhave's ideology in Modern Times: In today's context of corruption, inequality, and ecological crisis, Vinoba's values retain strong relevance: • **Ethical Governance**: His idea of trusteeship aligns with modern Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) and ethical public administration. • **Sustainable Development**: His vision of self-reliant rural communities resonates with UN SDGs and Gandhian models of rural sustainability. • **Social Harmony**: His emphasis on non-violence and inclusivity counters rising social polarisation and intolerance in contemporary society.
Conclusion	Vinoba Bhave's ideology remains a moral compass for modern India. His principles of Sarvodaya and trusteeship offer sustainable solutions to current socio-economic challenges. Reintegrating his ethical vision can nurture an inclusive, compassionate, and morally responsible public life.
Model Question	Assess how the principles of Vinoba Bhave's Sarvodaya and Bhoodan movements can contribute to ethical governance and social justice in contemporary India.
Value Addition	Acharya Vinoba Bhave, a revered religious leader in India, founded the Bhoodan movement and started this at Pochampally. Bhoodan translates as a land donation. As suggested by the movement's name, landowners voluntarily give up their property so that it can be transferred to labourers who are without land, who will subsequently cultivate it. The gap between the rich and the poor is meant to be closed through this. In this case, there is no payment made to the land givers. Bhave has travelled all over India over the 13-year duration of this movement. He gathered 4.4 million acres of land to give to farmers who were without land. He founded the Gramdan movement in 1954, which called for the voluntary surrender of entire villages. These movements won praise from all over the world for setting the bar so high for selfless social justice.
13. Attitude: Content, Functions, its influence and relation with thought and behaviour, Moral and Political attitudes, role of Social influence and persuasion. Emotional intelligence Concepts and their utilities and application in Administration and Governance	
8. Define attitude. How does attitude affect the behaviour of public servants? (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Attitude-its influence and relation with thought and behaviour
Keyword	Define, How
Approach	• Define attitude as a psychological tendency toward people/situations. • Show how attitudes (positive/negative) affect behaviour, decision-making, integrity, and empathy in public service. • Conclude that Right attitude ensures citizen-centric and ethical governance.
Introduction	Attitude is a psychological tendency expressed by evaluating a person, situation, or event either positively or negatively. It is formed through beliefs, values, experiences, and socialisation. For public servants, attitude is crucial as it shapes their decision-making, interaction with citizens, and commitment to public welfare.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Definition of Attitude:** • Social psychologists define attitude as a learned predisposition to respond consistently favourably or unfavourably toward an object, person, or situation. • It has three components such as cognitive (beliefs), affective (feelings), and behavioural (actions). **Impact of Attitude on the behaviour of Public Servants:** • **Citizen-Centric Service Delivery:** ✓ A positive attitude fosters empathy, patience, and efficiency in handling citizens' grievances.

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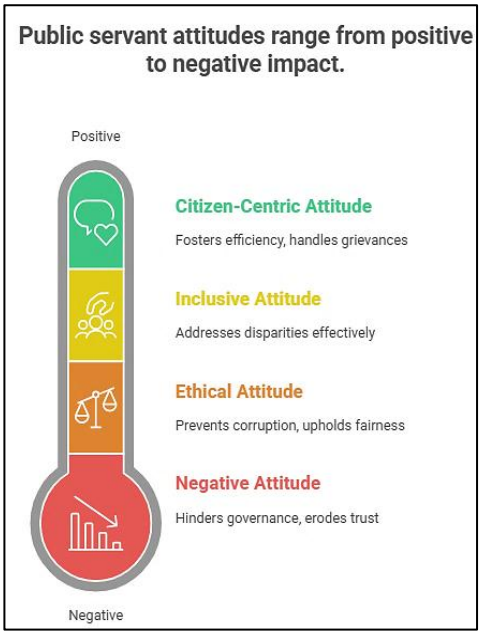
✓ Example: A civil servant with a pro-poor attitude ensures proper implementation of welfare schemes like PMAY or MGNREGA.

Ethical and Responsive Governance:

✓ Attitudes toward integrity and honesty prevent corruption and misuse of authority.
✓ Example: Officers inspired by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's ideal of "steel frame" uphold neutrality and fairness.

Handling Diversity and Inclusiveness:

✓ An inclusive attitude helps in addressing gender, caste, and regional disparities.
✓ Example: Public servants with a gender-sensitive attitude ensure effective implementation of Beti Bachao Beti Padhao.



Resistance or Bias: Negative attitudes such as apathy, arrogance, or caste bias hinder efficient governance and erode public trust.

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<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>Attitude significantly influences the conduct of public servants by shaping their responses to administrative challenges. A positive, citizen-centric, and ethical attitude ensures transparency, accountability, and people-friendly governance. Thus, nurturing the right attitude through training, value inculcation, and ethical codes is essential for building a responsive civil service in a democracy like India.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>Define attitude. How do attitudes of public servants influence their behaviour and decision-making in administration? Explain with examples.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>Role of attitude in shaping the success of individuals in their pursuit of civil services:

Motivation and Persistence: A positive attitude helps individuals stay motivated and persistent throughout their preparation. Example: T.N. Shesan`s persistence despite political pressure led to electoral reforms.
Resilience and Adaptability: They are more likely to learn from their experiences, make necessary adjustments, and adapt their strategies to improve themselves. Example Ramesh, DM of Chennai, actively engages with the community, listens to their concerns, and strives to find effective solutions to address them.
Self-Belief and Confidence: A positive attitude helps individuals believe in themselves and their abilities.
Goal Orientation and Focus: Individuals with a positive attitude are more likely to set clear goals and maintain focus on them.
Optimism and Problem-Solving: With a positive mindset, individuals can think creatively, find alternative solutions, and overcome difficult situations effectively.
Emotional Intelligence and Interpersonal Skills: A positive attitude helps individuals develop emotional intelligence and interpersonal skills necessary for effective communication, teamwork, and building relationships.
</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">9. Explain the difference between cognitive, affective, and behavioural components of attitude with suitable examples in the public service context. (APPSC, 2025)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Syllabus</td><td>Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Attitude-its influence and relation with thought and behaviour</td></tr>
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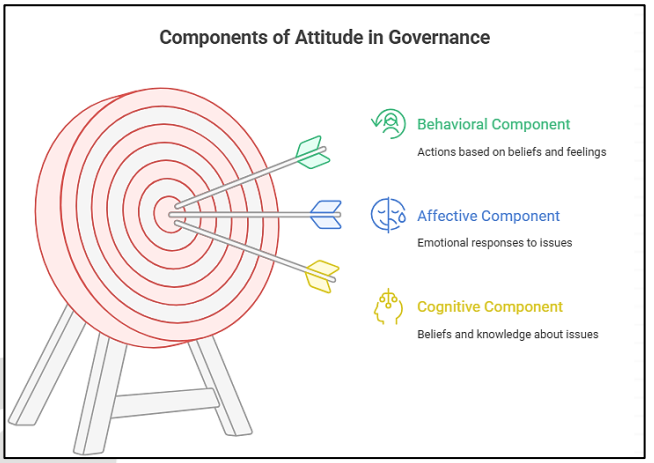
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Define three components of attitude. • Explain Cognitive (beliefs), Affective (feelings), Behavioural (action), with public service examples like belief in equality, empathy toward the poor, delivering welfare schemes fairly. • Conclude that Balanced components foster good governance.
Introduction	Attitude is a learned predisposition to respond positively or negatively toward a person, issue, or situation. It is not a single trait but a combination of three components: cognitive, affective, and behavioural. In public service, these components shape how administrators perceive issues, feel about them, and act in governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The difference between cognitive, affective and behavioural components of attitude:** • **Cognitive Component of attitude (Beliefs and Knowledge):** ✓ It refers to what a person knows or believes about an issue. ✓ Example: A public servant's belief that "corruption undermines democracy" shapes their stand against unethical practices. ✓ In governance, cognitive awareness of poverty, inequality, or climate change motivates evidence-based policymaking.  • **Affective Component of Attitude (Feelings and Emotions):** ✓ It involves the emotional response to an issue or situation. ✓ Example: A civil servant feeling empathy for marginalised groups may prioritise welfare schemes like PM Poshan or MGNREGA. ✓ Similarly, compassion during Disasters drives officials to work beyond office hours for relief and rehabilitation. • **Behavioural Component of attitude (Action and Conduct):** ✓ It reflects the actual behaviour or intended action based on beliefs and feelings. ✓ Example: An officer believing in equality (cognitive) and feeling empathy (affective) may actively promote gender budgeting or ensure fair distribution of rations under PDS. ✓ It shows how attitudes translate into administrative decisions and public interactions.
Conclusion	The cognitive, affective, and behavioural components of attitude are interrelated and together determine how public servant's function. A balanced and positive attitude ensures integrity, empathy, and responsiveness in governance. Training, ethical orientation, and exposure to citizen issues are essential to develop such attitudes, strengthening democratic administration in India.
Model Question	Explain the cognitive, affective, and behavioural components of attitude with relevant examples from the context of public service.
Value Addition	**Techniques to Bring Change in Attitude:**

	• **Classical/ Pavlovian Conditioning:** In this technique, the person is exposed to a positive and neutral stimulus repeatedly, and after some time, the response to neutral stimuli becomes the same as the response to positive stimuli. • **Instrumental Conditioning:** ✓ A process in which a positive behaviour, when rewarded, has more chances of repetition, unlike the negative behaviour, which, if repeated, would lead to punishment and thus fewer chances of repetition. ✓ Example: Parents celebrating the success of a child by praising them among friends will form a positive attitude of the child towards success. Further, when parents punish the child for their mistakes, it discourages the child from making those mistakes again. • **Social Observation:** This involves learning from our social environment, such as family, school, media, and its expression.
10. Do attitudes influence behaviour? Discuss the polarisation of political attitudes in India. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Moral and Political attitudes
Keyword	Do, Discuss
Approach	• Define attitude and its link with human behaviour. • Discuss how cognitive, affective, and behavioural components shape political actions, leading to ideological polarisation. • Highlight the need for ethical awareness and civic education to depolarise society.
Introduction	Attitudes are mental predispositions that shape how individuals perceive, evaluate, and respond to situations or people. They strongly influence behaviour through the cognitive, affective, and behavioural components of human personality. In India, the growing polarisation of political attitudes reflects how values, emotions, and group identities translate into divergent behavioural patterns in society.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Relationship Between Attitude and Behaviour** • Attitudes significantly determine an individual's choices, political participation, and interpersonal conduct. • According to Ajzen's Theory of Planned Behaviour (1991), behaviour is guided by intentions formed through attitudes, perceived norms, and control over actions. • For example, citizens with positive attitudes toward environmental responsibility are more likely to practice eco-friendly behaviour such as waste segregation or voting for green policies. • Conversely, negative attitudes toward government initiatives can result in resistance or apathy toward civic duties. **Polarisation of Political Attitudes in India** • Political polarisation refers to the ideological division of citizens into contrasting and rigid camps. • In India, this phenomenon has intensified due to identity politics, media influence, and social media algorithms that reinforce echo chambers. • The Lokniti-CSDS Survey (2022) indicates a growing partisan divide among urban and rural voters based on religion, caste, and regional identity. • The rise of majoritarian and minority-based politics, coupled with digital misinformation, deepens ideological separation. • Emotional appeals in political campaigns influence voters' affective attitudes more than rational discourse, leading to behavioural polarisation such as protests, online trolling, or selective media consumption.

	Ethical and Democratic Implications • This polarisation undermines democratic dialogue and tolerance, key components of ethical citizenship. When attitudes become rigid, confirmation bias and in-group loyalty replace rational public debate. • Efforts such as civic education, media literacy, and deliberative democracy platforms are essential to bridge the attitudinal divide and restore behavioural balance in politics.
Conclusion	Attitudes deeply influence behaviour by shaping perceptions, emotions, and actions. The polarisation of political attitudes in India highlights how biases distort civic reasoning and social cohesion. Promoting ethical awareness and inclusive dialogue is crucial to transforming divisive attitudes into constructive democratic behaviour.
Model Question	Examine the relationship between individual attitudes and behavioural outcomes in the political sphere. How has ideological polarisation affected democratic discourse in India?
Value Addition	**Theories Linking Attitude and Behaviour** • **Cognitive Dissonance Theory (Festinger, 1957):** Inconsistency between attitude and behaviour creates discomfort, leading to attitude change. • **Self-Perception Theory (Bem, 1972):** People infer their attitudes by observing their own behaviour. • **Balance Theory (Heider):** People seek psychological balance between beliefs, attitudes, and relationships.
11. Define moral attitude and explain the four qualities of moral attitude. What are the factors that shape political attitude? (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Moral and Political attitudes
Keyword	Define, Explain, What
Approach	• Define moral attitude as a value-based orientation guiding ethical judgment. • Explain four qualities like honesty, empathy, integrity, and fairness—then list socio-cultural, family, media, and educational factors shaping political attitude. • Emphasise moral attitude as the foundation for responsible political conduct.
Introduction	A moral attitude refers to a stable and value-based orientation of mind that guides an individual's judgments of right and wrong. It determines one's ethical conduct, empathy, and integrity in public and private life. Understanding moral attitude is essential for building a just, accountable, and participatory democracy.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Definition of Moral Attitude** • Moral attitude is a psychological disposition that directs human behaviour according to moral values such as honesty, fairness, compassion, and justice. • It links the internal conscience with external action. It is shaped by moral reasoning and emotional intelligence, which guide individuals in ethical decision-making. • Example: A civil servant refusing a bribe despite pressure demonstrates a strong moral attitude guided by integrity and fairness. **Four Qualities of Moral Attitude** • **Integrity:** ✓ The consistency between values and actions. ✓ Integrity ensures transparency and accountability in personal and public life. ✓ Example: IAS officer Armstrong Pame built a road in Manipur through public contribution, reflecting moral integrity. • **Empathy:** ✓ The ability to understand and share others' feelings, ensuring humane and compassionate behaviour.

	✓ Example: Civil servants involved in disaster relief show empathy toward affected citizens. • **Honesty:** ✓ Truthfulness in thought, speech, and action, creating trust in relationships and institutions. ✓ According to the Transparency International (2023) Corruption Perceptions Index, nations with higher honesty in governance rank higher in public trust. • **Fairness (Justice):** ✓ Impartial and equitable treatment of all individuals without bias or discrimination, strengthening social harmony. **Factors Shaping Political Attitude:** Political attitudes develop through socialisation and environmental influences such as: • **Family and upbringing:** Early exposure to political discussions shapes value orientation. • **Education:** Civics and ethics-based learning inculcate democratic values. • **Media and Technology:** Exposure to news and social media influences perception and ideology. • **Socio-economic background:** Class, caste, and economic status affect political preferences. • **Peer groups and leaders:** Influential figures shape collective political attitudes.
Conclusion	Moral attitude forms the ethical foundation of human and political behaviour. Its four qualities, such as integrity, empathy, honesty, and fairness, ensure moral governance and social trust. Strengthening these values through education and civic ethics can nurture responsible political attitudes in society.
Model Question	What do you understand by moral attitude? Describe its essential traits and analyse the social, cultural, and institutional influences that mould political attitudes in society.
Value Addition	Moral reasoning is the logical process of thinking about right and wrong, good and bad, and what one should do in a specific situation. It involves applying principles and logic, such as ethical theories, to analyse a moral issue and make a reasoned decision. While emotions play a role, moral reasoning is a conscious and reflective process aimed at reaching consistent and impartial conclusions, even though it can sometimes lead to strong conclusions that are difficult to defend logically
12. Define Persuasion and its constructs. Can the power of Persuasion be used by civil servants in order to realize the ends and objectives of a New India? Substantiate. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Role of Social influence and persuasion
Keyword	Define, Can, Substantiate
Approach	• Define persuasion and its constructs like source credibility, message, channel, and audience. • Explain how persuasive communication aids civil servants in implementing reforms, public participation, and behavioural change. • Link persuasion with New India goals—transparency, inclusivity, and citizen trust.
Introduction	Persuasion is a deliberate process of influencing people's attitudes, beliefs, or behaviours through reasoning, credibility, and emotional appeal rather than coercion. It is an ethical communication skill vital to consensus-building in governance. In a transformative era of New India, persuasion becomes a critical administrative tool for participatory and citizen-centric development.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Definition and Meaning of Persuasion:** • Persuasion is a voluntary process where individuals are motivated to change their mindset or action based on rational and emotional appeals.

	• It rests on communication ethics, convincing without manipulation, and fosters behavioural change aligned with social good. • Example: Campaigns like "Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao" and "Swachh Bharat Mission" used persuasive messages to reshape social attitudes. **Constructs of Persuasion:** According to Aristotle's Rhetorical Model and Modern Communication Theories, persuasion comprises four key constructs: • **Source Credibility (Ethos):** ✓ The trustworthiness and integrity of the communicator. ✓ Example: IAS officers like Dr. Rajendra Bharud gained credibility through transparency and community service. • **Message Content (Logos):** Logical, factual, and evidence-based argumentation ensures rational conviction. • **Emotional Appeal (Pathos):** Emotional connect encourages empathy and voluntary cooperation. • **Audience and Medium:** • Tailoring messages to the cultural and social context ensures acceptance. **Persuasion as a Tool for New India** • Civil servants can use persuasion to mobilize citizens, encourage behavioural change, and ensure inclusive policy implementation. • **Administrative Efficiency:** Persuasion helps achieve compliance without coercion, fostering public trust. • **Social Transformation**: In initiatives like Digital India and Jal Jeevan Mission, officers have used persuasion to encourage participation and technology adoption. • **Ethical Governance:** It aligns with Gandhian communication ethics, ensuring reform through dialogue rather than force.
Conclusion	Persuasion is a deliberate process of influencing people's attitudes, beliefs, or behaviours through reasoning, credibility, and emotional appeal rather than coercion. It is an ethical communication skill vital for consensus-building in governance. In a transformative era of *New India*, persuasion becomes a critical administrative tool for participatory and citizen-centric development.
Model Question	Explain the concept and components of persuasive communication. Evaluate how civil servants can use persuasion as a tool for effective policy implementation and citizen engagement in a transforming India.
Value Addition	**Core Concepts of Persuasion** • **Persuasion:** A conscious effort to influence others' attitudes, beliefs, or behaviours through communication, logic, and emotion rather than coercion. ✓ Example: A civil servant persuading citizens to adopt Swachh Bharat practices. • **Conviction:** A firm belief or opinion that motivates persuasive communication. • **Influence:** The ability to shape or modify others' opinions or actions indirectly. • **Compliance:** Behavioural change resulting from persuasion or social pressure. • **Conversion:** Deep internal change in belief or attitude due to successful persuasion. • **Nudge**: A subtle cue or policy design that alters behaviour predictably without restricting freedom of choice. ✓ Example: Using green footprints near dustbins to encourage cleanliness.
13. Explain the concept of emotional intelligence with special reference to the three main models of emotional intelligence. How are emotional intelligence applied in administration and governance? (APPSC 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Emotional intelligence Concepts and their utilities and application in Administration and Governance

Keyword	Explain, How
Approach	• Define Emotional Intelligence and briefly mention the three major models (Ability, Mixed, and Trait). • Explain each model with key features, then elaborate on its practical applications in administration and governance with relevant examples. • Conclude by emphasizing EI as indispensable for humane, ethical, and effective governance in achieving constitutional and developmental goals.
Introduction	Emotional Intelligence (EI) refers to the ability to perceive, understand, regulate, and use emotions effectively in decision-making and human interaction. EI is a crucial ethical competency for administrators, enabling empathy, stress management, and balanced judgment. In governance, EI ensures responsiveness, citizen trust, and conflict resolution—which are central to democratic functioning.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Three Main Models of Emotional Intelligence:** • **Ability Model (Mayer–Salovey–Caruso): Defines EI as a set of cognitive skills** ✓ Perceiving emotions (e.g., recognizing anger in citizen grievances), ✓ Using emotions (harnessing enthusiasm in community mobilization), ✓ Understanding emotions (anticipating public anxiety during reforms), ✓ Managing emotions (remaining calm in crises). • **Mixed Model (Daniel Goleman): Focuses on competencies in effective leadership** ✓ Self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, social skills. ✓ For instance, IAS officer Armstrong Pame ("Miracle Man of Manipur"), used empathy and social influence to mobilize citizens to build a 100-km road without government funds. • **Trait EI Model (K.V. Petrides):** ✓ Views EI as personality-based self-perceptions (Eg: optimism, stress tolerance). ✓ For example, district collectors who display resilience in stressful postings (like Naxal-affected Bastar) exemplify high Trait EI. **Applications of EI in Administration & Governance:** • **Citizen-Centric Service Delivery:** ✓ Empathy allows officials at MeeSeva centers in Telangana or e-Seva in Andhra Pradesh to patiently handle rural citizens unfamiliar with digital services. ✓ During COVID-19 vaccination drives, emotionally intelligent communication reduced vaccine hesitancy in rural India. • **Ethical Decision-Making & Integrity:** ✓ A self-aware officer avoids being swayed by political pressure, ensuring fairness in welfare delivery. ✓ Example: Ashok Khemka, IAS, known for his integrity, repeatedly exposed irregularities despite frequent transfers, reflecting EI in balancing emotion and principle. • **Leadership & Team Management:**

	✓ High-EI leaders maintain morale during demanding projects. For instance, E. Sreedharan ("Metro Man") combined technical expertise with motivational leadership to complete Delhi Metro ahead of deadlines. ✓ District Magistrates leading flood relief in Assam rely on empathy and motivation to mobilize inter-departmental teams. • **Crisis & Change Management:** ✓ During Kerala floods (2018), emotionally intelligent officers coordinated rescue while reassuring displaced families, avoiding panic. ✓ In COVID-19 lockdowns, empathetic police officers distributing food and medicines built citizen trust, contrasting with instances of insensitivity. • **Conflict Resolution & Negotiation:** ✓ EI is vital in land acquisition disputes (Eg: Narmada dam project), where empathetic dialogue reduced clashes and ensured fair rehabilitation packages. ✓ District collectors in Maoist-affected areas use EI to balance firmness with community engagement, encouraging surrenders and rehabilitation. • **Grievance Redressal & Public Interface:** ✓ Platforms like Jan Sunwai in Rajasthan or Lok Adalats succeed when officials listen empathetically, not mechanically. ✓ Example: In Delhi Mohalla Clinics, doctors trained in EI handle urban poor patients with dignity, improving satisfaction levels.
Conclusion	Emotional Intelligence—whether ability, mixed, or trait-based enables administrators to regulate emotions, understand citizens' needs, and resolve conflicts with empathy. By fostering compassion in service delivery, resilience in crises, and ethical decision-making, EI transforms rigid bureaucracy into humane governance. As India pursues Sustainable Development Goals and constitutional ideals, emotionally intelligent administration becomes essential for inclusive and responsive governance.
Model Question	How can training in Emotional Intelligence improve accountability, responsiveness, and empathy in Indian bureaucracy?
Value Addition	• The Economic Survey 2024-25 has highlighted the **Tim Tim Tare (TTT**) initiative as a government effort to equip India's adolescent students with essential life skills. Unlike traditional education that emphasises academic knowledge or vocational training that focuses on technical skills, TTT is designed to foster personal growth, **emotional intelligence, and social well-being.** • With over 10 crore students already benefiting from the program, government expects TTT to become a cornerstone of India's education system. The State Council of Educational Research and Training (SCERT) has officially approved the program, further cementing its place in the national education framework.
14. Concept of Public Service, "Philosophical basis of Governance professional Ethics in the light of right understanding and Vision for Holistic Technologies, Codes of Ethics, codes of Conduct, RTI, Public Service Act, Leadership Ethics, Work culture, Ethical principles within an Organizational content. - Ethical and moral values in governance, Ethical issues in international relations, corruption, Lokpal, Lokayukta	
14. Define public service broadly. How do the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude get manifested in public service? Explain with examples. Suggest three preventive measures of corruption. (APPSC, 2020)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Ethics in Public Service and knowledge of law: Concept of Public Service
Keyword	Define, How, Explain, Suggest
Approach	• Define public service as duty-oriented work for public welfare.

	• Explain how trustworthiness builds citizen confidence and fortitude ensures integrity amid challenges; cite examples like honest officers. • Suggest three preventive anti-corruption measures—transparency, accountability, and citizen vigilance.
Introduction	Public service is the ethical and professional commitment of individuals working for the welfare of society through impartial and efficient governance. Moral values, accountability, and the pursuit of public interest over personal gain guide it. Trustworthiness and fortitude are core virtues that sustain integrity and resilience in public administration.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Definition and Essence of Public Service** • Public service involves delivering justice, welfare, and development through honesty, equity, and empathy. • It extends beyond administrative duties to moral responsibility, serving citizens with integrity and compassion. • The Second Administrative Reforms Commission (2008) defines public service as the embodiment of ethical governance and citizen-centric delivery. **Virtue of Trustworthiness in Public Service** • Trustworthiness is the foundation of ethical governance. • It means reliability, honesty, and adherence to public duty. • A trustworthy officer earns public confidence by acting with transparency and fairness. • Example: E. Sreedharan, known as the "Metro Man of India," upheld credibility through punctuality and corruption-free execution of the Delhi Metro Project. • The World Bank Governance Indicators (2022) note that nations with higher government trust exhibit better service delivery and lower corruption levels. **Virtue of Fortitude in Public Service** • Fortitude signifies courage and perseverance in upholding ethical conduct despite adversity. • Civil servants demonstrate fortitude by resisting political pressure, enduring public criticism, and making morally right decisions. • Example: IAS officer Ashok Khemka showed moral fortitude by exposing irregularities despite facing multiple transfers. • Such resilience safeguards institutional integrity and strengthens citizens' faith in governance. **Preventive Measures of Corruption** • **Transparency and E-Governance:** Use of Digital India and RTI Act (2005) to reduce discretion and increase accountability. • **Ethical Training and Code of Conduct:** Strengthening value-based orientation in civil services. • **Citizen Participation and Vigilance**: Community monitoring through Social Audits under MGNREGA ensures grassroots accountability.
Conclusion	Public service is a moral duty anchored in the virtues of trustworthiness and fortitude. These qualities sustain integrity and courage in the face of ethical dilemmas. Strengthening transparency, civic vigilance, and ethical leadership can effectively prevent corruption and ensure citizen trust in governance.
Model Question	Discuss the ethical foundations of public service. Illustrate how integrity and resilience strengthen administrative ethics, and propose strategies to minimise corruption in governance.

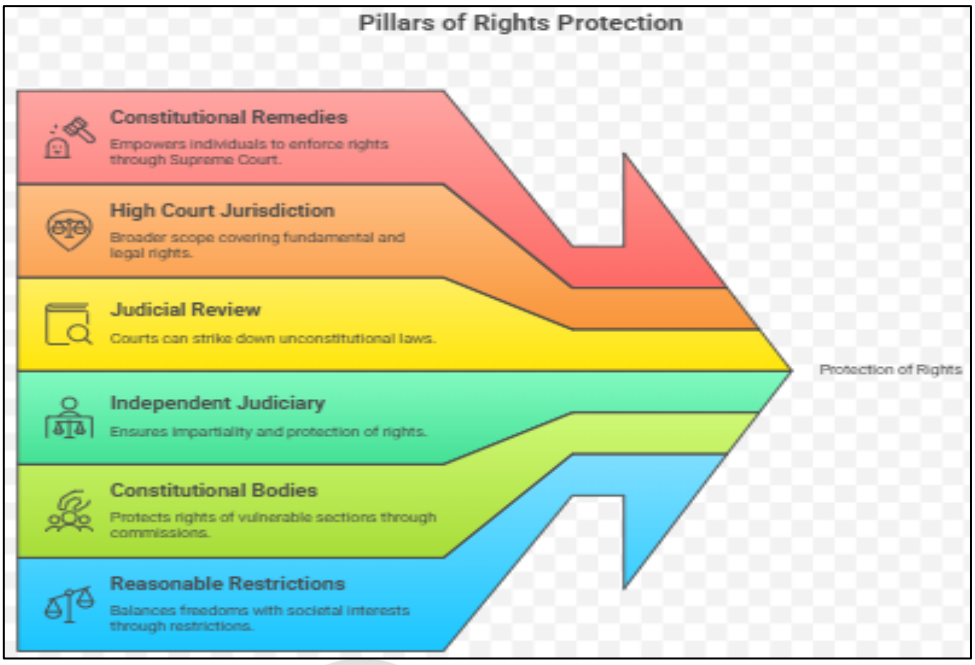
Value Addition	Public accountability is a core principle of good governance where public officials and institutions are held responsible to the public for their actions, decisions, and performance. It involves government actors justifying their actions, acting on criticism, and accepting responsibility for failures. The fundamental principles of public accountability are transparency, responsiveness, and robust accountability mechanisms.

Basic Knowledge of Laws in India

15. Constitution of India: Nature and salient features – Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles of State Policy – Bifurcation of powers between centre and state (state list, union list and concurrent list) – Powers of judiciary, executive and legislature. Civil and Criminal laws: hierarchy of civil and criminal courts in India – difference between substantial and procedural laws – order and decree - new developments in criminal laws, Nirbhaya Act. Labour Law: Concept of social welfare legislations in India, changing trends in employment and necessity for new labour laws. Cyber Laws: Information Technology Act – Cyber Security and Cyber Crime – difficulties in determining competent jurisdiction of courts in case of cyber-crimes. Tax Laws: Laws relating to income, Profits, Wealth Tax, Corporate Tax – GST

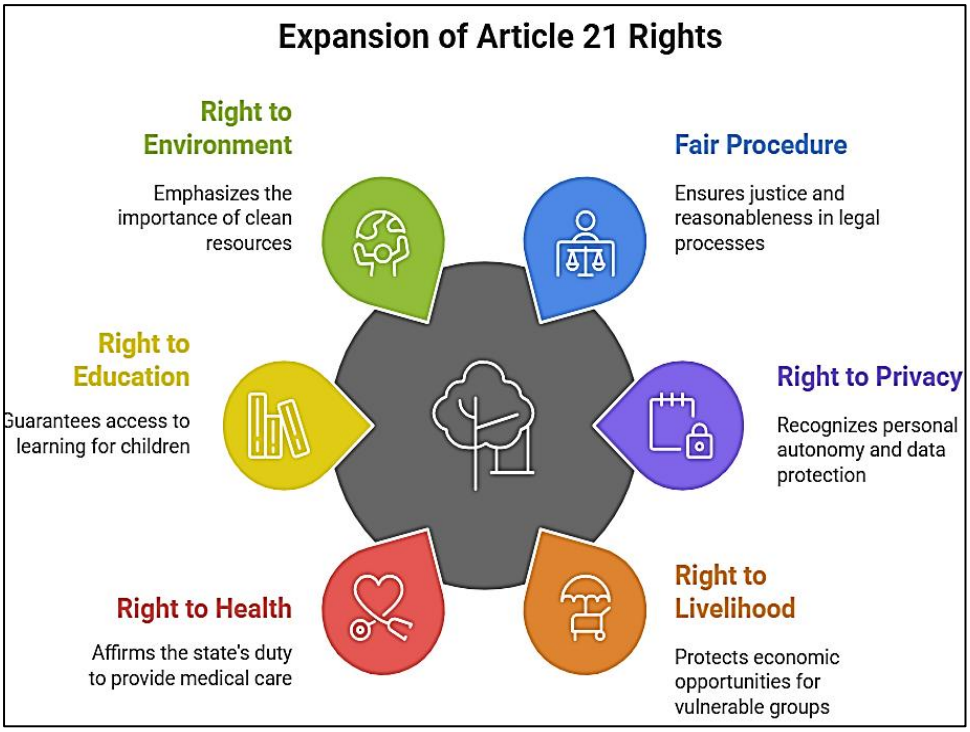
15. The Constitution of India grants certain rights to citizens and also provides measures to safeguard them. What are the key constitutional arrangements to ensure the protection of these rights? (APPSC, 2025)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	What
Approach	• Give an introduction by mentioning that fundamental Rights need protective mechanisms. • Judicial review, writ remedies, reasonable restrictions, independent judiciary, special provisions for vulnerable groups. • Give a conclusion by ensuring rights remain meaningful in a democratic framework.
Introduction	The Constitution of India enshrines Fundamental Rights in Part III (Articles 12–35) to ensure liberty, equality, and justice to all citizens. Recognizing that rights can be threatened by arbitrary state action or societal forces, the Constitution incorporates several safeguards such as judicial, constitutional, and institutional mechanisms, to protect these rights.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key Constitutional Arrangements for the Protection of Rights of citizens:** • **Right to Constitutional Remedies (Article 32)** ✓ This Article is called the "heart and soul" of the Constitution by B.R. Ambedkar. ✓ It empowers individuals to directly approach the Supreme Court for enforcement of Fundamental Rights. ✓ The Writs Habeas Corpus, Mandamus, Prohibition, Certiorari, and Quo Warranto come under this Article. ✓ Example: Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar (1979) ✓ The Supreme Court upheld the right to a speedy trial as an essential part of Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty), emphasizing that delays in the judicial process violate fundamental rights. • **High Court Writ Jurisdiction (Article 226)** ✓ It has a broader scope than Article 32, covering both Fundamental and legal rights. ✓ Example: People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) v. Union of India (2003): Right to know candidates' criminal records. • **Doctrine of Judicial Review:**

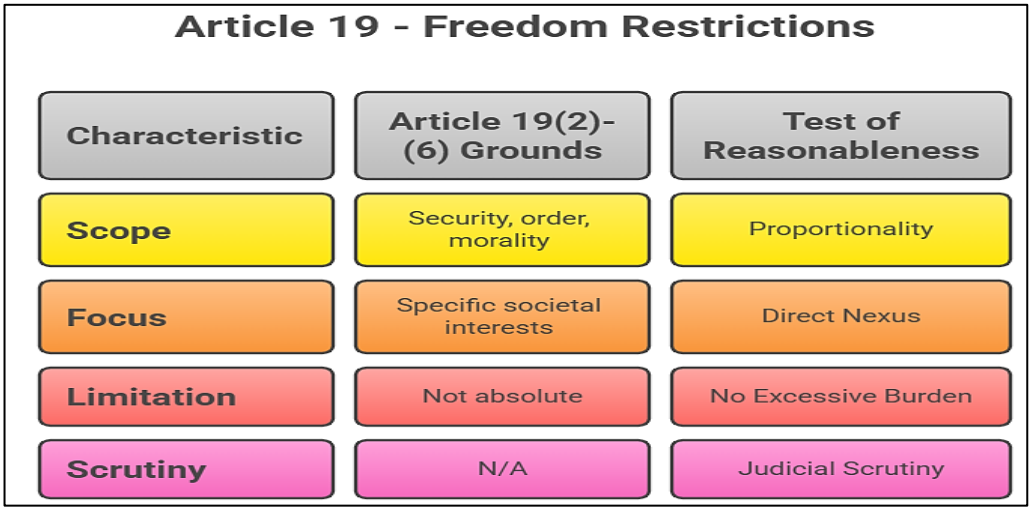
	✓ The Indian courts have the power to strike down unconstitutional laws and executive actions. ✓ Example: The Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973) introduced the Basic Structure Doctrine.  • **Independent Judiciary:** ✓ Security of tenure, fixed salaries, and separation of powers ensure impartiality. ✓ It enables courts to act as guardians of rights without political interference. • **Constitutional and Statutory Bodies** ✓ National Human Rights Commission (NHRC), National Commission for Women (NCW), National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR), and SC/ST Commissions safeguard the rights of vulnerable sections. • **Reasonable Restrictions and Constitutional Balance:** ✓ While Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees essential freedoms such as speech, assembly, movement, and profession, clauses (2) to (6) introduce reasonable restrictions to ensure these rights do not conflict with broader societal interests.
Conclusion	Thus, the Indian Constitution not only grants rights but also creates robust enforcement mechanisms to ensure they are meaningful. Through constitutional remedies, judicial review, and independent institutions, it upholds the rule of law and protects citizens from arbitrary action, thereby strengthening India's democratic fabric.
Model Question	The Constitution of India not only enumerates rights but also provides mechanisms to protect them. Examine the constitutional safeguards available to ensure the effective protection of citizens' rights.
Value Addition	**Writs under Article 32 of the Constitution:** **Habeas Corpus:** • It is a Latin term that means "to have the body of." This writ is an order issued by a court to a person who has detained another individual, compelling them to produce the detained person before the court. • The court then examines the reasons and legality behind the detention. • If the detention is found to be unlawful, the court will order the immediate release of the detained person.

	• The writ of Habeas Corpus can be issued against both public authorities and private individuals. **Mandamus:** • Mandamus means "we command." • It is a directive issued by a court to a public official, compelling them to perform a duty that they are legally obligated to fulfil but have either failed or refused to do. • This writ can also be issued to public bodies, corporations, lower courts, tribunals, or government agencies to ensure they perform their official duties. **Prohibition:** • Prohibition means "to forbid." • This writ is issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal, preventing it from acting beyond its legal authority or jurisdiction it does not have. • While Mandamus commands an authority to take action, Prohibition specifically orders an authority to refrain from continuing proceedings that are outside its jurisdiction. **Certiorari:** • Certiorari means "to be certified" or "to be informed." • This writ is issued by a higher court to a lower court or tribunal, either to transfer a case to itself or to quash the decision made by the lower authority. • It is issued when there has been an excess or lack of jurisdiction, or when there is an error in the application of law. • Unlike Prohibition, which only prevents future actions, Certiorari can be both preventive and corrective, addressing past legal errors. **Quo Warranto:** • Quo Warranto means "by what authority or warrant." • This writ is issued by a court to inquire into the legality of a person's claim to hold a public office. It serves to prevent the unlawful occupation of a public office by someone without proper legal authority.
16. 'Article 21 of the Indian Constitution facilitates the expansion of the scope of Fundamental Rights'. Comment. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Comment
Approach	• Mention Article 21 ensures life & liberty with "fair, just, reasonable" procedure. • Mention judicial interpretation: privacy, environment, education, legal aid; link with DPSPs. • Conclude Article 21 is a living provision enabling socio-economic rights.
Introduction	Article 21 of the Constitution states that "*No person shall be deprived of his life or personal liberty except according to procedure established by law*." It was originally interpreted narrowly in A.K. Gopalan v. State of Madras (1950). Its scope was significantly expanded post-Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978), making it the most dynamic provision for the protection of human dignity.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Judicial Expansion of Article 21 of the Indian Constitution:** • **Fair Procedure & Dignified Life:** ✓ Maneka Gandhi v. Union of India (1978) established that any procedure depriving life or liberty must be fair, just, and reasonable. ✓ This case broadened the scope of Article 21 to include dignity, quality of life, and socio-economic rights. • **Right to Privacy:** ✓ K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India (2017) recognized privacy as a fundamental right intrinsic to personal liberty.

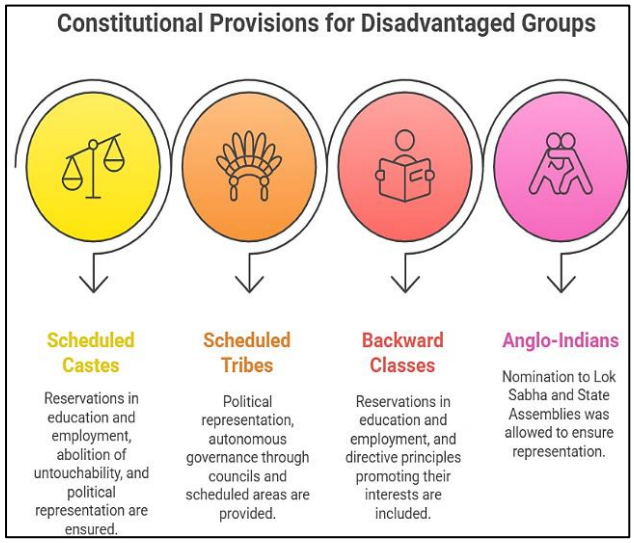
	✓ It raised critical questions about Aadhaar, state surveillance, and data protection. • **Right to Livelihood:** Olga Tellis v. Bombay Municipal Corporation (1985) held that the right to livelihood is an essential part of the right to life, protecting informal workers and street vendors from arbitrary eviction. • **Right to Health & Medical Care:** Paschim Banga Khet Mazdoor Samity v. State of West Bengal (1996) case affirmed the State's duty to provide adequate health services, especially in emergencies, as part of the right to life. • **Right to Education:** Mohini Jain (1992) and Unnikrishnan (1993) cases laid the foundation for Article 21A, inserted in 2002, guaranteeing the Right to Education for children aged 6–14. • **Right to a Clean Environment:** Subhash Kumar v. State of Bihar (1991) declared that access to pollution-free water and air is integral to the right to life, reinforcing environmental protection as a constitutional mandate. **Significance of Article 21 of the Indian Constitution:** • Article 21 has served as a "reservoir of rights", from civil liberties to socio-economic rights. • It reflects the concept of a living Constitution, adapting to changing societal needs.
Conclusion	Hence, the expansive interpretation of Article 21 has transformed it into the foundation for numerous unenumerated Fundamental Rights. Through progressive judicial activism, it bridges the gap between Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles, making the Constitution a more effective instrument of justice and human dignity.
Model Question	Comment on the statement that Article 21 has evolved into a source for expanding the ambit of Fundamental Rights through judicial interpretation, citing relevant Supreme Court judgments
Value Addition	• Recently, the Chhattisgarh High Court ruled that no one can force a woman to undergo a virginity test, as it violates Article 21 of the Constitution, which guarantees her fundamental right to life, liberty, and dignity.

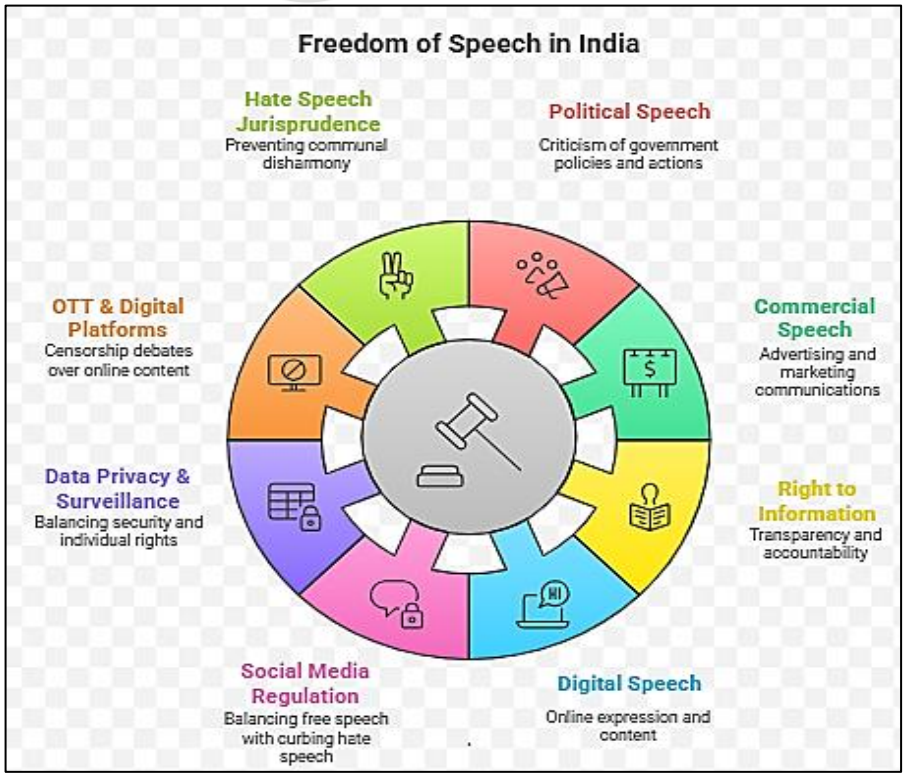


	• It stated that such a test violates Article 21, which guarantees dignity and personal liberty. Allowing a virginity test would violate fundamental rights, natural justice, and a woman's dignity. The High Court reaffirmed that the right to personal liberty under Article 21 is absolute.
17. 'The Indian Constitution promotes rule of law. Examine in the light of constitutional provisions (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Define Rule of Law and its constitutional relevance in India. • Cite key constitutional provisions, landmark judgments, and authoritative sources that uphold it. • Summarize its role in safeguarding democracy and stress the need for institutional integrity and citizen vigilance.
Introduction	The Rule of Law, a fundamental principle of democratic governance, signifies that law is supreme, applies equally to all citizens, and safeguards individual rights. Rooted in A.V. Dicey's concept, it is deeply embedded in the Preamble, Fundamental Rights, and institutional framework of the Indian Constitution. It ensures that governance operates within the framework of legality and accountability.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional Provisions Upholding Rule of Law:** • **Equality before Law (Article 14)** ✓ Guarantees equality before law and equal protection of laws; prevents arbitrariness (*E.P. Royappa vs. State of Tamil Nadu*, 1974). • **Supremacy of the Constitution** ✓ All laws and executive actions must conform to the Constitution (*Kesavananda Bharati vs. State of Kerala*, 1973). • **Separation of Powers** ✓ Distribution of powers among Legislature, Executive, and Judiciary ensures checks and balances (*Indira Nehru Gandhi vs. Raj Narain*, 1975). • **Judicial Review (Articles 32 & 226)** ✓ Empowers Supreme Court and High Courts to strike down unconstitutional actions (*Maneka Gandhi vs. Union of India*, 1978). • **Due Process & Personal Liberty (Article 21)** ✓ Ensures that deprivation of life or liberty follows fair, just, and reasonable procedures. • **Independent Judiciary (Articles 124–147, 214–231)** ✓ Guarantees judicial autonomy as a safeguard for rule of law.
Conclusion	The Indian Constitution enshrines the rule of law as both a legal doctrine and a constitutional ethos. By ensuring equality, judicial review, and constitutional supremacy, it safeguards democracy against arbitrariness. However, its true effectiveness depends on the integrity of institutions and the vigilance of citizens in upholding constitutional values.
Model Question	"Rule of Law is the cornerstone of Constitutional democracy." Critically analyze this statement in the Indian context.
Value Addition	The Rule of Law in India draws from A.V. Dicey and Article 13 (judicial review). Landmark cases like Kesavananda Bharati (basic structure), Indira Gandhi vs. Raj Narain (checks on executive), and Maneka Gandhi (expanded liberty) reinforce it. NITI Aayog's "Justice Index" and Global Rule of Law Index highlight implementation gaps.

18. Examine the scope of 'reasonable restrictions' and the 'test of reasonableness' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution. (APPSC, 2023)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Examine
Approach	• Describe Article 19 rights is subject to public interest limitations. • Mention grounds in clauses (2)–(6); tests from Chintaman Rao & proportionality doctrine. • Mention restrictions must balance individual liberty with societal needs.
Introduction	Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees six fundamental freedoms to citizens, such as the right to freedom of speech, assembly, movement, and profession. However, these rights are not absolute. Clauses (2) to (6) of Article 19 permit the State to impose reasonable restrictions in the interests of public order, morality, security, and other legitimate objectives. The judiciary has evolved the "test of reasonableness" to ensure that such restrictions do not nullify the essence of the right itself.
Body & Infographic Representation	**The scope of 'reasonable restrictions' in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution:** • **Not Absolute**: Freedom under Article 19 can be curtailed, but restrictions must be reasonable and proportionate. • **Grounds for restrictions under Article 19(2)–(6):** ✓ **Article 19(2):** It deals with security of the state, public order, morality, defamation, contempt of court, etc. ✓ **Article 19(3):** Restrictions on assembly for public order. ▪ **Example:** Anuradha Bhasin v. Union of India, 2020 case dealt with proportionality in internet shutdowns. ✓ **Article 19(4):** It deals with restrictions on the right to assemble peaceably ✓ **Article 19(5):** The article deals with restrictions on the right to move freely and reside anywhere in India ✓ **Article 19(6):** It deals with restrictions on the right to practice any profession or occupation. **Test of Reasonableness in connection with Article 19 of the Indian Constitution:** The Supreme Court applies certain principles to judge reasonableness: • **Proportionality:** Restriction must be in proportion to the objective sought. • **Direct Nexus:** There must be a clear link between the restriction and the objective. • **No Excessive Burden:** The restriction should not annihilate the right itself. • **Judicial Scrutiny**: The Courts examine both substantive and procedural aspects. 

Conclusion	Thus, the reasonable restrictions under Article 19 strike a balance between individual liberty and societal interests. The test of reasonableness ensures that state actions are proportionate, non-arbitrary, and legally justified, thereby safeguarding democratic freedoms while addressing collective needs.
Model Question	Discuss the scope of reasonable restrictions under Article 19 of the Constitution of India. Explain the judicially developed 'test of reasonableness' with suitable case law.
Value Addition	• Article 19 of the Indian Constitution guarantees certain freedoms to all citizens of India. It encompasses six fundamental rights: ✓ Right to freedom of speech and expression, ✓ Right to assemble peacefully and without arms, ✓ Right to form associations, unions, or co-operative societies, ✓ Right to move freely throughout the territory of India, ✓ Right to reside and settle in any part of the territory of India, ✓ Right to practice any profession or to carry on any occupation, trade, or business. • **Note:** Originally, Article 19 of the Indian Constitution contained seven rights. However, the right to acquire, hold, and dispose of property was deleted by the 44th Amendment Act of 1978.
19. Describe the various special provisions in the constitution relating to scheduled castes, scheduled tribes, backward classes, and Anglo- Indians. (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Describe
Approach	• Give an introduction about Social justice under Part XVI & Preamble. • Mention Reservations in education, jobs, politics; commissions; Anglo-Indian nomination (abolished 2020). • Conclude how various special provisions promote equality & representation for disadvantaged groups.
Introduction	The framers of the Indian Constitution recognized India's deep-rooted social inequalities and historical discrimination. Guided by the principles of justice, equality, and fraternity in the Preamble, special provisions were incorporated to uplift the Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), Backward Classes (BCs), and Anglo-Indians. These are mainly provided in Part XVI and other relevant Articles.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Special provisions in the constitution relating to scheduled castes, scheduled tribes, backward classes, and Anglo- Indians:** **Special Provisions in the Constitution related to the Scheduled Castes (SCs):** • **Reservation in Education & Employment** ✓ **Article 15(4):** This Article permits the State to make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes. ✓ **Article 16(4):** It allows reservation in public employment for backward classes not adequately represented. ✓ **Article 16(4A):** The article extends reservation in promotions for Scheduled Castes (SCs) and Scheduled Tribes (STs). • **Abolition of Untouchability** ✓ **Article 17:** ▪ This article declares untouchability as abolished and its practice as a punishable offense. ▪ It is supported by the Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955, which enforces penalties for discrimination based on untouchability.

	✓ **Political Representation:** As per the 2011 Census, 84 Lok Sabha seats are reserved for Scheduled Castes, ensuring their voice in national legislation and governance. **Special Provisions in the Constitution related to the Scheduled Tribes (STs):** • **Political Representation:** ✓ **Articles 330 and 332:** These articles reserve seats for STs in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies to ensure their participation in governance. ✓ **Autonomous Governance:** ▪ **Sixth Schedule:** It establishes Autonomous District Councils in tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram. Example: Councils for Khasi, Garo, and Jaintia Hills in Meghalaya. ▪ **Fifth Schedule:** it governs the administration of Scheduled Areas in other states, ensuring tribal welfare and self-governance.  **Special Provisions in the Constitution related to the Backward Classes (BCs):** • **Reservation in Education & Employment.** • **Articles 15(4) & 16(4):** Enable the State to provide reservations for socially and educationally backward classes in public institutions and jobs. • **Directive Principle: Article 46:** Directs the State to promote the educational and economic interests of weaker sections, especially BCs. • **Mandal Commission** Implementation (1990) introduced 27% reservation for Other Backward Classes (OBCs) in central government services and educational institutions. **Special Provisions in the Constitution related to the Anglo-Indians:** • **Article 331:** It allows the President and Governors to nominate Anglo-Indian members to the Lok Sabha and State Assemblies if the community lacks representation. • This Provision was repealed by the 104th Constitutional Amendment (2020), ending the provision for nominated seats.
Conclusion	In this way, these provisions aim to ensure adequate representation, social justice, and equality of opportunity for historically disadvantaged groups. While they have improved access to education, employment, and political participation, effective implementation and periodic review are essential to balance affirmative action with meritocracy and national integration.
Model Question	Enumerate the special constitutional provisions made for the protection and advancement of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes, Backward Classes, and Anglo-Indians, citing relevant Articles and examples.
Value Addition	**Article 164:** Other provisions as to Ministers: • The Chief Minister shall be appointed by the Governor, and the other Ministers shall be appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Minister, and the Ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the Governor:

	• Provided that in the States of Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Orissa, there shall be a Minister in charge of tribal welfare who may in addition, be in charge of the welfare of the Scheduled Castes and backward classes or any other work.
20. Discuss the scope and nature of Freedom of speech and Expression in India. Explain the emerging dimensions of freedom. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Discuss, Explain
Approach	• Mention that Article 19(1)(a) — cornerstone of democracy. • Describe how Freedom of Speech and Expression in India covers the press, internet, dissent, and also mention new issues like social media, hate speech, and data privacy. • Must balance free expression with public harmony.
Introduction	Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution guarantees Freedom of Speech and Expression as a cornerstone of democracy. It enables citizens to freely express opinions, thereby fostering informed public discourse. However, it is not absolute and is subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2) to balance individual liberty with societal interests.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Scope and Nature of Freedom of Speech and Expression in India:** • **Wide Interpretation by the Judiciary:** It includes freedom of the press (Indian Express v. Union of India, 1985), right to know (PUCL v. Union of India, 2003), artistic expression, academic freedom, and also peaceful protest. • **Components of Freedom of speech and Expression in India:** ✓ **Political Speech:** It refers to criticism of government policies and actions, a cornerstone of democratic discourse. It is protected as long as it does not incite violence or public disorder. ✓ **Commercial Speech:** It includes advertising and marketing communications. It is recognized as a form of speech but subject to reasonable restrictions (e.g., misleading ads, public health concerns). 

	✓ **Right to Information**: It is judicially recognized in State of U.P. v. Raj Narain (1975). It also laid the foundation for the Right to Information Act, 2005, promoting transparency and accountability. ✓ **Digital Speech:** In Shreya Singhal v. Union of India (2015), the Supreme Court struck down Section 66A of the IT Act, which criminalized "offensive" online content. The judgment upheld free speech online, emphasizing that vague laws cannot suppress legitimate expression • **Reasonable Restrictions on Freedom of speech and Expression in India (Article 19(2)):** ✓ **Grounds for Restrictions on Freedom of Speech and Expression under Article 19(2):** ▪ Sovereignty and integrity of India ▪ security of the state ▪ public order ▪ decency ▪ morality ▪ contempt of court ▪ defamation ▪ incitement to an offence **Emerging Dimensions in freedom of speech and Expression in India:** ✓ **Social Media Regulation:** Balancing free speech with curbing hate speech and misinformation. ✓ **Data Privacy & Surveillance:** Post-Puttaswamy (2017) case privacy ruling, balancing security and individual rights. ✓ **OTT & Digital Platforms:** Censorship debates over web series and online films. ✓ **Hate Speech Jurisprudence:** Growing focus on preventing communal disharmony (Pravasi Bhalai Sangathan v. Union of India, 2014).
Conclusion	To sum up, Freedom of speech and Expression in India has evolved from safeguarding political dissent to encompassing digital and informational freedoms. While new technologies have broadened the scope, they also bring challenges that require balancing liberty with public interest through nuanced laws and a vigilant judiciary.
Model Question	Examine the scope and nature of the Freedom of Speech and Expression under Article 19(1)(a) of the Constitution. How have emerging technologies and societal changes expanded its dimensions?
Value Addition	• Recently, in Imran Pratapgadhi vs. State of Gujarat, the Supreme Court underscored the importance of protecting the freedom of speech and expression and reminded authorities of their duty to uphold the rights of persons expressing unpopular opinions. • This Judgement came in response to an FIR filed against Rajya Sabha MP Imran Pratapgadh, alleging that the content incited enmity between communities (under Section 153A of IPC). • The Supreme Court found that Section 153A requires deliberate intent to promote hatred between communities. • Under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (2023), Section 196 penalizes actions or speech that incite hatred or disharmony between different groups based on religion, race, language, or region, to maintain peace.
21. Discuss if the right to vote is a statutory, constitutional, or fundamental right. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Discuss

Approach	• Mention that the right to vote is essential for democracy, but not a Fundamental Right. • Give Statutory right under RPA; constitutional basis in Art. 326; PUCL case. • Conclude Statutory with constitutional backing, distinct from fundamental rights.
Introduction	The right to vote is the bedrock of a representative democracy. In India, it enables citizens to directly participate in governance by electing representatives. While the Constitution lays down the framework for elections, the nature of the right, whether statutory, constitutional, or fundamental, has been clarified through judicial interpretation.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Right to Vote: Statutory, Constitutional, or Fundamental Right:** • **Constitutional Basis:** ✓ **Article 326:** The article provides for elections to the House of the People and State Legislative Assemblies based on adult suffrage (18 years and above). ✓ The Constitution does not directly confer the right to vote as a Fundamental Right; it only sets the eligibility criteria. • **Statutory Nature:** ✓ The Representation of the People Acts, 1950 and 1951, operationalize the right to vote. ✓ These laws detail voter registration, preparation of electoral rolls, and conduct of elections. ✓ Hence, the right to vote exists because of statute; without the statutory framework, the constitutional provision alone is not enforceable. • **Judicial Position** ✓ **PUCL v. Union of India (2003):** Supreme Court (SC) held that the right to know the antecedents of candidates is a Fundamental Right under Article 19(1)(a), but the act of voting is statutory. ✓ **Kuldip Nayar v. Union of India (2006):** This case affirmed that voting is not a Fundamental Right but a statutory one derived from legislation. ✓ **Rajbala v. State of Haryana (2016):** The Supreme Court (SC) emphasized that the state has the power to prescribe qualifications for holding public office and that the restrictions in this case were aimed at improving the quality of governance at the local level.
Conclusion	To summarize, the right to vote in India is primarily a statutory right with a constitutional foundation, not a Fundamental Right. However, facets related to the freedom to know and express political preferences enjoy Fundamental Rights protection, ensuring that electoral democracy functions within the ambit of constitutional principles.
Model Question	Critically examine the nature of the right to vote in India. Is it a statutory, constitutional, or fundamental right? Support your answer with constitutional provisions and case law.
Value Addition	• In the Anoop Baranwal case, one of the judges, in his dissent, presented a nuanced position. He argued that: ✓ Voting is an expression of choice protected under Article 19(1)(a), freedom of speech and expression. ✓ Free and fair elections are intrinsic to the basic structure of the Constitution. ✓ Although shaped by statutory law, the origin of this right lies in Article 326 of the Constitution. ✓ His reasoning could lay the foundation for a future judicial reconsideration that may elevate voting to the status of a constitutional right, particularly as jurisprudence around electoral rights and democratic accountability deepens.

22. Discuss the scope of special provisions for Backward classes and the test to determine Backward classes. Discuss the difference in the scope of provisions under Article 15(4) and 16(4). (TGPSC, 2016)

<table>
<tr><td>Syllabus</td><td>Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights</td></tr>
<tr><td>Keyword</td><td>Discuss</td></tr>
<tr><td>Approach</td><td>• Give Backward class protections under the social justice mandate.
• Mention Art. 15(4): educational/social uplift; Art. 16(4): reservation in public jobs; identification tests.
• Mention complementary provisions ensuring equality of opportunity.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Introduction</td><td>The Constitution of India aims to achieve social justice by providing protective discrimination for socially and educationally backward classes (SEBCs), including Other Backward Classes (OBCs). Provisions under Articles 15(4) and 16(4) enable the State to take affirmative action to ensure equality of opportunity and eliminate historical disadvantages.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Body & Infographic Representation</td><td>Scope of Special Provisions for Backward Classes in India:
• Article 15(4): It was added by the First Amendment (1951). It allows the State to make special provisions for the advancement of socially and educationally backward classes, including SCs and STs, in education.
• Article 16(4): The article enables reservation in public employment for backward classes not adequately represented in state services.
• Directive Principles (Art. 46): It promotes the educational and economic interests of weaker sections.
• Example: 27% reservation for OBCs in Central Government jobs and higher education following the Mandal Commission implementation (1990).
Tests to Determine Backward Classes in India:
• Social and Educational Backwardness Test: In M.R. Balaji v. State of Mysore (1963), the Supreme Court held that reservations must be based on demonstrable social and educational backwardness, not solely on caste, laying the foundation for a more nuanced approach to affirmative action.
• Creamy Layer Exclusion: In Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992), the Supreme Court introduced the concept of the creamy layer, excluding the economically advanced among backward classes from reservation benefits to ensure that affirmative action reaches the truly disadvantaged.
• Adequate Representation Test: As reaffirmed in Jarnail Singh v. Lachhmi Narain Gupta (2018), the Court emphasized that reservations in public employment must be justified by evidence of inadequate representation of marginalized groups, reinforcing the need for data-driven policy.
Difference Between Article 15(4) and 16(4) of the Indian Constitution:
<table>
<tr><th>Article 15(4)</th><th>Article 16(4)</th></tr>
<tr><td>This article applies to education & other fields.</td><td>This article applies to public employment only.</td></tr>
<tr><td>It focuses on social & educational backwardness.</td><td>It focuses on inadequate representation in state services.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Broader in scope.</td><td>Narrower, employment-specific.</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>Therefore, Articles 15(4) and 16(4) together form the backbone of affirmative action for backward classes. Judicial scrutiny through the “tests” ensures these provisions serve genuine disadvantaged groups while maintaining a balance with merit and equality under Article 14.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>Analyse the scope of special constitutional provisions for backward classes. What tests are applied to determine backwardness? Distinguish between the scope of Articles 15(4) and 16(4) with a relevant example.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC)</td></tr>
</table>

	• NCBC was initially constituted by the Central Government by the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment. • It has been accorded constitutional status through "The Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018", whereby Article 338B has been inserted, forming a Commission for the socially and educationally backward classes to be known as the NCBC. • The amendment inserted Article 338B, Article 342A, and Clause 26C in Article 366. • Composition: The Commission consists of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson, and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India. • The Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, and other Members of the Commission shall be appointed by the President by warrant under his hand and seal. • The President shall cause all such reports to be laid before each House of Parliament along with a memorandum explaining the action taken or proposed to be taken on the recommendations relating to the Union and the reasons for the non-acceptance, if any, of any of such recommendations.
23. Explain the Right to Equality guaranteed under the Constitution of India in-the light of the doctrine of reasonable classification. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Fundamental Rights
Keyword	Explain
Approach	• Define the Right to Equality under Article 14 and briefly introduce the doctrine of reasonable classification as its interpretative tool. • Explain the principles and tests of reasonable classification with relevant constitutional provisions, examples, and case laws showing its application and limitations. • Conclude by emphasizing how the doctrine balances equality with practical governance, ensuring justice and non-arbitrariness.
Introduction	The Right to Equality (Articles 14–18) is central to India's constitutional philosophy, ensuring fairness and justice for all citizens. However, equality under Article 14 does not imply identical treatment in every situation. To ensure social and economic fairness, the Supreme Court developed the doctrine of reasonable classification, which distinguishes between permissible and arbitrary differentiation.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Right to Equality and the Doctrine of Reasonable Classification:** • **Constitutional Foundation of Equality:** ✓ Article 14 embodies two key principles: equality before law (a negative concept, no special privileges) and equal protection of laws (a positive concept, equal treatment among equals). ✓ Articles 15–16 expand this principle by prohibiting discrimination while allowing affirmative action for women, children, and socially or educationally backward classes (State of Madras v. Champakam Dorairajan, 1951). ✓ Articles 17–18 further reinforce equality by abolishing untouchability and titles that perpetuate social hierarchy. • **Meaning and Essence of the Doctrine of Reasonable Classification** ✓ Absolute equality is impractical in a diverse society. The State can classify individuals or groups for specific purposes, provided the classification is reasonable and not arbitrary. The Supreme Court in State of West Bengal v. Anwar Ali Sarkar (1952) and Ram Krishna Dalmia v. Justice Tendolkar (1958) laid down two essential tests: ✓ Intelligible Differentia - The classification must clearly distinguish those grouped together from those left out.

	✓ Example: Separate laws for juveniles (Sheela Barse v. Union of India, 1986) are valid as minors require special care. ✓ Reservation policies for SCs/STs and OBCs (Indra Sawhney v. Union of India, 1992) also satisfy this condition, as they aim to uplift disadvantaged groups. ✓ Rational Nexus: There must be a logical connection between the basis of classification and the objective of the law. ✓ Example: Progressive taxation ensures that those with higher income contribute more to the State, serving a rational goal of economic justice. ✓ Similarly, special protections for women in employment laws uphold social welfare objectives, as affirmed in Air India v. Nergesh Meerza (1981), where arbitrary gender discrimination was struck down. • **Application and Limits of the Doctrine:** ✓ The doctrine permits differential treatment when it promotes public welfare, social reform, or equality of opportunity. ✓ However, classifications that are arbitrary, artificial, or without nexus violate Article 14. For example, Subramanian Swamy v. CBI (2014) invalidated special protection for senior officials as it lacked reasonable justification. ✓ The judiciary consistently tests such classifications to ensure they adhere to constitutional morality and the spirit of equality.
Conclusion	The Right to Equality under Article 14 embodies both formal and substantive justice. The doctrine of reasonable classification ensures that the State can treat different groups differently to achieve fairness, without resorting to arbitrariness. By balancing equality with pragmatism, the doctrine upholds India's democratic vision of justice, dignity, and inclusiveness for all citizens.
Model Question	Right to Life under Article 21 of the Indian Constitution has evolved from mere existence to a guarantee of dignified living." Examine this statement with reference to judicial interpretations and contemporary issues.
Value Addition	**The Doctrine of Pith and Substance:** • The Doctrine of Pith and Substance is a fundamental principle in constitutional law that aids in determining the true character and scope of legislation, particularly when it overlaps multiple jurisdictions within a federal framework. It allows courts to look beyond the literal wording of a law to identify its primary purpose and essential character. • This doctrine holds special significance in federal systems like those of India, Canada, and Australia, where legislative powers are divided between central and state authorities. By applying this principle, courts maintain the balance of legislative competence and ensure the smooth functioning of the constitutional structure. The Supreme Court of India first invoked this doctrine in the landmark case of **State of Bombay v. F.N. Balsara (1951).**
24. Critically examine different models of Secularism in India. (TGPSC, 2024)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Constitution of India and salient features
Keyword	Critically Examine
Approach	• Introduce by defining secularism in the Indian context, referencing its constitutional roots and formal inclusion via the 42nd Amendment. • Analyze the major models of secularism: Equal Respect, Principled Distance, Assertive, and Accommodative along with their constitutional backing, examples, and critiques. • Conclude by emphasizing the dynamic and plural nature of Indian secularism and the need for balanced application to uphold unity in diversity.

Introduction	Secularism in India reflects the Constitution's commitment to religious neutrality, equal respect for all religions, and the promotion of justice, liberty, and fraternity in a deeply pluralistic society. Unlike the Western model of strict separation between church and state, Indian secularism adopts balanced approach. Though the principle was embedded from the beginning, the **42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976** formally inserted the term "secular" into the Preamble.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Different Models of Secularism in India:** • **Equal Respect / Neutral State Model:** This model emphasizes the equal treatment of all religions, without state preference. Enshrined in**:** ✓ **Article 14:** Right to equality before law ✓ **Article 25:** Freedom of conscience and free profession, practice, and propagation of religion ✓ **Article 26:** Right to manage religious affairs ✓ **Article 28:** Freedom from religious instruction in state-funded institutions ✓ While ideal in theory, critics argue that it doesn't consider the social hierarchies and may lead to formal equality without substantive justice. • **Principled Distance Model:** Propounded by Rajeev Bhargava, this context-sensitive Indian model recognizes that the state may intervene in religious affairs to uphold constitutional morality and social reform: ✓ Example: State intervention in temple entry (e.g., Sabarimala case) ✓ **Article 17:** Abolition of untouchability ✓ **Article 15(2):** Prohibition of discrimination in public spaces, including religious institutions ✓ **Article 25(2):** State can regulate religious practices in the interest of public order, morality, and health ✓ This model allows flexibility while maintaining the constitutional commitment to social justice. • **Assertive or Positive Secularism:** Assertive secularism calls for active state intervention to uphold constitutional values, often involving reforms that clash with regressive religious practices: ✓ Example: The Triple Talaq (Shayara Bano Case) judgment and legislation ✓ Ban on cow slaughter in some states and regulation of religious conversions ✓ Article 21: Right to life with dignity, invoked in personal law reforms ✓ Critics argue that this model may be viewed as state overreach, risking politicization of religion. • **Contextual Pluralism / Accommodative Secularism:** India's secularism also accommodates minority-specific protections, highlighting the pluralistic ethos: ✓ **Article 29:** Protection of interests of cultural and linguistic minorities ✓ **Article 30:** Rights of minorities to establish and administer educational institutions ✓ **Special Personal Laws:** Muslim Personal Law (Shariat) Application Act, Hindu Marriage Act, etc. ✓ Such group-differentiated rights aim to ensure inclusiveness but are critiqued for encouraging legal pluralism and identity politics.
Conclusion	Indian secularism is an evolving and multifaceted model, rooted in constitutional morality. Unlike Western separationist secularism, India embraces "Sarva Dharma Sambhava", equal respect for all religions, balanced with the imperative of social justice. A nuanced application of different models based on constitutional provisions, social context, and judicial interpretations is vital to sustain the secular fabric in a deeply plural society.

Model Question	Critically examine the relationship between communalism and secularism in India. How can the state uphold secular values in a communally sensitive society?
Value Addition	India's diversity in religion and language is one of the primary factors which protects the secular character of the nation, ensuring its unity and integrity. But while religion and language are the two most crucial aspects of any culture, these are also the predominant cross-cultural barriers. This is clearly visible in recent communal tensions and the violence in Maharashtra.
25. Analyse the effectiveness of the implementation of the Directive Principles of State policy and suggest ways to improve it. (APPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Directive Principles of State policy
Keyword	Analyse and suggest
Approach	• Introduce by briefly explaining the concept, origin, and constitutional purpose of DPSPs as guiding principles for socio-economic governance. • Analyse the extent of their implementation with examples of initiatives, judicial interventions, challenges, and recent developments. • Conclude by emphasising the role of DPSPs in achieving constitutional goals of a welfare state and the need for stronger institutional commitment to their realisation.
Introduction	Directive Principles of State Policy (Articles 36–51) reflect the socio-economic philosophy of the Constitution, aiming to create a welfare state. While non-justiciable, they guide legislative, executive, and policy actions. Their partial realisation over the decades highlights both progress and persistent gaps in governance.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Effectiveness of implementation of Directive Principles of State policy:** • **Genuine Effort, Mixed Outcomes:** Many welfare and development programmes draw inspiration from DPSPs: ✓ Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 (Article 45) ✓ National Food Security Act, 2013 (Article 47: Nutrition and public health) ✓ Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), 2005 (Article 41: Right to work) ✓ Mid-Day Meal Scheme (Article 47: Nutrition) While these have improved human development indicators, implementation remains uneven due to capacity gaps and corruption. • **Structural & Institutional Constraints:** Challenges such as financial limitations, political short-termism, and non-binding nature hinder outcomes: ✓ **National Health Mission** (Article 47) suffers from underfunding, leading to unequal health outcomes. ✓ Housing for All (**PMAY**) (Article 39(b) – equitable distribution of resources) faces land acquisition bottlenecks and delays. • **Judicial Balancing Efforts:** The judiciary has upheld DPSP values while safeguarding Fundamental Rights: ✓ **Minerva Mills v. Union of India (1980)**: Declared FRs and DPSPs as complementary. ✓ **Unni Krishnan v. State of Andhra Pradesh (1993)**: Elevated right to education from a DPSP to a Fundamental Right. ✓ **Property Owners Association v. State of Maharashtra (2024)**: Balanced right to property with equitable resource distribution (Article 39(b) & (c)). • **Judicial Perspective and Vision:** ✓ Recent observations by CJI B. R. Gavai stress the *interdependence* of DPSPs and Fundamental Rights, urging legislative measures to bridge socio-economic inequalities.

	✓ The Supreme Court has also, through **PILs**, nudged the State to implement welfare-oriented policies such as environmental protection measures (*Article 48A*). **Suggestions for Strengthening Implementation of the Directive Principles of state policy:** • **Legal Enforcement:** Make select DPSPs enforceable by law through constitutional amendments. ✓ Example: *Right to Education Act* model for other DPSPs like right to health • **Judicial Role:** Broaden use of PILs to compel welfare compliance. ✓ Example: Supreme Court's directions in *PUCL v. Union of India* (2001) ensuring midday meals. • **Accountability & Oversight:** Annual DPSP Progress Reports by NITI Aayog linked to SDGs. ✓ Example**:** *Aspirational Districts Programme* aligning development with DPSPs. • **Public Awareness & Participation:** Grassroots legal literacy campaigns to demand welfare policies. ✓ Example: *Digital India* campaigns for service access.
Conclusion	DPSPs have driven transformative initiatives like MGNREGA, NFSA, RTE, and PMAY, but their impact is diluted by uneven execution, resource constraints, and lack of enforceability. Judicial interpretations have elevated many DPSP goals into enforceable rights, yet legislative and administrative reforms combined with citizen participation are essential to fully realise the Constitution's vision of social and economic justice.
Model Question	Critically analyse the Gandhian Principles under Part IV of the Constitution, citing their implementation in present-day governance.
Value Addition	There are certain Directive principles, based on the ideals advocated by Mahatma Gandhi. These Principles are as follows : • To organize village Panchayats. • To promote cottage industries in rural areas. • To prohibit intoxicating drinks and drugs that are injurious to health. • To preserve and improve the breeds of the cattle and prohibit slaughter of cows, calves and other milch and drought animals.
26. Discuss the right to legal aid and whether it is a Fundamental Right or a Directive principle of State policy. (TGPSC, 2016)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Directive Principles of State policy
Keyword	Discuss
Approach	• Introduce by mentioning legal aid and its constitutional placement under Article 39-A as a DPSP, while briefly noting its judicial recognition under Article 21. • Explain constitutional provisions, landmark judgments, statutory mechanisms (like the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987), institutional frameworks (NALSA, SLSAs), and discuss whether it is a Fundamental Right or a DPSP with supporting examples. • Conclude that judicial interpretation has made legal aid enforceable under Article 21, but its success depends on effective implementation and outreach.
Introduction	The right to legal aid ensures that justice is accessible to all, irrespective of economic means. While Article 39-A under Part IV (Directive Principles of State Policy) explicitly directs the State to provide free legal aid, the Supreme Court has, through its interpretation of Article 21 (Right to Life and Personal Liberty), elevated this right to that of a Fundamental Right in certain circumstances.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Constitutional & Statutory Foundations of the right to legal aid:** • **Article 39-A (DPSP):** ✓ Directs the State to provide free legal aid to ensure equal opportunity in securing justice.

	• **Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987:** ✓ Establishes a nationwide legal aid network including NALSA, State Legal Services Authorities, and local committees to operationalize Article 39-A. **Judicial Recognition under Article 21:** • In landmark cases such as Hussainara Khatoon v. State of Bihar and Suk Das v. Arunachal Pradesh, the Court emphasized that free legal aid is essential for ensuring a fair and reasonable legal process under Article 21. • Supreme Court recently underscored free legal assistance for the poor and indigent at the cost of the State is a fundamental right of a person under Article 21 of the Constitution even if the person does not seek legal assistance on their own. • In a recent judgment, the Calcutta High Court directed action against judicial officers who failed to provide legal aid to an accused, reaffirming the State's duty under Article 21. **Institutional Mechanisms & Outreach of the right to legal aid:** • **NALSA and Legal Services Bodies:** ✓ They provide free legal services, facilitate Lok Adalats, and conduct legal literacy and awareness campaigns. • **Tele-Law & Nyaya Bandhu:** ✓ Digital initiatives like Tele-Law (connecting marginalized groups via video-legal advice) and the Nyaya Bandhu pro bono platform extend legal aid to remote and vulnerable populations. **Contemporary Challenges & Innovations of the right to legal aid:** • **Access Gaps:** ✓ Despite structures in place, many disadvantaged individuals remain underserved due to inadequate resources, awareness, and implementation. ✓ Reports highlight that only a fraction of those needing aid actually receive it. • **Inclusive Initiatives:** ✓ Recent NALSA programs like the Veer Parivar Sahayata Yojana provide legal aid to defense personnel and their families, signaling policy expansion. • **Localized Outreach:** ✓ Interactive legal aid apps in local dialects (Eg: Bhojpuri) aim to ensure legal aid is accessible in regional languages, enhancing reach and comprehension.
Conclusion	While the right to legal aid is constitutionally enshrined as a Directive Principle under Article 39-A, the Supreme Court has, through expansive interpretation of Article 21, recognized it as a judicially enforceable Fundamental Right. This dual framework ensures that equality and access to justice are not mere ideals but realities safeguarded by law.
Model Question	"Directive Principles, though non-justiciable, are fundamental in the governance of the country." Discuss with reference to constitutional provisions and judicial interpretation.
Value Addition	The 42nd Constitutional Amendment, 1976 introduced certain changes in the part-IV of the Constitution by adding new directives like: • Article-39A – State to provide free legal aid to poor. • Article-43A – Participation of workers in management of Industries. • Article-48A – Directs the State to protect and improve environment. • The 44th Constitutional Amendment, 1978 inserted Section-2 to Article 38 which declares that; "The State in particular shall strive to minimise economic inequalities in income and eliminate inequalities in status, facilities and opportunities not amongst individuals but also amongst groups"

	• The 44th Constitutional amendment, 1978, eliminated, Right to property from the list of Fundamental Rights. It was considered as a hindrance in the path of implementing Directive Principles.
27. Analyse the concept and importance of Directive Principles of State Policy. Explain the relationship and difference between the Fundamental Rights and the Directive Principles. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Directive Principles of State policy
Keyword	Analyse, Explain
Approach	• Introduce by defining Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSPs) as guidelines in Part IV (Articles 36-51) that direct the State to ensure social and economic justice and establish a welfare state. • Analyse their importance in promoting equality, reducing inequalities, and guiding governance and policy formulation. • Explain the relationship and differences between DPSPs and Fundamental Rights with examples and key Supreme Court cases like Kesavananda Bharati and Minerva Mills. • Conclude by highlighting that harmony between both ensures the realization of the Constitution's vision of justice, liberty, equality, and fraternity.
Introduction	The Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSPs), enshrined in Part IV (Articles 36-51) of the Indian Constitution, provide guidelines to the State to establish a welfare state based on social, economic, and political justice. They complement the Fundamental Rights (FRs) by ensuring holistic democracy both political and socio-economic.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Concept of Directive Principles of State Policy:** • The framers borrowed the idea from the Irish Constitution, inspired by the Spanish model. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar described DPSPs as the "novel feature of the Constitution", and Granville Austin termed them the "Conscience of the Constitution", along with Fundamental Rights. • **Nature:** DPSPs are non-justiciable in nature (Article 37) but are fundamental in governance. They direct the State to promote welfare by securing a just social order. • **Objective:** To transform India from a police state to a welfare state, ensuring the realization of ideals like justice, equality, and fraternity stated in the Preamble. **Importance of Directive Principles of State Policy:** • **Foundation of Welfare State:** The DPSPs aim to transform India from a political democracy to a social and economic democracy by ensuring social justice, economic equality, and welfare of the people. • **Guiding Principles for Governance:** They act as moral and political guidelines for the legislature and executive while framing laws and policies to achieve the objectives laid down in the Preamble. • **Promote Social and Economic Justice:** DPSPs help in reducing inequalities in wealth, status, and opportunities, ensuring dignity and livelihood for all sections of society. • **Ensure Balanced Development:** They direct the state to promote equitable distribution of resources, protection of environment, and development of rural and weaker sections. • **Complement to Fundamental Rights:** While Fundamental Rights ensure individual liberty, DPSPs focus on community welfare. Together, they create a balance between individual freedom and social justice. **Relationship Between Fundamental Rights and DPSPs:** • Both FRs and DPSPs form the philosophical foundation of the Constitution. FRs guarantee individual liberty, while DPSPs ensure socio-economic justice. Together, they aim to create a just and egalitarian society.

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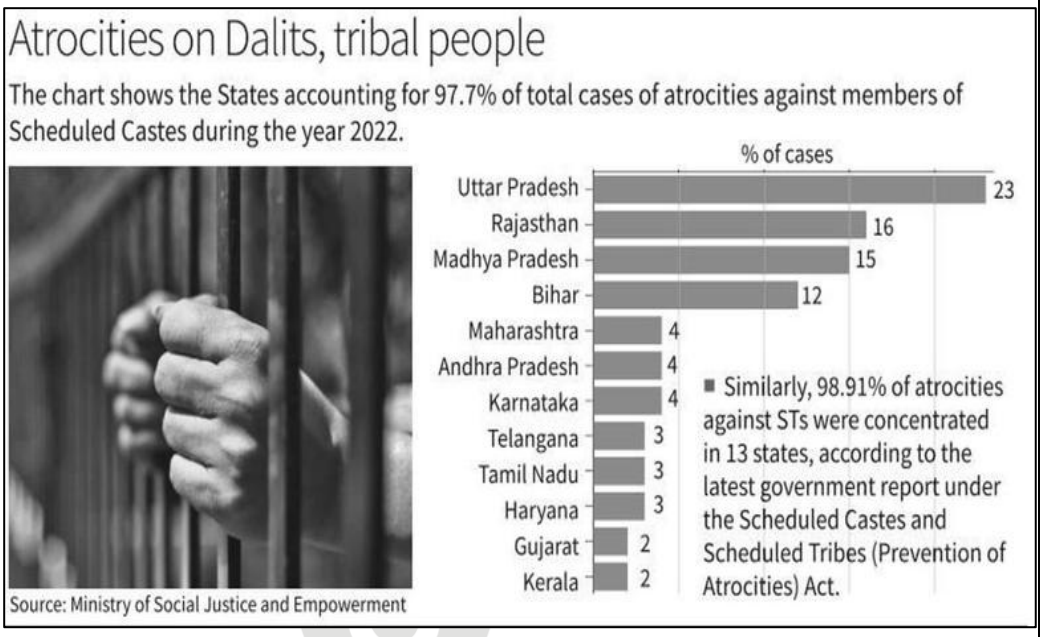
<tr><td></td><td>
✓ The Supreme Court in Kesavananda Bharati (1973) held that harmony between FRs and DPSPs is part of the basic structure of the Constitution.
✓ The Minerva Mills case (1980) reiterated that balance between Parts III and IV is essential for constitutional governance.
Differences Between Fundamental Rights and DPSPs:
<table>
<tr><th>Fundamental Rights</th><th>Directive Principles of State Policy</th></tr>
<tr><td>Legally enforceable (justiciable)</td><td>Non-justiciable but morally binding</td></tr>
<tr><td>Ensure political democracy</td><td>Aim at social & economic democracy</td></tr>
<tr><td>Negative in character-restrict State</td><td>Positive in character-direct State to act</td></tr>
<tr><td>Individual-centric</td><td>Community-centric</td></tr>
</table>
</td></tr>
<tr><td>Conclusion</td><td>Fundamental Rights and Directive Principles are complementary and supplementary. While FRs ensure freedom and equality, DPSPs aim to make these rights meaningful through social and economic reforms. Together, they embody the Constitution's vision of justice, ensuring both individual dignity and collective welfare in a democratic state.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Model Question</td><td>"Discuss how the Directive Principles of State Policy complement Fundamental Rights in achieving the goals of the Indian Constitution. Also examine the judicial interpretation of their relationship through landmark cases."</td></tr>
<tr><td>Value Addition</td><td>Directives Outside Part IV of Indian Constitution:
In addition to the Directives outlined in Part IV, several other Directive Principles are contained in the other parts of the Constitution. They are:
• Article 335 (Part XVI): Ensures that the claims of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in public service appointments are considered while maintaining administrative efficiency.
• Article 350-A (Part XVII): Directs states to provide primary education in the mother tongue for children of linguistic minorities.
• Article 351 (Part XVII): Mandates the Union to promote and develop Hindi as a medium reflecting India's composite culture.</td></tr>
<tr><td colspan="2">28. Trace the genesis and development of the Uniform Civil Code in India. Cite authoritative judgments on this issue. (APPSC 2011)</td></tr>
<tr><td>Syllabus</td><td>Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Directive Principles of State Policy</td></tr>
<tr><td>Keyword</td><td>Trace, Cite</td></tr>
<tr><td>Approach</td><td>
• Briefly define UCC and cite Article 44 (DPSP) as its constitutional basis.
• Trace historical origins, highlight key judicial pronouncements, and mention recent policy developments.
• Summarize its gradual progress and emphasize the need for consensus-based implementation balancing equality and diversity.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Introduction</td><td>The Uniform Civil Code (UCC) refers to a single body of secular civil laws governing marriage, divorce, maintenance, adoption, and succession for all citizens, irrespective of religion. It draws its constitutional basis from Article 44 of the Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP), which mandates that "The State shall endeavor to secure for the citizens a uniform civil code throughout the territory of India". While not enforceable by courts, Article 44 reflects the framers' vision of promoting national integration, equality, and gender justice.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Body & Infographic Representation</td><td>Constitutional Genesis of the Uniform Civil Code in India
• Originated as Article 35 in the Draft Constitution (1948) and adopted as Article 44 in 1950.
• Placed under DPSPs to signal its desirability while allowing for gradual implementation due to post-Partition socio-religious sensitivities.</td></tr>
</table>

	Judicial Development of the Uniform Civil Code • **Mohd. Ahmed Khan v. Shah Bano Begum (1985):** ✓ Upheld maintenance rights for a divorced Muslim woman under CrPC. ✓ Urged the State to implement UCC to promote gender equality and national integration. • **Sarla Mudgal v. Union of India (1995):** ✓ Prevented misuse of conversion to commit bigamy. ✓ Reaffirmed the need for UCC to harmonize personal laws. • **Pannalal Bansilal Pitti v. State of A.P. (1996):** ✓ Supported UCC in principle but stressed gradual, consultative reform. • **John Vallamattom v. Union of India (2003):** ✓ Struck down discriminatory provisions in Christian succession law; referred to Article 44 as an instrument for uniformity. • **Jose Paulo Coutinho v. Union of India (2019):** ✓ Praised Goa's uniform family law as a "shining example" of UCC in practice. **Policy and Recent Developments in the Uniform Civil Code** • Goa continues with Portuguese-origin family laws functioning as a de facto UCC. • Uttarakhand UCC (2024): First state to enact a comprehensive UCC covering marriage, divorce, succession, and live-in relationships; currently under judicial review for implementation.
Conclusion	The evolution of UCC in India reflects a gradualist, case-led, and state-specific approach—balancing constitutional ideals of equality with social pluralism. While the Supreme Court has repeatedly nudged the legislature, the path forward hinges on consensus-building and phased reforms, as seen in Goa and Uttarakhand, before a nationwide UCC becomes a reality.
Model Question	"Discuss the constitutional basis, judicial interpretation, and recent state-level initiatives related to the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) in India. In your answer, critically examine its implications for gender justice, secularism, and social harmony in a pluralistic society."
Value Addition	The Law Commission of India (2018) opined that a nationwide UCC is neither necessary nor desirable at present, advocating instead for reform within personal laws to ensure gender justice—reflecting a pragmatic, incremental path aligned with India's pluralistic social fabric.
29. Analyse the aims and objectives of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989. Explain whether such objectives have been achieved. (APPSC, 2012)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Civil and Criminal laws
Keyword	Analyse, Explain
Approach	• Begin by introducing the Act as a social justice legislation to prevent atrocities and discrimination against SCs and STs. • Explain its key aims protection, speedy justice, rehabilitation, and empowerment. • Analyse the extent of achievement improved awareness and legal deterrence but challenges like low conviction rates and poor implementation. • Conclude by stressing stronger enforcement and social change for real equality.
Introduction	The Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 was enacted to protect the most vulnerable communities from caste-based violence, humiliation, and discrimination. It seeks to ensure social justice, equality, and dignity for SCs and STs by punishing atrocities and promoting their rehabilitation and empowerment.
Body & Infographic Representation	**Aims and Objectives of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989:**

	The Act aims to protect members of SC and ST communities from atrocities committed by others and to uphold their constitutional rights under Articles 15, 17, and 46. • **Preventing Atrocities:** To identify and punish offences like social boycott, land grabbing, sexual abuse, and economic exploitation that threaten the dignity of SC/ST persons. • **Speedy Justice:** To establish Special Courts and Exclusive Special Courts for prompt trial of cases and to ensure victims' access to justice. • **Victim Relief and Rehabilitation:** To provide immediate compensation, legal aid, and rehabilitation for victims and their families through district authorities. • **Administrative Accountability:** To hold public servants accountable if they neglect duties under the Act, promoting effective enforcement. • **Empowerment and Integration:** To promote equality by enabling SC/ST communities to participate fully in social, economic, and political life. **Implementation and Achievements:** • The objectives of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 have been partially achieved. The Act has strengthened the legal framework against caste-based atrocities and increased awareness about rights among marginalized groups. • It has provided institutional mechanisms, such as Special Courts, Exclusive Special Courts, and SC/ST Protection Cells, ensuring victims receive some degree of protection and support. • However, the effectiveness of the Act remains limited by ground-level challenges. Low conviction rates, delays in investigation, and poor implementation in many states dilute its impact. • According to NCRB data, conviction rates hover around 30–35%, revealing systemic weaknesses in the judicial process. • Further, social stigma, fear of retaliation, and political interference discourage victims from filing complaints. The 2018 Amendment, which restored immediate arrest powers and expanded the definition of atrocities, has strengthened the law's intent, yet enforcement remains uneven. • Thus, while the Act has advanced legal protection and public awareness, achieving substantive social equality still requires attitudinal change, efficient implementation, and community empowerment. **Challenges persist:** • Low conviction rates (around 32.4% in 2022) reflect weak investigation and prosecution. • Delayed trials due to shortage of courts and staff hinder justice. • Fear, social stigma, and lack of awareness prevent victims from reporting crimes. • Bias among local officials and police often leads to poor implementation. • In some cases, misuse of provisions has also been reported, affecting genuine grievances.
Conclusion	The SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 remains a vital safeguard for ensuring equality and dignity. While its aims of protection and empowerment are partially achieved, consistent implementation, institutional accountability, awareness, and social reform are essential to truly eliminate caste-based discrimination and violence.
Model Question	"Despite the existence of stringent laws like the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, instances of caste-based discrimination and violence continue in India." Discuss the reasons for this persistence and suggest measures to strengthen the effectiveness of such laws.

Value Addition	**Key Findings on Atrocities Against SCs and STs (2022):** • Cases Registered: 51,656 cases against SCs and 9,735 against STs; 97–99% of cases concentrated in 13 states. • States with Highest Incidents: ✓ SCs: Uttar Pradesh (23.78%), Rajasthan (16.75%), Madhya Pradesh (14.97%), Bihar (13.16%), Odisha (6.93%), Maharashtra (5.24%). ✓ STs: Madhya Pradesh (30.61%), Rajasthan (25.66%), Odisha (7.94%), Maharashtra (7.10%), Andhra Pradesh (5.13%).



	• Investigations and Charge Sheets: Charge sheets filed in ~60–63% of cases; 14–15% concluded with final reports. Many cases still under investigation (17,166 SC; 2,702 ST). • Conviction Rate: Declined from 39.2% in 2020 to 32.4% in 2022. • Infrastructure Gaps: Only 194 of 498 districts have special courts; atrocity-prone areas not adequately identified. • Protection Measures: SC/ST protection cells exist in several states and union territories to oversee implementation and support victims.

30. What do you understand by cyberstalking? What are the various other cyber offences recognised under Information Technology Act, 2000? (APPSC, 2025)

Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Cyber Crime
Keyword	What
Approach	• Begin with a clear definition of cybercrime and introduce cyberstalking as a growing digital threat. • Explain what cyberstalking involves and present legal provisions briefly, highlighting IPC Section 354D and relevant IT Act sections in a tabular or infographic form. Discuss its impact on victims and society. • Conclude by stressing the need for legal enforcement, awareness, and safe digital practices.
Introduction	Cybercrime refers to offences involving the use of computers, networks, or digital devices to harass, cheat, threaten, or defraud others. One such significant offence is cyberstalking, which has become a major concern in India, especially among youth and women.

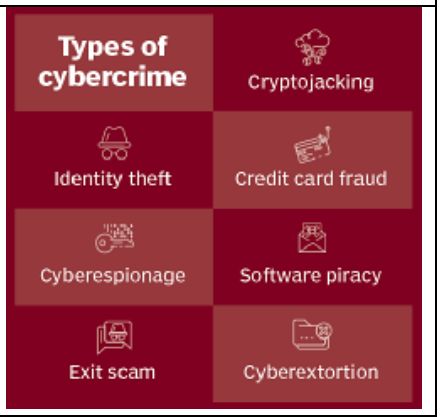
Body & Infographic Representation

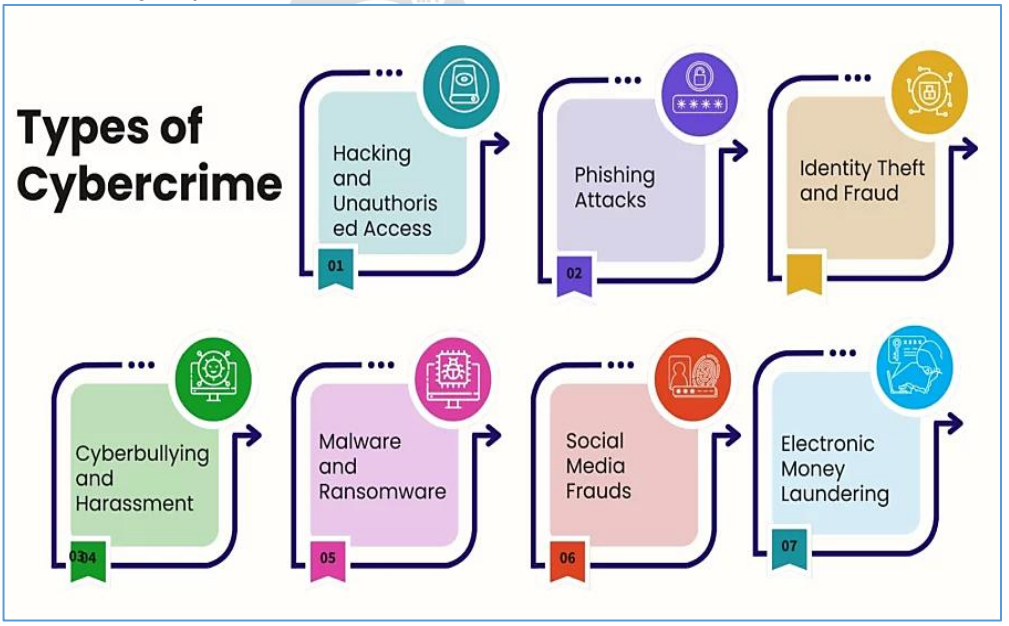
What is Cyberstalking?

- Cyberstalking is the use of the internet or other electronic means to persistently follow, harass, or intimidate an individual, group, or organization. It is characterized by a "course of conduct" involving repeated actions that cause alarm, distress, or a threat of violence in the victim's mind.
- **Key aspects of cyberstalking include:**
  - ✓ **Unsolicited contact online:** This involves sending persistent messages, emails, or making repeated phone calls despite the victim clearly indicating their disinterest.
  - ✓ **Monitoring Online Activity:** Perpetrators may track a victim's use of the internet, e-mail, or social media, sometimes using spyware or GPS tracking.
  - ✓ **Publication of Private Information (Doxxing):** Sharing personal details like home addresses, phone numbers, or private images without consent, often to humiliate or put the victim at risk.
  - ✓ **Threats and False Accusations:** This can involve explicit threats of physical or sexual violence, as well as spreading false, defamatory information about the victim.

- In India, while the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000 does not have a single dedicated section for cyberstalking, it is addressed through various provisions in the IT Act and the Indian Penal Code (IPC), specifically Section 354D of the IPC which specifically criminalizes stalking (including its digital form) against a woman.

Type of Cyber Offence	Relevant Section (IT Act, 2000)	Description
Hacking and Unauthorized Access	Section 66	Intentional access to data without permission causing harm or theft.
Identity Theft	Section 66C	Fraudulently using another person's electronic signature, password, or identification data.
Cheating by Personation (Online Impersonation)	Section 66D	Impersonating another person through digital platforms to cheat or deceive.
Violation of Privacy	Section 66E	Capturing, publishing, or transmitting images of private areas without consent.

	Obscene or Sexually Explicit Content Publication	Sections 67, 67A, 67B	Publishing or distributing obscene, sexually explicit, or child sexual abuse content online.
	Cyber Terrorism	Section 66F	Any act that threatens the unity, integrity, security, or sovereignty of India through computer resources.
	Tampering with Computer Source Code	Section 65	Altering or destroying computer source code, which is legally required to be maintained.
	Damage to Computer Systems/Data	Section 43	Unauthorized access leading to deletion, alteration, or extraction of data.
Conclusion	Cyberstalking and other cyber offences represent serious threats in the digital age, affecting privacy, safety, and individual freedom. The Information Technology Act, 2000, combined with relevant amendments to the Indian Penal Code, provides a legal framework to deter and punish offenders. However, stronger enforcement, digital awareness, and responsible online behavior are crucial to creating a safe cyberspace for all.		
Model Question	What is a cybercrime. Write a note on with any two types of cybercrime.		
Value Addition	**What is a cybercrime?** • Cybercrime is any illegal activity using a computer, the internet, or a network device to commit or assist in a crime, such as fraud, identity theft, and malware attacks. • Two common types are phishing, which uses fake emails or messages to trick people into revealing personal information, and identity theft, which is when a criminal steals personal data to impersonate someone for financial gain.		
31. Explain the different types of cybercrimes and the importance of cyber laws in India. (APPSC, 2020)			
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Cyber Crime		
Keyword	Explain		
Approach	• Begin by introducing the rise of digital technology and how it has enabled cybercrimes. Define cybercrime briefly. • Then explain its forms such as cyberbullying, stalking, phishing, vishing and ransomware with short examples. Discuss the importance of cyber laws in protecting individuals, preventing financial fraud, securing data, and safeguarding national security. • Conclude by emphasizing the need for stronger legal systems, awareness, and cybersecurity measures to ensure a safe digital environment.		
Introduction	The rapid expansion of the internet, digital payments, and online communication has created new avenues for growth and convenience. However, it has also led to the rise of cybercrimes, which involve illegal activities conducted using computers, networks, or digital devices. To handle these threats, cyber laws have become essential in protecting individuals, businesses, and national security in India.		

Body & Infographic Representation	**Cybercrime:** Cybercrime refers to criminal activities that use computers or the internet as a tool, target, or place of crime. These acts can harm individuals, organizations, and government systems. **Different Types of Cybercrimes:** • **Cyber bullying:** ✓ Harassing, humiliating or intimidating someone using digital means such as social media, messaging apps or online forums. This includes repeated offensive messages, sharing humiliating images, creating fake profiles to bully someone, etc. • **Cyber stalking:** ✓ Cyber stalking is the use of electronic communication by a person to follow a person, or attempts to contact a person to foster personal interaction repeatedly despite a clear indication of disinterest by such person; or monitors the internet, email or any other form of electronic communication commits the offence of stalking. • **Smshing:** ✓ Smishing is a type of fraud that uses mobile phone text messages to lure victims into calling back on a fraudulent phone number, visiting fraudulent websites or downloading malicious content via phone or web. • **Vishing:** ✓ Vishing is an attempt where fraudsters try to seek personal information like Customer ID, Net Banking password, ATM PIN, OTP, Card expiry date, CVV etc. through a phone call.  • **Ransomware:** ✓ Ransomware is a type of computer malware that encrypts the files, storage media on communication devices like desktops, Laptops, Mobile phones etc., holding data/information as a hostage. The victim is asked to pay the demanded ransom to get his device decrypts. **Importance of Cyber Laws in India:** • **Protection of Individuals:**

	✓ Cyber laws safeguard citizens from online frauds, harassment, privacy invasion, and financial losses. These laws ensure that digital platforms remain safe for communication and transactions. • **Preventing Financial Loss and Data Theft:** ✓ In a digital economy, data is an asset. Laws prevent unauthorized access, data theft, and secure digital payments. For example, RBI guidelines for online banking safety strengthen trust. • **Ensuring National Security:** ✓ Cyber laws help track and punish hacking attempts, cyber espionage, and attacks on critical infrastructure like telecom and banking systems. • **Legal Framework for Digital Transactions:** ✓ The Information Technology Act, 2000, provides legal recognition to electronic communications, digital signatures, and e-commerce, ensuring secure online trade.
Conclusion	Cybercrimes are increasing with greater internet use, making cyber laws crucial for protecting individuals, organizations, and national security. India must continue strengthening its legal framework, spreading awareness, and developing advanced cybersecurity systems to create a safe digital environment.
Model Question	Examine the role of Information Technology (Amendment) Act, 2008 in addressing cyber terrorism. How effective is it in dealing with modern cyber threats?
Value Addition	**Key Provisions of Cyber Laws in India** • Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000: Main law preventing unauthorized access, hacking, identity theft, and online fraud. • IT (Amendment) Act, 2008: Strengthened cybersecurity against cyber terrorism and data breaches. • Sections 66C & 66D: Punish identity theft and online cheating.
32. What is GST? Discuss the regulatory framework of GST in India, including Constitutional provisions applicable to GST. (APPSC, 2025)	
Syllabus	Paper III: Section C: Basic Knowledge of Laws in India: Cyber Crime**:** Tax Laws-GST
Keyword	What, Discuss
Approach	• Begin with a brief introduction explaining GST as a unified indirect tax reform replacing multiple taxes. • In the body, explain the key features such as destination-based taxation, and the dual GST model. Then discuss the regulatory framework, including the role of the GST Council, and relevant constitutional provisions under the 101st Amendment. • Conclude by highlighting GST's significance, achievements, and persisting challenges.
Introduction	The Goods and Services Tax (GST) is a comprehensive, destination-based indirect tax system implemented in India on 1st July 2017. It replaced multiple indirect taxes such as excise duty, service tax, VAT, and octroi, thereby simplifying the tax structure and promoting the idea of "One Nation, One Tax, One Market."
Body & Infographic Representation	**Key characteristics of GST:** • **Destination-based:** The tax revenue accrues to the state where the goods or services are finally consumed, not the state where they were produced. • **Cascading effect elimination:** It allows for a seamless flow of Input Tax Credit (ITC), meaning businesses can claim credit for taxes paid on inputs. This prevents the "tax on tax" effect, ultimately reducing the final cost for the consumer.

	• **Dual Model:** India adopted a dual GST model, meaning both the Central and State governments levy tax on a supply of goods or services. **Regulatory Framework of GST in India:** • **Types of GST:** ✓ Based on the dual model, GST is categorized into four types: Central GST (CGST) and State GST (SGST) or Union Territory GST (UTGST) are levied by the Central and State/UT governments respectively on intra-state supplies. Integrated GST (IGST) is levied by the Central Government on inter-state supplies and imports. • **Governing Body: The GST Council** ✓ The GST Council, a constitutional body, is crucial for governing GST. Chaired by the Union Finance Minister and comprising state finance ministers, it makes recommendations on various GST aspects like tax rates and exemptions. Decisions are made by a three-fourths majority vote, reflecting cooperative federalism. • **Constitutional Provisions Applicable to GST:** ✓ The implementation of GST was facilitated by the Constitution under 101st Amendment Act, 2016. ✓ **Article 246A:** Grants Parliament and State Legislatures concurrent power to legislate on GST, with Parliament having exclusive power over inter-state trade (IGST). ✓ **Article 269A:** Addresses the levy and collection of IGST on inter-state supplies and imports by the Central Government and its apportionment between the Union and States based on the GST Council's recommendations. ✓ **Article 279A:** Provides for the constitution, composition, functions, and decision-making process of the GST Council. ✓ **Article 366 (12A):** Defines "Goods and Services Tax" as a tax on the supply of goods or services, excluding alcoholic liquor for human consumption. • **Seventh Schedule:** Amendments were made to align taxation powers with the new GST regime.
Conclusion	GST represents a major milestone in India's fiscal history, strengthening cooperative federalism through a common, transparent, and simplified tax regime. While challenges remain in compliance and rate rationalization, ongoing reforms continue to refine GST into a more efficient and growth-oriented taxation framework.
Model Question	Write in brief about Wealth Tax and Corporate Tax.
Value Addition	**GST Reforms 2025: Relief for Common Man, Boost for Businesses** • GST simplified to a two-slab structure (5% & 18%) • GST reforms cut taxes on household essentials (soaps, toothpaste, and Indian breads) to 5% or Nil boosting affordability. • Life-saving drugs, medicines reduced from 12% to Nil or 5% making healthcare affordable • Two-wheelers, small cars, TVs, ACs, cement cut from 28% to 18% bringing relief to • middle-class. • Farm machinery, irrigation equipment cut from 12% to 5%, reducing farming costs • Tobacco, pan masala, aerated drinks, and luxury goods taxed at 40%.

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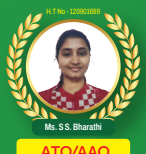

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